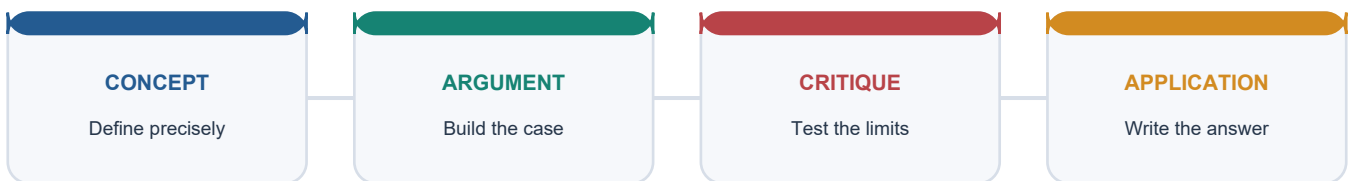


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Existentialism - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 18 teaching sessions, 32 diagnostics, 14 solved PYQs, 6 original Mains models and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Existentialism - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: *Existentialism (Kierkegaard, Sartre, Heidegger): Existence and Essence; Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence; Being-in-the-world and Temporality* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 10. Three printed thinkers and three printed limbs. □ The paper prints "**Sarte**"; the philosopher is **Jean-Paul Sartre**, and the misprint is preserved only inside a verbatim quotation of the syllabus. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks doctrine on which the standard sources converge, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction for exam use, and CAUTION: marks a live scholarly dispute or a contested attribution. *Being and Time* is cited by **Section number**, which is stable across the Macquarrie and Robinson (1962) and Stambaugh (1996, revised Schmidt 2010) translations even though their wording differs. Kierkegaard's pseudonymous books are cited **by pseudonym**, following the request he printed in the "First and Last Declaration" appended to the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846). Model answers below are independent learner practice and are **never** official UPSC keys: UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper I. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the Danish, German or French term follows immediately in parentheses - *the single individual (den Enkelte)*, *anxiety or dread (Angest / Angst)*, *the leap (Springet)*, *the moment (Øjeblikket)*, *indirect communication (indirekte Meddelelse)*, *being-there (Dasein)*, *being-in-the-world (In-der-Welt-sein)*, *ready-to-hand (Zuhandenheit)*, *present-at-hand (Vorhandenheit)*, *thrownness (Geworfenheit)*, *care (Sorge)*, *the "they" (das Man)*, *idle talk (Gerede)*, *falling (Verfallen)*, *authenticity (Eigentlichkeit)*, *being-toward-death (Sein-zum-Tode)*, *anticipatory resoluteness (vorlaufende Entschlossenheit)*, *temporality (Zeitlichkeit)*, *historicality (Geschichtlichkeit)*, *being-in-itself (en-soi)*, *being-for-itself (pour-soi)*, *being-for-others (l'être-pour-autrui)*, *nihilation (neantisation)*, *nothingness (neant)*, *bad faith (mauvaise foi)*, *facticity (facticité)*, *the Look (le regard)*, *anguish (angoisse)*, *abandonment (délaissement)*, *despair (désespoir)*. A source word may sharpen an English explanation; it may never replace one.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	18
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	14
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	18 (A-R)
ASCII master flow panels authored	53

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SOURCE TERM IMMEDIATELY AFTER

THE ONE MOVE THIS CLAUSE MAKES
 STOP ASKING WHAT A HUMAN BEING IS IN GENERAL AND ASK HOW THIS
 FINITE, SITUATED, DYING INDIVIDUAL HAS TO TAKE UP AN EXISTENCE THAT
 WAS NEVER HANDED OVER READY-MADE. THE HUMAN BEING IS NOT ONE MORE
 OBJECT WITH A NATURE; IT IS THE ONE ENTITY FOR WHICH ITS OWN BEING
 IS A QUESTION IT CANNOT REFUSE TO ANSWER.

THE WARNING THAT MUST COME FIRST
 'EXISTENTIALISM' IS A RETROSPECTIVE FAMILY LABEL, NOT A SCHOOL.
 KIERKEGAARD IS A CHRISTIAN WHO DIED IN 1855 AND NEVER HEARD THE
 WORD. HEIDEGGER PUBLICLY DENIED THAT HE WAS AN EXISTENTIALIST.
 ONLY SARTRE ACCEPTED THE LABEL AND DEFINED IT.

THE THREE PRINTED LIMBS
1 EXISTENCE AND ESSENCE
2 CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE
3 BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND TEMPORALITY

KIERKEGAARD 1813-55	SARTRE 1905-80	HEIDEGGER 1889-1976
THEISTIC	ATHEISTIC	ONTOLOGICAL
THE SINGLE INDIVIDUAL (den Enkelte)	BEING-FOR-ITSELF (pour-soi)	DASEIN = BEING-THERE the entity for whom BEING IS AT ISSUE
TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY = the HOW of appropriation, NOT 'anything goes'	EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE = no divine artisan, so no blueprint	BEING-IN-THE-WORLD (In-der-Welt-sein) ONE hyphenated structure, NOT subject + world
THREE SPHERES aesthetic -> ethical -> religious, joined by THE LEAP (Springet) , not by mediation	NIHILATION (neantisation) makes consciousness NEVER SELF-IDENTICAL	READY-TO-HAND (Zuhandenheit) is PRIMARY; PRESENT-AT- HAND (Vorhandenheit)
ANXIETY (Angest) = 'the dizziness of freedom'	vs TRANSCENDENCE BAD FAITH (mauvaise foi) = collapsing into ONE dimension	is DERIVATIVE CARE (Sorge) = AHEAD-OF-ITSELF / ALREADY-IN / ALONGSIDE
DESPAIR = misrelation in the self's relation to itself	THE LOOK (le regard) gives me an OUTSIDE I did not choose	THE 'THEY' (das Man) FALLING (Verfallen) BEING-TOWARD-DEATH (Sein-zum-Tode) -> ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS
INDIRECT COMMUNICATION and PSEUDONYMITY are the METHOD, not a disguise	CONFLICT is the original meaning of being-for-others	

THE STRUCTURE THAT RUNS THROUGH ALL THREE: ANXIETY IS NOT FEAR
 FEAR has a DETERMINATE object inside the world - a dog, an exam.
 ANXIETY / DREAD / ANGUISH has NO object: Kierkegaard says its object
 'is a nothing'. What it discloses is therefore not an ENTITY but a
 STRUCTURE - POSSIBILITY and freedom (Kierkegaard), MY OWN FREEDOM
 (Sartre), BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AS SUCH (Heidegger).

THE THREE ANSWERS TO 'WHAT IS AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE?'
 KIERKEGAARD faith - standing as a single individual before God,
 reached by a LEAP that reason cannot mediate
 SARTRE no positive doctrine of authenticity in Being and
 Nothingness; what he gives is the CRITIQUE of its
 opposite, BAD FAITH
 HEIDEGGER OWNING one's thrown projection - a FORMAL modification
 of everydayness. NOT a moral virtue. NOT a programme.

THE THREE ANSWERS TO 'WHAT IS FREEDOM?'
 KIERKEGAARD qualitative choice inside a finite God-relation
 SARTRE what the for-itself IS, not what it has - inescapable,
 but exercised only in SITUATION

HEIDEGGER THROWN PROJECTION upon possibilities - never voluntarism
 |
 TIME IS NOT A LINE OF NOWS
 HEIDEGGER PRIMORDIAL TEMPORALITY (Zeitlichkeit) = three ECSTASES,
 FUTURE (Zukunft) / HAVING-BEEN (Gewesenheit) / PRESENT
 (Gegenwart), matching the three limbs of CARE. THE FUTURE HAS
 PRIORITY. Ordinary clock-time is DERIVED, not false.
 SARTRE the for-itself is ecstatic too, but temporality is read
 off FREEDOM and the project, not off Being
 KIERKEGAARD THE MOMENT (Øjeblikket) - the eternal touching time
 |
 WHAT IS NOT OWNED HERE
 HUSSERL'S SUSPENSION, REDUCTION, ESSENCES,
 ANTI-PSYCHOLOGISM as DOCTRINE Topic 09, Phenomenology
 HEGEL'S SYSTEM, DIALECTIC, ABSOLUTE SPIRIT
 as DOCTRINE Topic 05, Hegel
 DESCARTES' COGITO AND DUALISM as DOCTRINE .. Topic 02, Rationalism
 KANT ON FREEDOM, THE ANTIMOMIES Topic 04
 NIETZSCHE - nihilism, will to power,
 eternal recurrence, the overhuman NOT A PRINTED THINKER
 CAMUS, JASPERS, MARCEL, DE BEAUVOIR optional comparison only
 EXISTENTIALIST THEOLOGY, DEATH AND
 IMMORTALITY Paper II

Concept spine: read it downward. One move, one warning, three printed limbs, three non-identical projects, one shared mood-structure, three answers to each of the two questions the clause actually asks - and a fence around what belongs to other clauses.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the three thinkers, "F-F-F"**. Kierkegaard = Faith; Sartre = Freedom; Heidegger = Finitude. Three thinkers, three destinations, one shared refusal to define a person by a general essence. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the three printed limbs, "E-C-B"**. Existence and essence -> Choice, responsibility and authentic existence -> Being-in-the-world and temporality. Limb 1 removes the blueprint, limb 2 asks what a person must do once the blueprint is gone, and limb 3 is Heidegger's refusal to let limbs 1 and 2 be answered by a subject standing over against a world. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - care, "A-A-A"**. Ahead-of-itself, Already-in, Alongside. Three limbs of *Sorge* (*Being and Time* Section 41), which map exactly onto the three ecstases of temporality - future, having-been, present (Section 65). Learn the two lists together and the hardest twenty-marker in the clause becomes one diagram. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - bad faith, "F-or-T"**. Bad faith collapses a person into Facticity alone or into Transcendence alone. Neither dimension is denied by Sartre; what is denied is the *tension*. A script that defines bad faith merely as "lying to yourself" has not stated the doctrine at all. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - what anxiety is not, "no object"**. Fear has an object; anxiety has none, which is exactly why it discloses a structure rather than a thing. This one line, written early, separates a prepared script from a paraphrase in every question on dread, anguish or *Angst*. MEMORY: **Mnemonic - the slogan's owner, "S-only"**. "Existence precedes essence" is Sartre's, from the **1945** lecture published in **1946**. Heidegger repudiated it in the "Letter on Humanism" (written 1946, published 1947); Kierkegaard died in 1855 and never wrote it. Attributing the slogan to all three is the single commonest way to lose marks on this clause.

ANSWER-WORTHINESS - WHAT EARNS MARKS AND WHAT DOES NOT

Classification	Content
CORE MAINS	The family-label warning and the exact ownership of the slogan; existence precedes essence with the paper-knife (<i>coupe-papier</i>) analogy, atheism as a premise, and the 1945/1946 provenance; Heidegger's repudiation of the slogan and the "essence of Dasein lies in its existence" (<i>Being and Time</i> Section 9); Kierkegaard's existing individual against Hegel's system, "truth is subjectivity" attributed to Johannes Climacus, and its distinction from relativism; the three spheres of existence with their limits and the leap (<i>Springet</i>); the teleological suspension of the ethical as staged by Johannes de Silentio; anxiety (<i>Angest</i>) as "the dizziness of freedom" from Vigilius Haufniensis, and despair as a misrelation from Anti-Climacus; Sartre's being-in-itself and being-for-itself with the two formulas, nihilation (<i>neantisation</i>) and the impossible <i>pour-soi-en-soi</i>; radical but situated freedom, "condemned to be free", non-choice as choice, and anguish, abandonment and despair; facticity and transcendence and bad faith with the waiter and the woman on the date, plus the self-deception paradox and its pre-reflective solution; freedom and determinism, motive-constitution and the qualified "no excuses"; being-for-others and the Look (<i>le regard</i>) with the keyhole, shame, conflict, and the corrected reading of "hell is other people"; Heidegger's Being-question and ontological difference; being-in-the-world as one unitary structure and his rejection of the transcendental ego; worldhood, ready-to-hand and present-at-hand, the referential totality and breakdown; the three existentialia and disclosedness; care (<i>Sorge</i>) and its three limbs; the "they" (<i>das Man</i>) with idle talk, curiosity and ambiguity, and falling; the call of conscience and being-toward-death with its four characters, ending in anticipatory resoluteness; authenticity as a non-moral existential modification; temporality with the three ecstases, the priority of the future, and primordial against ordinary time; the fear/anxiety distinction across all three thinkers; and all fourteen routed 2018-2025 question-parts
CORE SUPPORTING	Indirect communication (<i>indirekte Meddelelse</i>) and pseudonymity - promoted out of optional status on 15 August 2026 and now marks-essential for any question on subjectivity or the critique of Hegel - including the pseudonym table, the double authorship and the "First and Last Declaration"; the knight of faith against the knight of infinite resignation; historicality (<i>Geschichtlichkeit</i>); the dialectic of concrete relations with the Other - love, language and masochism against indifference, desire, sadism and hate; the four accounts of the Other across Husserl, Heidegger, Sartre and Levinas; the provenance rail, because three languages, three translation traditions and one unfinished book make dating and attribution directly examinable
SUPPORTING	Sartre's <i>Critique of Dialectical Reason</i> (1960) for scarcity, seriality, the practico-inert and the group-in-fusion, used to show that the strongest objection to early Sartre landed; de Beauvoir and Fanon for one constraint objection; Levinas for one ethical counter to both Sartre and Heidegger; Arendt on natality against mortality; Adorno's "jargon of authenticity" charge; Heidegger's turn (<i>Kehre</i>) and the unwritten Division III; Merleau-Ponty on structural constraint; the Nothing (<i>das Nichts</i>) of "What is Metaphysics?" (1929) only as the point where this clause touches Topic 07
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	How far a pseudonym's thesis may be treated as Kierkegaard's own, and whether the method leaves him any assertible doctrine at all; whether Sartrean freedom is fundamentally solitary or always exposed through the Other, and whether the conflictual social ontology admits a reciprocity reading; whether Heideggerian authenticity is heroic decisionism, a formally thin owning of finitude, or a doctrine permanently shadowed by 1933
NOT OWNED HERE	Husserl's suspension (<i>epoche</i>), reduction, theory of essences and avoidance of psychologism as doctrine (Topic 09 - they enter here only as the method Heidegger redirects and the position Sartre inherits); Hegel's dialectic, Absolute Spirit and system as doctrine (Topic 05 - Hegel is the target Kierkegaard needs, not a topic to expound); Descartes' methodic doubt, the <i>cogito</i> and dualism as doctrine (Topic 02 - Descartes is what being-in-the-world is designed to dissolve); Kant's antinomies and his own account of freedom (Topic 04 - Sartre's universalisability is quasi-Kantian and is stated in one clause); Nietzsche entirely, since he is not a printed thinker here; Camus's absurd, Jaspers's boundary situations, Marcel's mystery and de Beauvoir's ethics of ambiguity as systems rather than as bounded comparisons; existentialist theology, faith and revelation, and death and immortality (Paper II)

ANALYSIS: **Ownership boundary, stated once.** This clause owns **14 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus - **joint-highest** with Rationalism and with Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - and it owns **at least one part in every one of the eight years**. Three consequences follow, and all three are visible in the first paragraph of a script. First, **no thinker is optional**: Sartre carries eight parts, Kierkegaard four and Heidegger three, and 2024 Q4(a) requires all three in one answer, so a candidate who prepares "the existentialists" as a single doctrine has prepared the one thing the paper repeatedly punishes. Second, **the paper tests attribution as often as it tests doctrine** - 2024 Q4(a) asks what "the existentialist thinkers" mean by a slogan that belongs to exactly one of them, and 2018 Q4(a) opens with a term (*epoché*) that belongs to Husserl before turning to Heidegger's rejection of it. Third, **statement-based framing dominates**: 2020 Q4(a), 2021 Q4(b) and 2023 Q3(c) each hand you a sentence and require you to locate it inside its own author's system before unpacking it, which means the technical pair each sentence turns on must be reproducible on demand.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

Every subtopic below runs in the same order, so the shape becomes automatic:

Step	What it gives you
DEFINITION	plain-language definition, then the technical one
ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING	a sentence you can adapt directly as an introduction or a conclusion
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS	the terms that signal control of the topic
Plain-language visual	the idea before the vocabulary
VISUAL: VISUAL	the diagram that carries the argument
Numbered teaching	the doctrine, point by point, with work, Section number and date
HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH	claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification, written out for this subtopic
Exam link	which routed PYQ this subtopic answers, and how
UPSC traps	the specific ways candidates lose marks here
Revision notes	the compressed recall list
CLOSING RECALL FLOW	the subtopic reduced to one flow you can redraw from memory

Complete the Basic block first. Interpretive depth - how far a pseudonym speaks for Kierkegaard, whether Sartrean freedom is solitary, and whether Heideggerian authenticity is decisionism - is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections. Nothing in that block is needed to write a complete answer to any of the fourteen routed questions.

ORIGIN AND CHRONOLOGY - THE MINIMUM NEEDED TO AVOID ANACHRONISM

ANALYSIS: This clause has an unusual hazard: **three languages, three translation traditions, one unfinished masterwork, one popular lecture its author later regretted, and an author who asked in print not to be quoted under his own name**. The rail below prevents the seven commonest anachronisms - treating "existentialism" as a movement Kierkegaard joined; sourcing "condemned to be free" to *Being and Nothingness*; calling *Being and Time* a completed system; quoting "leap of faith" as Kierkegaard's phrase; writing "Kierkegaard says in *Fear and Trembling*" when the book is signed by a pseudonym; dating the "Letter on Humanism" to the 1930s; and treating the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* as if it were the doctrine of 1943.

1813 Søren Kierkegaard born, Copenhagen
 1841 Kierkegaard's dissertation, On the Concept of Irony
 1843 EITHER/OR (ed. Victor Eremita) - aesthetic and ethical papers
 FEAR AND TREMBLING (Johannes de Silentio) - Abraham, the
 teleological suspension of the ethical, the knight of faith
 REPETITION (Constantin Constantius)
 1844 THE CONCEPT OF ANXIETY (Vigilius Haufniensis) - 'the dizziness
 of freedom'. Lowrie translates the title The Concept of
 DREAD; Hong translates ANXIETY. Danish: Angest
 PHILOSOPHICAL FRAGMENTS (Johannes Climacus)
 1846 CONCLUDING UNSCIENTIFIC POSTSCRIPT (Johannes Climacus) -
 'truth is subjectivity'; the FIRST AND LAST DECLARATION,
 signed by Kierkegaard, asks that the PSEUDONYM be cited
 1848 THE POINT OF VIEW FOR MY WORK AS AN AUTHOR - WRITTEN 1848,
 PUBLISHED POSTHUMOUSLY 1859. Retrospective self-reading:
 do NOT cite it as contemporaneous evidence of intention
 1849 THE SICKNESS UNTO DEATH (Anti-Climacus) - despair as a
 MISRELATION in the self's relation to itself
 1850 PRACTICE IN CHRISTIANITY (Anti-Climacus)
 1855 Kierkegaard dies. He never used the word 'existentialism'

 1889 Martin Heidegger born
 1905 Jean-Paul Sartre born
 1927 BEING AND TIME (Sein und Zeit) - PUBLISHED UNFINISHED.
 Only Division One and Division Two of PART ONE appeared.
 Division III (Time and Being) and the whole of Part Two
 were never published. NEVER write that Heidegger
 'completes' his analysis of Being in this book
 1929 WHAT IS METAPHYSICS? - anxiety reveals the Nothing (das
 Nichts). 'Nothing noths' / 'the nothing nothings'.
 NEVER 'nothing noughts'. This is the sentence Carnap
 attacks in 1932 - see Topic 07
 1943 BEING AND NOTHINGNESS (L'Être et le Néant) - the ONTOLOGY:
 in-itself, for-itself, nihilation, bad faith, the Look.
 Eng. tr. Hazel Barnes 1956; Sarah Richmond 2018
 1944 HUIS CLOS / NO EXIT - the play. 'L'enfer, c'est les autres'
 1945 EXISTENTIALISM IS A HUMANISM - DELIVERED as a public lecture
 in October 1945; PUBLISHED 1946. The SLOGANS come from
 HERE, not from Being and Nothingness. Sartre later
 regretted publishing it
 1946 LETTER ON HUMANISM written; PUBLISHED 1947. Heidegger
 repudiates Sartre's slogan and denies that his own thought
 is existentialism
 1960 CRITIQUE OF DIALECTICAL REASON - later Sartre: scarcity,
 seriality, the practico-inert, the group-in-fusion. Cite
 it for the CONCESSION, never as the doctrine of 1943
 1962 Macquarrie and Robinson translate Being and Time
 1976 Heidegger dies 1980 Sartre dies
 1996 Stambaugh translation of Being and Time (rev. Schmidt 2010)

Chronology rail: the dates are not decoration. Three of them - 1927 unfinished, 1945/1946 for the slogans, and 1946/1947 for the repudiation - are the difference between a script that has read the topic and a script that has read about it.

ANALYSIS: Four attribution rules that are worth marks on their own.

1. **Cite the pseudonym.** Write "Johannes Climacus argues in the *Postscript* that truth is subjectivity", not "Kierkegaard says". Kierkegaard printed the request himself, calling himself only the "author's author" and a prompter (*souffleur*). FACT: It is textually correct and instantly visible as expertise.
2. **Cite Being and Time by section.** Section 9 (the essence of Dasein), Section 26 (being-with), Section Section 27 and 35-38 (the "they", idle talk, falling), Section 40 (anxiety), Section 41 (care), Section Section 46-53 (being-toward-death), Section Section 54-60 (conscience), Section 65 (temporality). Section numbers survive both translations; page numbers do not.
3. **Name the translation, or use the source word once.** *Angest* is "dread" in Lowrie and "anxiety" in Hong; *Zuhandenheit* is "readiness-to-hand" in Macquarrie and Robinson and "handiness" in Stambaugh; Barnes and Richmond differ throughout *Being and Nothingness*.
4. **Say where a slogan comes from.** "Condemned to be free", "existence precedes essence" and "man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" are all from the 1945 lecture published in 1946. Saying so in half a clause is a precision mark that costs nothing.

ONE-SCREEN ROUTE MAP

THE QUESTION SAYS ...	GO TO SESSION ...
'existence precedes essence'	06 (+01 for the fence, +03/+12 for the other two)
Kierkegaard on subjectivity / truth	02 (+05 for indirect communication)
Kierkegaard against Hegel	02 (+03 for the leap)
the three stages / spheres of existence	03
anxiety, dread, despair (Kierkegaard)	04 (+17 for the contrast)
pseudonyms, indirect communication	05
in-itself and for-itself	07
'consciousness is what it is not ...'	07 (+09 for bad faith)
radical freedom, choice, responsibility	08
'if I do not choose, I am still choosing'	08
anguish, abandonment, despair (Sartre)	08 (+17)
bad faith, inauthenticity, alienation	09
'you can always make something out of what you have been made into'	10 (+09)
freedom of choice and determinism	10
the Look, being-for-others, shame	11
epoche and Heidegger's rejection of it	12 (+13)
the Being-question, Dasein	12
being-in-the-world	13 (+14 for care)
equipment, ready-to-hand, the broken hammer	13
care (Sorge)	14
das Man, falling, authenticity	15
being-toward-death	15
temporality, the three ecstases	16
'Is Dasein authentic existence?'	15 + 16
fear against anxiety / dread / anguish	17
criticisms, comparisons, verdicts	18

Route map: fourteen owned question-parts, eighteen sessions, and a one-line lookup from the words the paper actually prints to the session that answers them.

SESSION 1 - WHAT THE PRINTED CLAUSE ASKS, AND WHY "EXISTENTIALISM" IS A FAMILY AND NOT A SCHOOL

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* existentialism is the name later given to a set of philosophies that refuse to explain a human life by first defining what a human being is in general, and start instead from the finite, situated individual who has to live one. *Technical:* **existentialism** is a retrospective family-label for projects that treat **concrete, finite, situated existence** as prior to any general essence, and that take **individuality, choice, anxiety, responsibility, finitude and authenticity** as the categories through which a person's being must be analysed - while disagreeing fundamentally about God, freedom, method and the ground of authentic existence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Existentialism" names a shared problem, not a shared doctrine: Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre all deny that a person can be understood as a specimen of a general definition, but they disagree about almost everything that follows - and an answer that treats them as one school has already conceded the examiner's first trap.*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. family resemblance · the single individual (*den Enkelte*) · being-for-itself (*pour-soi*) · being-there (*Dasein*) · concrete existence · finitude · situated choice · fundamental ontology · atheistic humanism · retrospective label.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

THE OLD QUESTION	THE EXISTENTIALIST QUESTION
What IS a human being?	What is it to BE this human being, HERE, once, mortally, with choices I cannot hand over to anyone else?
Answer: a rational animal; a creature made to a divine blueprint; a machine of causes	
v	v
The individual is one INSTANCE of the definition, and the definition does the work	The general definition may be TRUE and still miss the thing that has to be lived. No definition chooses for me.

What this shows: the shift is not from one answer to another answer. It is from a question about a kind to a question about an existing individual - which is why "essence" is the word under attack.

VISUAL: VISUAL - one problem, three non-identical projects, and the fences around them.

+-----+ THE SHARED PROBLEM-FIELD An abstract system, a fixed nature or an impersonal method loses exactly what it was supposed to explain: the finite, temporal, choosing individual who has to exist. +-----+		
v	v	v
+-----+ KIERKEGAARD 1813-1855 THEISTIC ENEMY: Hegel's SYSTEM and the CROWD AIM: how does a self exist BEFORE GOD? METHOD: indirect communication, pseudonyms +-----+	+-----+ HEIDEGGER 1889-1976 ONTOLOGICAL ENEMY: Cartesian subject-object dualism, das Man AIM: to REOPEN THE QUESTION OF THE MEANING OF BEING METHOD: existen- tial analytic of Dasein +-----+	+-----+ SARTRE 1905-1980 ATHEISTIC ENEMY: determinism bad faith, the 'serious spirit' AIM: an ontology of consciousness, nothingness and situated freedom METHOD: phenom- enological ontology of the for-itself +-----+
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
+-----+ WHAT THEY DO NOT SHARE - SAY THIS EARLY GOD central bracketed by the ontology DENIED as a PREMISE THE SLOGAN never wrote it REPUDIATED it 1946/47 COINED it LABEL died 1855, never heard the word DENIED being an existentialist ACCEPTED and DEFINED the label AUTHENTICITY faith by a LEAP owning thrown projection, NOT a virtue no positive doctrine, only the critique of BAD FAITH +-----+		
+-----+ THE THREE PRINTED LIMBS, AND WHO CARRIES EACH ONE 1 EXISTENCE AND ESSENCE Sartre owns the slogan; Heidegger supplies the repudiation; Kierkegaard supplies the older and deeper form of the same refusal 2 CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE ... all three, in three incompatible registers - faith, freedom, finitude 3 BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND TEMPORALITY ... HEIDEGGER, almost alone; this limb is where the clause stops being about 'attitudes to life' and becomes fundamental ontology +-----+		

Caption: the printed clause is not a list of three topics with three owners. Limb 1 removes the blueprint, limb 2 asks what a person must then do, and limb 3 is Heidegger's insistence that limbs 1 and 2 cannot be answered by a subject facing a world - which is why the third limb has a different vocabulary from the first two.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The label is retrospective, and the paper knows it.** FACT: Kierkegaard died in **1855**; the term "existentialism" belongs to the French debates of the 1940s. Heidegger, in the "**Letter on Humanism**" (written 1946, published **1947**), explicitly denies that his thought is existentialism. Only **Sartre** accepted the label and, in the lecture of October **1945** published in **1946**, gave it a definition. ANALYSIS: An answer that says "the existentialists held that..." has therefore made a claim that two of the three printed thinkers would reject.
2. **What genuinely unites them is a refusal, not a thesis.** ANALYSIS: Each denies that the being of a human individual is settled in advance by a general nature - Kierkegaard against Hegel's mediating system, Heidegger against the Cartesian subject who is first a thinking thing and only then in a world, Sartre against the divine artisan and the determinist. The unity is a **family resemblance**: overlapping problems, not a common creed.
3. **The three names for the human being are three different concepts, not three translations.** FACT: Kierkegaard's **single individual** (*den Enkelte*) is a religious and ethical category - the one who cannot hide in the crowd and must stand before God. Sartre's **being-for-itself** (*pour-soi*) is an ontological category - consciousness as a nihilating, self-surpassing structure. Heidegger's **Dasein** is neither: it is "the entity for which its own Being is at issue and which has an understanding of Being", chosen as the route into the Being-question and not as a name for the human subject. ANALYSIS: Translating all three as "the human person" flattens the entire clause.
4. **Why the disagreement about God is structural, not biographical.** FACT: For Sartre, atheism is a **premise**: if God existed, a divine artisan would have conceived human nature before creating individuals, and essence *would* precede existence. For Kierkegaard, the God-relation is what makes the single individual possible at all - despair, in Anti-Climacus's analysis, is precisely a misrelation of the self to "the power that established it". For Heidegger, the question is neither raised nor settled by the fundamental ontology of *Being and Time*. ANALYSIS: So "existentialism is atheistic" is false as stated; **Sartre's** existentialism is.
5. **What the clause is not.** FACT: It is not **pessimism** - anxiety, despair and death are analysed as *disclosive structures*, not as the claim that life is miserable. It is not **nihilism** - Kierkegaard grounds value in faith, Sartre in the responsibility that free commitment generates, Heidegger in a formal ownership of finitude. It is not **subjective whim** - Kierkegaardian appropriation, Sartrean choice and Heideggerian resoluteness are all situated and responsibility-laden. It is not **self-help** - the clause is ontology, ethics and religious thought.
6. **The exam-critical asymmetry in the printed limbs.** ANALYSIS: Limbs 1 and 2 are shared ground on which the three can be compared; limb 3 - **being-in-the-world and temporality** - is almost entirely **Heidegger's**, with Sartre entering only as a contrast. This asymmetry is why 2019 Q3(a) and 2022 Q2(a) are Heidegger questions and 2024 Q4(a) is a comparison question: the paper follows the structure of the clause.
7. **Boundary discipline - where Husserl and Hegel enter, and where they stop.** ANALYSIS: **Husserl** enters as the method Heidegger inherits and redirects, and as the phenomenology Sartre takes over and rewrites; his suspension, theory of essences and anti-psychologism are **Topic 09** doctrine and must not be expounded here. **Hegel** enters as the system Kierkegaard attacks and as the source of the negation and recognition themes Sartre reworks; the dialectic and Absolute Spirit are **Topic 05**. FACT: In 2018 Q4(a) the paper deliberately walks across that boundary - it asks "What is 'Epoche'?" before turning to Heidegger - and the correct move is to attribute the *epoche* to Husserl in one accurate sentence and then spend the answer on Heidegger.
8. **Nietzsche is not a printed thinker in this clause.** FACT: The syllabus prints Kierkegaard, "Sarte" and Heidegger. Nihilism, the will to power, eternal recurrence and the overhuman are **not** owner content here. ANALYSIS: Camus, Jaspers, Marcel and de Beauvoir may appear only as a bounded comparison or a single criticism, never as a section of the answer.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. "Existentialism" is best treated as a family of projects united by a refusal rather than by a doctrine, and the refusal is that no general essence settles in advance what it is for this individual to exist. **Named evidence.** Kierkegaard's pseudonym Johannes Climacus argues in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846) that a logical system is possible but an existential system is not; Heidegger writes in *Being and Time* (1927) Section 9 that the essence of Dasein lies in its existence, and in the "Letter on Humanism" (written 1946, published 1947) explicitly refuses both Sartre's slogan and the label; Sartre, in the lecture of October 1945 published in 1946, coins "existence precedes essence" and accepts the label as his own. **Analysis.** The three therefore converge on a negative claim and diverge on every positive one: the individual is grounded before God for Kierkegaard, disclosed as the site of Being's intelligibility for Heidegger, and self-made through situated freedom for Sartre - which is why their vocabularies (*den Enkelte*, *Dasein*, *pour-soi*) are not intertranslatable. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The family label remains useful only if it names a recurring problem-field; used as a creed, it silently converts Heidegger's fundamental ontology into humanism and Kierkegaard's Christianity into atheism, which is precisely the error the 2024 comparison question is built to expose.

EXAM LINK. This session is the *frame* for **2024 Q4(a)**, which asks what "the existentialist thinkers" mean by a slogan owned by one of them; it supplies the opening fence for **2018 Q4(a)**, where the *epoche* must be attributed to Husserl before Heidegger is discussed; and it supplies the closing qualification for every comparison answer in the clause.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Opening "The existentialists believed that..."	ANALYSIS: Two of the three printed thinkers reject the label. Open with the shared problem and name the three projects separately.
Treating the syllabus spelling "Sarte" as a fourth thinker or as an error to be silently corrected	□ It is a printed misspelling of Sartre . Preserve it only inside a verbatim syllabus quotation; spell the philosopher correctly everywhere else.
Making atheism definitional of existentialism	FACT: Atheism is a premise of Sartre's version. Kierkegaard is a Christian thinker; Heidegger's ontology does not settle the question.
Calling existentialism pessimism or nihilism	FACT: Anxiety, despair and death are disclosive structures . The analysis is diagnostic, not an emotional verdict on life.
Importing Nietzsche as a printed thinker	FACT: He is not named in the clause. Nihilism, will to power and recurrence are outside this owner.
Expounding Husserl's method or Hegel's dialectic at length	ANALYSIS: They are Topics 09 and 05. Here they are the position being redirected and the system being attacked - one accurate sentence each.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Retrospective family label**, not a school; Kierkegaard d. **1855**, Heidegger **denied** the label (1946/47), Sartre **accepted and defined** it (1945/46).
- Shared **refusal**: no general essence settles what it is for this individual to exist.
- Three non-identical concepts: **den Enkelte** (religious-ethical) · **pour-soi** (ontological structure of consciousness) · **Dasein** (route into the Being-question).
- God: **central** (K) · **denied as premise** (S) · **not settled by the ontology** (H).
- Not pessimism, not nihilism, not whim, not self-help.
- Limb 3 (**being-in-the-world and temporality**) is almost entirely **Heidegger's**.
- Fences: Husserl = Topic 09; Hegel = Topic 05; Descartes = Topic 02; Nietzsche = not printed.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

ONE PROBLEM (abstraction loses the existing individual) -> THREE PROJECTS (faith / Being / freedom) -> THREE NAMES (den Enkelte / Dasein / pour-soi) -> THREE POSITIONS ON GOD (central / bracketed / denied as premise) -> ONE SLOGAN OWNED BY ONE MAN (Sartre 1945-46, repudiated by Heidegger 1946-47) -> FAMILY RESEMBLANCE, NOT A CREED

SESSION 2 - KIERKEGAARD: THE EXISTING INDIVIDUAL AGAINST THE SYSTEM, AND WHY "TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY" IS NOT RELATIVISM

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* Kierkegaard's complaint against Hegel is not that the system is wrong in detail but that it explains everything except the one person who has to stand somewhere and decide - and "truth is subjectivity" says that for the truths that matter existentially, *how* you hold a belief is what makes it true *for you as an existing person*, not what the belief reports. *Technical:* the **single individual** (*den Enkelte*) is the finite, temporal, passionate, deciding existent who cannot be exhaustively represented as a moment within a completed rational totality; **"truth is subjectivity"** - argued by the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus** in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846) - asserts that in ethical and religious matters the **mode of appropriation** (infinite passionate inwardness, personal commitment, risk) is the locus of truth for the existing subject, without denying objective truth in logic or the sciences.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Climacus's thesis that truth is subjectivity is not a licence to believe what one likes; it is the claim that a truth about how to exist cannot be possessed in the way a result can be possessed - and Hegel's system fails precisely because it hands over results to a reader it cannot account for."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. the single individual (*den Enkelte*) · Johannes Climacus · appropriation · infinite passionate inwardness · the *how* against the *what* · "subjectivity is untruth" · "the crowd is untruth" · existential system · mediation · either/or against both/and.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

TWO WAYS OF 'KNOWING' THE SAME SENTENCE: 'GOD EXISTS'

OBJECTIVE ROUTE

Treat it as a proposition.
Weigh the arguments. Reach
a probability. File the
result.

|
v

I now HAVE an opinion, and
nothing about my existence
has changed.

SUBJECTIVE ROUTE

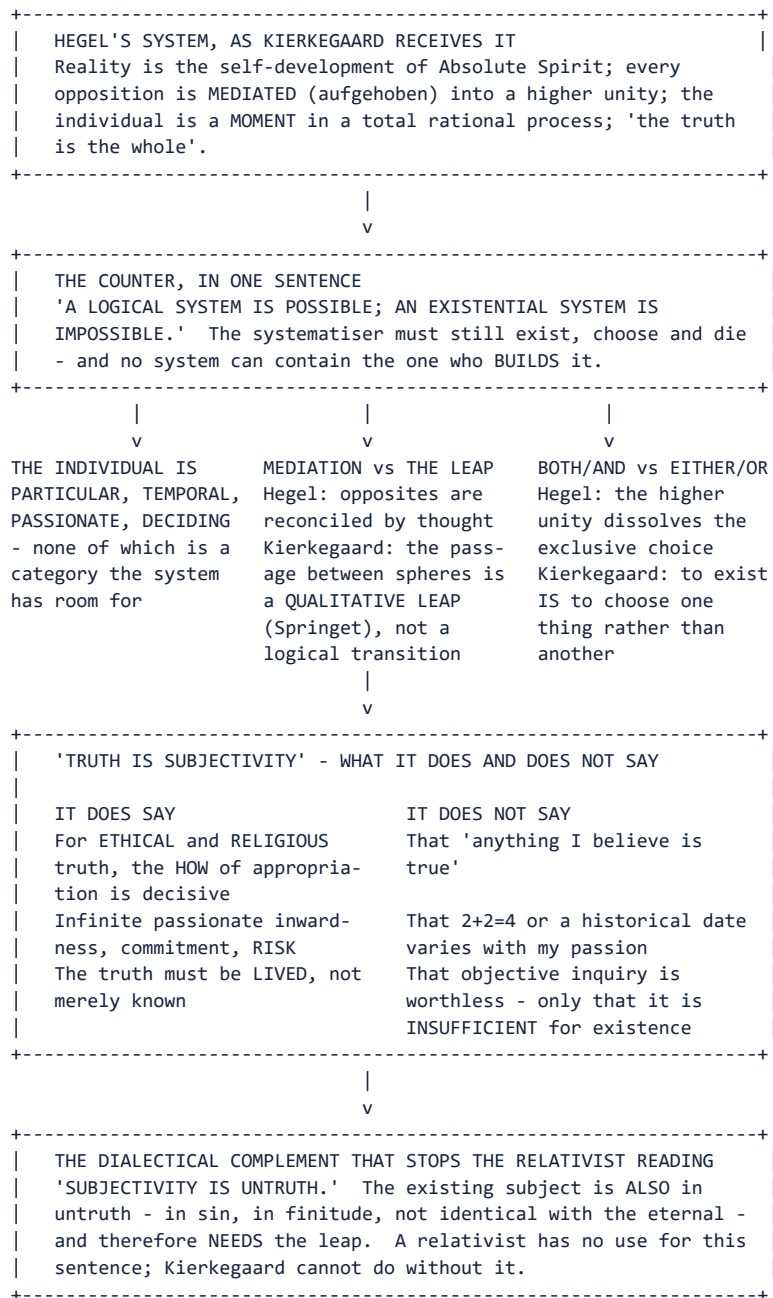
Ask what it is to EXIST
before God: in fear, in
trembling, staking a life
on it without proof.

|
v

I am now a DIFFERENT
EXISTING PERSON, and the
'result' cannot be handed
to anyone else.

What this shows: the two routes do not disagree about the sentence. They disagree about what it would be to be in the truth about it.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the anti-Hegelian argument, and the two things "truth is subjectivity" does not say.



Caption: the two boxes at the bottom are the answer to the commonest objection. If "truth is subjectivity" meant that whatever I sincerely believe is true, the companion sentence "subjectivity is untruth" would be unintelligible - and Climacus writes both.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Name the target precisely.** FACT: Kierkegaard's opponent is **Hegel's System**: the claim that reality is the self-development of Absolute Spirit (*Geist*), that oppositions are **mediated** into higher unities, and that the individual is a moment within a total rational process. ANALYSIS: Do not expound the dialectic here - that is Topic 05. State the target in two clauses and spend the answer on the counter.
2. **The counter is structural, not a complaint about difficulty.** FACT: The system explains everything **except the existing individual who is supposed to understand it**. To exist is to be *particular, temporal, passionate and deciding*; none of these is a category the system can accommodate without cancelling it. The single sentence to deploy is: **"A logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible."**
3. **"Truth is subjectivity" belongs to Johannes Climacus.** FACT: It is argued in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript (1846)*, written under the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus** - a self-described humorist who explicitly says he is **not** a Christian, which is exactly why he can pose the problem of *becoming* one. ANALYSIS: Attribute it to Climacus. Kierkegaard printed the request that his pseudonyms be cited by name.

4. **What the thesis asserts.** FACT: For **ethical and religious** truth, the *mode of appropriation* matters more than the objective content: **how** one holds a belief - with infinite passionate inwardness, personal commitment and risk - is the locus of truth for the existing subject. The worked contrast: to "know" that God exists as an item in a philosophical system is not the same as *existing before God* in faith and trembling.
5. **What the thesis does not assert, in three parts.** ANALYSIS: (i) It is **not** the relativist claim that anything believed is true; that is the standard misreading and a direct UPSC trap. (ii) It does **not** deny objective truth for logic, mathematics or history; it denies its **sufficiency** for existential and religious truth. (iii) It is **not** a general theory that factual truth varies with the passion of the believer.
6. **The complement that settles the reading: "subjectivity is untruth".** FACT: Climacus's dialectical counterpart states that the existing subject is *also* in untruth - in sin, in finitude, in non-identity with the eternal - and therefore stands in need of the **leap**. ANALYSIS: This is the decisive evidence against the relativist reading and should be quoted in any answer on subjectivity: a relativist has no use for the sentence, and Climacus cannot do without it.
7. **"The crowd is untruth."** FACT: The social form of the same point. The anonymous public permits ethical evasion, because a responsibility distributed among everyone is borne by no one. Authentic existence requires the individual to stand alone - before God, or before the ethical demand. ANALYSIS: Note the structural parallel with Heidegger's **das Man** (Session 15), but do not merge them: Kierkegaard's target is evasion of *responsibility before God*, Heidegger's is a *levelling of possibilities* with no theological content.
8. **The Hegelian reply, and Kierkegaard's counter.** CAUTION: A Hegelian may answer that the "existing individual" whose truth resists systematisation is simply an unreflective stage that philosophy sublates. Kierkegaard's counter is that **no system can contain the one who builds it**: the systematiser must still exist, choose and die. ANALYSIS: The honest verdict is bounded - Kierkegaard exposes a first-person appropriation that a completed system-view risks losing, but he does not thereby refute Hegel's ontology or offer a rival comprehensive system, and Hegel need not simply deny individuality.
9. **Why the method follows from the doctrine.** ANALYSIS: If existential truth is a *mode of existing* rather than a result, it cannot be handed over directly without being falsified - which is why Kierkegaard writes pseudonymously and indirectly. Session 5 develops this; note here only that the method is a **consequence** of the thesis, not a literary preference.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Kierkegaard's thesis that truth is subjectivity is a claim about the mode in which existential truth can be possessed, and its force comes from a structural objection to systematic philosophy rather than from any doubt about objective knowledge. **Named evidence.** The pseudonym Johannes Climacus argues in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846) that for ethical and religious truth the *how* of appropriation - infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk - is decisive, and in the same work states the dialectical complement that "subjectivity is untruth", since the existing subject stands in sin and finitude and therefore needs the leap; the accompanying formula against Hegel is that a logical system is possible but an existential system is not. **Analysis.** The two sentences must be read together: if the thesis were relativism, its complement would be unintelligible, and the point of the pair is that the existing individual is neither a self-certifying authority nor a moment inside a completed totality, but a finite subject whose relation to the truth is itself part of what makes the truth his. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The critique is bounded - it exposes what a system-view risks losing about first-person appropriation without refuting Hegel's ontology, and Kierkegaard offers no rival comprehensive system in its place.

EXAM LINK. This session is the core of **2020 Q3(a)** ("Subjectivity is the truth" and the single individual), **2022 Q4(a)** (subjectivity, then the three stages), **2023 Q1(d)** (against Hegel's universal spirit) and **2024 Q1(e)** (truth in terms of subjectivity). Four of the fourteen owned parts - nearly a third of the clause - begin here.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
"Truth is subjectivity" = relativism	FACT: It concerns the mode of appropriation , not the propositional content, and Climacus also writes " subjectivity is untruth ".

Trap	Correction
Writing "Kierkegaard says in the <i>Postscript</i> ..."	ANALYSIS: The book is signed Johannes Climacus , and Kierkegaard printed a request that the pseudonym be cited. Attribution is a free precision mark.
Expounding Hegel's dialectic at length	ANALYSIS: Topic 05. Two clauses of target-setting, then the counter.
Reducing the critique to "Kierkegaard disliked abstraction"	FACT: The objection is structural: no system can contain the one who builds it; either/or against both/and ; the leap against mediation .
Treating "the crowd is untruth" as Heidegger's <i>das Man</i>	ANALYSIS: Structurally parallel, doctrinally different - evasion before God against the levelling of possibilities.
Claiming Kierkegaard refutes Hegel outright	CAUTION: The honest verdict is bounded: he exposes a loss, not a contradiction, and offers no rival system.

REVISION NOTES.

- Target: **Hegel's System** - Absolute Spirit, mediation, the individual as a moment, "the truth is the whole".
- Counter-sentence: **"A logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible."**
- **Johannes Climacus**, *Concluding Unscientific Postscript*, 1846 - a humorist who says he is not a Christian.
- Thesis = the **how** of appropriation for **ethical/religious** truth: infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk.
- Three denials: not relativism · not a denial of objective truth · not a theory that facts vary with passion.
- Complement: **"subjectivity is untruth"** - sin, finitude, need of the leap.
- Social form: **"the crowd is untruth"** - distributed responsibility is no responsibility.
- Verdict: exposes what system-view loses; does not refute Hegel or replace him.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

HEGEL'S SYSTEM (mediation, the whole) -> IT CANNOT CONTAIN THE ONE WHO BUILDS IT -> 'a logical system is possible, an existential system is impossible' -> CLIMACUS, *Postscript* 1846: TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY = the HOW of appropriation for ETHICAL/RELIGIOUS truth -> NOT relativism (objective truth retained, only INSUFFICIENT) -> 'SUBJECTIVITY IS UNTRUTH' proves it -> 'THE CROWD IS UNTRUTH' -> the single individual must stand alone -> and therefore the METHOD must be INDIRECT

SESSION 3 - KIERKEGAARD: THE THREE SPHERES OF EXISTENCE, THE LEAP, AND THE TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION OF THE ETHICAL

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* Kierkegaard maps three ways a life can be organised - around enjoyment, around duty, and around a relation to God - and insists you do not grow from one into the next; you have to jump, because there is no argument that carries you across. *Technical:* the **spheres or stages of existence** (aesthetic, ethical, religious) are **qualitative** modes of existing, each with its own governing category and its own characteristic collapse; transition between them is not psychological maturation and not Hegelian mediation but a **qualitative leap** (*Springet*) made in freedom.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"The three spheres are not a staircase up which a person matures; they are three incompatible ways of organising a life, each of which breaks down in its own way - and what carries a person across the break is not an argument but a leap, which is exactly why Hegelian mediation cannot describe the movement."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. aesthetic · ethical · religious · qualitative sphere, not chronological stage · the leap (*Springet*) · boredom, guilt, paradox · Judge William · Johannes de Silentio · teleological suspension of the ethical · knight of faith · knight of infinite resignation · the absurd.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

THREE WAYS TO ANSWER 'WHAT IS MY LIFE ORGANISED AROUND?'

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| AESTHETIC | -> the INTERESTING. Keep options open; avoid anything that binds. Ends in BOREDOM and a scattered self. |
| ETHICAL | -> DUTY. Marry, work, be transparent, accept the universal. Ends in GUILT, because the demand cannot be perfectly met. |
| RELIGIOUS | -> GOD, related to as a single individual. Ends in PARADOX: faith is not rational, not universal, and cannot be mediated. |

YOU DO NOT GRADUATE. YOU LEAP. AND YOU CAN FALL BACK.

What this shows: each sphere is defined by what it treats as final, and each collapses from the inside - which is what makes the next sphere thinkable without making it deducible.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the three spheres, their limits, and the two knights.

SPHERE	CORE / MODE	LIMIT - HOW IT COLLAPSES
AESTHETIC pseudonymous portrayals in EITHER/OR (1843), ed. Victor Eremita	Living for the moment: the interesting, enjoyment, the avoidance of binding commitment; immediacy, detach- ment, irony	BOREDOM, FRAGMENTATION, DESPAIR. Nothing binds, so nothing holds the self together
ETHICAL Judge William, the 'judge' of EITHER/OR	Living by UNIVERSAL DUTY: commitment, marriage, vocation, transparency; the self as responsible agent under universal categories	GUILT. The ethical demand cannot be perfectly fulfilled, and the UNIVERSAL cannot accommodate the individual's anguished singularity
RELIGIOUS Johannes de Silentio, FEAR AND TREMBLING (1843)	Standing BEFORE GOD as a singular individual; faith as 'the absurd'; infinite passion	PARADOX. Faith is not rational, not universal, not mediated by the crowd or the church
 v		
THE TRANSITION: WHY IT MUST BE A LEAP Hegel: opposites are MEDIATED - the transition is a THOUGHT Kierkegaard: no argument delivers me from one sphere to the next. I have to CHOOSE, and the choosing is not underwritten by the sphere I am leaving. Hence QUALITATIVE LEAP (Springet). NOT a chronology. NOT maturation. RELAPSE IS ALWAYS POSSIBLE.		
 v		
THE TWO KNIGHTS - LEARN THE DIFFERENCE, IT IS THE WHOLE POINT		
KNIGHT OF INFINITE RESIGNATION Gives the finite up, and the renunciation SHOWS. Visibly heroic, visibly apart from ordinary life.	KNIGHT OF FAITH Gives it up AND RECEIVES IT BACK. Outwardly INDISTINGUISHABLE from a bourgeois citizen: he lives fully in the finite world WHILE relating absolutely to the Absolute.	
THE DOUBLE MOVEMENT: infinite resignation FIRST, then faith - which is why faith is HIGHER than resignation, not easier		

Caption: the two knights are the fastest way to show that faith, for Johannes de Silentio, is not withdrawal from the world. The knight of infinite resignation is legible; the knight of faith is invisible - and that invisibility is the doctrine.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

- Spheres, not stages in time.** ANALYSIS: The commonest error is to present the three as a developmental chronology. They are **qualitative spheres**: one does not "grow out of" the aesthetic by maturation, and **relapse is always possible**. The word "stages" is standard in English translations, which is exactly why the qualification must be written explicitly.
- Aesthetic.** FACT: The life organised around the **interesting** - enjoyment, immediacy, irony, and the systematic avoidance of anything that binds. Portrayed pseudonymously in *Either/Or* (1843), edited by **Victor Eremita**, who prints the aesthetic papers ("A") and the ethical papers side by side **without deciding between them**, so that the reader must choose. Its limit is **boredom, fragmentation and despair**: a self with no binding commitment has nothing to hold it together.
- Ethical.** FACT: The life organised around **universal duty** - commitment, marriage, vocation, transparency - voiced by **Judge William** in *Either/Or*. The self here is a responsible agent choosing under universal categories. Its limit is **guilt**: the ethical demand cannot be perfectly fulfilled, and the universal cannot accommodate the

individual's anguished singularity.

4. **Religious. FACT:** The life organised around standing **before God as a singular individual**, with faith as "the absurd" and infinite passion. Its limit - better, its defining structure - is **paradox**: faith is not rational, not universal, and not mediated by the crowd or the church.
5. **The leap (Springet). FACT:** Transition is a **qualitative choice**, not a Hegelian deduction and not a psychological development. **ANALYSIS: Provenance caution:** Kierkegaard writes of *the leap* and of *faith*; the fused English phrase "**leap of faith**" belongs to the English tradition and is not a literal translation of a Kierkegaardian term. Write "the leap - what the English tradition calls the leap of faith" and the caution is discharged in six words.
6. **The teleological suspension of the ethical. FACT:** Analysed by the pseudonym **Johannes de Silentio** in *Fear and Trembling (1843)* through Abraham, commanded to sacrifice Isaac. The ethical (the universal) is *suspended* in relation to a higher *telos*, the absolute relation to the Absolute. **ANALYSIS:** The text **stages the paradox** of faith; it must not be cited as Kierkegaard's straightforward licence for private revelation to override morality. De Silentio himself writes as one who **admires faith but does not have it** - hence "silentio", the silence of one who can describe Abraham but not understand him.
7. **The two knights. FACT:** The **knight of infinite resignation** renounces the finite visibly; the **knight of faith** is outwardly indistinguishable from a bourgeois citizen - he lives fully in the finite world *while* relating absolutely to the Absolute, having made the double movement of resignation *and* faith. **ANALYSIS:** This is the fastest available refutation of the "existentialism is world-denying" reading.
8. **Why the spheres matter for the subjectivity thesis. ANALYSIS:** The spheres are the **content** of which "truth is subjectivity" is the **form**: each sphere is a mode of appropriating existence, and the intensification from dispersion (aesthetic) through duty (ethical) to the absolute relation (religious) *is* the intensification of inwardness. In 2022 Q4(a) the paper asks for both in one answer, in exactly this order.
9. **The standing objection. CAUTION: Fideism/irrationalism:** the leap abandons rational accountability. Kierkegaard's reply is that reason is not *wrong* but *limited* - it cannot deliver what the religious individual needs. **ANALYSIS:** Whether that is a defensible epistemology or a *reductio* is a live question, and the honest closing move is to say so rather than to pretend the objection has been answered.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Kierkegaard's three spheres are qualitative modes of existing rather than developmental stages, and the movement between them must be a leap because each sphere collapses in a way that no argument internal to it can repair. **Named evidence.** *Either/Or* (1843), edited by the pseudonym Victor Eremita, prints the aesthetic papers of "A" beside Judge William's ethical papers without adjudicating between them, so that the reader is forced into the choice; *Fear and Trembling* (1843), written by Johannes de Silentio, stages the religious sphere through Abraham and the teleological suspension of the ethical, and distinguishes the visibly renouncing knight of infinite resignation from the knight of faith, who is outwardly indistinguishable from an ordinary citizen. **Analysis.** Each sphere has a characteristic collapse - boredom in the aesthetic, guilt in the ethical, paradox in the religious - and because the collapse is *of* the sphere's own governing category, no mediation can carry the individual across; only a qualitative leap in freedom can, which is precisely the movement Hegelian dialectic has no room for. **Qualification.** **ANALYSIS:** *Fear and Trembling* stages the paradox rather than licensing private revelation against morality, and the fused phrase "leap of faith" is the English tradition's rather than Kierkegaard's, who writes of the leap (*Springet*).

EXAM LINK. This session carries the second half of **2022 Q4(a)** ("explain it with reference to three stages of existence") and supplies the decisive movement-concept - the leap against mediation - for **2023 Q1(d)** and **2020 Q3(a)**.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Presenting the spheres as a chronological or developmental ladder	FACT: They are qualitative spheres ; one leaps, and relapse is always possible.
Quoting "leap of faith" as Kierkegaard's phrase	ANALYSIS: He writes of the leap (<i>Springet</i>); the fused phrase is the English tradition's. Say so in one clause.

Trap	Correction
Using the teleological suspension as a licence for private revelation over morality	FACT: <i>Fear and Trembling</i> stages the paradox , and de Silentio explicitly does not possess the faith he describes.
Writing "Kierkegaard argues in <i>Fear and Trembling</i> "	ANALYSIS: The signatory is Johannes de Silentio .
Conflating the two knights	FACT: Resignation is visible ; faith is invisible and lives fully in the finite after the double movement.
Treating the aesthetic sphere as mere hedonism	ANALYSIS: Its category is the interesting , and its structural feature is the refusal of binding commitment - irony and detachment, not simply pleasure.

REVISION NOTES.

- Three **spheres**: aesthetic (the interesting -> **boredom**) · ethical (universal duty -> **guilt**) · religious (before God -> **paradox**).
- *Either/Or* 1843, ed. **Victor Eremita**; Judge William voices the ethical; "A" the aesthetic.
- *Fear and Trembling* 1843, **Johannes de Silentio** - Abraham, **teleological suspension of the ethical**.
- Transition = **qualitative leap** (*Springet*), not mediation, not maturation; **relapse possible**.
- **Knight of infinite resignation** (visible renunciation) vs **knight of faith** (invisible; double movement; lives in the finite).
- Provenance: "**leap of faith**" is the **English tradition's** phrase.
- Objection: **fideism**; reply: reason is limited, not wrong; verdict left open.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

AESTHETIC (the interesting) -> collapses in BOREDOM -> ETHICAL (universal duty, Judge William) -> collapses in GUILT -> RELIGIOUS (before God, de Silentio's Abraham) -> lives as PARADOX -> MOVEMENT = QUALITATIVE LEAP (*Springet*), never mediation -> KNIGHT OF RESIGNATION is visible, KNIGHT OF FAITH is not -> the spheres are the CONTENT of which 'truth is subjectivity' is the FORM

SESSION 4 - KIERKEGAARD: ANXIETY AS THE DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM, AND DESPAIR AS A MISRELATION IN THE SELF

DEFINITION. *Plain language*: anxiety is what you feel when you realise you *could* - not that something will hurt you, but that nothing stops you; and despair, for Kierkegaard, is not sadness but a structural fault in the way a self is related to itself and to what made it. *Technical*: **anxiety or dread** (*Angest*), analysed by the pseudonym **Vigilius Haufniensis** in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), is the "dizziness of freedom" - an objectless disclosure of **possibility**, distinct in kind from fear; **despair**, analysed by **Anti-Climacus** in *The Sickness unto Death* (1849), is a **misrelation** in the relation the self is - the self failing to be itself before the power that established it.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Anxiety, for Vigilius Haufniensis, is not fear intensified but fear's opposite in structure: fear has an object and drives me back into the world, while anxiety has none and discloses that I am able - which is why Kierkegaard can call it the dizziness of freedom and make it the presupposition of the leap.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. anxiety or dread (*Angest*) · Vigilius Haufniensis · "the dizziness of freedom" · "a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy" · the object of anxiety is a nothing · innocence · despair · Anti-Climacus · misrelation · the self is a relation relating itself to itself · not willing to be oneself · defiantly willing to be oneself.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

AT THE EDGE OF A CLIFF

FEAR

'The rock might give way.'
An OBJECT threatens me.
I step back, INTO the world.

|
v

Discloses a THREAT.

ANXIETY

'Nothing is stopping me from
throwing myself over.'
No object at all - what
appears is that I AM ABLE.

|
v

Discloses POSSIBILITY, i.e.
FREEDOM - and it dizzies me
because the ground of the
choice is nowhere but in me.

'The dizziness is as much in the EYE as in the ABYSS.'

What this shows: the difference is not intensity. It is whether there is an object at all - and it is the absence of the object that makes anxiety philosophically informative.

VISUAL: VISUAL - anxiety and the two shapes of despair.

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+-----+
| ANXIETY (Angest) - Vigilius Haufniensis, THE CONCEPT OF ANXIETY |
| 1844. Lowrie translates the title 'The Concept of DREAD'.       |
|                                                                     |
| OBJECT ..... none. 'The object of anxiety is a NOTHING.'      |
| WHAT APPEARS ... POSSIBILITY - 'the possibility of being able'  |
| FORMULA ..... 'the DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM'                       |
| AMBIVALENCE .... 'a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic |
|                   sympathy' - we are DRAWN to what we SHRINK    |
|                   from                                           |
| IN INNOCENCE ... there is no knowledge of good and evil, yet   |
|                   anxiety is ALREADY there, because freedom's   |
|                   possibility is already sensed                  |
| ROLE ..... anxiety is the PRESUPPOSITION of the LEAP by       |
|                   which sin - and selfhood - enters             |
+-----+
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|
v

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+-----+
| DESPAIR - Anti-Climacus, THE SICKNESS UNTO DEATH 1849          |
| Anti-Climacus writes as a Christian at an EXTRAORDINARILY HIGH |
| level - deliberately the MIRROR IMAGE of Climacus, who says he |
| is not a Christian at all                                       |
|                                                                     |
| THE SELF IS NOT A THING. It is a RELATION that relates itself  |
| to itself - and, in relating to itself, relates to THE POWER   |
| THAT ESTABLISHED IT.                                           |
|                                                                     |
| DESPAIR = A MISRELATION IN THAT RELATION. Not an emotion.      |
| Not sadness. A STRUCTURAL FAULT that may be entirely unfelt.   |
|                                                                     |
| FORM 1 NOT WILLING TO BE ONESELF                                |
|         - fleeing the self one is; wanting to be someone else, |
|         or no one                                               |
| FORM 2 DEFIANTLY WILLING TO BE ONESELF                          |
|         - insisting on being oneself WITHOUT the grounding     |
|         God-relation; self-assertion as the refusal of         |
|         dependence                                              |
+-----+
```

|
v

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+-----+
| THE FENCE THAT MUST BE STATED                                   |
| KIERKEGAARDIAN DESPAIR (theological: misrelation before God)   |
| IS NOT                                                           |
| SARTREAN DESPAIR (desespoir, 1946 lecture: acting without     |
| relying on outcomes beyond one's control)                       |
| Same English word, two unrelated doctrines.                     |
+-----+
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Caption: the bottom panel is worth a mark on its own. "Despair" appears in both Kierkegaard and Sartre, and the two uses have nothing in common beyond the translator's word.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Anxiety is objectless, and that is the whole argument.** FACT: **Vigilius Haufniensis** ("the watchman of Copenhagen") writes in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844) as a **psychological observer**, deliberately not as a dogmatist. Anxiety's object "is a **nothing**"; what discloses itself is **possibility** - that one can choose, and can fail.
2. **The formula and the ambivalence.** FACT: Anxiety is "the **dizziness of freedom**", and it is "a **sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy**" - we are drawn towards what we shrink from. ANALYSIS: Both phrases are safe as **renderings with attribution**; Lowrie and Hong differ, and Lowrie's title is *The Concept of Dread*. Name the translation or use the Danish *Angest* once.
3. **The canonical example.** FACT: A man at the edge of an abyss looks down and grows dizzy - "the dizziness is as much in the **eye** as in the **abyss**." The vertigo is not produced by the drop; it is produced by the disclosure that nothing prevents him.
4. **Anxiety in innocence.** FACT: In innocence there is no knowledge of good and evil, and yet anxiety is already present, because freedom's possibility is already sensed. ANALYSIS: This is why anxiety is the **presupposition** of the leap by which sin - and, with it, selfhood - enters: anxiety does not *cause* the leap, which would make the leap a determined event, but it is the condition in which a leap becomes intelligible.
5. **Despair is structural, not emotional.** FACT: **Anti-Climacus** opens *The Sickness unto Death* (1849) with the definition that the self is a **relation that relates itself to itself**, and, in so relating, relates to **the power that established it**. **Despair** is a **misrelation** in that relation. ANALYSIS: Consequently a person may be in despair without feeling anything - the commonest and most examinable feature of the doctrine.
6. **The two shapes of despair.** FACT: **Not willing to be oneself** - fleeing the self one actually is. **Defiantly willing to be oneself** - insisting on being oneself *without* the grounding God-relation. The second is the deeper form precisely because it looks like strength.
7. **Anti-Climacus is a constructed standpoint.** FACT: He writes as a Christian at an **extraordinarily high** level - above Kierkegaard himself, and the deliberate mirror image of **Climacus**, who says he is not a Christian. ANALYSIS: The pair is evidence that the pseudonyms are **existence-possibilities**, not disguises (Session 5).
8. **The fence against Sartre.** ANALYSIS: Sartre's **despair** (*desespoir*), in the 1946 lecture, means acting without relying on outcomes beyond one's control and reasonable probabilities. It is not a theological misrelation, and the two must never be merged. FACT: Similarly, Kierkegaard's *Angest* and Heidegger's *Angst* are related but non-identical: Session 17 sets out the three-way comparison.
9. **Why the examiner cares.** ANALYSIS: Anxiety is the point at which Kierkegaard's psychology becomes an argument about **freedom**, and despair is the point at which his account of the self becomes an argument about **dependence**. Both feed the subjectivity questions: the single individual is anxious because free, and in despair because it will not be grounded.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. In Kierkegaard's pseudonymous psychology, anxiety and despair are not moods reported but structures disclosed: anxiety discloses freedom, and despair discloses the self's failure to be grounded. **Named evidence.** Vigilius Haufniensis, in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), states that the object of anxiety is a nothing and calls anxiety the dizziness of freedom, illustrating it with the man at the abyss in whom the dizziness lies as much in the eye as in the depth; Anti-Climacus, in *The Sickness unto Death* (1849), defines the self as a relation that relates itself to itself and, in so doing, relates to the power that established it, and defines despair as a misrelation within that relation, appearing either as not willing to be oneself or as defiantly willing to be oneself without that grounding. **Analysis.** Because anxiety has no object it cannot be disclosing an entity, so what it discloses must be a structure - possibility, "the possibility of being able" - and because despair is a misrelation rather than a feeling, it can be present unfelt, which is why Anti-Climacus can call it universal without making an empirical claim about how people feel. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Both analyses are **pseudonymous** and voice-specific, and the English word "despair" must be kept apart from Sartre's *desespoir*, which concerns acting without reliance on outcomes rather than any relation to God.

EXAM LINK. This session supplies the mood-analysis that any Kierkegaard answer needs as its psychological engine (2020 Q3(a), 2022 Q4(a), 2024 Q1(e)), and it is one of the three legs of the fear/anxiety comparison in **Session 17** that a question on dread or anguish requires.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Defining anxiety as intense fear	FACT: Fear has a determinate object; anxiety's object "is a nothing ". The difference is in kind .
Treating despair as sadness or depression	FACT: It is a misrelation in the self's relation to itself and to the power that established it - and may be entirely unfelt.
Merging Kierkegaardian and Sartrean despair	ANALYSIS: Two doctrines, one translator's word. Sartre's <i>desespoir</i> is about not relying on outcomes beyond one's control.
Attributing the analyses to Kierkegaard directly	ANALYSIS: Vigilius Haufniensis (1844) and Anti-Climacus (1849) - cite the pseudonyms.
Saying anxiety <i>causes</i> the leap	ANALYSIS: It is the presupposition of the leap; a caused leap would not be a leap.
Ignoring the translation split	ANALYSIS: <i>Angest</i> is "dread" in Lowrie and "anxiety" in Hong; the book title differs accordingly.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Anxiety** (*Angest*), **Vigilius Haufniensis**, *The Concept of Anxiety*, **1844**; Lowrie: *The Concept of Dread*.
- Object = **a nothing**; what appears is **possibility**; formula = "the **dizziness of freedom**".
- "A **sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy**"; the abyss example - dizziness in the **eye**.
- Anxiety already present **in innocence**; it is the **presupposition** of the leap.
- **Despair**, **Anti-Climacus**, *The Sickness unto Death*, **1849**: the self = a relation relating itself to itself and thereby to **the power that established it**.
- Despair = **misrelation**, possibly unfelt; two forms - **not willing** to be oneself; **defiantly willing** to be oneself without the God-relation.
- Fence: Kierkegaardian despair $\neq$ **Sartrean desespoir***

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

FEAR has an object -> ANXIETY has NONE -> so it discloses not a THING but a STRUCTURE -> POSSIBILITY = 'the possibility of being able' -> 'THE DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM' (Haufniensis 1844) -> present already IN INNOCENCE -> PRESUPPOSITION of the LEAP -> and the self that leaps is a RELATION relating itself to itself (Anti-Climacus 1849) -> failure of that relation = DESPAIR, in two forms, possibly UNFELT -> not Sartre's desespoir

SESSION 5 - KIERKEGAARD: INDIRECT COMMUNICATION AND PSEUDONYMITY AS THE FORM OF THE DOCTRINE

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* if the truth you want to convey is a way of living rather than a piece of information, then telling someone directly will destroy it - they will file it as a fact instead of becoming it - so Kierkegaard writes in voices that refuse to give the reader a result. *Technical:* **indirect communication** (*indirekte Meddelelse*) is a form of address that withholds the result, declines authority and forces the recipient to relate to the possibility for himself; **pseudonymity** is its execution, in which each pseudonym is a **personified existence-possibility** writing from within a sphere of existence it cannot see beyond.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Pseudonymity is not literary decoration but the formal counterpart of the doctrine that truth is subjectivity: because ethical and religious truth is a mode of existing rather than a result, it can be communicated only in a form that refuses to deliver a result.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. indirect communication (*indirekte Meddelelse*) · direct communication · appropriation · Socratic maieutics · "deceives into the truth" · vanishing occasion · personified existence-possibility · double authorship · upbuilding discourses · First and Last Declaration · "author's author" · prompter (*souffleur*) · revocation.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

TWO WAYS OF TELLING SOMEONE SOMETHING

DIRECT

'Here is the result.'
The reader RECEIVES it and
files it. Nothing about
his existence need change.

|
v

PERFECT for history, science,
mathematics.

INDIRECT

'Here is a person living this
possibility to its end. I
give you no result and no
authority.'

|
v

NECESSARY when the truth IS
a way of existing - because
a received result would
FALSIFY exactly what was
being communicated.

What this shows: the choice of form is forced by the kind of truth in question. It is an argument, not a style.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the six-step argument, the pseudonyms, and the double authorship.

- 1 OBJECTIVE TRUTH - historical, scientific, metaphysical - can be transmitted DIRECTLY. I state a result; you receive it; nothing about your existence need change.
|
- 2 ETHICAL AND RELIGIOUS TRUTH is not a result but a MODE OF EXISTING, an APPROPRIATION in inwardness (Climacus, Postscript 1846: truth is subjectivity - the HOW of the relation).
|
- 3 IF such truth were communicated DIRECTLY, the recipient would take it over AS A RESULT - as information, as doctrine, as something one can KNOW WITHOUT BECOMING. The communication would thereby FALSIFY what it communicates.
|
- 4 THEREFORE ethical-religious truth requires INDIRECT COMMUNICATION: a form that WITHHOLDS the result, REFUSES to be an authority, and forces the reader to relate to the possibility FOR HIMSELF.
|
- 5 THE MODEL IS SOCRATIC MAIEUTICS - the midwife who brings to birth what the other must produce, and who 'DECEIVES INTO THE TRUTH'. The author must become a VANISHING OCCASION, not a teacher with a doctrine.
|
- 6 THEREFORE PSEUDONYMITY. The pseudonyms are not disguises for a shy author but PERSONIFIED EXISTENCE-POSSIBILITIES, each writing from INSIDE a sphere it cannot see beyond.

PSEUDONYM	WORK (YEAR)	STANDPOINT WRITTEN FROM
Victor Eremita (ed.)	Either/Or 1843	prints aesthetic 'A' and ethical Judge William side by side WITHOUT deciding
Johannes de Silentio	Fear and Trembling 1843	ADMIRE faith but DOES NOT HAVE it - hence 'silence'
Constantin Constantius	Repetition 1843	aesthetic-experimental observer
Vigilius Haufniensis	The Concept of Anxiety 1844	psychological observer of anxiety, deliberately NOT a dogmatist
Johannes Climacus	Philosophical Fragments 1844; Postscript 1846	a HUMORIST who is explicitly NOT A CHRISTIAN - which is why he can pose the problem of BECOMING one
Anti-Climacus	The Sickness unto Death 1849; Practice in Christianity 1850	a Christian at an EXTRAORDINARILY HIGH level - above Kierkegaard himself; Climacus's mirror

THE DOUBLE AUTHORSHIP: simultaneously, UNDER HIS OWN NAME, Kierkegaard published the UPBUILDING / EDIFYING DISCOURSES. The signed religious writings stand BESIDE the pseudonymous works as the DIRECT pole of a single strategy.

THE INSTRUCTION HE PRINTED: the 'FIRST AND LAST DECLARATION' appended to the Postscript (1846). He acknowledges authorship while insisting he is only the 'AUTHOR'S AUTHOR', a PROMPTER (souffleur) who produced characters, and ASKS THAT ANYONE CITING THEM QUOTE THE PSEUDONYM'S NAME, NOT HIS.

Caption: steps 1-6 are an argument, not a biography. Read them in order and pseudonymity stops being a curiosity about Kierkegaard and becomes a consequence of the thesis in Session 2.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **This is now Core, not optional background.** FACT: Indirect communication and the pseudonymous authorship were promoted out of optional-enrichment status on **15 August 2026** and are marks-essential for any question on subjectivity or the critique of Hegel. ANALYSIS: A "truth is subjectivity" answer that omits the form the doctrine forces is incomplete, and the point is almost never made in ordinary scripts.
2. **Follow the six steps in order.** FACT: They are set out in the visual above; the load-bearing step is **3** - direct communication would convert a mode of existing into a result and thereby falsify it.
3. **Socratic maieutics and the vanishing occasion.** FACT: The model is the **midwife** who brings to birth what the other must produce, and who, in Kierkegaard's phrase, "**deceives into the truth**". The author must become a **vanishing occasion**, not a teacher with a doctrine. ANALYSIS: Note the deliberate provocation in "deceives": the

deception is formal, not moral - the reader is denied a result *for his own sake*.

4. **The pseudonyms are standpoints, not masks.** FACT: Each writes from inside a sphere and cannot see beyond it, which is why **de Silentio** can describe Abraham but not understand him, why **Climacus** can pose the problem of becoming a Christian precisely because he is not one, and why **Anti-Climacus** is placed *above* Kierkegaard rather than beside him.
5. **The double authorship.** FACT: Simultaneously and **under his own name**, Kierkegaard published the *Upbuilding (Edifying) Discourses*. The signed religious writings are the **direct pole** of a single strategy. ANALYSIS: Saying this shows that pseudonymity is a **method**, not an evasion.
6. **The printed instruction.** FACT: In the "**First and Last Declaration**" appended to the *Postscript (1846)*, Kierkegaard acknowledges authorship of the pseudonymous books while insisting that he is only their "**author's author**", a **prompter (souffleur)**, and asks that anyone citing them **quote the pseudonym's name, not his**. WRONG: Writing "Kierkegaard says in *Fear and Trembling...*" ignores an instruction the author printed.
7. **Objection 1 - unattributability.** CAUTION: If the author speaks through masks, his own position becomes unpinable and the method insulates him from criticism. **Reply:** the signed discourses supply the direct pole, and *The Point of View for My Work as an Author - written 1848, published posthumously 1859* - gives an explicit account of the strategy. ANALYSIS: **Residual:** *The Point of View* is itself a retrospective self-interpretation and is disputed as evidence.
8. **Objection 2 - self-undermining.** CAUTION: If subjective truth cannot be said directly, the thesis "truth is subjectivity" cannot be said directly either. **Reply:** Climacus **concedes exactly this** - the *Postscript* ends by **revoking** itself. ANALYSIS: This is a first-class exam observation: Kierkegaard's revocation, the early Wittgenstein's ladder at *Tractatus* 6.54, and Hegel's Unhappy Consciousness all end in a text that consumes itself. Cross-link, in one clause, to Topics 06 and 05 - and do not expound either.
9. **Objection 3 - the Hegelian reply.** CAUTION: The "existing individual" whose truth resists systematisation is simply an unreflective stage philosophy sublates. **Counter:** no system can contain the one who *builds* it; the systematiser must still exist, choose and die.
10. **The executable verdict.** ANALYSIS: Pseudonymity is the formal counterpart of the doctrine that truth is subjectivity. The method's **cost** is that it is self-consuming - Climacus revokes the *Postscript* - and its **power** is that the cost is intended: Kierkegaard is not evading the demand for a position but denying that a position, in the systematic sense Hegel required, is the sort of thing an existing individual can hand over.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Kierkegaard's pseudonymity is the formal consequence of his account of existential truth, not a literary habit that can be omitted from an exposition of it. **Named evidence.** Climacus argues in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846) that ethical and religious truth is a mode of existing rather than a result; the same volume carries the "First and Last Declaration", in which Kierkegaard acknowledges the pseudonymous books while calling himself only their "author's author" and a prompter, and asks that citations name the pseudonym; and the *Upbuilding Discourses*, published simultaneously under his own name, form the direct pole of the same strategy. **Analysis.** If such truth were transmitted directly, the recipient would take it over as information and could hold it without becoming it, so the communication would falsify its own content; the remedy is a Socratic form that withholds the result and makes the author a vanishing occasion, which is executed by giving each existence-possibility its own voice - de Silentio who admires faith without having it, Climacus who is not a Christian, Anti-Climacus who stands above the author. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The method is deliberately self-limiting: Climacus revokes the *Postscript* at its close, so the thesis cannot be asserted directly even by its own author, and *The Point of View*, written 1848 and published posthumously in 1859, is a retrospective self-reading rather than contemporaneous evidence of intention.

EXAM LINK. This session upgrades **2020 Q3(a)**, **2022 Q4(a)**, **2023 Q1(d)** and **2024 Q1(e)** from competent to distinctive: each is a subjectivity or anti-Hegel question, and each rewards the observation that the doctrine dictates the form. The attribution rule alone - writing "Climacus argues" rather than "Kierkegaard says" - is visible expertise in the first line.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Treating pseudonymity as biography or shyness	FACT: It is the formal counterpart of the doctrine; the pseudonyms are existence-possibilities .
Citing pseudonymous works under Kierkegaard's own name	ANALYSIS: The " First and Last Declaration " (1846) asks for the pseudonym; ignoring it discards a free precision mark.
Omitting the double authorship	FACT: The signed <i>Upbuilding Discourses</i> are the direct pole; without them the method looks like evasion.
Using <i>The Point of View</i> as contemporaneous evidence	ANALYSIS: Written 1848, published posthumously 1859 ; a retrospective self-interpretation, and disputed.
Missing the revocation of the <i>Postscript</i>	CAUTION: It is the strongest evidence that the self-undermining objection was anticipated, not overlooked.
Expounding <i>Tractatus</i> 6.54 or the Unhappy Consciousness	ANALYSIS: One clause of cross-link each; they belong to Topics 06 and 05.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Promoted to Core, 15 Aug 2026** - marks-essential for subjectivity and anti-Hegel questions.
- Six steps: objective truth is transmissible -> existential truth is a **mode of existing** -> direct transmission **falsifies** it -> therefore **indirect communication** -> **Socratic maieutics**, "deceives into the truth", **vanishing occasion** -> therefore **pseudonymity**.
- Pseudonyms: **Victor Eremita** · **Johannes de Silentio** · **Constantin Constantius** · **Vigilius Haufniensis** · **Johannes Climacus** · **Anti-Climacus**.
- **Double authorship**: signed *Upbuilding Discourses* run beside the pseudonymous books.
- "**First and Last Declaration**", *Postscript* **1846**: "author's author", **prompter** (*souffleur*), cite the pseudonym.
- Objections: unattributability (reply: signed pole + *Point of View*, itself disputed) · self-undermining (reply: Climacus **revokes** the *Postscript*) · Hegelian sublation (counter: no system contains its builder).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

EXISTENTIAL TRUTH IS A MODE OF EXISTING -> DIRECT TELLING TURNS IT INTO A RESULT AND FALSIFIES IT -> SO THE FORM MUST WITHHOLD THE RESULT -> SOCRATIC MIDWIFERY, 'deceives into the truth', the author VANISHES -> PSEUDONYMS AS EXISTENCE-POSSIBILITIES (Eremita, de Silentio, Constantius, Haufniensis, Climacus, Anti-Climacus) -> DOUBLE AUTHORSHIP with the SIGNED discourses -> 'FIRST AND LAST DECLARATION' 1846: cite the pseudonym -> and the POSTSCRIPT REVOKES ITSELF, which is the cost the method intends

SESSION 6 - SARTRE: "EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE", THE PAPER-KNIFE, AND WHY HEIDEGGER REPUDIATED THE SLOGAN

DEFINITION. *Plain language*: a paper-knife exists because someone first had a design for it; Sartre says a human being is the one thing that turns up first and gets defined afterwards, because there is no designer. *Technical*: **existence precedes essence** is the thesis that, for the human being alone, there is no antecedent nature or blueprint that fixes what it is to be; a person **first exists, encounters himself, surges up in the world - and defines himself afterwards**, so that what he is is constituted through the project he takes up in situation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Sartre's slogan is an argument, not a motto: if there is no divine artisan then there is no antecedent design for the human being, and everything the lecture goes on to claim about freedom, anguish and responsibility is an inference from that single missing premise.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. existence precedes essence · paper-knife (*coupe-papier*) · artisan and design · atheism as a **premise**, not a conclusion · "man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" · facticity as constraint · *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, lecture October **1945**, published **1946** · "Letter on Humanism", written 1946, published **1947** · "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence" (*Being and Time* Section 9) · metaphysics of subjectivity · shepherd of Being.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

THE PAPER-KNIFE

- 1 The artisan has a CONCEPT:
what it is for, how it cuts.
- 2 He then MAKES it.
- 3 So ESSENCE (design/function)
comes BEFORE EXISTENCE.

Traditional theism said MAN was
like this: God conceives human
nature, then creates individuals
to that blueprint.

THE HUMAN BEING (Sartre)

- 1 There is NO artisan, because
there is no God.
- 2 So there is no prior concept
of 'human nature' waiting to
be filled in.
- 3 The person turns up FIRST -
and is defined AFTERWARDS,
by what he makes of himself.

So EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE.

What this shows: the slogan is the conclusion of a two-line argument whose premise is the denial of the artisan. State the premise and the slogan stops being a slogan.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the argument, its provenance, and the two other thinkers' positions on it.

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+-----+
| THE ARGUMENT (Existentialism Is a Humanism - lecture October |
| 1945, PUBLISHED 1946. NOT Being and Nothingness 1943)      |
|                                                                 |
| P1 For a MANUFACTURED object, the artisan conceives the design |
| (essence/function) and THEN produces it. ESSENCE PRECEDES    |
| EXISTENCE. Sartre's example: the PAPER-KNIFE (coupe-papier)  |
| P2 Theism treats MAN analogously: God conceives 'human nature'|
| and creates individuals to that blueprint.                    |
| P3 THERE IS NO GOD. (ATHEISM IS A PREMISE OF SARTRE'S        |
| ARGUMENT, NOT A CONCLUSION FROM IT.)                          |
|-----|
| C There is no prior design. 'Man first of all exists,         |
| encounters himself, surges up in the world - and defines     |
| himself afterwards.' EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE.              |
+-----+

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v

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+-----+
| WHAT FOLLOWS, AND WHAT MUST BE QUALIFIED                     |
| FOLLOWS: no blueprint exhausts human reality; the for-itself |
| (pour-soi) must TAKE UP a project; responsibility is radical |
| QUALIFY: biology, history and society form FACTICITY and     |
| constraint. 'Man is nothing else but what he makes of        |
| himself' is the 1946 LECTURE's formula and must be BALANCED  |
| BY SITUATION. The slogan denies a PRIOR ESSENCE; it does not  |
| deny that circumstances limit what can be done               |
+-----+

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|

<pre> +-----+ v HEIDEGGER REPUDIATES IT 'LETTER ON HUMANISM', written 1946, published 1947 * 'THE ESSENCE OF DASEIN LIES IN ITS EXISTENCE' (Being and Time SECTION 9) is an ONTOLOGICAL claim - Dasein's 'what' is not a fixed quidditas but its MANNER OF BEING, its Existenz, its standing-out into the clearing of Being * Sartre merely REVERSES the essence/ existence priority while KEEPING the humanistic frame: he stays inside the METAPHYSICS OF SUBJECTIVITY * The question is not man's SELF-CREATION but BEING. Man is the 'SHEPHERD OF BEING', not the lord of beings +-----+ </pre>	<pre> +-----+ v KIERKEGAARD NEVER WROTE IT He died in 1855. His refusal of an antecedent essence takes an entirely different form: the EXISTING INDIVIDUAL who cannot be completed inside a system - and he is a CHRISTIAN, so the atheistic premise is unavailable +-----+ </pre>
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SO: 2024 Q4(a) asks what 'the existentialist THINKERS' mean by the slogan. The correct answer NAMES ITS OWNER and then shows that the other two printed thinkers do NOT hold it - one repudiating it, one never having encountered it.

Caption: the right-hand panel is the whole reason 2024 Q4(a) is a twenty-mark question rather than a definition. The paper attributes the slogan to "the existentialist thinkers"; a prepared answer corrects the attribution while still answering the question that was asked.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The paper-knife (coupe-papier).** FACT: For a manufactured object the artisan first conceives its design and function, and *then* produces it: essence precedes existence. Traditional philosophy and theism treated *man* analogously - God conceives "human nature" and then creates individuals to that blueprint.
2. **Sartre's denial, and the exact place of atheism.** FACT: There is no God; therefore there is no prior design. ANALYSIS: **Atheism is a premise, not a conclusion.** Sartre does not argue from existentialism to atheism; he argues from atheism to the slogan. This is why the slogan in its Sartrean form is **not definitional of existentialism as such** - Kierkegaard is an existentialist *and* a theist.
3. **The formula.** FACT: "Man first of all exists, encounters himself, surges up in the world - and defines himself afterwards." The consequence for the **for-itself** (*pour-soi*) is that no predetermined blueprint exhausts human reality.

4. **The qualification that separates a good script from a slogan-repeating one.** ANALYSIS: Biology, history and society form **facticity** and constraint; they do not by themselves settle the meaning or project one takes up. "Man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" belongs to the **1946 lecture** and must be **balanced by situation**. The thesis denies an antecedent essence; it does not deny that circumstances limit what is practically possible.
5. **Provenance - a free precision mark.** FACT: *Existentialism Is a Humanism* (*L'existentialisme est un humanisme*) was **delivered as a public lecture in October 1945 and published in 1946**. The slogans - "existence precedes essence", "condemned to be free", "man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" - come from **there**, not from *Being and Nothingness* (1943). ANALYSIS: Sartre later regretted publishing the lecture; say so in a clause and the examiner sees a reader rather than a repeater.
6. **Heidegger's repudiation.** FACT: In the "**Letter on Humanism**" (written **1946**, published **1947**) Heidegger explicitly disowns Sartre's reading. His own sentence - "**the essence of Dasein lies in its existence**", *Being and Time* **Section 9** - does **not** mean "existence precedes essence" in Sartre's voluntarist sense. It is an **ontological** claim: Dasein's "what" is not a fixed *quidditas* but its very **manner of being** - its being-open-to-Being, its *Existenz*, its standing-out into the clearing of Being.
7. **The charge behind the repudiation.** ANALYSIS: Sartre, Heidegger holds, remains trapped in the **metaphysics of subjectivity**: he merely **reverses** the essence/existence priority while keeping the humanistic framework with man at the centre. For Heidegger the question is not man's self-creation but **Being** - man is the "**shepherd of Being**", not the lord of beings.
8. **Kierkegaard's very different refusal.** FACT: Kierkegaard never wrote the slogan and could not have accepted its premise. His refusal of an antecedent essence takes the form of the **existing individual** who cannot be completed inside a system (Session 2) - a refusal made *within* a God-relation, not against it.
9. **What the three share, stated exactly.** ANALYSIS: All three deny that a general essence settles in advance what it is for this individual to exist. **How** they deny it differs: Sartre by removing the designer, Heidegger by reconceiving what "essence" means for the entity whose being is at issue, Kierkegaard by insisting that existing is a task rather than a classification. That sentence is the correct core of any 2024 Q4(a) answer.
10. **The standing objection.** CAUTION: If there are no antecedent values, what makes one project better than another? Sartre's answer - that the *engagement* of choice generates its own criteria - is charged with circularity and with **decisionism** (Iris Murdoch, *The Sovereignty of Good*; Marxist critics). ANALYSIS: The honest verdict: the doctrine foregrounds project and responsibility but leaves value-criteria and situated constraint underdeveloped.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. "Existence precedes essence" is Sartre's thesis and Sartre's alone among the three printed thinkers, and it is the conclusion of an argument whose decisive premise is the denial of a divine artisan. **Named evidence.** In the lecture *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, delivered in October 1945 and published in 1946, Sartre argues from the paper-knife (*coupe-papier*), whose design precedes its manufacture, to the claim that since there is no God there is no antecedent concept of human nature, so that man "first of all exists, encounters himself, surges up in the world - and defines himself afterwards"; Heidegger, in the "Letter on Humanism", written 1946 and published 1947, rejects the formula and insists that his own sentence at *Being and Time* Section 9, that the essence of Dasein lies in its existence, is an ontological claim about Dasein's manner of being rather than a humanistic inversion. **Analysis.** The two positions are not variants of one doctrine: Sartre reverses the traditional priority while keeping man at the centre, which is exactly what Heidegger calls the metaphysics of subjectivity, and Kierkegaard, who died in 1855, refuses antecedent essence in a third way - by treating existing as a task before God that no system can complete. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Even in Sartre the slogan must be balanced by facticity: biology, history and social position constrain what can be done, and the lecture's formula that man is nothing but what he makes of himself is a rhetorical compression of a doctrine that elsewhere insists freedom is exercised only in situation.

EXAM LINK. This session is the whole of **2024 Q4(a)** and the opening of **2020 Q4(a)**; it also supplies the fence sentence that any comparison question needs, and the provenance line that upgrades every Sartre answer in the clause.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Attributing the slogan to all three thinkers	FACT: It is Sartre's . Heidegger repudiated it in 1946/47; Kierkegaard died in 1855 .
Sourcing the slogan to <i>Being and Nothingness</i>	FACT: It is from the lecture of October 1945 , published 1946 . <i>Being and Nothingness</i> is 1943 .
Treating atheism as a conclusion of the argument	FACT: It is a premise . The argument runs <i>from</i> the absence of a designer <i>to</i> the absence of a blueprint.
Reading the slogan as "circumstances do not matter"	ANALYSIS: Facticity constrains. The thesis denies an antecedent essence, not situation.
Quoting Section 9 as Heideggerian agreement with Sartre	FACT: "The essence of Dasein lies in its existence" is ontological ; Heidegger denies the humanist reading in the same breath.
Ignoring the value-criteria objection	CAUTION: Decisionism is the strongest standing objection; name it and rule on it.

REVISION NOTES.

- Argument: artisan -> design -> object; **no God** -> **no blueprint** -> existence first, essence afterwards.
- Example: **paper-knife** (*coupe-papier*). Formula: "**man first of all exists ... and defines himself afterwards**".
- **Atheism is a premise**, not a conclusion.
- Provenance: lecture **Oct 1945**, published **1946**; *Being and Nothingness* is **1943**; Sartre **regretted** publishing the lecture.
- Heidegger: "**Letter on Humanism**" written **1946**, published **1947**; Section 9 is **ontological**; Sartre stays in the **metaphysics of subjectivity**; man is the **shepherd of Being**.
- Kierkegaard: never wrote it; refuses antecedent essence as the **existing individual** before God.
- Objection: **decisionism** / no value-criteria (Murdoch, Marxists); verdict - powerful on responsibility, thin on criteria.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

PAPER-KNIFE: design BEFORE object -> theism said MAN is like that ->
 SARTRE'S PREMISE: THERE IS NO GOD -> so NO blueprint -> EXISTENCE
 PRECEDES ESSENCE (lecture Oct 1945, published 1946) -> but FACTICITY
 still constrains -> HEIDEGGER REPUDIATES (Letter on Humanism, 1946/
 47): Section 9 is ONTOLOGICAL, Sartre only REVERSES metaphysics ->
 KIERKEGAARD never wrote it and could not accept the premise ->
 SHARED REFUSAL, THREE DIFFERENT REASONS

SESSION 7 - SARTRE: BEING-IN-ITSELF AND BEING-FOR-ITSELF, NIHILATION, AND "CONSCIOUSNESS IS WHAT IT IS NOT AND IS NOT WHAT IT IS"

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* a stone simply is what it is; consciousness never simply is anything, because it is always standing back from what it is and reaching towards what it is not yet - and that gap is what Sartre calls nothingness. *Technical:* **being-in-itself** (*en-soi*) is being that is full, solid, self-identical and opaque - "it is what it is"; **being-for-itself** (*pour-soi*) is consciousness as **nihilating** and self-surpassing - "it is what it is not and is not what it is"; the for-itself is "the being by which **nothingness** (*neant*) comes into the world", and its structural desire to become self-identical while remaining conscious - to be a *pour-soi-en-soi*, which is God - is contradictory.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Sartre's formula that consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is looks like a paradox and is in fact a definition: it says that the for-itself is constituted by a gap it can never close, and every later doctrine - freedom, bad faith, temporality, the useless passion - is an application of that single structural claim.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. being-in-itself (*en-soi*) · being-for-itself (*pour-soi*) · self-identity against non-self-identity · nihilation (*neantisation*) · nothingness (*neant*) · "de trop" (superfluous, in excess) · project · the impossible

pour-soi-en-soi · "man is a useless passion" · ontological, not mind-matter.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

A STONE

It is a stone. Fully. With no distance from itself. Nothing in it stands back and asks whether it should be a stone.

IT IS WHAT IT IS.

A WAITER

He IS a waiter (job, uniform, history) - and simultaneously IS NOT a waiter, because he can question it, resent it, quit tomorrow, imagine otherwise.

HE IS WHAT HE IS NOT
AND IS NOT WHAT HE IS.

What this shows: the formula is not word-play. It marks the difference between a being with no internal distance and a being that is nothing but internal distance.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the two regions of being, the two halves of the formula, and the impossible synthesis.

	EN-SOI (being-in-itself)
NATURE	full, solid, SELF-IDENTICAL, opaque
FORMULA	'IT IS WHAT IT IS'
EXAMPLES	a stone, a table - they simply ARE
FREEDOM	none: complete, determined
TEMPORALITY	not defined by projective temporal transcendence
CONTINGENCY	groundless, brute - 'DE TROP', in excess
	POUR-SOI (being-for-itself)
NATURE	NIHILATING, self-surpassing, NEVER self- identical
FORMULA	'IT IS WHAT IT IS NOT AND IS NOT WHAT IT IS'
EXAMPLE	consciousness - always BEYOND itself, intending what it is not, negating what it is
FREEDOM	structurally inescapable, yet SITUATED and FACTICAL
TEMPORALITY	ECSTATIC - related to past facticity and future project
DESIRE	to BECOME en-soi while staying conscious
	v
THE TWO HALVES OF THE FORMULA - UNPACK BOTH, ALWAYS	
'IS WHAT IT IS NOT'	consciousness is always AHEAD of itself, projecting toward possibil- ities it does not yet possess. It IS (is defined by) its FUTURE - which does not yet exist
'IS NOT WHAT IT IS'	consciousness can never COINCIDE with its past or its facticity. The waiter IS a waiter (facticity) and simultaneously IS NOT one (he transcends the role, is free to quit)
	v
HOW IS THIS POSSIBLE? NIHILATION (neantisation)	
Consciousness introduces NOTHINGNESS (neant) into being: it stands back from what is and NEGATES it - questions it, imagines alternatives, projects beyond it. The pour-soi is 'THE BEING BY WHICH NOTHINGNESS COMES INTO THE WORLD'.	
	v
THE IMPOSSIBLE SYNTHESIS	
The pour-soi PERPETUALLY DESIRES to become en-soi - to achieve full self-identity WHILE REMAINING CONSCIOUS. That would be a POUR-SOI-EN-SOI = GOD, and it is a CONTRADICTION. Human reality is defined by this impossible desire: hence 'MAN IS A USELESS PASSION'.	

*Caption: read the two-column table first and the formula becomes readable; read the bottom two panels and it becomes an argument. Nihilation explains **how** the gap is possible; the impossible synthesis explains **why** it can never be closed.*

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The distinction is ontological, not psychological or physical.** ANALYSIS: *En-soi* is **not** "matter" and *pour-soi* is **not** "mind". The contrast is between **being that is what it is** (self-identical) and **being that is not what it is** (nihilating). FACT: This correction is a standing UPSC trap and belongs in the first three lines of any answer on the pair.

2. **The in-itself.** FACT: Full, solid, self-identical, opaque; it *simply is*. It is **contingent** and groundless - "**de trop**", in excess - which is the ontological root of the experience Sartre calls nausea.
3. **The for-itself.** FACT: Consciousness, which is always *beyond* itself: intending what it is not, negating what it is, never coinciding with itself.
4. **"Is what it is not."** FACT: Consciousness is always **ahead of itself**, projecting toward possibilities it does not yet possess; it *is* - in the sense of being defined by - its **future**, which does not yet exist.
5. **"Is not what it is."** FACT: Consciousness can never coincide with its **past** or its **facticity**. The waiter *is* a waiter (facticity) and simultaneously *is not* a waiter (he transcends the role and is free to quit).
6. **Nihilation (neantisation) is the mechanism.** FACT: Non-self-identity is possible because consciousness introduces **nothingness** (*neant*) into being: it stands back from what is and negates it - questions it, imagines alternatives, projects beyond it. The for-itself is "the being by which nothingness comes into the world."
ANALYSIS: Say *how*, not just *that*: the question form, the imagined alternative and the projected possibility are the three concrete faces of nihilation.
7. **The impossible synthesis and the "useless passion".** FACT: The for-itself perpetually desires to become **en-soi** - to achieve full self-identity *while remaining conscious*. That would be a **pour-soi-en-soi**, which is what "God" would have to mean, and it is a contradiction. Human reality is defined by this impossible desire; hence Sartre's formula that man is a **useless passion**.
8. **What the formula grounds.** ANALYSIS: This single structure generates the rest of the system: **freedom** (nothing in me is fixed enough to determine me), **bad faith** (the attempt to be self-identical anyway), **temporality** (the for-itself exists as past-facticity and future-project), and the **desire to be God**. Saying this explicitly is what turns 2023 Q3(c) from an exposition into an argument.
9. **The standing objection.** CAUTION: Is "non-self-identity" coherent, or a contradiction dressed in phenomenological language? ANALYSIS: The reply is that the claim is not that consciousness violates the law of identity but that consciousness is not the kind of thing that has a completed nature to be identical with - it exists as a relation to its own possibilities. Whether this reply succeeds is contested, and the honest closer says so.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Sartre's formula that consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is states the defining structure of the for-itself: a being constituted by an internal distance from itself that it cannot close. **Named evidence.** *Being and Nothingness* (1943) divides being into the in-itself, which is full, self-identical and contingent - "de trop" - and the for-itself, which is nihilating and self-surpassing; the waiter who is a waiter in his facticity and is not one in his transcendence is Sartre's own illustration of the second half of the formula, and the first half is exhibited in the fact that consciousness is defined by a future that does not yet exist. **Analysis.** The two halves are made possible by nihilation (*neantisation*): consciousness introduces nothingness into being by standing back from what is, questioning it and projecting beyond it, which is why Sartre calls the for-itself the being by which nothingness comes into the world, and why the for-itself's desire to become self-identical while remaining conscious - to be a *pour-soi-en-soi*, that is, God - is a contradictory ideal that makes man a useless passion. **Qualification.** CAUTION: Whether non-self-identity is a coherent ontological category or a contradiction in phenomenological dress remains disputed; the reply that the for-itself has no completed nature with which to be identical is defensible but not decisive.

EXAM LINK. This session is the whole of **2025 Q1(c)** and the whole of **2023 Q3(c)**, and it supplies the ontology that **2019 Q4(c)** (freedom and determinism), **2021 Q4(b)** (choice) and **2018 Q1(d)** (bad faith and alienation) all presuppose. Five of the fourteen owned parts stand on this one distinction.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
<i>En-soi</i> = matter, <i>pour-soi</i> = mind	FACT: The distinction is ontological : self-identical being against nihilating being, not a mind-matter dualism.
Unpacking only one half of the formula	FACT: "Is what it is not" = the future/project ; "is not what it is" = the past/facticity . Both halves, always.

Trap	Correction
Treating nihilation as destruction	ANALYSIS: It is the introduction of nothingness : questioning, imagining alternatives, projecting beyond the given.
Omitting the impossible synthesis	FACT: The <i>pour-soi-en-soi</i> is God and is contradictory; hence the "useless passion". Without it the account has no conclusion.
Forgetting contingency	FACT: The in-itself is " de trop " - groundless and in excess; this is the root of nausea.
Presenting non-self-identity as beyond criticism	CAUTION: Name the coherence objection and rule on it.

REVISION NOTES.

- **En-soi**: full, self-identical, opaque, contingent (**de trop**) - "it is what it is".
- **Pour-soi**: nihilating, self-surpassing, never self-identical - "it is what it is not and is not what it is".
- Half 1 = ahead of itself, defined by a **future** that does not exist; Half 2 = cannot coincide with **past/facticity** (the waiter).
- **Nihilation** (*neantisation*): consciousness introduces **nothingness** (*neant*) - questions, imagines, projects.
- Impossible synthesis: **pour-soi-en-soi = God**; hence "**man is a useless passion**".
- Grounds freedom, bad faith, temporality, the desire to be God.
- Objection: is non-self-identity coherent? Reply: no completed nature to be identical with. **Contested**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

TWO REGIONS OF BEING -> EN-SOI 'is what it is' (full, self-identical, DE TROP) | POUR-SOI 'is what it is not and is not what it is' ->
 HALF 1: ahead of itself, defined by a FUTURE that does not exist ->
 HALF 2: cannot coincide with its PAST/FACTICITY (the waiter) ->
 HOW? NIHILATION - consciousness puts NOTHINGNESS into being ->
 THEREFORE freedom, bad faith, ecstatic temporality -> AND the impossible desire to be POUR-SOI-EN-SOI (God) -> 'MAN IS A USELESS PASSION'

SESSION 8 - SARTRE: RADICAL BUT SITUATED FREEDOM, CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY, AND THE THREE MOODS

DEFINITION. *Plain language*: for Sartre freedom is not something you have, like a talent; it is what you are, so you cannot put it down - and even refusing to decide is a decision. *Technical*: the **for-itself** is *constituted* by freedom: it is the nihilating, self-transcending movement that continually surpasses what it is toward what it is not yet. Freedom is therefore **structurally inescapable** but exercised only **in situation**; **anguish** (*angoisse*), **abandonment** (*délaissement*) and **despair** (*desespoir*) are the three moods in which this structure is lived.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Sartre's claim that we are condemned to be free is not rhetoric about the burden of choice but a structural thesis: freedom is not a capacity the for-itself possesses and might set aside, it is what the for-itself is - which is why the attempt to escape choosing is itself a choice, and typically a choice of bad faith.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. freedom is what we **are**, not what we have · "man is condemned to be free" · non-choice is choice · situation and facticity · anguish (*angoisse*) · abandonment (*délaissement*) · despair (*desespoir*) · "in choosing myself, I choose man" · quasi-Kantian universalisability · radical responsibility.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

'I'LL DECIDE LATER.'

Deferral feels like NOT choosing. So does going along with what everyone does. So does 'having no choice'.

SARTRE'S REPLY

Deferring IS deciding - to let circumstances, or other people, or the passage of time settle the matter. The outcome you did not choose is the outcome your non-choice produced.

|

v

And pretending otherwise -
'I had no option' - is the
standard form of BAD FAITH.

What this shows: the doctrine is not that every option is open. It is that no stance towards a situation is stance-free.

VISUAL: VISUAL - freedom, its three moods, and the two boundaries that must be stated.

[illegible]

Caption: the bottom panel is the difference between a script that has understood Sartre and one that has caricatured him. Sartre's freedom is unlimited in kind - there is no situation in which the for-itself becomes a thing - and severely limited in scope.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Freedom is constitutive, not possessed.** FACT: The *pour-soi* is *constituted* by freedom: it **is** the nihilating, self-transcending movement of consciousness that continually surpasses what it is toward what it is not yet. ANALYSIS: This is why Sartre cannot treat freedom as one human capacity among others that might be absent in some people or some conditions.
2. **"Man is condemned to be free."** FACT: From *Existentialism Is a Humanism* (lecture **1945**, published **1946**). We did not choose to exist, yet cannot escape taking up a stance within our situations. ANALYSIS: "Thrown" is

Heidegger's term (*Geworfenheit*) and should not be silently made Sartre's own - a small attribution discipline that examiners notice.

3. **Non-choice is choice.** FACT: "I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing." Inaction, deferral and conformity are themselves choices; the attempt to escape choice is already a choice, and typically a choice of **bad faith** (Session 9).
4. **Anguish (angoisse).** FACT: Not fear of an object but **vertigo before one's own freedom**: I recognise that my future is radically undetermined, that nothing compels me, and that "I am not sustained by anything, nothing justifies me." ANALYSIS: Session 17 gives the cliff-path and the gambler, which are the two examples that make this concrete.
5. **Abandonment (délaissement).** FACT: There is no God, no cosmic moral order and no *a priori* values written in an "intelligible heaven"; I must therefore **invent** values through my choosing and cannot lean on a pre-given ethical framework.
6. **Despair (désespoir).** FACT: In the lecture this means confining oneself to what lies within one's action and to reasonable probabilities, rather than relying on outcomes beyond one's control. ANALYSIS: It is **not** Kierkegaard's theological despair, and the two must be kept apart explicitly (Session 4).
7. **Universalisability: "in choosing myself, I choose man."** FACT: A quasi-Kantian principle: every choice implies an image of what human beings *ought* to be. If I choose to marry, I affirm that monogamy is valuable *for everyone*; I cannot choose "just for me" in moral isolation. This generates the **weight** of responsibility and the anguish that accompanies it - I am not merely deciding my own fate but **legislating** an image of humanity.
8. **The internal tension in universalisability.** CAUTION: It appears to conflict with the denial of *a priori* values: whence the universalisability demand if no prior moral framework is given? **Sartre's reply**: the *form* of universalisability is inherent in the **structure of free choice**, not imported from a pre-existing ethics. ANALYSIS: Kantians and communitarians press the point; Sartre concedes tension, and the posthumous *Notebooks for an Ethics* attempts a more substantive ethics but was never completed.
9. **Boundary 1 - situation.** ANALYSIS: Sartre does **not** deny that facticity limits practical possibilities. Early Sartre calls freedom "absolute" in the **structural** sense that the for-itself cannot become a completed thing: it must take up a stance. This is not omnipotence, and coercion, trauma and social structures can constrain both action and the intelligibility of alternatives.
10. **Boundary 2 - "there are no excuses".** ANALYSIS: The phrase expresses responsibility for **taking up** motives and situations. It must not be converted into the psychologically implausible claim that trauma, illness, coercion or affect can be dismissed at will. FACT: Stating this boundary is what allows an answer to be critical without being dismissive.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Sartre's freedom is inescapable in structure and constrained in scope, and the two claims are consistent only because freedom is what the for-itself is rather than something it has. **Named evidence.** In *Existentialism Is a Humanism* (lecture 1945, published 1946) Sartre writes that man is condemned to be free, that not choosing is still choosing, and that in choosing myself I choose man; the same lecture names the three moods in which this structure is lived - anguish before one's own undetermined future, abandonment in the absence of any *a priori* value written in an intelligible heaven, and despair in the sense of not relying on what lies beyond one's action. **Analysis.** Because the for-itself is the nihilating movement by which any given is surpassed, no situation converts it into a completed thing, which is why deferral and conformity are stances rather than absences of stance, and why responsibility extends to the meaning one confers on one's circumstances; the quasi-Kantian universalisability clause then supplies the weight that turns this structure into anguish, since each choice projects an image of humanity. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: "Absolute" here is structural rather than practical: facticity limits what can be done, "there are no excuses" concerns the taking up of motives and not the dismissal of trauma or coercion, and Sartre himself broadened the account in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) with scarcity, seriality and the practico-inert.

EXAM LINK. This session is the whole of **2021 Q4(b)** and the second half of **2024 Q4(a)**; it is the doctrinal base for **2019 Q4(c)** and **2020 Q4(a)** (Session 10), and it supplies the responsibility clause that a bad-faith answer (Session 9) needs in order to reach a verdict.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
"Sartrean freedom means constraints are unreal"	ANALYSIS: Facticity constrains . The early claim concerns how situations acquire meaning and are taken up.
Using "thrown" as Sartre's own term	FACT: <i>Geworfenheit</i> is Heidegger's . Sartre's parallel is that we did not choose to exist yet must take a stance.
Merging Sartre's <i>desespoir</i> with Kierkegaard's despair	FACT: Lecture-term about outcomes against a theological misrelation . Two doctrines.
Reading "no excuses" as a denial of trauma or coercion	ANALYSIS: It concerns responsibility for taking up motives; the stronger reading is the caricature critics attack.
Dropping the universalisability clause	FACT: "In choosing myself, I choose man" is where the weight of responsibility and the anguish come from.
Presenting universalisability as untroubled	CAUTION: It sits uneasily with the denial of objective values; name the tension and Sartre's structural reply.

REVISION NOTES.

- Freedom is **what the for-itself is**, not what it has; the nihilating surpassing of any given.
- **"Man is condemned to be free"** - lecture **1945**, published **1946**. "Thrown" is **Heidegger's** word.
- **Non-choice is choice**; the attempt to escape choice is a choice, usually **bad faith**.
- Three moods: **anguish** (vertigo before my own freedom) · **abandonment** (no *a priori* values) · **despair** (do not rely on what is beyond my action).
- **"In choosing myself, I choose man"** - quasi-Kantian universalisability; source of the **weight** and the anguish.
- Tension: universalisability against the denial of objective values; reply = form inherent in free choice; *Notebooks for an Ethics* unfinished.
- Two boundaries: freedom is **situated**; **"no excuses"** = responsibility for taking up motives, not denial of coercion.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

FREEDOM IS WHAT THE FOR-ITSELF IS -> 'CONDEMNED TO BE FREE' (1945/46)
-> NON-CHOICE IS CHOICE -> lived as ANGUISH (vertigo before my freedom) + ABANDONMENT (no *a priori* values) + DESPAIR (no reliance on outcomes) -> weighted by 'IN CHOOSING MYSELF I CHOOSE MAN' ->
BUT FREEDOM IS SITUATED (facticity limits) AND 'NO EXCUSES' MEANS RESPONSIBILITY FOR TAKING UP MOTIVES, NOT DENIAL OF COERCION

SESSION 9 - SARTRE: FACTICITY AND TRANSCENDENCE, BAD FAITH, AND THE ROUTE FROM INAUTHENTICITY TO ALIENATION

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* bad faith is not ordinary lying; it is the trick of treating yourself as a fixed thing so that you do not have to answer for what you do - or, in the opposite direction, of pretending your situation places no limits on you at all. *Technical:* **bad faith** (*mauvaise foi*) is a form of self-deception in which the for-itself flees its freedom by identifying exclusively with **facticity** - the given: body, past, social position, situation - or flees its situation by identifying exclusively with **transcendence** - the freedom to negate facticity and project beyond what one presently is. Bad faith is the denial of the **tension** between the two, not the denial of either.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Bad faith is not the lie one tells another but the project of ceasing to be a question to oneself: by collapsing into facticity alone or into transcendence alone, the for-itself buys relief from the tension that constitutes it - and pays for that relief with the alienation of living as a thing among things."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. bad faith (*mauvaise foi*) · facticity (*facticité*) · transcendence · collapsing into one dimension · the waiter · the woman on the date · the double lie · the paradox of self-deception · pre-reflective, non-thetic awareness · the Freudian unconscious rejected · inauthenticity · alienation · the serious spirit.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

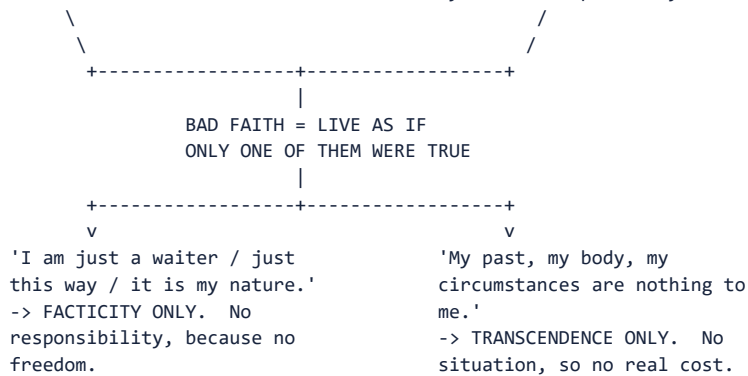
EVERY PERSON HAS TWO SIDES AT ONCE

FACTICITY

what is GIVEN: my body, my
past, my class, my job, my
situation

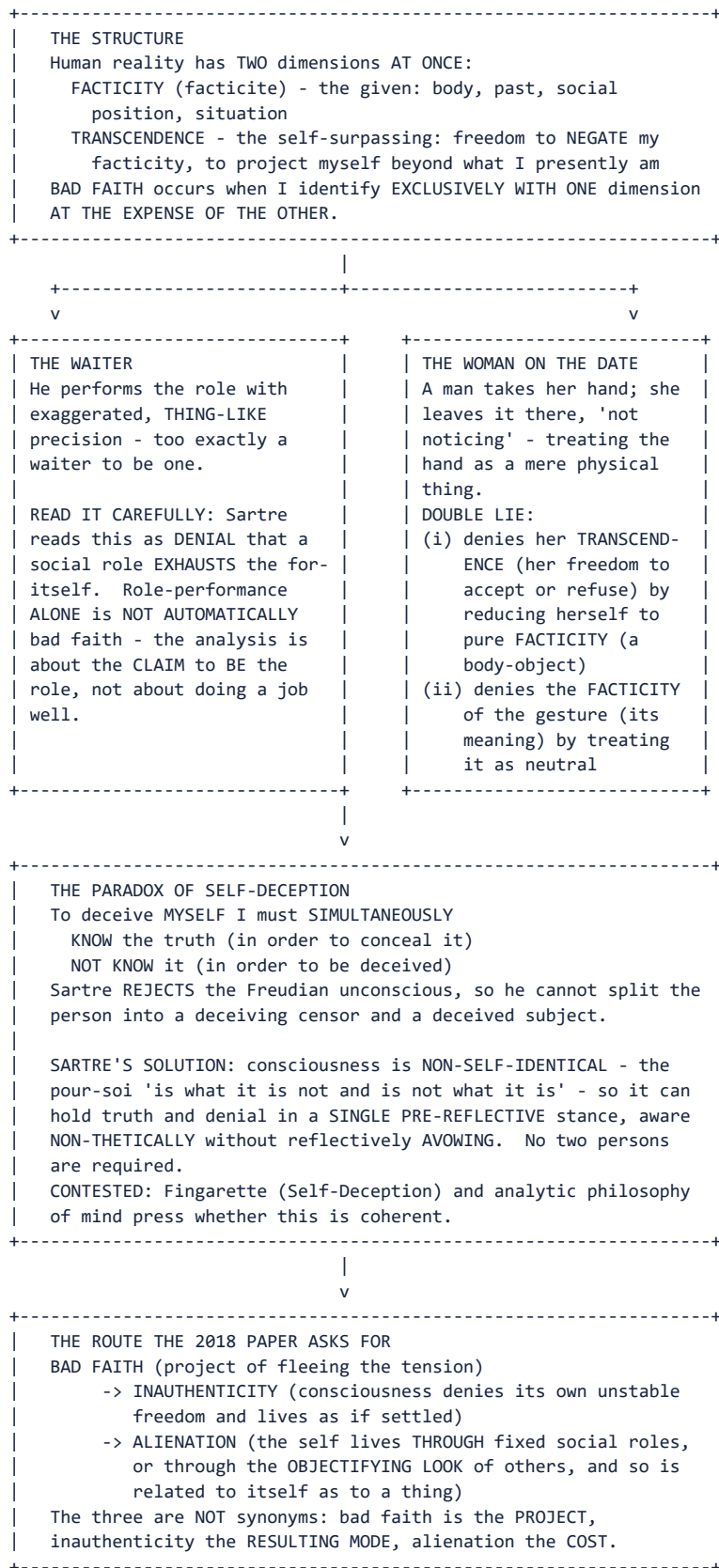
TRANSCENDENCE

what SURPASSES it: my freedom
to negate, question, project
beyond what I presently am



What this shows: bad faith always has the same shape - one of the two dimensions is silently deleted. Naming which one is deleted is how an answer analyses an example instead of retelling it.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the structure, the two examples, the paradox, and the route to alienation.



Caption: the bottom panel is the exact chain 2018 Q1(d) asks for. Answering it well means showing that the three terms are ordered - a project, a mode and a cost - rather than three names for one idea.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Define bad faith by its structure, not by "lying to oneself".** FACT: It is a flight from freedom achieved by pretending to be a fixed *thing* (*en-soi*) - or, conversely, a flight from facticity achieved by pretending to be pure transcendence. ANALYSIS: The doctrine is the **collapse of the tension**, and an answer that stops at "self-deception" has not stated it.

2. **Facticity and transcendence.** FACT: **Facticity** is the given - body, past, social position, situation. **Transcendence** is the self-surpassing - the freedom to negate facticity and project beyond what one presently is. Both are always present; bad faith deletes one.
3. **The waiter, read accurately.** FACT: The waiter performs his role with exaggerated, thing-like precision. ANALYSIS: **Sartre's point is the denial that a social role exhausts the for-itself; role-performance alone is not automatically bad faith.** The bad faith lies in the claim to *be* the role in the mode of the in-itself, not in doing the job well - a distinction most scripts miss.
4. **The woman on the date, and the double lie.** FACT: A man takes her hand; she leaves it there, "not noticing", treating the hand as a mere physical thing. She denies her **transcendence** - her freedom to accept or reject the advance - by reducing herself to pure **facticity**, a body-object; and simultaneously she denies the **facticity** of the gesture, its sexual meaning, by treating it as neutral. Two denials, in opposite directions, in one act.
5. **The paradox of self-deception.** ANALYSIS: To deceive myself I must *know* the truth in order to conceal it and *not know* it in order to be deceived. Sartre **rejects the Freudian unconscious**, so he cannot solve the paradox by splitting the person into a censor and a subject.
6. **Sartre's solution.** FACT: Consciousness is **non-self-identical** - the for-itself "is what it is not and is not what it is" (Session 7) - so it can hold truth and denial in a single **pre-reflective** stance: I am aware **non-thetically** without reflectively avowing. No two persons are required. CAUTION: Whether this is coherent remains debated; **Fingarette's Self-Deception** and analytic philosophy of mind press the point.
7. **The chain the 2018 paper asks for.** FACT: **Bad faith** is the *project* of treating oneself as only facticity or only transcendence in order to flee responsibility; **inauthenticity** follows because consciousness denies its own unstable freedom; **alienation** follows when the self lives through fixed social roles or through the objectifying look of others. ANALYSIS: Present them as ordered - project, mode, cost - not as synonyms.
8. **Why bad faith is not a rare pathology.** ANALYSIS: Because the tension it flees is constitutive, bad faith is a permanent temptation rather than an occasional vice; the "**serious spirit**" - treating values as though they were properties of the world rather than products of commitment - is its everyday social form.
9. **What Sartre does not supply.** CAUTION: *Being and Nothingness* gives a powerful critique of bad faith but **no developed positive doctrine of authenticity**; the promised ethics was never completed. ANALYSIS: Saying this is the correct closing qualification for any bad-faith answer, and it is also the honest reason Sartre's "authenticity" cannot be compared straightforwardly with Heidegger's *Eigentlichkeit*.
10. **The strongest external objection.** CAUTION: Radical freedom under-describes **gendered, racialised and material constraint** - a criticism pressed by **de Beauvoir, Fanon** and later feminist and postcolonial writers. ANALYSIS: Reply: situated freedom can appropriate facticity without being reducible to it, and later Sartre broadens social mediation - but the early vocabulary remains abstract, and that residue should be conceded.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Bad faith is best defined as the collapse of the tension between facticity and transcendence rather than as self-deception in general, and this definition is what makes Sartre's route from bad faith through inauthenticity to alienation intelligible. **Named evidence.** In *Being and Nothingness* (1943) Sartre analyses the waiter, whose exaggerated precision expresses the denial that a social role exhausts the for-itself, and the woman on the date, who leaves her hand in her companion's while "not noticing", thereby denying her own transcendence by reducing herself to a body-object and denying the facticity of the gesture by treating it as neutral. **Analysis.** Because the for-itself is constituted by the tension between what it is given as and what it projects, any project of living as though only one dimension were real must be a flight from that constitution, which is why bad faith is a permanent temptation rather than an occasional vice, and why its outcome is alienation: a self that lives through a fixed role or through another's objectifying gaze relates to itself as to a thing. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The account faces a live objection - since Sartre rejects the Freudian unconscious, self-deception must be lodged in a single pre-reflective, non-thetic awareness, and whether that is coherent is disputed by Fingarette and others; and *Being and Nothingness* offers no completed positive doctrine of authenticity to set against the critique.

EXAM LINK. This session is the whole of **2018 Q1(d)** (inauthenticity, bad faith, alienation), the second half of **2023 Q3(c)** (bad faith as the application of the non-self-identity formula), and the analytic core of **2020 Q4(a)** (Session 10) and **2021 Q4(b)** (Session 8), where evasion of choice is diagnosed as bad faith.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Defining bad faith as "lying to oneself"	FACT: It is the collapse of the facticity/transcendence tension into one dimension.
Saying the waiter is in bad faith merely by performing his role	ANALYSIS: Sartre's point is the denial that the role exhausts the for-itself; role-performance alone is not automatically bad faith.
Giving only one half of the woman's double lie	FACT: Both: transcendence denied (reduced to a body-object) and facticity denied (the gesture treated as neutral).
Solving the paradox by invoking the unconscious	FACT: Sartre rejects it; the solution is pre-reflective, non-thetic awareness within a non-self-identical consciousness.
Treating bad faith, inauthenticity and alienation as synonyms	FACT: Project -> mode -> cost . The 2018 question is precisely about the chain.
Claiming Sartre supplies a full theory of authenticity	CAUTION: <i>Being and Nothingness</i> gives the critique of its opposite; the positive ethics was never completed.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Bad faith** = flight from the **tension** by collapsing into **facticity** alone or **transcendence** alone.
- **Facticity** = body, past, social position, situation. **Transcendence** = freedom to negate and project.
- **Waiter** = denial that a role exhausts the for-itself (not "acting a role is bad faith").
- **Woman on the date** = **double lie** - denies her transcendence *and* the gesture's facticity.
- **Paradox**: must know and not know. **Unconscious rejected**. Solution = **pre-reflective, non-thetic** awareness; contested (Fingarette).
- 2018 chain: **bad faith (project) -> inauthenticity (mode) -> alienation (cost)**.
- Everyday form: the **serious spirit**. Residue: no completed positive authenticity; de Beauvoir/Fanon on constraint.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

TWO DIMENSIONS AT ONCE: FACTICITY + TRANSCENDENCE -> BAD FAITH =
 DELETE ONE -> WAITER (denies the role does not exhaust him) | WOMAN
 ON THE DATE (DOUBLE lie, both directions) -> PARADOX: know AND not
 know -> no Freudian unconscious, so PRE-REFLECTIVE NON-THETIC
 awareness in a NON-SELF-IDENTICAL consciousness -> BAD FAITH (project)
 -> INAUTHENTICITY (mode) -> ALIENATION (cost) -> and NO completed
 positive doctrine of authenticity in Being and Nothingness

SESSION 10 - SARTRE: FREEDOM OF CHOICE AND DETERMINISM, AND "YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE INTO"

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* Sartre's reply to determinism is not that causes do not exist but that a cause only becomes a *reason for acting* once I have given it that role - and giving it that role is something I do. *Technical:* causal, psychological and social explanations cannot convert the for-itself into a thing whose project is wholly fixed in advance, because a **motive** acquires action-guiding force only through the **meaning** conferred on it, and meaning-conferral is itself an act of the for-itself (nihilation and transcendence). Freedom is therefore exercised **in** situation, never **despite** it.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"For Sartre the quarrel between freedom and determinism is a false problem, because determinism misdescribes the for-itself as an in-itself: it treats a being that must confer meaning on its own past as though it were a thing standing among causes."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. motive and meaning-conferral · nihilation as the condition of motivation · the for-itself is not a thing among causes · "you can always make something out of what you have been made into" · situation · "there

are no excuses", qualified · practico-inert · scarcity · seriality · group-in-fusion · *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960).

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

THE DETERMINIST PICTURE

Desire ---> pushes ---> Action
like one billiard ball
striking another.

|

v

The person is a THING among
causes.

SARTRE'S CORRECTION

Desire is THERE. But it moves
me only as the desire I have
TAKEN UP as a reason, inside
a project I am pursuing.

|

v

Remove the project and the
same desire motivates nothing.
So the 'cause' had to pass
through an act of MEANING.

What this shows: the argument does not deny the desire. It denies that the desire can do the work without me.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the argument, the 2020 sentence, and what later Sartre concedes.

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+-----+
| THE KEY ARGUMENT (Being and Nothingness 1943)
| 1 A MOTIVE - a desire, an emotion, a situation - can become a
| REASON FOR ACTION only through the MEANING I confer on it.
| 2 Meaning-conferral is itself an ACT of the pour-soi -
| nihilation, transcendence, projection.
| 3 THEREFORE no motive determines me UNLESS I FREELY CONSTITUTE
| IT AS A MOTIVE.
| 4 THEREFORE determinism misdescribes the for-itself: it treats
| a nihilating being as an EN-SOI, a thing among causes.
| The 'problem' of freedom and determinism is a FALSE PROBLEM.
+-----+
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v

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+-----+
| THE 2020 SENTENCE, UNPACKED
| 'YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE
| INTO.'
|
| 'WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE INTO' = FACTICITY. Sartre CONCEDES
| the making: class, body, upbringing, history, the gaze of
| others. The sentence GRANTS the determinist his data.
| 'YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF' = TRANSCENDENCE. The
| for-itself must still take up that facticity in a project;
| it cannot receive it as a completed nature.
| 'ALWAYS' = the STRUCTURAL claim, not a promise of success.
| It says there is no situation in which the for-itself becomes
| a thing - NOT that every outcome is available.
+-----+
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|

v

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+-----+
| THE CRITICISM THAT LANDED, AND THE EVIDENCE THAT IT LANDED
| OBJECTION Radical freedom is psychologically and socially
| implausible: slavery, torture, mental illness and structural
| oppression limit not only ACTION but the COGNITIVE range of
| alternatives. (Merleau-Ponty, Adventures of the Dialectic;
| Marxist critics; de Beauvoir; Fanon)
| FIRST REPLY Distinguish freedom-of-CONSCIOUSNESS (I can always
| interpret) from freedom-of-ACTION (limited by situation).
| BUT this WEAKENS the radical thesis.
| THE DECISIVE EVIDENCE In the CRITIQUE OF DIALECTICAL REASON
| (1960) SARTRE HIMSELF integrates SCARCITY, SERIALITY and the
| PRACTICO-INERT, and introduces the GROUP-IN-FUSION. That
| self-revision is the best evidence the objection landed.
| USE IT AS A CONCESSION, NEVER AS THE DOCTRINE OF 1943.
+-----+
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Caption: the third panel is how to be critical without being crude. The strongest evidence against early Sartre is late Sartre - and citing the 1960 self-revision by name converts a generic "critics say" into an argument.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **State the position precisely.** FACT: In the early Sartrean account, causal, psychological and social explanations cannot convert the for-itself into a thing whose project is wholly fixed in advance. ANALYSIS: Note the wording: the claim is about *conversion into a thing*, not about the non-existence of causes.
2. **The key argument, in three steps.** FACT: A **motive** - desire, emotion, situation - becomes a reason for action only through the **meaning** I confer on it; meaning-conferral is itself an act of the for-itself (nihilation and transcendence); therefore **no motive determines me unless I freely constitute it as a motive**.
3. **Why the dispute is a false problem.** FACT: Determinism misunderstands the *pour-soi* by treating it as an *en-soi* - a thing among causes. The correct response is not to defeat determinism on its own ground but to show that its subject-matter has been misdescribed.
4. **The 2020 sentence, word by word.** FACT: "You can always make something out of what you have been made into." **"What you have been made into"** concedes facticity: class, body, upbringing, history, the gaze of others. **"You can always make something out of"** asserts transcendence: the for-itself must still take up that facticity in a project. **"Always"** is the **structural** claim - there is no situation in which the for-itself becomes a thing - and **not** a promise that every outcome is available. ANALYSIS: Unpacking the sentence in these three moves *is* the answer to 2020 Q4(a).
5. **"There are no excuses", qualified.** ANALYSIS: The phrase expresses responsibility for **taking up** motives and situations. It should not become the psychologically implausible claim that trauma, illness, coercion or affect can simply be dismissed at will.
6. **Situation and freedom.** FACT: Sartre does not deny that facticity limits practical possibilities. Early Sartre nevertheless calls freedom "absolute" in the **structural** sense that the for-itself cannot become a completed thing: it must take up a stance. ANALYSIS: This is not omnipotence - "I cannot fly, but I am free to interpret my inability and to project alternatives."
7. **The objection.** CAUTION: Radical freedom is psychologically and socially implausible: people under extreme oppression - slavery, torture, severe mental illness - are not "absolutely free", and structural oppression limits not merely action but the **cognitive** range of alternatives. Pressed by common sense, by the Marxist tradition (**Merleau-Ponty**, *Adventures of the Dialectic*), and by **de Beauvoir** and **Fanon** on gendered, racialised and material constraint.
8. **The first reply, and why it costs something.** ANALYSIS: Sartre distinguishes freedom of **consciousness** - always present, since I can always interpret - from freedom of **action**, limited by situation. CAUTION: This is a real reply, but it **weakens** the radical thesis, and an honest answer says so rather than presenting it as a clean defence.
9. **The decisive evidence.** FACT: In the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) Sartre himself integrates **scarcity**, **seriality** and the **practico-inert**, and introduces the **group-in-fusion** as a form of non-objectifying solidarity. ANALYSIS: Cite it as a **concession**, never as the doctrine of 1943 - the point is that the strongest objection is confirmed by the author's own revision.
10. **The executable verdict.** ANALYSIS: Freedom is the for-itself's non-coincidence with facticity, exercised only in situation; motives acquire action-guiding significance within a project rather than operating as external causes; and coercion, trauma and material structures genuinely pressure the early radicalism, which later scarcity and seriality broaden without simply retracting.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Sartre treats the opposition between freedom and determinism as a false problem, because determinism describes the for-itself in categories that belong to the in-itself. **Named evidence.** *Being and Nothingness* (1943) argues that a motive acquires action-guiding force only through the meaning conferred on it and that such conferral is itself an act of the for-itself, so that no motive determines unless it is freely constituted as a motive; the 1945 lecture's "there are no excuses" states the responsibility that follows; and the sentence "you can always make something out of what you have been made into" concedes the making - class, body, upbringing, the gaze of others - while insisting that what has been made must still be taken up. **Analysis.** The word "always" is doing structural rather than practical work: it denies that any situation converts the for-itself into a completed thing, and it does not assert that every outcome is available, which is why the doctrine is compatible with severe practical constraint and incompatible with the claim that a person is exhaustively explained by causes. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The objection from slavery, torture, mental illness and structural oppression is strong, the distinction between freedom of consciousness and freedom of action weakens the radical thesis in answering it, and Sartre's own *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), with scarcity, seriality and the practico-inert, is the clearest evidence that the criticism landed.

EXAM LINK. This session is the whole of **2019 Q4(c)** and the whole of **2020 Q4(a)**; it also supplies the criticism paragraph for **2021 Q4(b)** and the constraint qualification that a well-judged **2024 Q4(a)** needs in its final third.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Presenting Sartre as denying that causes exist	FACT: The claim is that a cause becomes a motive only through conferred meaning .
Reading "always" as "every outcome is available"	ANALYSIS: It is structural : no situation converts the for-itself into a thing.
Ignoring the first half of the 2020 sentence	FACT: "What you have been made into" concedes facticity ; the answer must show the concession before the reply.
Presenting freedom-of-consciousness as a clean defence	CAUTION: It answers the objection but weakens the radical thesis. Say so.
Using the 1960 <i>Critique</i> as Sartre's standing doctrine	ANALYSIS: It is a later concession ; the 1943 ontology is what the question asks about.
Dismissing the oppression objection as a misreading	CAUTION: Merleau-Ponty, de Beauvoir and Fanon press a real limitation; the residue must be conceded.

REVISION NOTES.

- Argument: motive -> **meaning-conferral** -> an act of the for-itself -> no motive determines unless **constituted** as one.
- Determinism misdescribes the *pour-soi* as an *en-soi*: the problem is **false**, not merely mistaken.
- 2020 sentence: **facticity conceded + transcendence asserted + "always" is structural**.
- **"No excuses"** = responsibility for taking up motives; not the denial of trauma or coercion.
- Objection: oppression limits action **and** the cognitive range (Merleau-Ponty, Marxists, de Beauvoir, Fanon).
- Reply: freedom of **consciousness** vs freedom of **action** - real, but weakening.
- **Critique of Dialectical Reason 1960: scarcity, seriality, practico-inert, group-in-fusion** - the concession that proves the objection landed.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

MOTIVE MOVES ME ONLY THROUGH MEANING -> MEANING-CONFERRAL IS AN ACT OF THE FOR-ITSELF -> SO NO MOTIVE DETERMINES UNLESS I CONSTITUTE IT -> DETERMINISM TREATS THE POUR-SOI AS AN EN-SOI: FALSE PROBLEM -> 'YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE INTO': facticity CONCEDED, transcendence ASSERTED, 'always' is STRUCTURAL -> OBJECTION: oppression limits action AND awareness -> REPLY splits consciousness/action and WEAKENS the thesis -> CRITIQUE 1960 concedes scarcity, seriality, practico-inert

SESSION 11 - SARTRE: THE LOOK, BEING-FOR-OTHERS, SHAME, AND WHY CONFLICT IS THE ORIGINAL MEANING OF THE RELATION

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* when someone catches you, you do not infer that another mind exists - you *feel* it, because you suddenly have an outside you cannot see and did not choose. *Technical:* **being-for-others** (*l'être-pour-autrui*) is the dimension of my being that is constituted from a perspective I cannot occupy; the **Look** (*le regard*) is the encounter in which the Other is given not as an object I observe but as the subject for whom I am an object, and **shame** (*la honte*) is the mode in which that dimension is lived.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "Sartre's argument from the Look is not a proof that other minds exist but a demonstration that I already live one: shame is by its structure shame of myself before someone, so the Other is given in the very form of my self-experience rather than reached at the end of an inference."

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. the Look (*le regard*) · being-for-others (*l'être-pour-autrui*) · shame (*la honte*) · pre-reflective consciousness · "shame is by nature recognition" · "the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me" · the body-for-others (*le corps-pour-autrui*) · conflict (*conflit*) · love, language, masochism · indifference, desire, sadism, hate · "l'enfer, c'est les autres".

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

AT THE KEYHOLE

STAGE 1 ABSORBED

Bent at a keyhole out of jealousy or curiosity. I am wholly absorbed: there is NO EGO in my consciousness, only the scene and my project. Consciousness is PRE-REFLECTIVE. THERE IS NO SELF TO BE ASHAMED.

STAGE 2 CAUGHT

Footsteps in the hall. I AM SEEN. Instantly I am no longer pure surveying transcendence - I am A PEEPING TOM: an object with a nature, seen from outside, judged. SHAME.

What this shows: nothing changed in the corridor or in the room. What changed is that I acquired an outside - and the fact that I could not have given it to myself is the whole argument.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the seven-step argument, the two failing strategies, and the four accounts of the Other.

- 1 In being looked at I experience SHAME - and shame is not a private feeling I might have alone; by its structure it is SHAME OF MYSELF BEFORE SOMEONE.
- 2 'SHAME IS BY NATURE RECOGNITION': in being ashamed I RECOGNISE that I am as the Other sees me. I do not INFER the Other; I LIVE his presence as the condition of my new mode of being.
- 3 The Other is NOT reached by explicit inference. Sartre contrasts the Look with Husserlian APPRESENTATION and Heideggerian BEING-WITH - though neither rival is fairly reduced to an argument from analogy or to neutral co-existence. THE OTHER IS GIVEN AS THE SUBJECT FOR WHOM I AM AN OBJECT.
- 4 THEREFORE 'THE OTHER IS THE INDISPENSABLE MEDIATOR BETWEEN MYSELF AND ME': I acquire an OUTSIDE, a 'nature', a being I AM without having chosen it and without being able to know it from within - my BEING-FOR-OTHERS.
- 5 The Look reveals a dimension of FACTICITY: the meanings of my acts and my body are constituted from a perspective I cannot control. This is ONE limit on mastery, not the only constraint Sartre recognises.
- 6 THE DIALECTIC OF CONCRETE RELATIONS (Being and Nothingness, Part III, ch. 3). Objectified by the Other's freedom, I can respond in only TWO directions - AND BOTH FAIL:

(a) ASSIMILATE the Other's freedom - possess the freedom that judges me WHILE IT REMAINS FREE
 FORMS: LOVE, LANGUAGE, MASOCHISM
 WHY IT FAILS: love wants to be loved FREELY - but to be loved is to be made an object, so the very freedom sought is destroyed in the possessing. Masochism collapses because I cannot succeed in being pure object while remaining conscious.

(b) TRANSCEND the Other's freedom - reduce him to an object so his look cannot fix me
 FORMS: INDIFFERENCE, DESIRE, SADISM, HATE
 WHY IT FAILS: an object cannot confer the recognition I wanted; the moment he looks back the structure reverses. Hate wants the Other's DISAPPEARANCE - which would leave my being-for-others intact.

-
- 7 THEREFORE 'CONFLICT IS THE ORIGINAL MEANING OF BEING-FOR-OTHERS.' The line of HUIS CLOS (No Exit, 1944) - 'L'ENFER, C'EST LES AUTRES' - follows from this.
 QUOTE IT, THEN CORRECT THE POPULAR MISREADING: Sartre himself explained, in a 1965 recorded preface to the play, that the line does NOT mean relations with others are always poisonous. It means that IF one's relations are twisted, the Other's judgement becomes the medium of one's own self-torment - and that the three characters are DEAD, i.e. FIXED, unable to change their acts. MAKING THIS CORRECTION IS A HIGH-VALUE MOVE.

THE FOUR ACCOUNTS OF THE OTHER - A TABLE WORTH MEMORISING

HUSSERL	passive PAIRING and APPRESENTATION, not a discursive analogy-inference. The Other is non-originally given; ownness-first circularity remains
HEIDEGGER	Dasein is ALWAYS ALREADY BEING-WITH (Mitsein). Social existence is constitutive - though Sartre presses for the conflictual concrete encounter
SARTRE	the LOOK - the Other is revealed in the SHAME of being objectified. CONFLICT; recognition structurally unattainable
LEVINAS	the FACE (visage) of the Other, which COMMANDS before it is known. ETHICAL ASYMMETRY - responsibility precedes freedom; explicitly a reply to both Husserl and Sartre

Caption: steps 1-4 give the argument, steps 6-7 give its consequence, and the four-account table is what turns a description of the keyhole into a comparative answer. The Levinas row is the strongest single line of criticism in the clause.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Bounded relevance - state the fence.** ANALYSIS: Being-for-others is **necessary** for questions on alienation, bad faith or intersubjectivity, but it must **not displace the printed freedom/choice spine** in every Sartre answer. One enriching development is right; a whole section is not.

2. **The exact printed subterms.** FACT: *le regard* (the Look) · *l'être-pour-autrui* (being-for-others) · *la honte* (shame) · *le corps-pour-autrui* (the body-for-others) · "*objet-autrui*" / "*sujet-autrui*" · "*la chute originelle*" (the original fall) · *conflit* as "the original meaning of being-for-others".
3. **The keyhole, in two stages.** FACT: **Absorbed:** bent at the keyhole out of jealousy or curiosity, I am wholly absorbed; there is **no ego** in my consciousness, only the scene and my project; consciousness is **pre-reflective**, non-positional about itself; **there is no self to be ashamed.** **Caught:** footsteps in the hall - **I am seen** - and instantly my whole being is transformed: I am no longer pure surveying transcendence but a *peeping Tom*, an object with a nature, seen from outside and judged.
4. **The argument.** FACT: Shame is by its structure shame **of myself before someone**; "**shame is by nature recognition**"; the Other is therefore not inferred but **lived** as the condition of my new mode of being; hence "**the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me**" - I acquire an **outside** I did not choose and cannot know from within.
5. **What the Look adds to facticity.** FACT: It reveals that the meanings of my acts and my body are constituted from a perspective I cannot control. ANALYSIS: This is **one** limit on mastery, not the only constraint Sartre recognises.
6. **The dialectic of concrete relations.** FACT: Two possible responses, both failing. **(a) Assimilate** the Other's freedom - love, language, masochism - which fails because love wants to be loved *freely*, yet to be loved is to be made an object, so the freedom sought is destroyed in the possessing, and masochism collapses because I cannot be pure object while remaining conscious. **(b) Transcend** the Other's freedom - indifference, desire, sadism, hate - which fails because an object cannot confer the recognition wanted, and hate wants a disappearance that would leave my being-for-others intact.
7. **The conclusion and the famous line.** FACT: "**Conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others.**" The line of *Huis clos* (*No Exit*, 1944) - "**L'enfer, c'est les autres**" - follows from it. ANALYSIS: **Quote it, then correct the popular reading:** Sartre explained in a 1965 recorded preface to the play that the line does not mean relations with others are always poisonous, but that if one's relations are twisted the Other's judgement becomes the medium of one's own self-torment - and that the three characters are **dead**, that is, **fixed**, unable to change their acts.
8. **The presuppositions.** ANALYSIS: (P1) shame is irreducibly relational and cannot be analysed away as self-assessment; (P2) pre-reflective consciousness is egoless, so the ego that appears under the Look is genuinely **conferred**; (P3) subject and object are exclusive - I cannot be looked-at and looking in the same act, which is what makes reciprocity impossible; (P4) there is no third term, no "we-subject" of the kind Marxists posit, that could stabilise the relation - Sartre discusses and rejects it in Part III.
9. **The three strongest objections.** CAUTION: (i) Sartre **generalises from pathological encounters** - the peeping Tom, sadism, seduction - to the structure of all relations. *Reply:* the claim is ontological rather than statistical; it analyses possibility-conditions, and conflict is the structure even where unnoticed. *Residual:* a strong objection, and Sartre's own move toward the **group-in-fusion** in the *Critique* (1960) is the best evidence it landed. (ii) **Love, trust and being-cared-for** are equally basic and are not objectifications. *Reply:* Sartre analyses love and finds an internal contradiction - but the analysis is compelling only if P3 is accepted. (iii) **Levinas:** to encounter the Other only as a rival freedom is still to think him from the self. ANALYSIS: Sartre has **no reply within Being and Nothingness***; this is the single strongest line of criticism.
10. **The executable verdict.** ANALYSIS: The Look gives a powerful non-inferential account of being exposed to another perspective, but Sartre may generalise conflict from selective examples; later solidarity, feminist and postcolonial accounts **test** rather than simply repeat the subject/object model.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Sartre's Look establishes not that other minds exist but that I already live a dimension of my being that only another's perspective can confer. **Named evidence.** In *Being and Nothingness* (1943) the man bent at the keyhole is pre-reflectively absorbed and has no ego to be ashamed of until footsteps are heard, whereupon he is constituted as a peeping Tom; Sartre's formula that shame is by nature recognition and that the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me states the result; and Part III, chapter 3 works out the two available responses - love, language and masochism, which try to possess the Other's freedom, and indifference, desire, sadism and hate, which try to abolish it - before concluding that conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others, a conclusion dramatised in *Huis clos* (1944). **Analysis.** The argument turns on the exclusivity of looking and being looked at: because I cannot occupy the perspective from which I am an object, the outside I acquire is genuinely conferred rather than constructed, and both strategies for recovering mastery fail for the same structural reason - the first destroys the freedom it wants to possess, the second destroys the recognition it wants to receive. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The subject/object exclusivity is a presupposition rather than a result, the examples are drawn from a narrow and largely pathological range, and Levinas's charge that a rival freedom is still an Other thought from the self receives no answer within *Being and Nothingness*.

EXAM LINK. This session supplies the **alienation** limb of **2018 Q1(d)** - the self living through the objectifying gaze - and gives one enriching development to **2023 Q3(c)** and **2021 Q4(b)**. **ANALYSIS:** It is bounded content: it should occupy one paragraph, never the spine of a freedom answer.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Treating the Look as an argument for other minds	FACT: It is a description of a lived structure , not an inference; shame already contains the Other.
Retelling the keyhole without the two stages	FACT: Stage 1 has no ego ; stage 2 is where the ego is conferred . Without stage 1 the argument disappears.
Quoting "hell is other people" without the correction	ANALYSIS: Sartre's 1965 recorded preface corrects the popular reading; the characters are dead , i.e. fixed.
Listing the failing strategies without saying why each fails	FACT: Love destroys the freedom it seeks; hate leaves being-for-others intact. The reasons are the doctrine.
Letting the Look displace freedom and choice in a Sartre answer	ANALYSIS: Bounded content: one development, not a section.
Presenting conflict as demonstrated rather than presupposed	CAUTION: P3 , subject/object exclusivity, is a presupposition; Levinas's objection is unanswered in 1943.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Keyhole:** absorbed (**no ego**, pre-reflective) -> **caught** (an outside is conferred) -> **shame**.
- "**Shame is by nature recognition**"; "**the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me**".
- Two failing strategies: **assimilate** (love, language, masochism) · **transcend** (indifference, desire, sadism, hate).
- "**Conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others**"; *Huis clos* **1944**; correction in the **1965** preface.
- Presuppositions P1-P4, esp. **P3 subject/object exclusivity** and the rejection of a "we-subject".
- Four accounts: **Husserl** (pairing/appresentation) · **Heidegger** (*Mitsein*) · **Sartre** (the Look, conflict) · **Levinas** (the **face**, ethical asymmetry).
- Objections: pathological sample · love and trust as basic · **Levinas unanswered** in 1943; *Critique* 1960 **group-in-fusion**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

ABSORBED AT THE KEYHOLE (no ego) -> FOOTSTEPS: I AM SEEN -> SHAME,
which is BY NATURE RECOGNITION -> so the Other is LIVED, not inferred
-> 'THE OTHER IS THE INDISPENSABLE MEDIATOR BETWEEN MYSELF AND ME'
-> I have an OUTSIDE I did not choose -> TWO responses: ASSIMILATE
(love/masochism) or TRANSCEND (sadism/hate) -> BOTH FAIL -> CONFLICT
IS THE ORIGINAL MEANING -> 'hell is other people' + Sartre's 1965
correction -> LEVINAS: still thought from the self (unanswered 1943)

SESSION 12 - HEIDEGGER: THE BEING-QUESTION, THE ONTOLOGICAL DIFFERENCE, AND WHY THE ROUTE RUNS THROUGH DASEIN RATHER THAN A TRANSCENDENTAL EGO

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* Heidegger is not asking what exists; he is asking what it *means* for anything to be at all - and he says we can only get at that by examining the one entity that already understands, however dimly, what "being" means: ourselves. *Technical:* **fundamental ontology** is the inquiry into the **meaning of Being** (*Sein*), conducted through an **existential analytic of Dasein**; the **ontological difference** distinguishes **Being** - the intelligibility in virtue of which entities show up as entities - from **particular beings**, and denies that Being is one supreme entity among others.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Heidegger's starting point is not the subject but the question: what does it mean for anything to be? - and the reason the inquiry runs through Dasein is not that the human being is philosophically privileged but that it is the only entity that already operates with an understanding of Being it has never made explicit."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. the Being-question (*Seinsfrage*) · fundamental ontology · ontological difference · Being (*Sein*) against beings (*Seiende*) · pre-ontological understanding · Dasein · "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence" (Section 9) · existentials against category · *Being and Time* (1927), **unfinished** · suspension (*epoche*) belongs to Husserl · transcendental ego rejected · being-in-the-world as the more primordial condition.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

TWO QUESTIONS THAT LOOK ALIKE

'WHAT THINGS EXIST?'

Answer: stars, numbers, laws,
minds, God. You produce a
LIST.

|

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Every answer names a BEING.

'WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE?'

Answer: not another THING on
the list. It asks what has to
be in place for anything at all
to show up AS something.

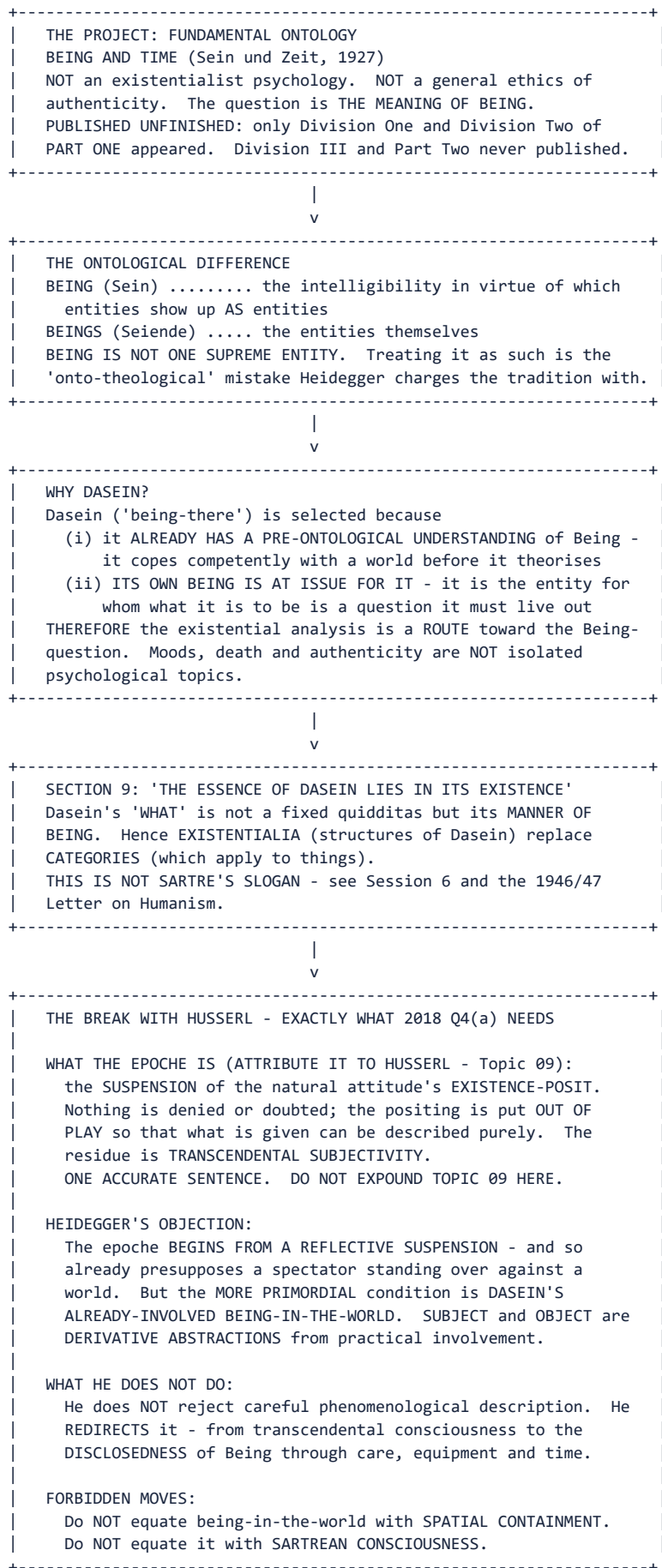
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v

THIS is the ONTOLOGICAL
DIFFERENCE: BEING is not one
more BEING, however supreme.

What this shows: the difference between an inventory and a condition. Miss it and Heidegger's whole project reads as a strange theology.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the question, the difference, the choice of Dasein, and the break with Husserl.



Caption: the last panel is the map of 2018 Q4(a). The paper asks three things in sequence - what the epoche is, how Heidegger rejects it, and what being-in-the-world is as opposed to a transcendental ego - and the answer must move in that order, spending one accurate sentence on Husserl and the rest on Heidegger.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **State the project correctly in the first line.** FACT: Heidegger's enterprise is **fundamental ontology** - the question of the **meaning of Being** - not an existentialist psychology and not a general ethics of authenticity. ANALYSIS: An answer that opens by describing Heidegger as a philosopher of anxiety and death has already misplaced the topic.
2. **The ontological difference.** FACT: **Being** is the intelligibility in virtue of which entities show up as entities; **beings** are the entities. Being is **not one supreme entity**. ANALYSIS: This single distinction blocks the commonest misreading, in which "Being" is treated as a metaphysical super-object or as a synonym for God.
3. **Why Dasein is the route.** FACT: Two reasons, both textual: Dasein already has a **pre-ontological understanding of Being** - it copes competently with a world long before it theorises about it - and its **own Being is at issue for it**. ANALYSIS: Dasein is therefore chosen for a methodological reason, not because human beings are metaphysically special.
4. **What "Dasein" does and does not mean.** FACT: "Being-there": the entity each of us is insofar as its own Being is at issue and it understands Being. ANALYSIS: It is **not** merely a biological synonym for "human being", and it is not a name for consciousness, a subject or a soul.
5. **Section 9 and the replacement of categories by existentialia.** FACT: "The essence of Dasein lies in its existence" means that Dasein's "what" is not a fixed *quidditas* but its **manner of being**. Consequently Heidegger replaces the traditional **categories**, which apply to things, with **existentialia**, the structures of Dasein's being. ANALYSIS: This is the sentence Sartre appropriates and Heidegger repudiates (Session 6).
6. **The unfinished book.** FACT: *Being and Time* (1927) appeared as Divisions One and Two of **Part One only; Division III ("Time and Being") and the whole of Part Two were never published**. WRONG: Never write that Heidegger "completes his analysis of Being" in the book. ANALYSIS: He later underwent the **turn (Kehre)**, moving from the Dasein-analytic toward the history of Being, language and art; whether that is a failure or a deepening is contested.
7. **The epoche, attributed correctly.** FACT: Husserl's **suspension** puts the natural attitude's **existence-posit** out of play - nothing is denied or doubted - so that what is given may be described purely, leaving transcendental subjectivity as the residue. ANALYSIS: **One accurate sentence**. The doctrine belongs to **Topic 09**, and 2018 Q4(a) asks for it only as the position Heidegger rejects.
8. **Heidegger's objection, stated as an argument.** FACT: The reduction **begins from a reflective suspension** and therefore already presupposes a spectator set over against a world. But the **more primordial** condition is Dasein's **already-involved being-in-the-world**: subject and object are **derivative abstractions** from practical involvement. ANALYSIS: The point is one of *order*, not of accuracy - Husserl's descriptions are not being called false; his starting point is being called late.
9. **What Heidegger does not do.** ANALYSIS: He does **not** reject careful phenomenological description; he **redirects** it from transcendental consciousness to the **disclosedness of Being** through care, equipment and temporality. FACT: This qualification is what keeps a 2018 Q4(a) answer from becoming a caricature.
10. **Two forbidden equations.** WRONG: Do **not** equate being-in-the-world with **spatial containment** - Dasein is not "in" the world as water is in a glass. WRONG: Do **not** equate it with **Sartrean consciousness** - the for-itself is still a consciousness facing being, which is precisely the framework Heidegger's structure dissolves.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Heidegger's rejection of the transcendental ego is not a rejection of phenomenological description but a claim about where description must begin. **Named evidence.** Husserl's suspension (*epoche*) puts the natural attitude's existence-positing out of play so that givenness can be described without prejudice, and its residue is transcendental subjectivity; Heidegger, in *Being and Time* (1927), argues that this procedure already presupposes a reflective spectator, and sets against it the structure of being-in-the-world (*In-der-Welt-sein*), together with the claim at Section 9 that the essence of Dasein lies in its existence, which is why Dasein's structures must be called existentialia rather than categories. **Analysis.** The objection is one of order rather than of accuracy: if Dasein is always already absorbed in a referential context of equipment and concern, then the subject-object pair is an abstraction *from* that involvement, so a method that starts by suspending the world's positing has begun one step too late and has silently retained the very framework it meant to bracket. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Heidegger does not discard phenomenology but redirects it toward the disclosedness of Being through care, equipment and temporality; and the project itself remained incomplete, since Division III of *Being and Time* was never published and Heidegger subsequently turned toward the history of Being.

EXAM LINK. This session is the first two-thirds of **2018 Q4(a)** ("What is 'Epoché'? How does Heidegger reject this method...?") and the necessary frame for **2019 Q3(a)** and **2022 Q2(a)**, both of which fail if Dasein is introduced as a name for the human subject.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Treating "Being" as a supreme entity or as God	FACT: The ontological difference : Being is not one more being, however exalted.
Introducing Dasein as "the human being"	FACT: It is the entity for whom its own Being is at issue and which has a pre-ontological understanding of Being.
Expounding Husserl's method at length in 2018 Q4(a)	ANALYSIS: One accurate sentence attributing the <i>epoche</i> to Husserl; the burden of the question is Heidegger.
Saying Heidegger rejects phenomenology	FACT: He redirects it; description is retained, its starting point is changed.
Writing that <i>Being and Time</i> completes the analysis of Being	FACT: Unfinished - Division III and Part Two never appeared.
Reading being-in-the-world as spatial containment	WRONG: Explicitly forbidden; it is a unitary structure , not a location.

REVISION NOTES.

- Project = **fundamental ontology**: the **meaning of Being**, not a psychology of moods.
- **Ontological difference**: **Being** (intelligibility) ≠ **beings** (entities); Being is not a supreme entity.
- Dasein chosen for two reasons: **pre-ontological understanding**; its **own Being is at issue**.
- **Section 9**: "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence" -> **existentialia**, not categories.
- *Being and Time* **1927, unfinished**; Division III never published; later **the turn** (*Kehre*).
- *Epoche* = **Husserl's** suspension of the existence-posit - one sentence, Topic 09.
- Objection: reduction **starts from reflection**; the primordial condition is **already-involved being-in-the-world**; subject/object are **derivative**.
- Forbidden: being-in-the-world as **spatial containment** or as **Sartrean consciousness**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

THE QUESTION IS 'WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE?' -> ONTOLOGICAL
 DIFFERENCE: Being is NOT a being -> ROUTE: the entity that ALREADY
 UNDERSTANDS Being and whose OWN BEING IS AT ISSUE = DASEIN ->
 Section 9: essence lies in EXISTENCE -> so EXISTENTIALIA, not
 categories -> HUSSERL'S EPOCHE suspends the existence-posit and
 leaves TRANSCENDENTAL SUBJECTIVITY -> HEIDEGGER: that STARTS FROM
 REFLECTION and presupposes a spectator -> the PRIMORDIAL condition
 is BEING-IN-THE-WORLD -> subject and object are DERIVATIVE ->
 description REDIRECTED, not abandoned -> and the book is UNFINISHED

SESSION 13 - HEIDEGGER: BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, WORLDHOOD, AND WHY THE HAMMER IS NOT FIRST AN OBJECT

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* you are not a mind that happens to be located near some objects; you are already caught up in a world of tasks and tools that make sense together, and things show up first as *for* something, not as things with properties. *Technical:* **being-in-the-world** (*In-der-Welt-sein*) is a **unitary** structure - one hyphenated phenomenon, not subject **plus** relation **plus** world; the **world** is not the totality of physical objects but the **referential context of meaning** within which entities show up as significant; entities are encountered primarily as **ready-to-hand** (*Zuhandenheit*) equipment and only derivatively as **present-at-hand** (*Vorhandenheit*) objects with properties.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"The hyphens in 'being-in-the-world' are the doctrine: Heidegger's compound is designed to resist decomposition, because the moment it is broken into a subject, a relation and a world, the Cartesian picture it was built to dissolve has been reinstated."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. being-in-the-world (*In-der-Welt-sein*) · unitary, not composite · worldhood (*Weltlichkeit*) · referential context · ready-to-hand (*Zuhandenheit*) · present-at-hand (*Vorhandenheit*) · equipment (*Zeug*) · the in-order-to (*Um-zu*) · referential totality · breakdown - unusability, absence, obstruction · dwelling as a way of being.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

HOW A HAMMER IS ACTUALLY MET

THE THEORY-FIRST PICTURE

- 1 An object: 700 g, wooden handle, steel head.
- 2 I notice its properties.
- 3 I decide it could be used for hammering.

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The USE is added on at the end.

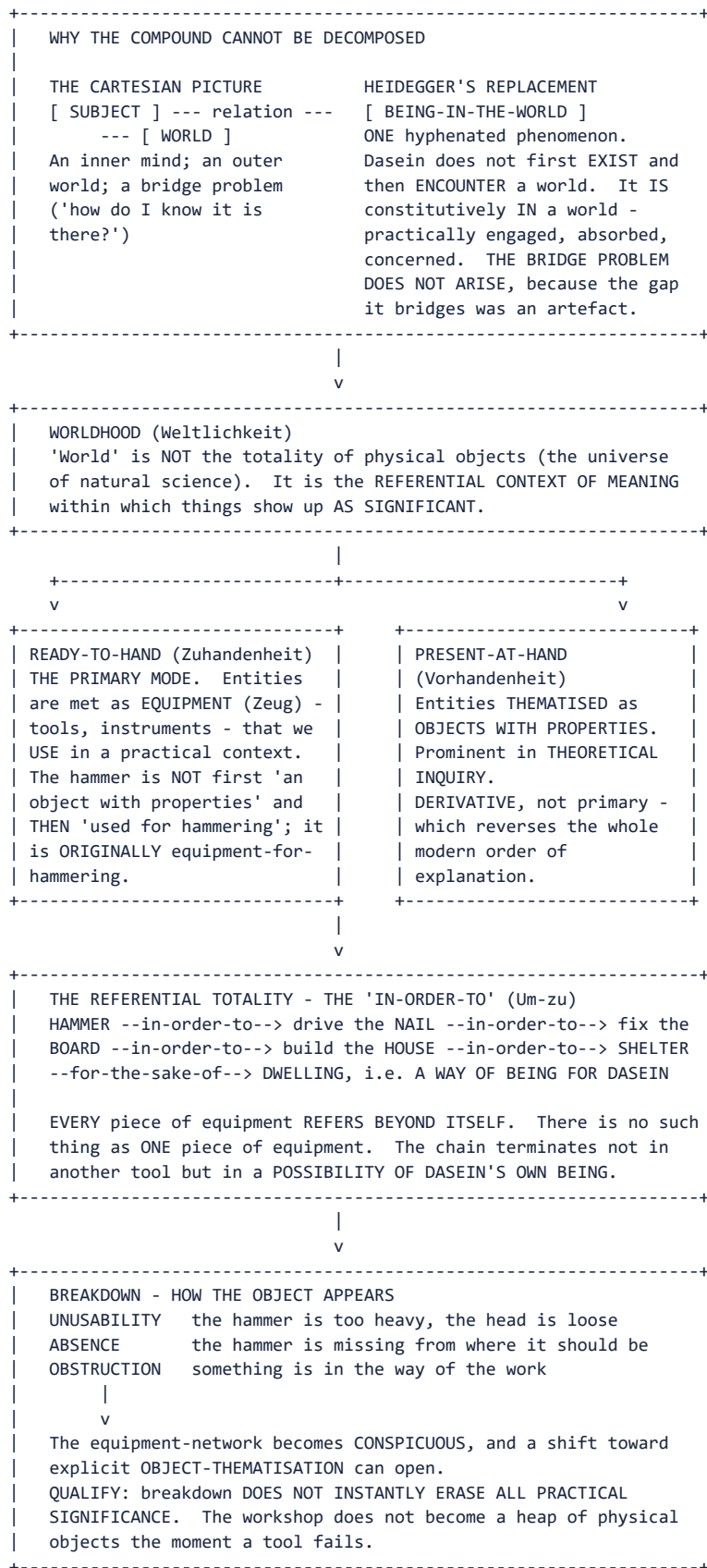
HEIDEGGER'S PICTURE

- 1 Something TO HAMMER WITH - met INSIDE a task.
- 2 In skilled use it 'withdraws': the better it works, the LESS it is noticed.
- 3 It refers BEYOND itself: nail
-> board -> house -> shelter
-> a WAY OF LIVING.

The OBJECT-WITH-PROPERTIES appears LATER - typically when something GOES WRONG.

What this shows: the order of encounter is reversed. Use is not applied to a previously known object; the object emerges out of a disturbance in use.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the unitary structure, the two modes, the referential chain, and breakdown.



Caption: read the chain in the third panel from left to right and the phrase "referential totality" becomes concrete. Note where it ends - not in a further tool but in a way of being - which is why worldhood is an existential structure rather than an inventory.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The compound is unitary.** FACT: Being-in-the-world is a **single hyphenated structure**, not three separate elements (subject + relation + world). ANALYSIS: Its purpose is to dissolve the Cartesian split between an inner subject and an external world - which is why the traditional "bridge" problem (how do I know the external world

exists?) does not arise: the gap it bridges was an artefact of the decomposition.

2. **Dasein does not first exist and then encounter a world.** FACT: It is constitutively *in* a world - practically engaged, absorbed, concerned. WRONG: "In" is not spatial containment.
3. **Worldhood.** FACT: The "world" is not the totality of physical objects - that is the universe of natural science - but the **referential context** of meaning within which things show up **as** significant.
4. **Ready-to-hand is primary.** FACT: Entities are met first as **equipment** (*Zeug*) that we *use* within a practical context. The hammer is not first "an object with properties" and then "used for hammering"; it is **originally** encountered as equipment-for-hammering, within a totality of references.
5. **Present-at-hand is derivative.** FACT: Entities thematised as objects with properties - a mode prominent in theoretical inquiry. ANALYSIS: Heidegger's claim is about **order of foundation**: the theoretical stance is a *modification* of practical engagement, not the neutral baseline from which practice is a special case. This reverses the modern order of explanation and is the real content of the doctrine.
6. **The referential totality and the in-order-to.** FACT: Every piece of equipment refers beyond itself - hammer to nail, nail to board, board to house, house to **dwelling-as-a-way-of-being**. This **in-order-to** (*Um-zu*) structure constitutes the worldhood of the world as a meaningful whole. ANALYSIS: There is no such thing as a *single* piece of equipment: the chain ends not in another tool but in a possibility of Dasein's own being.
7. **Breakdown analysis, with its qualification.** FACT: **Unusability, absence or obstruction** first makes the equipment-network **conspicuous** and can open a shift toward explicit object-thematisation. ANALYSIS: **Breakdown does not instantly erase all practical significance** - the workshop does not become a heap of physical objects the moment a tool fails. State this qualification; it is where careless scripts overclaim.
8. **Why this answers the Cartesian question rather than solving it.** ANALYSIS: Heidegger's move is not to prove the external world but to show that the demand for such a proof arises only after the unitary phenomenon has been broken up. FACT: In *Being and Time* he treats the persistence of that demand as the scandal, not its lack of an answer.
9. **The fence.** ANALYSIS: Descartes' own system - methodic doubt, the *cogito*, dualism - belongs to **Topic 02**. Here he appears as the position being dissolved, in one or two clauses.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Being-in-the-world is a single structure whose hyphens carry the argument, because any decomposition of it restores the subject-object picture it was constructed to replace. **Named evidence.** In *Being and Time* (1927) the world is defined not as the totality of physical objects but as the referential context within which entities show up as significant; the hammer is encountered primarily as ready-to-hand equipment within an in-order-to chain running from nail to board to house to dwelling; and the present-at-hand object with properties emerges in modes of breakdown - unusability, absence, obstruction - which make the equipmental network conspicuous. **Analysis.** Because the chain terminates not in a further tool but in a possibility of Dasein's own being, worldhood is an existential structure rather than an inventory, and because the theoretical stance is reached by a modification of practical engagement, the modern order of explanation is reversed: the neutral object is the late arrival, not the datum. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Breakdown does not instantly abolish practical significance, and Heidegger's move is not a proof of the external world but a diagnosis of why the demand for one arises - a diagnosis whose force depends on accepting that the subject-object pair is derivative rather than basic.

EXAM LINK. This session is the first half of **2022 Q2(a)** ("a critical account of Heidegger's Being-in-the-world") and the final third of **2018 Q4(a)** ("being in the world as opposed to the concept of a transcendental ego"). It is also the necessary base for care (Session 14), since care is the unity of exactly this structure.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Describing Dasein as "a human being in the world"	ANALYSIS: That decomposition is the error the compound exists to block; the structure is unitary .
Treating "world" as the sum of physical things	FACT: It is a referential context of meaning - the workshop, not the universe.

Trap	Correction
Presenting present-at-hand as the basic mode	FACT: Ready-to-hand is primary ; the theoretical object is a modification .
Saying breakdown turns the world into mere objects	ANALYSIS: It makes the network conspicuous and can open thematisation; it does not erase significance.
Stopping the in-order-to chain at another tool	FACT: It terminates in dwelling , a possibility of Dasein's own being.
Expounding Descartes' dualism	ANALYSIS: Topic 02. Here he is the position dissolved, in a clause.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Unitary** structure; the hyphens block decomposition; the bridge problem is dissolved, not solved.
- **Worldhood** = **referential context of meaning**, not the totality of objects.
- **Ready-to-hand** (*Zuhandenheit*) is **primary**; **present-at-hand** (*Vorhandenheit*) is **derivative**.
- **In-order-to** (*Um-zu*): hammer -> nail -> board -> house -> **dwelling as a way of being**.
- **Breakdown**: unusability, absence, obstruction -> network becomes **conspicuous**; **does not erase significance**.
- "In" is **not spatial containment**; Descartes = Topic 02, one clause.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

SUBJECT + WORLD IS ALREADY THE MISTAKE -> BEING-IN-THE-WORLD IS ONE STRUCTURE -> WORLD = REFERENTIAL CONTEXT OF MEANING -> things are met FIRST as READY-TO-HAND EQUIPMENT -> IN-ORDER-TO chain: hammer, nail, board, house, DWELLING -> PRESENT-AT-HAND OBJECT arrives LATER, via BREAKDOWN (unusable / missing / obstructing) -> which makes the network CONSPICUOUS but does NOT erase significance -> so the theoretical object is DERIVATIVE, and the bridge problem never arises

SESSION 14 - HEIDEGGER: THE EXISTENTIALIA, DISCLOSEDNESS, AND CARE AS THE BEING OF DASEIN

DEFINITION. *Plain language*: three things are always true of you at once - you always find yourself in some mood, you always understand your situation as offering things you could do, and that understanding is always articulable; put them together and you get "care", Heidegger's name for the single structure of a human life. *Technical*: the **existentialia** - **attunement** (*Befindlichkeit*), **understanding** (*Verstehen*) and **discourse** (*Rede*) - constitute the **disclosedness** (*Erschlossenheit*) of Dasein, the "there" (*Da*) of *Da-sein*; **care** (*Sorge*) is the unitary structural whole of Dasein's being, formally defined as "**ahead-of-itself - already-in (a world) - alongside (entities encountered within-the-world)**".

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*Care is not an attitude Dasein sometimes takes but the formal name for the fact that Dasein is always simultaneously ahead of itself, already in a situation it did not choose, and absorbed in the things it deals with - which is why worry and indifference are equally expressions of care, not exceptions to it.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. existentialia against category · attunement or state-of-mind (*Befindlichkeit*) · mood (*Stimmung*) · understanding (*Verstehen*) · projection upon possibilities · discourse (*Rede*) · disclosedness (*Erschlossenheit*) · the "there" (*Da*) · care (*Sorge*) · ahead-of-itself / already-in / alongside · concern (*Besorgen*) · solicitude (*Fürsorge*) · being-with (*Mitsein*).

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

THREE THINGS THAT ARE ALWAYS TRUE OF YOU AT ONCE

YOU ARE IN SOME MOOD	-> ATTUNEMENT (Befindlichkeit)
There is no mood-free state.	The mood is how the situation
Even 'neutral' is a mood.	MATTERS to you at all.
YOU SEE THINGS AS DOABLE	-> UNDERSTANDING (Verstehen)
Not 'I have a theory of the	Practical know-how; you PROJECT
chair' but 'I can sit'.	yourself on possibilities.
IT CAN BE ARTICULATED	-> DISCOURSE (Rede)
The situation is already	Not 'you talk about it'; the
structured for saying.	structure is sayable.
PUT TOGETHER: the 'THERE' IS OPEN. DISCLOSEDNESS.	
NAME OF THE WHOLE: CARE (Sorge).	

What this shows: the three existentialia are not three faculties. They are three inseparable aspects of one fact - that a world is open for Dasein at all.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the three existentialia, disclosedness, and the three limbs of care.

EXISTENTIALE	GERMAN	WHAT IT MEANS
ATTUNEMENT / STATE-OF-MIND	Befindlichkeit (mood = Stimmung)	Dasein ALWAYS ALREADY finds itself in a MOOD - anxiety, boredom, joy. Mood is NOT a subjective colouring added to an objectively given world; it is a fundamental mode of DISCLOSING the world and one's situation. 'We are always already attuned.'
UNDERSTANDING	Verstehen	Dasein PROJECTS itself upon POSSIBILITIES - it under- stands its world in terms of what it CAN DO. NOT theo- retical cognition but practical KNOW-HOW and projection upon potentiality- for-being.
DISCOURSE	Rede	The ARTICULATION of under- standing. Dasein's being- open to meaning is always linguistically structured. Discourse is the CONDITION OF POSSIBILITY of both speech and listening.

|
v

TOGETHER THEY CONSTITUTE DISCLOSEDNESS (Erschlossenheit)
= the 'THERE' (Da) of DA-SEIN: the fact that Being is DISCLOSED
or OPENED UP for this entity.

|
v

CARE (Sorge) - THE UNITARY STRUCTURAL WHOLE (Being and Time
SECTION 41). FORMAL DEFINITION:

'AHEAD-OF-ITSELF -- ALREADY-IN (a world) -- ALONGSIDE (entities
encountered within-the-world)'
(Sich-vorweg -- schon-sein-in -- Sein-bei)

AHEAD-OF-ITSELF Dasein is always PROJECTING toward its future
possibilities UNDERSTANDING, freedom
ALREADY-IN Dasein is always THROWN into a world and a
situation it did not choose ... FACTICITY, ATTUNEMENT
ALONGSIDE Dasein is always ABSORBED in its practical
dealings with entities CONCERN, FALLING

CARE IS NOT A PSYCHOLOGICAL ATTITUDE (worry, anxiety). It is
the ONTOLOGICAL STRUCTURE that makes all particular attitudes
and activities possible - including indifference.

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v

TWO NEIGHBOURING TERMS, KEPT DISTINCT
CONCERN (Besorgen) Dasein's dealings with EQUIPMENT and
tasks - the 'alongside' limb
SOLICITUDE (Fursorge) .. Dasein's dealings with OTHER DASEIN,
because BEING-WITH (Mitsein, SECTION
26) is constitutive, not added on

|
v

WHY LEARN THE THREE LIMBS EXACTLY: THEY MAP ONTO TEMPORALITY
AHEAD-OF-ITSELF ---> FUTURE (Zukunft)
ALREADY-IN ---> HAVING-BEEN (Gewesenheit)
ALONGSIDE ---> PRESENT (Gegenwart)
Session 16 completes this. Learning the two lists together

| turns the hardest 20-marker in the clause into one diagram. |
+-----+

Caption: the last panel is the reason care must be memorised in Heidegger's exact words. The three limbs are not a description of moods; they are the three places where temporality will be found in Division Two.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Existentialia replace categories.** FACT: Heidegger replaces the traditional **categories** - which apply to things - with **existentialia**, the structures of Dasein's being. ANALYSIS: The substitution follows directly from Section 9 (Session 12): if Dasein's essence lies in its existence, then thing-concepts cannot describe it.
2. **Attunement (Befindlichkeit).** FACT: Dasein always **already** finds itself in a **mood** (*Stimmung*) - anxiety, boredom, joy. ANALYSIS: Mood is **not** a subjective colouring added to an objectively given world; it is a fundamental mode of **disclosing** the world and one's situation. "We are always already attuned": there is no mood-free access to anything, and even indifference is a mood.
3. **Understanding (Verstehen).** FACT: Dasein projects itself upon **possibilities** - it understands its world in terms of what it *can do*. ANALYSIS: Understanding is **not** theoretical cognition but practical **know-how** and projection upon **potentiality-for-being**.
4. **Discourse (Rede).** FACT: The **articulation** of understanding: Dasein's being-open to meaning is always linguistically structured, and discourse is the condition of possibility of both speech and listening. ANALYSIS: It is not the act of talking; idle talk (Session 15) is a **deficient mode** of it.
5. **Disclosedness.** FACT: The three together constitute the **disclosedness** (*Erschlossenheit*) of Dasein - the "**there**" (*Da*) of *Da-sein*: the fact that Being is disclosed or opened up for this entity.
6. **Care, in Heidegger's exact words.** FACT: "**Ahead-of-itself - already-in (a world) - alongside (entities encountered within-the-world)**" (*Sich-vorweg - schon-sein-in - Sein-bei*), *Being and Time* Section 41. ANALYSIS: Reproduce the formula; paraphrasing it loses the mapping onto temporality.
7. **The three limbs decoded.** FACT: **Ahead-of-itself** = projection toward future possibilities (understanding, freedom). **Already-in** = thrownness into a world and a situation not chosen (facticity, attunement). **Alongside** = absorption in practical dealings with entities (concern, falling).
8. **Care is ontological, not psychological.** ANALYSIS: It is **not** worry or anxiety. It is the **structure** that makes all particular attitudes and activities possible - including indifference, which is a *mode* of care rather than its absence. FACT: This correction is a standing examiner test.
9. **Concern and solicitude.** FACT: **Concern** (*Besorgen*) names Dasein's dealings with equipment and tasks; **solicitude** (*Fürsorge*) names its dealings with **other Dasein**, because **being-with** (*Mitsein*, Section 26) is constitutive rather than added on. ANALYSIS: Dasein is never first solitary and then social.
10. **Why the formula must be memorised.** ANALYSIS: The three limbs map exactly onto the three ecstases of temporality - future, having-been, present (Session 16). Learning the two lists together converts the hardest twenty-marker in the clause (2019 Q3(a)) into a single diagram.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Care is Heidegger's name for the unity of Dasein's being, and it is an ontological structure rather than an emotional attitude. **Named evidence.** *Being and Time* (1927) identifies three existentialia - attunement (*Befindlichkeit*), in which Dasein always already finds itself in a mood that discloses its situation; understanding (*Verstehen*), in which it projects itself upon what it can do; and discourse (*Rede*), the articulation of that understanding - which together constitute disclosedness, the "there" of *Da-sein*; Section 41 then formalises their unity as "ahead-of-itself - already-in (a world) - alongside (entities encountered within-the-world)". **Analysis.** Each limb collects one existentials - projection for the first, thrownness and attunement for the second, absorbed concern for the third - so that care is not one more feature of Dasein alongside moods and skills but the single structure of which they are aspects; consequently even indifference expresses care, since it is a way of being ahead of oneself in a situation while dealing with things. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The formula is formal: it says how Dasein is structured, not what Dasein should do, and its ultimate purpose is not psychological description but the demonstration in Division Two that the meaning of this structure is temporality.

EXAM LINK. This session is the central section of **2022 Q2(a)** and the doctrinal hinge of **2019 Q3(a)**, where the question "how does he relate temporality with Dasein?" is answered by mapping the three limbs of care onto the three ecstases.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Translating <i>Sorge</i> as worry or anxiety	FACT: Ontological structure , not a psychological attitude; indifference is a mode of care.
Treating mood as a subjective colouring	FACT: Mood discloses ; there is no mood-free access.
Making <i>Verstehen</i> theoretical knowledge	FACT: Practical know-how and projection upon possibilities .
Reducing <i>Rede</i> to talking	FACT: It is the articulability of understanding; idle talk is a deficient mode .
Paraphrasing the care formula	ANALYSIS: Reproduce " ahead-of-itself - already-in - alongside "; the mapping onto temporality depends on it.
Treating being-with as an addition to a solitary Dasein	FACT: <i>Mitsein</i> (Section 26) is constitutive ; solicitude is the correlative of concern.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Existentialia** replace **categories** (things).
- **Befindlichkeit** - always already **attuned**; mood **discloses**, never colours.
- **Verstehen** - **projection upon possibilities**; practical know-how, not cognition.
- **Rede** - **articulation** of understanding; condition of speech and listening.
- Three together = **disclosedness** (*Erschlossenheit*) = the "**there**" (*Da*).
- **Care (Section 41)**: "**ahead-of-itself - already-in - alongside**" = projection · thrownness/attunement · concern/falling.
- Care is **ontological**, not psychological. **Concern** (equipment) vs **solicitude** (others); **being-with Section 26** constitutive.
- The three limbs map onto **future / having-been / present**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

ALWAYS IN A MOOD (Befindlichkeit) + ALWAYS PROJECTING ON POSSIBILITIES (Verstehen) + ALWAYS ARTICULABLE (Rede) -> together = DISCLOSEDNESS, the 'THERE' -> named as a whole: CARE (*Sorge*, Section 41)
-> 'AHEAD-OF-ITSELF (projection) -- ALREADY-IN (thrownness) -- ALONGSIDE (concern)' -> NOT worry: it is the STRUCTURE that makes worry AND indifference possible -> and its three limbs will become FUTURE / HAVING-BEEN / PRESENT in Division Two

SESSION 15 - HEIDEGGER: THE "THEY", FALLING, THE CALL OF CONSCIENCE, BEING-TOWARD-DEATH, AND WHY AUTHENTICITY IS NOT A VIRTUE

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* most of the time you do what "one" does - what people say, what is normally thought - and Heidegger says this is not a moral failing but the ordinary condition of being among others; becoming authentic is not becoming a better person but taking over your own life as yours, and the thing that forces the question is your own death. *Technical:* **authenticity** (*Eigentlichkeit*) and **inauthenticity** (*Uneigentlichkeit*) are **existential modifications** - modes of Dasein's self-relation - not moral categories; Dasein is **proximally and for the most part** (*zunächst und zumeist*) inauthentic, dispersed in the "**they**" (*das Man*) and **falling** (*Verfallen*); **being-toward-death** (*Sein-zum-Tode*), taken over in **anticipatory resoluteness** (*vorlaufende Entschlossenheit*), individualises Dasein and lets it take over its existence as a **whole**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Authenticity, for Heidegger, is not a moral achievement but a change in the ownership of one's existence: the call of conscience says nothing about what to do, and its whole content is that the life in question is mine to answer for."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. authenticity (*Eigentlichkeit*) · inauthenticity, not a moral failing · existential modification · proximally and for the most part (*zunächst und zumeist*) · the "they" (*das Man*) · idle talk (*Gerede*) · curiosity (*Neugier*) · ambiguity (*Zweideutigkeit*) · falling (*Verfallen*) · call of conscience (*Ruf des Gewissens*) · null and groundless · being-toward-death (*Sein-zum-Tode*) · ownmost, non-relational, certain, indefinite as to when · "one dies" (*man stirbt*) · anticipatory resoluteness.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

WHO IS LIVING YOUR LIFE?

THE 'THEY' (*das Man*)

One reads what one reads.

One takes the job one takes.

One retires when one retires.

Nobody in particular decides.

AND THAT IS COMFORTABLE:

nobody in particular is
answerable either.

|

v

THIS IS NOT A MORAL FAILING.

IT IS THE ORDINARY CONDITION

OF BEING AMONG OTHERS.

OWNING IT (*Eigentlichkeit*)

The same job, the same city,

the same reading - but taken

over as MINE, chosen from the

possibilities I am thrown

among.

NOTHING NEW IS PRESCRIBED.

THE OWNERSHIP CHANGES.

WHAT FORCES THE QUESTION?

MY DEATH - which nobody can

take over for me, and which

'one dies' conceals.

What this shows: the contrast is not between a bad life and a good life. It is between a life that is nobody's in particular and the same life owned.

VISUAL: VISUAL - inauthenticity, the call, death's four characters, and what authenticity is not.

THE PRELIMINARY THAT DECIDES THE ANSWER
AUTHENTICITY (Eigentlichkeit) IS NOT A MORAL VIRTUE, AND
INAUTHENTICITY IS NOT A MORAL FAILING. They are EXISTENTIAL
MODIFICATIONS - modes of Dasein's SELF-RELATION.
Dasein is PROXIMALLY AND FOR THE MOST PART (zunächst und
zumeist) INAUTHENTIC - and this is NOT a deficiency but a
STRUCTURAL FEATURE of being-in-the-world.

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v

INAUTHENTICITY: THE 'THEY' (das Man)
Dasein exists WITH OTHERS (Mitsein, SECTION 26) and tends to
lose itself in what 'ONE' (man) does, says, thinks - the
ANONYMOUS PUBLIC.

THREE MARKS (SECTIONS 35-38):
IDLE TALK (Gerede) passing along received opinions
WITHOUT genuine understanding
CURIOSITY (Neugier) flitting restlessly from novelty to
novelty; never dwelling
AMBIGUITY (Zweideutigkeit) everything SEEMS accessible, nothing
is genuinely appropriated

FALLING (Verfallen): Dasein's tendency to be absorbed in the
world of its concern and in das Man - losing its 'OWNMOST'
self. NOT a theological 'fall from grace'. AN ONTOLOGICAL
STRUCTURE.

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v

THE CALL OF CONSCIENCE (Ruf des Gewissens, SECTIONS 54-60)
Dasein is called BACK from dispersal in das Man to its NULL /
GROUNDLESS responsibility for TAKING OVER its thrown projection.
THE CALL IS SILENT. IT GIVES NO MORAL RULE AND NO SUBSTANTIVE
PROGRAMME. Its whole content is: THIS EXISTENCE IS YOURS.

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v

BEING-TOWARD-DEATH (Sein-zum-Tode, SECTIONS 46-53)
DEATH HAS FOUR CHARACTERS - LEARN ALL FOUR:
OWNMOST no one can die for me
NON-RELATIONAL it isolates me from others
CERTAIN it is inevitable
INDEFINITE AS TO WHEN it may come at any time
AND IT IS A POSSIBILITY, not an event on a calendar.
INAUTHENTIC RELATION we FLEE it: 'ONE DIES' (man stirbt),
'everyone dies someday' - covering over death's
INDIVIDUALISING FORCE by making it an event that happens to
people in general
AUTHENTIC RELATION ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS (vorlaufende
Entschlossenheit) - I face death as MY OWN possibility, which
discloses the FINITUDE and URGENCY of my existence, frees me
from das Man, and lets me take over my existence AS A WHOLE

|
v

FOUR THINGS AUTHENTICITY IS NOT
NOT 'living a morally good life'
NOT 'being true to yourself' in the popular sense
NOT rugged individualism or social withdrawal - individualisa-
tion by death does NOT abolish being-with; it MODIFIES how
Dasein OWNS its ALREADY SOCIAL possibilities
NOT contemplating suicide or fearing the empirical event of
dying
IT IS: a FORMAL modification of everydayness - OWNING one's
thrownness and projecting upon one's ownmost possibilities

Caption: the four characters of death are the most reliably examinable list in the clause, and the bottom panel is the correction the paper has demanded twice - in 2019 and again in 2022.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The preliminary that decides the answer.** FACT: **Authenticity is not a moral virtue and inauthenticity is not a moral failing.** They are **existential modifications** - modes of Dasein's self-relation. Dasein is **proximally and for the most part** (*zunächst und zumeist*) inauthentic, and this is not a deficiency but a **structural feature** of being-in-the-world. ANALYSIS: Both 2019 Q3(a) and 2022 Q2(a) directly demand this clarification.
2. **The "they" (das Man).** FACT: Dasein exists with others (*Mitsein*, Section 26) and tends to lose itself in what "one" (*man*) does, says and thinks - the anonymous public. ANALYSIS: *Das Man* is not "other people"; it is the impersonal norm-setting **anyone** in whose name things are done.
3. **The three marks.** FACT: **Idle talk** (*Gerede*) - passing along received opinions without genuine understanding; **curiosity** (*Neugier*) - flitting restlessly from novelty to novelty; **ambiguity** (*Zweideutigkeit*) - everything seems accessible and nothing is genuinely appropriated. ANALYSIS: Each is a **deficient mode** of an existentials: idle talk of discourse, curiosity of sight, ambiguity of understanding.
4. **Falling (Verfallen).** FACT: Dasein's tendency to be absorbed in the world of its concern and in *das Man*, losing its "ownmost" self. ANALYSIS: **Not** a theological "fall from grace"; it is an **ontological structure**, which is why it carries no blame.
5. **The call of conscience.** FACT: Dasein is called **back** from dispersal in *das Man* to its **null**, groundless responsibility for taking over its thrown projection (Section Section 54-60). ANALYSIS: The call is **silent** and gives **no moral rule and no substantive programme**: its whole content is that this existence is Dasein's own to answer for.
6. **Being-toward-death, with all four characters.** FACT: Death is Dasein's **ownmost** (no one can die for me), **non-relational** (it isolates me from others), **certain** (inevitable), and **indefinite as to when** possibility. ANALYSIS: It is a **possibility**, not a dated event - which is why the analysis is not morbid.
7. **The inauthentic relation to death.** FACT: We flee it: "**one dies**" (*man stirbt*), "everyone dies someday" - covering over death's individualising force by converting it into an event that happens to people in general.
8. **The authentic relation.** FACT: **Anticipatory resoluteness** (*vorlaufende Entschlossenheit*): I face death as *my own* possibility, which discloses the finitude and urgency of my existence, frees me from *das Man*, and lets me take over my existence **as a whole**. ANALYSIS: "As a whole" is doing technical work: only a being that can relate to its own end can be grasped as a totality, which is the problem Division Two is built to solve.
9. **Individualisation does not abolish being-with.** FACT: Authenticity does not prescribe social withdrawal; it **modifies how Dasein owns its already social possibilities**. ANALYSIS: This blocks the "rugged individualist" reading, which is the second commonest error after the moral reading.
10. **The four things authenticity is not.** ANALYSIS: Not moral goodness; not "being true to yourself" in the popular sense; not individualism or withdrawal; not contemplating suicide or fearing the empirical event of dying. FACT: It **is a formal** modification of everydayness - owning one's thrownness and projecting upon one's ownmost possibilities.
11. **The strongest objection: formal emptiness.** CAUTION: Authenticity prescribes no content - so, critics say, a Nazi could be "authentic", a charge sharpened by Heidegger's own **1933** complicity. **Heidegger's reply:** authenticity is deliberately non-prescriptive; it tells you *how* to hold your existence, not *what* to choose. ANALYSIS: Many find this ethically irresponsible, and **Adorno's** charge of a "jargon of authenticity" presses the same point. FACT: The honest verdict: the formality is deliberate **and** it is the doctrine's deepest problem - a criterion that tells you to own your choices without telling you which to make can dignify any resolute commitment; the defence that fundamental ontology is not ethics is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying.
12. **The second objection: morbidity and the Other.** CAUTION: **Levinas** argues that the ethical relation to the Other, not death, is primary; **Arendt** sets **natality** against mortality. **Heidegger's reply:** death is not morbidity but the disclosure of finitude that makes *any* authentic engagement possible, including care for others. ANALYSIS: Levinas's alternative remains a powerful counter and should be named rather than dismissed.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Heidegger's authenticity is a change in the ownership of an existence rather than an improvement in its moral quality, and this is why the analysis passes through the "they" and through death rather than through virtue. **Named evidence.** *Being and Time* (1927) describes Dasein as proximally and for the most part absorbed in the "they" (*das Man*), whose three marks are idle talk, curiosity and ambiguity (Section Section 27, 35-38), and calls this falling an ontological structure rather than a fall from grace; the call of conscience (Section Section 54-60) is silent and issues no rule, summoning Dasein back to its null responsibility for its thrown projection; and death (Section Section 46-53) is characterised as ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite as to when, so that the inauthentic "one dies" conceals precisely its individualising force. **Analysis.** Because the call has no content and death is a possibility rather than an event, what anticipatory resoluteness changes is not the range of options but their ownership: the same thrown possibilities are taken over as mine and thereby gathered into a whole, which is why individualisation modifies rather than abolishes being-with. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The formality that makes the doctrine ontologically clean is also its deepest liability - a criterion that requires resolute ownership without specifying content can dignify any commitment, a charge sharpened by Heidegger's own 1933 complicity and by Adorno's "jargon of authenticity", and the reply that fundamental ontology is not ethics is textually correct without being reassuring.

EXAM LINK. This session is the second half of **2022 Q2(a)** and the first half of **2019 Q3(a)** ("Is Dasein authentic existence for Heidegger?" - the answer is *no*, and this session says why). It also supplies the criticism paragraph any Heidegger answer needs to reach a verdict.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
"Authenticity = being morally good / true to yourself"	FACT: A formal existential modification ; the call gives no content.
Treating inauthenticity as a failure to be corrected	FACT: Dasein is inauthentic proximally and for the most part ; this is structural .
Identifying <i>das Man</i> with "other people"	ANALYSIS: It is the impersonal anyone that sets norms; being-with is constitutive and not itself inauthentic.
Reading being-toward-death as fear of dying or suicide	FACT: It is a possibility disclosed as ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite - not the empirical event.
Giving fewer than four characters of death	FACT: Ownmost · non-relational · certain · indefinite as to when .
Reading authenticity as withdrawal from society	FACT: It modifies how Dasein owns already social possibilities.
Treating falling as sin	FACT: Ontological structure , not theology.

REVISION NOTES.

- Authenticity/inauthenticity = **existential modifications**, not moral categories; inauthenticity is the **default** and is structural.
- **Das Man**: **idle talk · curiosity · ambiguity**; **falling** (Verfallen*) is ontological, not theological.
- **Call of conscience** (Section Section 54-60): **silent**, gives **no rule**, calls Dasein back to its **null** responsibility.
- **Death** (Section Section 46-53): **ownmost · non-relational · certain · indefinite as to when**; a **possibility**.
- Inauthentic: **"one dies"** (*man stirbt*). Authentic: **anticipatory resoluteness** -> existence **as a whole**.
- Individualisation **modifies**, does not abolish, **being-with**.
- Objections: **formal emptiness** (Nazi charge, 1933, Adorno's "jargon") · **Levinas** (the Other) and **Arendt** (natality).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

DASEIN IS INAUTHENTIC PROXIMALLY AND FOR THE MOST PART - STRUCTURAL,
NOT A FAILING -> DAS MAN: IDLE TALK / CURIOSITY / AMBIGUITY ->
FALLING (ontological, not sin) -> THE SILENT CALL OF CONSCIENCE
summons Dasein back to its NULL responsibility -> DEATH: OWNMOST,
NON-RELATIONAL, CERTAIN, INDEFINITE - a POSSIBILITY, not an event ->
'ONE DIES' conceals it -> ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS owns it and gives
existence AS A WHOLE -> AUTHENTICITY IS FORMAL: no content ->
WHICH IS THE DOCTRINE'S POWER AND ITS DEEPEST PROBLEM

SESSION 16 - HEIDEGGER: TEMPORALITY AS THE MEANING OF CARE, THE THREE ECSTASES, AND WHY CLOCK-TIME IS DERIVED

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* Heidegger's claim is that a human life is not *in* time the way a stone is in a river; a life *is* time - a stretching-out toward what is coming, out of what has been, into what is here - and the clock's row of nows is an abstraction from that. *Technical:* **temporality** (*Zeitlichkeit*) is the **meaning of care**: the three limbs of care are grounded in three **ecstases** - **future** (*Zukunft*), **having-been** (*Gewesenheit*) and **present** (*Gegenwart*) - which are not segments of a line but ways in which Dasein **stands out** (*ek-stasis*) into its own being; **ordinary or world-time** is a **derived** interpretation, not a falsehood.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "*The central thesis of Division Two is that care has a meaning and that its meaning is temporality: to be ahead of oneself is to be futural, to be already-in is to have-been, and to be alongside is to make present - so Dasein does not occupy time but temporalises it.*"

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. temporality (*Zeitlichkeit*) · the meaning of care · ecstasis, standing-out · future (*Zukunft*), coming-toward · having-been (*Gewesenheit*), the past I still am · present (*Gegenwart*), making-present · priority of the future · finite and unified · ordinary or world-time (*innerzeitige Zeit*) · the now-series · levelled interpretation · historicity (*Geschichtlichkeit*).

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

TWO PICTURES OF TIME

THE CLOCK'S TIME

... now now now now ...
A row of nows. The past ones
are gone, one is here, the
future ones are not yet.
INFINITE in both directions.

|
v
Time is a CONTAINER I am
inside.

DASEIN'S TIME

I am ALREADY in a situation I
did not choose (HAVING-BEEN)
while COMING TOWARD what I am
becoming (FUTURE) and DEALING
with what is here (PRESENT).

|
v
THE THREE ARE SIMULTANEOUS.
Time is not a container; it is
how I am STRETCHED OUT.
FINITE - bounded by death.

What this shows: the clock's picture is not wrong about clocks. It is wrong as a description of what it is to live a life - and Heidegger's claim is that it is derived from the second picture, not the other way round.

VISUAL: VISUAL - care mapped onto the ecstases, the priority of the future, and the derivation of clock-time.

THE CENTRAL THESIS OF DIVISION TWO The MEANING of CARE - and therefore of Dasein's being - is TEMPORALITY (Zeitlichkeit).		
v		
ECSTASIS	EXISTENTIAL MOMENT	LIMB OF CARE
FUTURE (Zukunft) 'coming toward' oneself	Projection, anticipation, BEING-TOWARD-DEATH	AHEAD-OF-ITSELF
HAVING-BEEN (Gewesenheit) the past I STILL AM	THROWNNES, facticity, guilt	ALREADY-IN
PRESENT (Gegenwart) 'making present'	Absorption in entities, practical engagement	ALONGSIDE
v		
PRIORITY OF THE FUTURE The FUTURE - Dasein projecting upon its ownmost possibility, DEATH - is the PRIMARY ecstasis. The past and the present are TEMPORALISED OUT OF the future. AUTHENTICITY IS FUTURAL: in ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS, Dasein RUNS AHEAD to its death and thereby GATHERS ITS EXISTENCE INTO A WHOLE. NOTE THE WORD 'GEWESENHEIT': not 'the past that is gone' but 'HAVING-BEEN' - the past I STILL AM and carry as possibility.		
v		
'ECSTATIC' - WHAT THE WORD IS DOING The three dimensions are NOT containers or segments of a line. They are ECSTASES: Dasein STANDS OUT (ek-stasis) into each SIMULTANEOUSLY. Temporality is a UNITY of future-past-present in which Dasein holds itself open.		
v		
PRIMORDIAL TEMPORALITY (Zeitlichkeit)	VULGAR / ORDINARY TIME (innerzeitige Zeit)	
ECSTATIC, FINITE, UNIFIED, FUTURAL	A SEQUENCE OF 'NOWS' - past nows gone, a present now here, future nows not yet	
The temporality OF DASEIN - how Dasein EXISTS its own being	'Time' as measured by CLOCKS - the time IN WHICH events occur	
FINITE - bounded by DEATH	INFINITE - the now-series is endless in both directions	
The MORE PRIMORDIAL existential condition	DERIVED public/world-time interpretation and clock measurement	
v		
THE QUALIFICATION THAT MUST BE WRITTEN Heidegger DERIVES ordinary now-time THROUGH world-time and PUBLIC DATING from more primordial temporality. A LEVELLED interpretation CAN accompany falling - BUT CLOCK-TIME IS NOT THEREBY MORALLY DEFECTIVE OR PRACTICALLY DISPENSABLE. 'VULGAR' NAMES A LEVELLED CONCEPTUAL INTERPRETATION, NOT A SIN.		
v		
HISTORICALITY (Geschichtlichkeit) Dasein INHERITS possibilities and PROJECTS them. History is an EXISTENTIAL STRUCTURE rather than merely an external sequence		

	of events - which is how the finite, futural self is also a	
	handed-down self.	
+-----+		

Caption: the two-column table at the bottom is the answer to any "primordial versus ordinary time" demand, and the qualification panel beneath it is what keeps the answer from sliding into the false claim that Heidegger condemns clocks.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **The thesis.** FACT: The central claim of **Division Two** of *Being and Time* is that the **meaning of care** - and therefore of Dasein's being - is **temporality** (*Zeitlichkeit*). ANALYSIS: "Meaning" here is technical: it names that in terms of which the structure becomes intelligible as a unity.
2. **The three ecstases, mapped.** FACT: **Future** (*Zukunft*), "coming toward" oneself -> projection, anticipation, being-toward-death -> the limb **ahead-of-itself**. **Having-been** (*Gewesenheit*), the past that I *still am* -> thrownness, facticity, guilt -> **already-in**. **Present** (*Gegenwart*), "making present" -> absorption in entities, practical engagement -> **alongside**.
3. **Why *Gewesenheit* is not "the past".** ANALYSIS: Heidegger's word means **having-been**, the past that Dasein *still is* and carries forward as possibility - not a stretch of elapsed time left behind. FACT: Using the English "having-been" once shows the point without a translation lecture.
4. **The priority of the future.** FACT: The future - Dasein projecting upon its ownmost possibility, **death** - is the **primary** ecstasis; past and present are **temporalised out of** the future. **Authenticity is futural**: in anticipatory resoluteness Dasein runs ahead to its death and thereby gathers its existence into a **whole**.
5. **What "ecstatic" is doing.** FACT: The three dimensions are **not** containers or segments of a line; they are **ecstases** - Dasein *stands out* (*ek-stasis*) into each **simultaneously**. Temporality is a **unity** of future-past-present in which Dasein holds itself open. ANALYSIS: This is why a diagram of three boxes in a row misrepresents the doctrine.
6. **Primordial against ordinary time.** FACT: Primordial temporality is **ecstatic, finite, unified and futural**; ordinary time (*innerzeitige Zeit*) is a **sequence of nows**, the time *in which* events occur, **infinite** in both directions and measured by clocks.
7. **The derivation, and the qualification that must accompany it.** FACT: Heidegger derives ordinary now-time **through world-time and public dating** from more primordial temporality. ANALYSIS: A **levelled** interpretation *can* accompany falling, **but clock-time is not thereby morally defective or practically dispensable**: "vulgar" names a levelled conceptual interpretation, not a sin. ANALYSIS: Scripts routinely overclaim here, and the qualification is the difference between a careful answer and a caricature.
8. **Historicality (*Geschichtlichkeit*).** FACT: Dasein **inherits** possibilities and **projects** them; history is an existential structure rather than merely an external sequence. ANALYSIS: This is how the finite, futural self is also a **handed-down** self, and it prevents the resoluteness doctrine from reading as pure self-creation.
9. **The incompleteness.** ANALYSIS: **Division III ("Time and Being")** - where the move from Dasein's temporality to the meaning of Being as such was to be made - **was never published**. CAUTION: Whether the subsequent **turn** (*Kehre*) toward the history of Being is a failure or a deepening is debated, and an answer on temporality should register that the argument stops short of its announced destination.
10. **Two comparative counters.** CAUTION: **Sartre**: temporality grounds **freedom** and the project, not merely a formal ontology - the for-itself is ecstatic because it nihilates its past, not because Being is disclosed. CAUTION: **Levinas**: death individualises excessively; what of the **temporality of the Other**, and of a future that comes from the Other rather than from my own end? ANALYSIS: One clause each is enough to convert an exposition into an assessment.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Heidegger relates temporality to Dasein by showing that temporality is the meaning of care, so that Dasein does not occupy time but temporalises it. **Named evidence.** *Being and Time* (1927), Division Two, grounds the three limbs of care in three ecstases - the future as coming-toward oneself, which corresponds to being ahead-of-itself and is exhibited in being-toward-death; having-been (*Gewesenheit*), the past Dasein still is, which corresponds to being already-in and is exhibited in thrownness; and the present as making-present, which corresponds to being alongside entities - and it assigns primacy to the future, since in anticipatory resoluteness Dasein runs ahead to its death and thereby gathers its existence into a whole. **Analysis.** Calling these ecstases rather than parts is decisive: Dasein stands out into all three simultaneously, so temporality is a unity rather than a sequence, and the now-series of clock measurement is reached only by way of world-time and public dating, which is why the ordinary conception is derivative rather than basic. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: "Vulgar" names a levelled conceptual interpretation and not a moral defect - clock-time is neither false nor dispensable - and the argument itself stops short of its destination, since Division III, in which temporality was to yield the meaning of Being as such, was never published.

EXAM LINK. This session is the second half of **2019 Q3(a)** ("How does he relate temporality with Dasein?") and the closing movement of **2022 Q2(a)**. Combined with Session 14, it converts the temporality demand into a single mapping: three limbs of care, three ecstases, one priority.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Drawing the ecstases as three segments of a line	FACT: They are ecstases - Dasein stands out into all three simultaneously ; temporality is a unity .
Translating <i>Gewesenheit</i> as "the past"	FACT: Having-been - the past Dasein still is and carries as possibility.
Saying clock-time is false or inauthentic	ANALYSIS: It is derived and levelled , not defective; it is practically indispensable.
Omitting the priority of the future	FACT: Past and present are temporalised out of the future; authenticity is futural .
Forgetting the mapping onto care	FACT: Ahead-of-itself -> future; already-in -> having-been; alongside -> present.
Presenting the temporality analysis as complete	ANALYSIS: Division III was never published ; the turn followed.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Temporality is the meaning of care** - Division Two's central thesis.
- **Future** (projection, being-toward-death) <-> **ahead-of-itself**; **having-been** (thrownness, guilt) <-> **already-in**; **present** (making-present) <-> **alongside**.
- **Priority of the future**; authenticity is **futural**; anticipatory resoluteness yields existence **as a whole**.
- **Ecstasis** = standing out; the three are **simultaneous**, a **unity**, and **finite** (bounded by death).
- **Ordinary time** = infinite **now-series**, clock-measured, **derived** through **world-time and public dating**.
- Qualification: "**vulgar**" = **levelled interpretation, not a sin**; clock-time is indispensable.
- **Historicity**: Dasein **inherits** and **projects** possibilities.
- **Division III never published**; the **turn** (*Kehre*) followed; Sartre and Levinas supply comparative counters.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

CARE HAS A MEANING, AND ITS MEANING IS TEMPORALITY -> AHEAD-OF-ITSELF = FUTURE | ALREADY-IN = HAVING-BEEN | ALONGSIDE = PRESENT -> THE FUTURE HAS PRIORITY: past and present are temporalised OUT OF it -> ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS runs ahead to death and gathers existence AS A WHOLE -> ECSTASES, not segments: SIMULTANEOUS, UNIFIED, FINITE -> CLOCK-TIME is the NOW-SERIES, DERIVED via world-time and public dating - LEVELLED, NOT FALSE -> HISTORICALITY: possibilities are INHERITED and PROJECTED -> and DIVISION III WAS NEVER PUBLISHED

SESSION 17 - FEAR AGAINST ANXIETY, DREAD AND ANGUISH: THE DISTINCTION THE WHOLE CLAUSE TURNS ON

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* fear is always fear of something in the world; anxiety is not - and because it has nothing to be about, what it reveals cannot be a thing but must be the shape of existence itself. *Technical:* **fear** (*Frygt / Furcht / peur*) is directed at a **determinate entity within the world**; **anxiety, dread or anguish** (*Angest / Angst / angoisse*) has **no determinate object** and therefore discloses a **structure** - possibility and freedom (Kierkegaard), the collapse of world-significance and being-in-the-world as such (Heidegger), or one's own freedom (Sartre).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: "Fear and anxiety are not two intensities of one feeling but two structures: fear has an object and drives us back into the world, while anxiety has none and therefore cannot be disclosing an entity at all - which is precisely why all three thinkers make it philosophically privileged."

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. determinate object against no object · "the object of anxiety is a nothing" · the dizziness of freedom · complete insignificance · *Grundbefindlichkeit* (fundamental attunement) · individualisation · *solus ipse* · the cliff path · the gambler · nausea (*la nausée*) · the Nothing (*das Nichts*) · disclosive mood, not infallible cognition.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

FEAR

Something threatens me.
I can name it: the dog, the
exam, the fall.

|
v

I FLEE TOWARD the world:
safety, the familiar, other
people, routine.

DISCLOSES: a THREAT.

ANXIETY / DREAD / ANGUISH

Nothing in particular is
wrong. And yet the whole
thing - being here at all -
has become a question.

|
v

IT INDIVIDUALISES: the world's
significance drains away, 'what
one does' stops helping, and
I am left with my own
existence on my hands.

DISCLOSES: FREEDOM, FINITUDE,
GROUNDLESSNESS.

What this shows: the two moods move in opposite directions. Fear sends me into the world; anxiety strips the world of the significance I was hiding in.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the comparison table, the three canonical examples, and the argument they share.

	FEAR (Frygt/Furcht/peur)	ANXIETY / DREAD / ANGUISH (Angest/Angst/ angoisse)
OBJECT	A DETERMINATE ENTITY WITHIN THE WORLD - a dog, an examination, a fall	NO DETERMINATE OBJECT. KIERKEGAARD: 'the object of anxiety is a NOTHING'. HEIDEGGER: that in the face of which one is anxious 'is completely indefinite'
WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT	the threatening thing	KIERKEGAARD: POSSIBIL- ITY - my own 'possibil- ity of being able' HEIDEGGER: BEING-IN- THE-WORLD AS SUCH SARTRE: MY OWN FREEDOM
DIRECTION	I FLEE TOWARD the world, seeking shelter in the familiar	It INDIVIDUALISES: the world's significance COLLAPSES, das Man FALLS AWAY, and Dasein stands alone
DISCLOSIVE VALUE	Discloses a THREAT	Discloses FREEDOM, FINITUDE and the GROUNDLESSNESS of existence - a PRIVI- LEGED mood (Grund- befindlichkeit)
CANONICAL FORMULA	-	KIERKEGAARD: 'ANXIETY IS THE DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM' (The Concept of Anxiety, 1844); 'a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy'

|
v

THE THREE CANONICAL EXAMPLES - LEARN ONE FROM EACH THINKER

1 KIERKEGAARD (INNOCENCE). The man at the edge of an abyss looks down and grows dizzy - but THE DIZZINESS IS AS MUCH IN THE EYE AS IN THE ABYSS. In innocence there is no knowledge of good and evil, yet there IS anxiety, because freedom's possibility is already sensed. Anxiety is the PRESUPPOSITION of the LEAP by which sin - and selfhood - enters.

2 HEIDEGGER (BEING AND TIME, SECTION 40). In anxiety 'THE WORLD HAS THE CHARACTER OF COMPLETE INSIGNIFICANCE': the totality of involvements - the workshop of ready-to-hand things - COLLAPSES, and Dasein is thrown back on its bare THAT-IT-IS. THE COMPRESSED FORMULA: THAT IN THE FACE OF WHICH ONE IS ANXIOUS AND THAT FOR WHICH ONE IS ANXIOUS ARE THE SAME - BEING-IN-THE-WORLD. Anxiety therefore discloses Dasein as SOLUS IPSE and FREES IT FOR AUTHENTIC CHOOSING. In 'WHAT IS METAPHYSICS?' (1929) Heidegger adds that anxiety reveals DAS NICHTS - the Nothing. 'Nothing noths' / 'the nothing nothings'; NEVER 'nothing noughts'. This is the source of the sentence CARNAP attacks - see Topic 07.

3 SARTRE (BEING AND NOTHINGNESS, PART I). TWO examples, and BOTH should be named.

THE CLIFF PATH. Walking a narrow path above a precipice I feel FEAR of the drop - the loose stone, the gust of wind, the world's threat. Then I realise that NOTHING PREVENTS ME FROM THROWING MYSELF OVER: no barrier within me, no fixed nature. That vertigo is ANGUISH - not fear of the abyss but anguish before MY OWN FREEDOM.

THE GAMBLER. A man resolved firmly, YESTERDAY, never to gamble again. Standing at the table today he discovers that

yesterday's resolution is THERE but POWERLESS - it must be REMADE NOW, and nothing guarantees he will remake it. Anguish is this discovery that MY PAST SELF CANNOT BIND MY PRESENT SELF.

THE ARGUMENT IMPLICIT IN ALL THREE

- 1 Moods (Stimmungen, Befindlichkeit) are not private colourings added to a neutral world; they are ways in which one's situation is DISCLOSED.
- 2 FEAR discloses an entity as threatening, and so KEEPS US WITHIN the world of concern.
- 3 ANXIETY has NO entity as its object; therefore it CANNOT disclose an entity.
- 4 YET it plainly discloses SOMETHING, since it has definite content and is not mere confusion.
- 5 THEREFORE what it discloses is not an ENTITY but a STRUCTURE - my FREEDOM (Kierkegaard, Sartre) or BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AS SUCH (Heidegger).
- 6 THEREFORE anxiety is philosophically PRIVILEGED: it is the one mood in which existence AS A WHOLE becomes an issue for the existing individual.

Caption: the six-step argument at the bottom is what makes this a philosophical claim rather than a report about feelings. Steps 3 and 4 together are the pressure point: an objectless state that nevertheless has content must be disclosing something other than an object.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **This is the most frequently botched distinction in the clause.** ANALYSIS: Fear and anxiety are **not degrees of the same thing**; they differ in *what they are about*, and it is that difference which makes anxiety disclosive.
2. **Fear.** FACT: Directed at a **determinate entity within the world**; it discloses a threat, and it moves me **toward** the world, seeking shelter in what is familiar.
3. **Anxiety, in three voices.** FACT: **Kierkegaard**: the object of anxiety "is a **nothing**"; what it is about is **possibility**, "the possibility of being able". **Heidegger**: that in the face of which one is anxious "is completely indefinite"; what it is about is **being-in-the-world as such**. **Sartre**: it is **my own freedom**. ANALYSIS: Three related but **non-identical** analyses; presenting them as one mood theory is a trap.
4. **The Kierkegaardian formula and example.** FACT: "**Anxiety is the dizziness of freedom**" (*The Concept of Anxiety*, 1844, Vigilius Haufniensis), and "**a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy**" - we are drawn to what we shrink from. The man at the abyss grows dizzy, and **the dizziness is as much in the eye as in the abyss**; anxiety is already present **in innocence** and is the **presupposition** of the leap by which sin and selfhood enter.
5. **The Heideggerian analysis.** FACT: In *Being and Time* **Section 40**, in anxiety "**the world has the character of complete insignificance**": the totality of involvements - the workshop of ready-to-hand things - collapses, and Dasein is thrown back on its bare **that-it-is**. The compressed formula: **that in the face of which one is anxious and that for which one is anxious are the same - being-in-the-world**. Anxiety discloses Dasein as *solus ipse* and **frees it for authentic choosing**.
6. **The 1929 addition, and its cross-link.** ANALYSIS: In "**What is Metaphysics?**" (1929) Heidegger adds that anxiety reveals **the Nothing** (*das Nichts*). FACT: Correct renderings: "**Nothing noths**" / "the nothing nothings". WRONG: "**Nothing noughts**" is wrong and must not be used. This is the source of the sentence **Carnap** attacks in 1932 - one clause of cross-link to **Topic 07**, and no more.
7. **The two Sartrean examples, both named.** FACT: **The cliff path**: walking a narrow path above a precipice I feel *fear* of the drop, and then realise that **nothing prevents me from throwing myself over** - no barrier within me, no fixed nature - and that vertigo is **anguish** before my own freedom. **The gambler**: a man who resolved firmly yesterday never to gamble again discovers at the table that yesterday's resolution is *there* but **powerless**; it must be **remade now**, and nothing guarantees that he will remake it. Anguish is the discovery that **my past self cannot bind my present self**. ANALYSIS: The gambler is the example most scripts omit, and it is the one that connects anguish directly to the non-self-identity of the for-itself (Session 7).
8. **Nausea, briefly.** ANALYSIS: Sartre's *la nausée* is the affective disclosure of the **contingency** of the in-itself - brute, groundless, *de trop* - and is distinct from anguish, which discloses freedom. Naming both, and distinguishing them in a clause, is a precision mark.

9. **The presuppositions of the whole analysis.** ANALYSIS: (P1) moods are **cognitively disclosive**, not merely affective - deny this and anxiety is only a symptom; (P2) there is a difference **in kind**, not degree, between an indefinite and a definite intentional object; (P3) what is disclosed in a rare mood is not thereby less real than what is disclosed in ordinary comportment.
10. **The strongest objection and its reply.** CAUTION: The **naturalist** reply: anxiety is a pathological or neurochemical state with no cognitive credentials, and treating it as a source of ontological insight is a category mistake. **Reply:** the existentialist claim is not that anxious people know more, but that the **structure** of the mood - having no object - is itself the datum requiring explanation, and no account of it in terms of an unnoticed object has succeeded. ANALYSIS: The honest verdict: a mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition, and naturalistic and clinical explanations remain compatible competitors rather than refuted rivals.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Fear and anxiety differ in kind rather than in degree, and it is the objectlessness of anxiety that gives it its philosophical role in all three thinkers. **Named evidence.** Vigilius Haufniensis writes in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844) that the object of anxiety is a nothing and calls anxiety the dizziness of freedom, illustrated by the man at the abyss in whom the dizziness lies as much in the eye as in the depth; Heidegger states at *Being and Time* Section 40 that in anxiety the world has the character of complete insignificance and that that in the face of which and that for which one is anxious are the same, namely being-in-the-world; and Sartre, in Part I of *Being and Nothingness* (1943), gives the cliff path, where the vertigo is not fear of the drop but anguish before the absence of any barrier within me, and the gambler, whose yesterday's resolution stands powerless until it is remade. **Analysis.** Since anxiety has no entity as its object it cannot be disclosing an entity, yet it plainly has content and is not confusion, so what it discloses must be a structure - possibility for Kierkegaard, being-in-the-world for Heidegger, freedom for Sartre - which is why each thinker treats it as the privileged mood in which existence as a whole becomes an issue. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The three analyses are related but not identical and must not be merged into one mood theory; and the naturalist objection that anxiety is a clinical state with no cognitive credentials is met, not defeated, by the reply that its objectlessness is itself the datum requiring explanation.

EXAM LINK. This session answers any "difference between fear and dread/anxiety" demand directly, and it supplies indispensable paragraphs to **2020 Q3(a)** and **2024 Q1(e)** (Kierkegaard), **2021 Q4(b)** and **2019 Q4(c)** (Sartrean anguish), and **2019 Q3(a)** and **2022 Q2(a)** (Heideggerian anxiety as the mood that individualises and frees Dasein for authentic choosing).

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
Defining anxiety as intense fear	FACT: The difference is in kind : fear has a determinate object , anxiety has none .
Merging the three thinkers' analyses	ANALYSIS: Possibility (K) · being-in-the-world (H) · freedom (S) - three related but non-identical accounts.
Writing "nothing noughts"	WRONG: Wrong. "Nothing noths" / "the nothing nothings", <i>What is Metaphysics?</i> , 1929 .
Giving only the cliff path for Sartre	FACT: Both examples; the gambler shows that the past self cannot bind the present self.
Confusing anguish with nausea	ANALYSIS: Anguish discloses freedom ; nausea discloses the contingency of the in-itself.
Treating the disclosure as infallible	CAUTION: A mood can disclose a structure without being infallible cognition; naturalistic explanations remain competitors.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Fear:** determinate object; flees **toward** the world; discloses a **threat**.
- **Anxiety:** **no object**; **individualises**; discloses **freedom**, **finitude**, **groundlessness**; a **privileged mood**.
- **K:** "object is a **nothing**"; "**dizziness of freedom**"; abyss - dizziness in the **eye**; present in **innocence**; presupposition of the **leap**.

- **H (Section 40): "complete insignificance"**; in-the-face-of-which = for-which = **being-in-the-world**; *solus ipse*; frees for authentic choosing; **1929 the Nothing**.
- **S: cliff path** (nothing prevents me) and **gambler** (yesterday's resolution is powerless); anguish ≠ **nausea**.
- Six-step argument: moods disclose -> fear discloses an entity -> anxiety has none -> yet has content -> so it discloses a **structure** -> hence privileged.
- Presuppositions P1-P3; **naturalist objection** met but not defeated.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

FEAR HAS AN OBJECT -> ANXIETY HAS NONE -> so it cannot disclose an ENTITY -> yet it has CONTENT -> therefore it discloses a STRUCTURE -> K: POSSIBILITY, 'the dizziness of freedom', already in INNOCENCE -> H: BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, 'complete insignificance' (Section 40), *solus ipse*, and the NOTHING (1929) -> S: MY FREEDOM - CLIFF PATH and GAMBLER -> anxiety is the PRIVILEGED mood -> but disclosure is not INFALLIBLE, and the naturalist competitor is not refuted

SESSION 18 - CRITICISM, COMPARISON AND ANSWER CRAFT: THE DEBATES, THE DIRECTIVE DECODER AND THE VERDICT BANK

DEFINITION. *Plain language:* this session is where the three projects are set against each other and against their critics, and where the machinery for actually writing the answer - what each command word obliges you to do, and what a defensible closing line looks like - is assembled. *Technical:* the clause requires **thinker-specific** criticism and reply, because movement-level objections (subjectivism, pessimism, social abstraction) have **three different answers** depending on whose project is being attacked; and it requires **directive fidelity**, because the paper's command words - comment, discuss, critically examine, explain the difference - each impose a distinct structural obligation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING. ANALYSIS: *"Objections to 'existentialism' as a movement rarely survive contact with its members: the charge of subjectivism means something different when levelled at Kierkegaard's appropriation, at Sartre's choice and at Heidegger's ontology - and an answer that replies once has replied to nobody."*

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS. thinker-specific reply · subjectivism · pessimism · social abstraction · decisionism · formal emptiness · fideism · elitism · situated freedom · practico-inert · natality against mortality · directive fidelity · graded verdict.

Plain-language visual - the idea before the vocabulary.

ONE OBJECTION, THREE DIFFERENT ANSWERS

'EXISTENTIALISM IS SUBJECTIVIST'

- > to KIERKEGAARD: no - subjectivity names the MODE OF APPROPRIATION, and he also writes 'subjectivity is untruth'
- > to SARTRE: no - choice is tied to RESPONSIBILITY and to 'in choosing myself I choose man'
- > to HEIDEGGER: no - he is doing ONTOLOGY; das Man is criticised precisely for validating received opinion

REPLY ONCE AND YOU HAVE REPLIED TO NOBODY.

What this shows: the movement-level objection is a shape, not an argument. Filling in the shape requires knowing which project is being attacked.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the criticism ledger, the debate grid, and the directive decoder.

CRITICISMS OF SARTRE

- 1 RADICAL FREEDOM IS PSYCHOLOGICALLY IMPLAUSIBLE - people under slavery, torture or mental illness are not 'absolutely free'.
SOURCE: common sense; Marxist tradition (Merleau-Ponty, Adventures of the Dialectic).
REPLY: freedom-of-consciousness (I can always interpret) vs freedom-of-action (limited by situation) - BUT THIS WEAKENS THE RADICAL THESIS. In the Critique of Dialectical Reason (1960) Sartre HIMSELF integrates scarcity, seriality and the practico-inert.
- 2 BAD FAITH PRESUPPOSES WHAT IT DENIES - to deceive myself I must both know and not know; but Sartre rejects the Freudian unconscious. SOURCE: Fingarette, Self-Deception.
REPLY: pre-reflective, NON-THETIC awareness in a non-self-identical consciousness. COHERENCE REMAINS DEBATED.
- 3 CHOICE WITHOUT CRITERIA IS BLIND - 'existentialist DECISIONISM'. SOURCE: Iris Murdoch, The Sovereignty of Good; Marxist critics. REPLY: engagement generates its own criteria - critics find this CIRCULAR.
- 4 UNIVERSALISABILITY sits uneasily with the denial of objective values. SOURCE: Kantians, communitarians. REPLY: Sartre concedes tension; Notebooks for an Ethics never completed.
- 5 UNDER-DESCRIBES GENDERED, RACIALISED AND MATERIAL CONSTRAINT. SOURCE: de Beauvoir, Fanon, feminist and postcolonial criticism. REPLY: situated freedom appropriates facticity without being reducible to it; later Sartre broadens social mediation - but the early vocabulary remains abstract.

CRITICISMS OF HEIDEGGER

- 1 OBSCURITY - neologisms obstruct rather than clarify. SOURCE: Carnap (1932), Ayer, Russell, the analytic tradition.
REPLY: ordinary language is saturated with the metaphysical tradition, so new terms are needed to break through to the phenomena. WHETHER THIS JUSTIFIES THE OPACITY IS CONTESTED.
- 2 THE PROJECT WAS NEVER COMPLETED - Division III (Time and Being) was never published. SOURCE: internal. REPLY: Heidegger acknowledged this and underwent the TURN (Kehre). Failure or deepening is debated.
- 3 AUTHENTICITY IS FORMALLY EMPTY - it prescribes no content; a Nazi could be 'authentic'. SOURCE: political critics, given Heidegger's own 1933 complicity; Adorno's 'jargon of authenticity'. REPLY: authenticity is deliberately non-prescriptive. MANY FIND THIS ETHICALLY IRRESPONSIBLE.
- 4 BEING-TOWARD-DEATH IS MORBID / EXCLUDES POSITIVE SOCIAL BONDS. SOURCE: Levinas (ethics of the Other); Arendt (NATALITY over mortality). REPLY: death discloses the finitude that makes ANY authentic engagement possible. But Levinas's alternative remains a powerful counter.
- 5 ONTOLOGICAL FORMALITY PERMITS POLITICAL AMBIGUITY. REPLY: fundamental ontology is not a political programme - textually relevant, but it does not settle whether formal authenticity LACKS CRITICAL NORMS.

CRITICISMS OF KIERKEGAARD

- 1 FIDEISM / IRRATIONALISM - the leap abandons rationality. SOURCE: Hegel implicitly; analytic philosophy of religion.
REPLY: reason is not WRONG but LIMITED - it cannot deliver what the religious individual needs. Whether this is a reductio or a valid critique of rationalism DEPENDS ON ONE'S EPISTEMOLOGY.
- 2 ELITISM OF THE INDIVIDUAL - elevating the single individual over the community undermines ethics and social responsibility. SOURCE: communitarians, Hegelians. REPLY: 'the crowd is untruth' because it enables ethical evasion; genuine responsibility requires standing alone.
- 3 'TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY' COLLAPSES INTO RELATIVISM. SOURCE: common misreading. REPLY: WHAT is believed vs HOW it is believed; objective truth is retained for logic and science, only its SUFFICIENCY for existential truth is denied.
- 4 A PESSIMISTIC OR ELITIST IDEAL OF SOLITARY EXISTENCE. SOURCE: secular and social critics. REPLY: despair is a UNIVERSAL STRUCTURAL POSSIBILITY and responsibility is individual - but THE LIMITED ACCOUNT OF INSTITUTIONS AND

	COMMUNITY REMAINS A GENUINE WEAKNESS.	
+-----+		
	MOVEMENT-LEVEL OBJECTIONS NEED THINKER-SPECIFIC REPLIES	
	SUBJECTIVISM / IRRATIONALISM K: appropriation, not opinion.	
	S: choice is tied to RESPONSIBILITY. H: ontology, not the	
	validation of opinion.	
	PESSIMISM anxiety, despair, death and nothingness are	
	DIAGNOSTIC / DISCLOSIVE structures - not the claim that every	
	life is emotionally miserable.	
	SOCIAL ABSTRACTION feminist, Marxist and postcolonial critics	
	RIGHTLY pressure the early focus on solitary or formally free	
	agents; facticity, being-with and later situated ethics give	
	PARTIAL rather than complete replies.	
+-----+		

Caption: the ledger is arranged so that each row is usable as a single exam sentence - objection, named source, reply, residue. The last panel is the one to reach for whenever a question attacks "existentialism" rather than a named thinker.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the inter-thinker debate grid.

AXIS	KIERKEGAARD	SARTRE	HEIDEGGER
GOD	CENTRAL - faith in the absurd, the God-relation	DENIED - atheism as a PREMISE	BRACKETED - ontology, not theology
CORE TERM FOR HUMAN BEING	den Enkelte, the single individual	pour-soi, the for-itself, nihilating consciousness	Dasein, the entity that questions Being
PATH / AUTHENTICITY	religious faith in pseudonymous and signed contexts	bad-faith CRITIQUE; positive authenticity UNDERDEVELOPED	ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS (being-toward- death) - NOT a moral code
FREEDOM	qualitative choice within a finite God- relation	radical BUT SITUATED freedom of the for-itself	THROWN PROJEC- TION upon possibility - NOT Sartrean voluntarism
TEMPORALITY	REPETITION and THE MOMENT (Ojeblikket) - the eternal entering time	pour-soi as ECSTATIC; freedom NIHILATES the past	Zeitlichkeit - three ecstases, FUTURE-primacy, FINITE
CHIEF ENEMY	Hegel's System, the crowd, objective Christianity	determinism, bad faith, the SERIOUS SPIRIT	Cartesian dualism, das Man, the metaphysics of presence
RELATION TO HEGEL	existing individual vs completed system	uses Hegelian negation and otherness but rejects teleological totality	REOPENS the Being-question AGAINST metaphysics; the relation is NOT simple inheritance
MOOD DISCLOS- ING TRUTH	anxiety (Angest), despair	anguish (angoisse), nausea (la nausee)	anxiety (Angst) - discloses the Nothing and thrownness

Caption: eight axes, three columns. This grid is the fastest available answer to any comparison demand, and the "path/authenticity" row is the one most scripts get wrong, because Sartre has no positive doctrine to place beside the other two.

VISUAL: VISUAL - the directive decoder and the graded verdict bank.

DIRECTIVE DECODER - WHAT EACH COMMAND WORD OBLIGES YOU TO DO HERE

'COMMENT / ELUCIDATE THE STATEMENT' (2021 'if I do not choose...';
2023 'consciousness is what it is not...'; 2020 'you can always
make something...')

DEMANDS: locate the sentence IN ITS OWN THINKER'S SYSTEM, then
unpack the technical terms.

DO: identify the work, the PAIR OF TERMS it turns on (pour-soi/
en-soi; facticity/transcendence), then two consequences, then a
judgment.

FATAL: treating the sentence as a general maxim about life.

'DISCUSS EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE' (2024)

DEMANDS: reconstruct Sartre's atheistic no-blueprint argument and
the project/facticity consequence.

DO: no divine artisan -> no predetermined blueprint -> persons
take up projects in situations. THEN note Heidegger's
rejection.

FATAL: attributing the slogan to every existentialist.

'CRITICALLY EXAMINE AUTHENTICITY' (2019, 2022)

DEMANDS: ASSESSMENT DOMINATES, and the NON-MORAL reading is the
marked point.

DO: state that Eigentlichkeit is an existential modification, not
a virtue; then das Man, the call of conscience, being-toward-
death; then the charge of FORMAL EMPTINESS.

FATAL: treating authenticity as 'being true to yourself'.

'DISCUSS BEING-IN-THE-WORLD' (2022, 20m)

DEMANDS: THE HYPHENS ARE THE DOCTRINE - show that the compound
resists decomposition.

DO: refuse the subject/object split FIRST, then Zuhandenheit/
Vorhandenheit, the broken hammer, care (Sorge), and ONLY THEN
temporality.

FATAL: describing Dasein as 'a human being in the world'.

'HOW DOES KIERKEGAARD OPPOSE HEGEL?' (2023, 2020)

DEMANDS: a STRUCTURAL opposition, not a list of complaints.

DO: the existing individual vs the system; either/or vs both/and;
the LEAP vs MEDIATION; indirect communication vs the lecture.
Add 'a logical system is possible; an existential system is
impossible.'

FATAL: 'Kierkegaard disliked abstraction.'

'EXPLAIN FREEDOM AND DETERMINISM IN SARTRE' (2019)

DEMANDS: explain MEANING-CONFERRAL together with FACTICITY.

DO: motives do not operate as mechanical causes of a thing-like
self; analyse situation, project and later social constraint.

FATAL: pretending coercion, trauma or material limits are unreal.

'BRING OUT THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FEAR AND DREAD/ANXIETY'

DEMANDS: compare object-directed fear with existential anxiety
WHILE PRESERVING THINKER DIFFERENCES.

DO: Kierkegaard = possibility; Heidegger = collapse of world-
significance; Sartre = freedom.

FATAL: treating three vocabularies as one identical mood theory.

'ASSESS / DO YOU AGREE?'

DEMANDS: A DEFENDED RULING IN THE FIRST LINE.

DO: rule on radical freedom, on whether authenticity has content,
or on whether conflict is really the basic relation with others.

FATAL: a neutral survey.

=====

GRADED VERDICT BANK - EXECUTABLE CLOSING POSITIONS

EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE

10m Sartre's atheistic argument denies a predetermined human
blueprint; it does not erase biological or social facticity.

15m ...It is SARTRE'S slogan, not existentialism's common creed;
Heidegger repudiates the humanist inversion and Kierkegaard
is theistic.

20m The doctrine foregrounds project and responsibility but
leaves value-criteria and situated constraint underdeveloped.

RADICAL FREEDOM

10m Freedom is the for-itself's non-coincidence with facticity,

exercised only in situation.

15m ...Motives acquire action-guiding significance WITHIN a project; they are not irrelevant causes or instantly dismissible feelings.

20m Coercion, trauma and material structures pressure early radicalism; later scarcity and seriality broaden Sartre without simply retracting freedom.

BAD FAITH

10m Bad faith evades the TENSION of facticity and transcendence rather than merely lying.

15m ...Pre-reflective, non-thetic awareness is Sartre's proposed answer to the self-deception paradox.

20m The account is influential but normatively incomplete, because positive authenticity remains thin and its examples require contextual criticism.

THE LOOK / BEING-FOR-OTHERS

10m Shame discloses myself as object for another subject; it is not an empirical proof of all other minds.

15m ...Sartre improves on inferential models but may generalise conflict from selective encounters.

20m Love, solidarity, de Beauvoir, Fanon and later Sartre pressure subject/object exclusivity; these are BOUNDED criticisms, not replacements.

ANGUISH / FEAR

10m Fear has a determinate threat; existential anxiety discloses possibility, freedom or world-collapse depending on the thinker.

15m ...Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre use related but NON-IDENTICAL moods.

20m A mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition; naturalistic and clinical explanations remain compatible competitors.

AUTHENTICITY (HEIDEGGER)

10m Eigentlichkeit is an existential modification, not a moral achievement; Dasein is inauthentic proximally and for the most part, and this is structural.

15m ...Anticipatory resoluteness gives Dasein its ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite possibility, and thereby a whole - but it prescribes NO CONTENT WHATEVER.

20m The formality is deliberate and it is the doctrine's deepest problem. Adorno's charge of a 'jargon of authenticity', and the political catastrophe of Heidegger's own 1933, press the same question: a criterion that tells you to own your choices without telling you which to make can dignify any resolute commitment. The defence - that fundamental ontology is not ethics - is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying.

KIERKEGAARD VS HEGEL

10m No completed system substitutes for the temporal choice of the existing individual.

15m ...Leap, either/or and indirect communication resist mediated systematic closure, but Hegel need not simply deny individuality.

20m Kierkegaard exposes first-person appropriation that a system-view risks losing; he does not offer a rival comprehensive ontology.

INDIRECT COMMUNICATION

10m Ethical-religious appropriation cannot be handed over as neutral information.

15m ...Pseudonyms stage existence-possibilities; attribution must follow their voices.

20m Revocation makes the method deliberately self-limiting, though whether it clarifies or evades doctrine remains disputed.

Caption: the decoder tells you what to do; the verdict bank tells you how to stop. Both are graded, so the same sub-topic yields a different closing sentence at 10, 15 and 20 marks - which is what "answer to the marks" actually means.

NUMBERED TEACHING.

1. **Criticise thinker by thinker.** ANALYSIS: The three criticism ledgers above are not interchangeable. An answer that attacks "existentialism" for subjectivism and then replies once has replied to nobody.
2. **The Sartre ledger, in order of force.** CAUTION: Psychological and social implausibility of radical freedom (strongest, and conceded in 1960) -> the coherence of bad faith without an unconscious -> decisionism -> the universalisability tension -> gendered, racialised and material constraint.
3. **The Heidegger ledger, in order of force.** CAUTION: Formal emptiness (strongest, sharpened by 1933 and by Adorno) -> the unwritten Division III -> Levinas and Arendt on death -> obscurity -> political ambiguity. ANALYSIS: Note that objection 2 is **internal**: the project's incompleteness is not a hostile claim but a fact about the book.
4. **The Kierkegaard ledger, in order of force.** CAUTION: Fideism -> the thin account of institutions and community (a **genuine weakness**, and the honest concession) -> elitism -> the relativism misreading, which is a misreading rather than an objection.
5. **Movement-level objections, answered three ways.** ANALYSIS: **Subjectivism**: Kierkegaard's subjectivity concerns *appropriation*; Sartre links choice with *responsibility*; Heidegger is doing *ontology* rather than validating opinion. **Pessimism**: anxiety, despair, death and nothingness are **diagnostic and disclosive structures**, not the claim that every life is miserable. **Social abstraction**: feminist, Marxist and postcolonial critics **rightly** pressure the early focus on solitary or formally free agents; facticity, being-with and later situated ethics provide **partial rather than complete** replies.
6. **The debate grid is the comparison answer.** ANALYSIS: Eight axes - God, core term, path to authenticity, freedom, temporality, chief enemy, relation to Hegel, disclosive mood. FACT: Reproducing four or five of these rows, with one sentence each, is a complete comparative section.
7. **Directive fidelity.** ANALYSIS: Each command word imposes a structural obligation, listed in the decoder above. Three of the fourteen owned parts are **statement questions** (2020, 2021, 2023), and for those the first move is always to **locate the sentence in its own thinker's system**, not to comment on it as a maxim about life.
8. **The verdict bank is graded for a reason.** ANALYSIS: At 10 marks a verdict is a single defended clause; at 15 it adds the distinction that makes the clause non-obvious; at 20 it must name the residue and rule on it. FACT: Using the wrong grade - a 20-mark verdict on a 10-mark part - costs time that the earlier sections needed.
9. **Provenance discipline is part of answer craft, not pedantry.** ANALYSIS: Three languages, three translation traditions, one unfinished book, one lecture the author regretted, and one printed instruction about attribution. Naming a translation once, citing *Being and Time* by section, attributing the slogans to 1945/46 and quoting a pseudonym by name are four cheap marks available in every answer in this clause.
10. **What must never be written.** WRONG: "The existentialists held that..." as though the three shared a doctrine; that authenticity means being true to oneself; that *Being and Time* is a completed system; that "leap of faith" is a phrase of Kierkegaard's; that "nothing noughts"; or that Sartre's slogan is Heidegger's.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Claim. Criticism of this clause must be thinker-specific, because the standard movement-level charges have three different answers depending on which project is in view. **Named evidence.** Against Sartre, Merleau-Ponty's *Adventures of the Dialectic* and the Marxist tradition press the implausibility of radical freedom, Fingarette's *Self-Deception* presses the coherence of bad faith without an unconscious, and Murdoch's *The Sovereignty of Good* presses decisionism; against Heidegger, Carnap's 1932 attack presses obscurity, Adorno's "jargon of authenticity" and Heidegger's 1933 complicity press formal emptiness, and Levinas and Arendt press the primacy of the Other and of natality over mortality; against Kierkegaard, the fideism charge is pressed by analytic philosophy of religion and the elitism charge by communitarians and Hegelians. **Analysis.** Each reply belongs to a different structure - Sartre answers by distinguishing freedom of consciousness from freedom of action and then, in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), by conceding scarcity and seriality; Heidegger answers that fundamental ontology is not ethics; Kierkegaard answers that reason is limited rather than wrong and that the crowd enables ethical evasion - so a single reply to "existentialism" would have to be true of all three at once, which none is. **Qualification.** CAUTION: Two residues should be conceded rather than argued away: Heidegger's formality genuinely lacks critical norms, and Kierkegaard's account of institutions and community is thin; in both cases the defence is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying.

EXAM LINK. This session supplies the assessment third of every twenty-mark part in the clause - **2018 Q4(a), 2019 Q3(a), 2020 Q3(a), 2020 Q4(a), 2022 Q2(a), 2022 Q4(a)** and **2024 Q4(a)** - and the closing verdict for every ten- and fifteen-mark part.

UPSC TRAPS.

Trap	Correction
One reply to a movement-level objection	ANALYSIS: Three thinkers, three replies. Subjectivism means something different in each.
Treating pessimism as a fair description	FACT: Anxiety, despair and death are disclosive structures , not emotional verdicts on life.
Dismissing the social-abstraction objection	CAUTION: It is rightly pressed; the replies are partial . Concede the residue.
Neutral survey when the directive says "critically"	ANALYSIS: Assessment must dominate , and the ruling belongs in the first line.
Using a 20-mark verdict on a 10-mark part	ANALYSIS: Verdicts are graded ; the wrong grade costs the marks the earlier sections needed.
Skipping provenance	ANALYSIS: Section citation, translation naming, 1945/46 attribution and pseudonym citation are four cheap marks.

REVISION NOTES.

- **Sartre ledger:** implausibility (conceded 1960) · bad-faith coherence (Fingarette) · **decisionism** (Murdoch) · universalisability tension · constraint (de Beauvoir, Fanon).
- **Heidegger ledger:** **formal emptiness** (1933, Adorno) · unfinished Division III · Levinas/Arendt · obscurity (Carnap) · political ambiguity.
- **Kierkegaard ledger:** **fideism** · thin institutions/community (**genuine weakness**) · elitism · relativism (a misreading).
- Movement-level: **subjectivism** (three replies) · **pessimism** (disclosive structures) · **social abstraction** (partial replies).
- Debate grid: **God** · **core term** · **path** · **freedom** · **temporality** · **enemy** · **Hegel** · **mood**.
- Directive decoder: statement questions -> **locate in the thinker's system first**; "critically" -> assessment dominates.
- Verdicts are **graded 10/15/20**; provenance discipline is **four cheap marks**.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW.

NAME THE THINKER BEFORE THE OBJECTION -> SARTRE: implausibility ->
bad-faith coherence -> decisionism -> universalisability -> constraint
| HEIDEGGER: formal emptiness -> unfinished -> Levinas/Arendt ->
obscurity | KIERKEGAARD: fideism -> thin community -> elitism ->
relativism misread -> MOVEMENT-LEVEL CHARGES GET THREE REPLIES ->
COMPARE ON EIGHT AXES -> OBEY THE DIRECTIVE -> CLOSE WITH THE VERDICT
AT THE RIGHT GRADE -> AND SPEND FOUR CHEAP MARKS ON PROVENANCE

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated, and no cycle such as ABCD can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Existence and Essence*; *Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence*; *Being-in-the-world and Temporality* - together with the family-label warning and the ownership of the slogan, "truth is subjectivity" and its dialectical complement, the structural form of the anti-Hegelian argument, the three spheres with their characteristic collapses, the leap against mediation, the teleological suspension staged by Johannes de Silentio, anxiety as objectless and despair as a misrelation, indirect communication and the printed attribution rule, the paper-knife argument and the exact place of atheism in it, Heidegger's repudiation and *Being and Time* Section 9, the in-itself/for-itself distinction and both halves of the non-self-identity formula, nihilation and the impossible synthesis, non-choice as choice, the three moods of the 1945 lecture, the facticity/transcendence structure of bad faith, the self-deception paradox and its pre-reflective solution, motive-constitution against determinism, the Look and shame as recognition, and the two failing strategies that yield conflict. The eight remedial drills attack the confusions that cost marks every year: the provenance of the slogans, the unfinished state of *Being and Time*, the correct rendering of *das Nichts nichtet*, the Lowrie/Hong split over *Angest*, the non-moral status of authenticity, the corrected reading of "hell is other people", the derived rather than defective status of clock-time, and the ownership fence around Topics 02, 05, 07 and 09, Nietzsche and Paper II.

MCQ 1. What kind of thing "existentialism" is

Which statement most accurately describes the standing of the term "existentialism" in relation to the three thinkers printed in the syllabus?

- A. It is a retrospective family label that only Sartre accepted and defined for himself.
- B. It is a school founded by Kierkegaard, systematised by Heidegger and popularised in France by Sartre after the Second World War.
- C. It is a method of philosophical analysis that all three thinkers applied to different subject-matters while sharing its procedural rules.
- D. It is a doctrine whose founding thesis is that human beings have no nature, a thesis each of the three defended in his own vocabulary.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Kierkegaard died in 1855 and never met the word; Heidegger explicitly denied the label in the "Letter on Humanism"; only Sartre accepted it and, in the 1945 lecture published in 1946, defined it.
- **B:** Incorrect: it invents a lineage. Kierkegaard founded nothing called existentialism, and Heidegger's fundamental ontology is not a systematisation of Kierkegaard's religious writings.
- **C:** Incorrect: there is no shared procedure - Kierkegaard writes indirectly through pseudonyms, Heidegger conducts an existential analytic, Sartre a phenomenological ontology.
- **D:** Incorrect: the "no nature" thesis in that form is Sartre's, and Heidegger repudiated precisely the humanistic reading it presupposes.

Examiner trap 1: Writing "the existentialists held that..." assumes a shared doctrine, and the assumption is refuted by two of the three printed thinkers, one of whom denied the label in print and one of whom died before it existed.

MCQ 2. Which printed limb belongs almost entirely to one thinker

The syllabus prints three limbs: *Existence and Essence*; *Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence*; *Being-in-the-world and Temporality*. Which claim about their distribution is correct?

- A. The first limb is Heidegger's, since only he analyses the essence of Dasein as lying in its existence.
- B. The second limb is Kierkegaard's, since only he treats choice as a qualitative leap rather than as deliberation.
- C. The third limb is almost entirely Heidegger's, with Sartre entering only as a contrast.
- D. All three limbs are shared equally, which is why the syllabus names three thinkers rather than one.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the first limb turns on Sartre's slogan and on Heidegger's repudiation of it, so it cannot be assigned to Heidegger alone.
- **B:** Incorrect: choice, responsibility and authenticity are handled by all three in incompatible registers - faith, freedom and finitude.
- **C:** Correct: being-in-the-world and temporality are Heideggerian technical structures; Sartre's ecstatic temporality is read off freedom, not off Being, and Kierkegaard's "moment" is a different concept entirely.
- **D:** Incorrect: the asymmetry is exactly why 2019 Q3(a) and 2022 Q2(a) are Heidegger questions while 2024 Q4(a) is a comparison question.

Examiner trap 2: Distributing the three limbs evenly across the three thinkers produces an answer that spends a third of a Heidegger question on Kierkegaard, which is the commonest way of failing 2022 Q2(a).

MCQ 3. What "truth is subjectivity" asserts

The thesis that truth is subjectivity is argued in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846). What does it assert?

- A. That no proposition is true independently of someone's believing it, so that objective truth is an illusion produced by grammar.
- B. That for ethical and religious truth the mode of appropriation is decisive, without denying objective truth in logic or history.
- C. That the passion with which a belief is held is evidence for its truth, so that sincerity functions as a criterion of correctness.
- D. That truth is whatever the existing individual finds it useful to affirm in the situation in which he is placed.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Climacus denies the *sufficiency* of objective truth for existential matters, not its existence; logic and history retain their objective standing.
- **B:** Correct: the thesis concerns the *how* of appropriation - infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk - for truths that must be lived rather than merely known.
- **C:** Incorrect: passion is the mode of relation, not evidence; treating it as a criterion converts the thesis into the relativism it is designed to avoid.
- **D:** Incorrect: usefulness is a pragmatist criterion nowhere present in the *Postscript*, and it makes existential truth a matter of convenience.

Examiner trap 3: Reading the thesis as relativism makes its companion sentence "subjectivity is untruth" unintelligible, which is the internal evidence that the relativist reading cannot be right.

MCQ 4. The function of "subjectivity is untruth"

Why does Climacus also assert that subjectivity is untruth?

- A. Because the existing subject stands in sin and finitude and therefore needs the leap.
- B. Because subjective certainty is unreliable and must always be corrected by objective inquiry conducted in a community of enquirers.
- C. Because the pseudonymous form requires each thesis to be balanced by its opposite in order to preserve the reader's freedom to choose.
- D. Because passion distorts judgement, so that the more inwardly a belief is held the less likely it is to correspond to how things are.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the existing subject is not identical with the eternal, and the recognition of that non-identity is what makes the leap necessary rather than optional.
- **B:** Incorrect: the sentence is not an epistemological caution about unreliable feelings; it is a claim about the subject's standing before God.
- **C:** Incorrect: this makes the sentence a formal device of the method rather than a substantive theological claim, which reverses the order of explanation.
- **D:** Incorrect: it converts a doctrine about sin and finitude into a psychological generalisation about bias.

Examiner trap 4: Quoting "truth is subjectivity" without its complement leaves the relativism charge unanswered; quoting both, and explaining why a relativist could not use the second, answers it in one sentence.

MCQ 5. The structure of Kierkegaard's objection to Hegel

Which formulation best captures the *structural* form of Kierkegaard's objection to Hegel's system?

- A. The system is internally inconsistent, since its categories cannot be derived from one another without circularity at the decisive transitions.
- B. The system is empirically false, since history does not in fact display the rational development the dialectic requires it to display.
- C. No system can contain the one who builds it: a logical system is possible, an existential system is not.
- D. The system is morally objectionable, since it subordinates the suffering of individuals to the achievements of the world-spirit.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: internal inconsistency is a Hegelian-scholarship dispute; Kierkegaard's point holds even if the derivations succeed.
- **B:** Incorrect: an empirical objection would be answerable by better history, whereas Kierkegaard's objection concerns what any completed system must omit.
- **C:** Correct: the systematiser must still exist, choose and die, so the existing individual is the one item the system cannot absorb without cancelling it.
- **D:** Incorrect: the moral complaint is a consequence some critics draw, not the argument Kierkegaard actually mounts.

Examiner trap 5: Reducing the critique to "Kierkegaard disliked abstraction" removes the argument and leaves a temperament, which is why the 2023 part asks specifically how he argues *in favour of the individual as the essence of spirit*.

MCQ 6. The three spheres and their limits

Which pairing of sphere and characteristic collapse is correct throughout?

- A. Aesthetic - guilt; ethical - paradox; religious - boredom.
- B. Aesthetic - paradox; ethical - boredom; religious - guilt.
- C. Aesthetic - guilt; ethical - boredom; religious - paradox.
- D. Aesthetic - boredom; ethical - guilt; religious - paradox.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it inverts the sequence entirely; boredom belongs to a life organised around the interesting, not to faith.
- **B:** Incorrect: paradox is the structure of faith, which is the religious sphere, and it cannot characterise the aesthetic.
- **C:** Incorrect: guilt arises from the impossibility of perfectly fulfilling a universal ethical demand, so it belongs to the ethical sphere.
- **D:** Correct: nothing binds in the aesthetic, so the self fragments; the ethical demand cannot be perfectly met, so guilt arises; faith is not rational or universal, so it lives as paradox.

Examiner trap 6: Listing the spheres without their internal collapses makes them look like preferences; naming the collapse of each is what shows why a leap to the next becomes intelligible.

MCQ 7. The leap, and the phrase "leap of faith"

Which statement about the transition between spheres and the phrase "leap of faith" is correct?

- A. The transition is a Hegelian mediation performed at a higher level, and "leap of faith" is Kierkegaard's own term for it in *Fear and Trembling*.
- B. The transition is a gradual psychological maturation, and "leap of faith" translates the Danish *Troens Spring* exactly as Kierkegaard wrote it.
- C. The transition is a qualitative leap, and "leap of faith" is the English tradition's fused phrase rather than a Kierkegaardian term.
- D. The transition is a leap only from the ethical to the religious, and elsewhere the movement between spheres proceeds by ordinary deliberation.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the leap is defined against mediation, and the fused English phrase is not Kierkegaard's.
- **B:** Incorrect: maturation would make the movement continuous, which is precisely what "qualitative" denies.
- **C:** Correct: Kierkegaard writes of *the leap* and of faith; the compound phrase belongs to the English reception, and saying so in one clause discharges the provenance caution.
- **D:** Incorrect: the spheres are qualitatively distinct throughout, and relapse from any of them is always possible.

Examiner trap 7: Presenting the spheres as a developmental ladder implies that one grows out of the aesthetic, whereas Kierkegaard's point is that one leaps and can always fall back.

MCQ 8. Who analyses Abraham, and what the analysis does

Fear and Trembling (1843) treats Abraham under the heading of the teleological suspension of the ethical. Which statement is correct?

- A. It is written by Johannes de Silentio, who admires faith without possessing it, and it stages the paradox rather than licensing private revelation.
- B. It is written by Kierkegaard under his own name, and it establishes that a direct divine command may override the moral law whenever the individual is sincere.
- C. It is written by Johannes Climacus, whose humorist standpoint allows him to describe the knight of faith from within the religious sphere itself.
- D. It is written by Anti-Climacus, and it shows that the ethical is permanently cancelled once the individual enters the religious sphere of existence.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the pseudonym's name records his position - he can describe Abraham but not understand him - and the text presents the paradox of faith rather than a moral permission.
- **B:** Incorrect: the book is pseudonymous, and reading it as a licence for private revelation is the standard misuse Kierkegaard scholarship warns against.
- **C:** Incorrect: Climacus writes the *Fragments* and the *Postscript* and describes himself as not a Christian; he is not the author of *Fear and Trembling*.
- **D:** Incorrect: Anti-Climacus writes *The Sickness unto Death* (1849) and *Practice in Christianity* (1850), and the ethical is suspended in relation to a higher telos, not abolished.

Examiner trap 8: Attributing pseudonymous books to Kierkegaard ignores an instruction he printed himself in the "First and Last Declaration", where he asks that the pseudonym be quoted instead.

MCQ 9. What makes anxiety philosophically disclosive

On the analysis given in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), what distinguishes anxiety from fear?

- A. Anxiety is more intense than fear, and its greater intensity overwhelms the capacity to identify what is threatening.
- B. Anxiety concerns future harms while fear concerns present ones, so the two differ only in the temporal location of the object that each of them takes.
- C. Anxiety has no determinate object, so what it discloses is not an entity but possibility - freedom's own "possibility of being able".
- D. Anxiety is a mood while fear is an emotion, and moods differ from emotions in lacking any intentional structure whatever.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: intensity would make the two differ in degree, whereas the analysis requires a difference in kind.
- **B:** Incorrect: fear can be directed at future harms and remain fear; the distinguishing feature is objectlessness, not tense.
- **C:** Correct: because there is no entity for anxiety to be about, what it discloses must be a structure, and Vigilius Haufniensis names that structure the dizziness of freedom.
- **D:** Incorrect: it introduces a mood/emotion taxonomy the text does not use, and denying all intentional structure would make anxiety mere confusion.

Examiner trap 9: Describing anxiety as "fear without a clear cause" preserves the object and merely makes it obscure, which loses the argument that an objectless state must be disclosing something other than an object.

MCQ 10. Despair, as *The Sickness unto Death* defines it

What is despair, on the analysis given by Anti-Climacus in 1849?

- A. A prolonged emotional condition of hopelessness that follows repeated failure to realise the projects one has chosen.
- B. A misrelation in the relation the self is - the self failing to be itself before the power that established it.
- C. The recognition that the ethical demand cannot be fulfilled, which drives the individual out of the ethical sphere.
- D. The mood in which the possibility of one's own death first becomes an issue for the existing individual as such.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: despair on this account may be entirely unfelt, so it cannot be identified with an emotional condition.
- **B:** Correct: the self is defined as a relation that relates itself to itself and thereby to the power that established it, and despair is a fault within that relation.
- **C:** Incorrect: that describes the collapse of the ethical sphere into guilt, which is a different analysis in a different pseudonymous work.
- **D:** Incorrect: this conflates despair with anxiety, and imports a Heideggerian concern that Kierkegaard's text does not carry.

Examiner trap 10: Treating despair as sadness makes the claim that despair is universal look like an empirical exaggeration, when it is a structural claim about the self's relation to its ground.

MCQ 11. Why the doctrine forces the method

Consider the following claims about indirect communication.

1. It is required because ethical and religious truth is a mode of existing rather than a result.
2. It is required because Kierkegaard wished to protect himself from censorship and from the Danish church.
3. Direct communication of such truth would falsify it, since the recipient could then hold it without becoming it.
4. The model is Socratic midwifery, in which the author becomes a vanishing occasion rather than an authority.

Which of the above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only.
- B. 2 and 3 only.
- C. 1, 2 and 4 only.
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it includes the biographical motive, which is not the argument, and omits the two steps that make the argument work.
- **B:** Incorrect: it retains the biographical motive and drops the premise about what kind of truth is at stake.
- **C:** Incorrect: 4 is correct but 2 is not, and dropping 3 removes the step in which the falsification actually occurs.
- **D:** Correct: the three steps form the argument - the kind of truth, the falsification that direct transmission would cause, and the Socratic form that avoids it.

Examiner trap 11: Explaining pseudonymity by the author's temperament or circumstances converts an argument into a biography, and loses the point that the form is deduced from the doctrine.

MCQ 12. The "First and Last Declaration"

What does Kierkegaard do in the "First and Last Declaration" appended to the *Postscript* (1846)?

- A. He renounces the pseudonymous authorship entirely and asks readers to disregard the books published under invented names.
- B. He acknowledges the pseudonymous books while calling himself their "author's author" and asks that citations name the pseudonym.
- C. He explains that the pseudonyms were adopted to avoid prosecution, and announces that he will henceforth publish only under his own name.
- D. He identifies each pseudonym with a stage of his own biography, so that the works may be read as a spiritual autobiography.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: he does not renounce them; he acknowledges authorship while refusing to be quoted as their speaker.
- **B:** Correct: he describes himself as only the "author's author", a prompter (*souffleur*) who produced characters, and asks that the pseudonym's name be quoted instead of his own.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such legal motive is stated, and the pseudonymous works continue after 1846 with Anti-Climacus in 1849 and 1850.
- **D:** Incorrect: the pseudonyms are existence-possibilities rather than autobiographical stages, and Anti-Climacus is placed deliberately above the author himself.

Examiner trap 12: Citing "Kierkegaard in *Fear and Trembling*" is not merely loose but contrary to a printed instruction, so the correct attribution is a mark available at no cost.

MCQ 13. The exact role of atheism in the paper-knife argument

In Sartre's argument for "existence precedes essence", what role does atheism play?

- A. It is a premise: because there is no divine artisan, there is no antecedent design for the human being.
- B. It is a conclusion: the absence of any fixed human nature shows that no creator could have conceived one in advance.
- C. It is an illustration: the artisan is introduced only to make the structure of essence and existence vivid to a lay audience.
- D. It is a corollary: once freedom is recognised as absolute, the existence of a determining God is seen to be incompatible with it.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the argument runs from the absence of a designer to the absence of a blueprint, which is why the slogan in its Sartrean form is not definitional of existentialism as such.
- **B:** Incorrect: it reverses the inference; Sartre does not derive atheism from the absence of a nature.
- **C:** Incorrect: the paper-knife is the illustration; the denial of God is a substantive premise doing argumentative work.
- **D:** Incorrect: this makes atheism follow from the doctrine of freedom, whereas the lecture argues in the opposite direction.

Examiner trap 13: Missing the premissory role of atheism makes it impossible to explain why Kierkegaard, a Christian, can be an existentialist while rejecting the slogan.

MCQ 14. Heidegger on essence and existence

Which statement correctly reports Heidegger's relation to the formula "existence precedes essence"?

- A. He accepts it as a compressed statement of *Being and Time* Section 9, while regretting its use in a popular lecture rather than a technical work.
- B. He accepts its negative half - that there is no fixed human nature - while rejecting the positive claim that man creates himself.
- C. He is silent about it, since the "Letter on Humanism" concerns the history of Being and does not discuss Sartre's formulations.
- D. He repudiates it as a humanistic inversion: Section 9 makes an ontological claim, and Sartre stays inside the metaphysics of subjectivity.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: he does not accept it at all; Section 9 is expressly distinguished from the Sartrean reading.
- **B:** Incorrect: the objection is not to one half of the formula but to the framework that generates both halves.
- **C:** Incorrect: the "Letter on Humanism", written 1946 and published 1947, addresses Sartre's slogan directly.
- **D:** Correct: reversing the priority of essence and existence leaves man at the centre, which for Heidegger is the metaphysics the Being-question is meant to displace.

Examiner trap 14: Quoting Section 9 as evidence that Heidegger agrees with Sartre uses the very sentence Heidegger wrote the "Letter on Humanism" to reclaim.

MCQ 15. What kind of distinction the in-itself/for-itself distinction is

Sartre distinguishes being-in-itself from being-for-itself. What kind of distinction is this?

- A. A distinction between matter and mind, corresponding to the two substances of Cartesian dualism in a phenomenological idiom.
- B. An ontological distinction between being that is self-identical and being that is not what it is and is what it is not.
- C. An epistemological distinction between what can be known directly and what can be known only through reflective self-awareness.
- D. A distinction between the world as science describes it and the world as it appears within ordinary pre-scientific experience.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the in-itself is not matter and the for-itself is not mind; a mental state considered as a completed fact would be in-itself.
- **B:** Correct: the contrast is between full self-coincidence and constitutive non-coincidence, which is why nihilation rather than substance is the operative concept.
- **C:** Incorrect: it is not a distinction between modes of knowing but between modes of being.
- **D:** Incorrect: that is a contrast between attitudes to one world, not a division of being into two regions.

Examiner trap 15: Translating the pair as "matter and mind" makes the impossible synthesis of a *pour-soi-en-soi* look like a mind-body union rather than the contradictory ideal of a self-identical consciousness.

MCQ 16. Both halves of the formula

"Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is." Which reading gives both halves correctly?

- A. "Is what it is not" - it is defined by a future it does not yet possess; "is not what it is" - it cannot coincide with its past or facticity.
- B. "Is what it is not" - it cannot coincide with its past; "is not what it is" - it is defined by a future it does not yet possess.
- C. "Is what it is not" - it misdescribes itself in bad faith; "is not what it is" - it can always revise the description it has given.
- D. "Is what it is not" - it depends on the Other for the being it has; "is not what it is" - it refuses the fixed identity that the Other's look confers upon it.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the first half is the projective, futural dimension and the second the refusal of coincidence with facticity, illustrated by the waiter who is and is not a waiter.
- **B:** Incorrect: it swaps the halves, which destroys the connection between the first half and the project.
- **C:** Incorrect: bad faith is an *application* of the formula, not its meaning; the formula states an ontological structure.
- **D:** Incorrect: being-for-others is a further dimension analysed in Part III, not the content of this formula.

Examiner trap 16: Unpacking only one half turns a fifteen-mark question into a definition, since the whole point is that the two halves name the future and the past dimensions of one non-coincidence.

MCQ 17. Nihilation and the impossible synthesis

Which statement about nihilation and the for-itself's desire is correct?

- A. Nihilation destroys the in-itself, and the for-itself's desire is to complete that destruction so that only consciousness remains.
- B. Nihilation introduces nothingness into being, and the for-itself desires to become self-identical while remaining conscious - an impossible ideal.
- C. Nihilation is the act by which the for-itself denies the existence of the world outside consciousness, and its desire is to sustain that denial indefinitely.
- D. Nihilation is the negation of one's past, and the for-itself desires to be free of every past so that no facticity constrains it.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: nihilation does not annihilate anything; it introduces distance, question and possibility into what is.
- **B:** Correct: consciousness stands back from what is and negates it, and the resulting ideal - a *pour-soi-en-soi*, that is, God - is contradictory, which is why man is called a useless passion.
- **C:** Incorrect: Sartre affirms the in-itself's brute existence; nothing in the doctrine denies that the world is.
- **D:** Incorrect: this narrows nihilation to one of its exercises and replaces the impossible synthesis with an ordinary wish.

Examiner trap 17: Omitting the impossible synthesis leaves the account without its conclusion, and the phrase "useless passion" then looks like rhetoric rather than the result of an argument.

MCQ 18. Non-choice

"I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing." What does this assert?

- A. That deliberation must terminate in a decision, since an indefinitely postponed deliberation is not a genuine deliberation at all.
- B. That every choice, however trivial, has consequences for others and therefore carries a responsibility one cannot decline.
- C. That some situations offer no acceptable options, in which case refusing to act is the only responsible course available.
- D. That deferral and conformity are themselves stances, so that the attempt to escape choosing is already a choice.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the claim is not about the logic of deliberation but about the impossibility of a stance-free relation to a situation.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the universalisability point, which is a further thesis and not what this sentence states.
- **C:** Incorrect: it converts a structural claim into practical advice for hard cases.
- **D:** Correct: because the for-itself must take up some relation to its situation, non-choice is a way of choosing, and it is typically a way of choosing in bad faith.

Examiner trap 18: Reading the sentence as a maxim about procrastination loses its ontological force, and the 2021 part explicitly asks for Sartre's *conception of choice and responsibility* in its light.

MCQ 19. The three moods of the 1945 lecture

In *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, what do anguish, abandonment and despair respectively name?

- A. Fear of death; loss of religious belief; recognition that most projects fail.
- B. Vertigo before freedom; the loss of community; resignation in the face of history.
- C. Vertigo before one's own freedom; the absence of any *a priori* value; acting without reliance on outcomes beyond one's action.
- D. Guilt before others; the absence of divine forgiveness; the impossibility of ever completing any project that one has begun in the course of a finite life.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: none of the three is about death, belief-loss or the frequency of failure; each names a structural feature of choosing without a given framework.
- **B:** Incorrect: the first term is right but abandonment concerns the absence of *a priori* values, not the loss of community.
- **C:** Correct: anguish is vertigo before one's own undetermined future, abandonment is the absence of any value written in an intelligible heaven, and despair is the discipline of confining oneself to what lies within one's action.
- **D:** Incorrect: guilt and forgiveness belong to a theological register that Sartre's lecture does not use.

Examiner trap 19: Translating Sartre's *desespoir* by Kierkegaard's despair merges a lecture-term about reliance on outcomes with a theological account of the self's misrelation to its ground.

MCQ 20. The structure of bad faith

Which formulation states the structure of bad faith correctly?

- A. It is the deliberate assertion of what one knows to be false, directed at oneself rather than at another person.
- B. It is the repression of an unwelcome truth, which then continues to operate on conduct from outside conscious awareness.
- C. It is the failure to act on values one sincerely holds, and it is therefore a species of weakness of will rather than of deception.
- D. It is the collapse of the tension between facticity and transcendence, by living as though only one dimension were real.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is ordinary lying redirected inwards, and it generates the paradox Sartre's analysis is designed to solve rather than solving it.
- **B:** Incorrect: repression requires the Freudian unconscious, which Sartre explicitly rejects.
- **C:** Incorrect: weakness of will concerns motivation, whereas bad faith concerns the ontological description one gives of oneself.
- **D:** Correct: both dimensions are always present, and bad faith deletes one of them - the waiter's claim to be his role, or the flight from a situation's real meaning.

Examiner trap 20: Defining bad faith as self-deception in general omits the pair of terms the doctrine turns on, and the 2018 part cannot then be answered, since it asks how bad faith connects with inauthenticity and alienation.

MCQ 21. The self-deception paradox

How does Sartre answer the objection that self-deception is impossible because the deceiver must know what the deceived does not?

- A. By denying that consciousness is self-identical, so that truth and its denial can be held in a single pre-reflective, non-thetic stance.
- B. By dividing the person into a censoring agency and a censored one, which is precisely what the analysis of the unconscious was designed to supply.
- C. By arguing that the deception is temporally staggered, so that one knows at one moment and has genuinely forgotten at the next.
- D. By treating bad faith as a limiting ideal that is never fully achieved, so that the paradox describes something no one actually does.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: because the for-itself is not what it is, it can be aware without avowing, and no second person inside the person is required.
- **B:** Incorrect: Sartre rejects the Freudian unconscious precisely because it reintroduces a small deceiver within the self.
- **C:** Incorrect: staggering the knowledge would make bad faith ordinary forgetting, which cannot explain its motivated character.
- **D:** Incorrect: Sartre treats bad faith as widespread and describable, not as an unrealisable limit.

Examiner trap 21: Solving the paradox by importing the unconscious contradicts the position being expounded, and it also removes the reason Sartre needs the non-self-identity thesis in the first place.

MCQ 22. Freedom and determinism

On Sartre's account, why does a motive not determine action?

- A. Because motives are mental events without causal power, and only physical events can stand in causal relations to bodily movements.
- B. Because the for-itself is able to suspend any of its motives by an act of will, and any motive that is suspended has by that very fact been overridden.
- C. Because motives conflict with one another, and where several motives are present none of them can be singled out as the determining one.
- D. Because a motive acquires action-guiding force only through the meaning conferred on it, and that conferral is itself an act of the for-itself.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Sartre is not defending epiphenomenalism or any thesis about the causal powers of the mental.
- **B:** Incorrect: this makes freedom a faculty of veto exercised over pre-existing forces, which is the voluntarism the analysis avoids.
- **C:** Incorrect: conflict among motives is a psychological commonplace and would leave determinism untouched.
- **D:** Correct: no motive operates as an external cause, because what makes it a motive is the significance it has within a project the for-itself is pursuing.

Examiner trap 22: Presenting Sartre as denying that circumstances constrain anything produces the caricature critics attack, whereas the doctrine concedes facticity and denies only that the for-itself becomes a thing among causes.

MCQ 23. The Look

What does Sartre's analysis of the Look establish?

- A. That other minds exist, since the behaviour of others cannot be explained without attributing consciousness to them.
- B. That the body is primarily an object for others, and only secondarily the medium of one's own practical engagement.
- C. That shame is by its structure shame before someone, so that the Other is lived rather than inferred as the condition of my having an outside.
- D. That social roles are imposed on us from without, so that the self is simply a product of the expectations other people direct towards it over time.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the analysis is not an argument from behaviour to consciousness; it describes a structure already present in shame.
- **B:** Incorrect: the body-for-others is a consequence drawn later, not the result the keyhole scene establishes.
- **C:** Correct: in being ashamed I recognise myself as the Other sees me, which is why Sartre calls the Other the indispensable mediator between myself and me.
- **D:** Incorrect: this sociological reading loses the ontological point that the outside conferred cannot be known from within.

Examiner trap 23: Retelling the keyhole scene without the first stage removes the crucial premise that pre-reflective consciousness is egoless, so the ego that appears under the Look no longer looks conferred.

MCQ 24. Why conflict follows

Sartre concludes that conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others. Which pair of reasons supports that conclusion?

- A. Others compete for scarce goods, and scarcity is the permanent background against which all human relations are formed.
- B. Others judge us by standards we did not set, and no standard set by another can be authoritative for a free being.
- C. Others are opaque to us, and the impossibility of knowing another's inner life makes stable cooperation permanently insecure.
- D. Assimilating the Other's freedom destroys the freedom it seeks, and objectifying him destroys the recognition it wants.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: scarcity belongs to the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), not to the argument of 1943.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is a claim about the authority of norms rather than about the structure of the encounter.
- **C:** Incorrect: opacity is an epistemic difficulty; Sartre's conflict is ontological and arises even where each party understands the other perfectly.
- **D:** Correct: love and masochism fail because being loved is being made an object, and indifference, sadism and hate fail because an object cannot confer recognition.

Examiner trap 24: Listing the two strategies without saying why each fails leaves the conclusion unsupported, and the failure-reasons are precisely what a fifteen- or twenty-mark answer is being paid for.

MCQ 25. Remedial drill - where the slogans come from

Which statement about the provenance of Sartre's best-known phrases is correct?

- A. "Condemned to be free" and "existence precedes essence" both appear in *Being and Nothingness* (1943), and the 1945 lecture merely repeats them.
- B. Both phrases come from the lecture *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, delivered in October 1945 and published in 1946.
- C. "Existence precedes essence" is from *Being and Nothingness* (1943) and "condemned to be free" from the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960).
- D. Both phrases were coined by Sartre's critics and adopted by him only after the label "existentialism" had become current in France.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the 1943 treatise is a technical ontology and does not contain the popular formulations.
- **B:** Correct: the slogans belong to the popular lecture, which Sartre later regretted publishing - a point worth one clause in any answer.
- **C:** Incorrect: it splits the pair across the wrong works and dates one of them seventeen years too late.
- **D:** Incorrect: the phrases are Sartre's own, and the lecture is where he sets them out.

Examiner trap 25: Sourcing the slogans to *Being and Nothingness* misses the difference between a technical ontology and a popular defence, and the distinction is exactly the kind of precision the paper rewards.

MCQ 26. Remedial drill - the state of Being and Time

Which statement about *Being and Time* (1927) is correct?

- A. It was published complete in 1927, and the later "turn" abandoned its conclusions in favour of a new starting point in language.
- B. It was published in two volumes, the second of which appeared in 1929 under the title "What is Metaphysics?".
- C. It was published unfinished: only Divisions One and Two of Part One appeared, and Division III was never published.
- D. It was published unfinished, and Heidegger completed it in the Stambaugh edition of 1996 with the addition of the missing division.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the book is incomplete on its own terms, and the turn is a change of approach rather than the abandonment of a finished result.
- **B:** Incorrect: "What is Metaphysics?" is the 1929 Freiburg inaugural lecture, not a second volume.
- **C:** Correct: Division III ("Time and Being") and the whole of Part Two were never published, which is why one must never write that Heidegger completes his analysis of Being in the book.
- **D:** Incorrect: Stambaugh's 1996 volume is a translation, and it adds no missing text.

Examiner trap 26: Writing that *Being and Time* completes the analysis of Being asserts something the book itself denies, and it removes the internal objection that any critical account of Heidegger should register.

MCQ 27. Remedial drill - rendering das Nichts nichtet

In "What is Metaphysics?" (1929) Heidegger writes *Das Nichts nichtet*. Which rendering is acceptable?

- A. "Nothing noths", or equivalently "the nothing nothings".
- B. "Nothing noughts", which preserves the play on the arithmetical zero in the German original.
- C. "Nothingness annihilates", which conveys the destructive force the German verb is intended to express.
- D. "There is nothing", which avoids the neologism while retaining the sense of the sentence for an English reader.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: these are the standard renderings, and the coined verb is deliberate - the Nothing is presented as doing something rather than as a mere absence.
- **B:** Incorrect: "noughts" is simply wrong, and the German makes no arithmetical play.
- **C:** Incorrect: "annihilates" imports a destructive sense the analysis does not carry; the point is disclosure, not destruction.
- **D:** Incorrect: rendering it as an existential denial removes the verb and with it the whole provocation Carnap attacked.

Examiner trap 27: Reproducing "nothing noughts" signals that the sentence has been copied from an unreliable summary, and it also weakens the cross-reference to the logical-positivist attack, which turns on the exact wording.

MCQ 28. Remedial drill - translating Angest

Why should an answer name a translation, or use the Danish word once, when discussing Kierkegaard's *Angest*?

- A. Because the Danish term has no English equivalent, so any translation misrepresents the concept it names.
- B. Because Lowrie renders it "dread" and Hong renders it "anxiety", and the book's English title differs accordingly.
- C. Because Kierkegaard used the term inconsistently across his works, so each occurrence has to be dated before it can be translated.
- D. Because the German *Angst* and the Danish *Angest* are false friends, and the two words name unrelated states.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the term is translatable; the difficulty is that two standard traditions translate it differently.
- **B:** Correct: *The Concept of Dread* (Lowrie) and *The Concept of Anxiety* (Hong) are the same book, and naming the translation prevents an apparent contradiction.
- **C:** Incorrect: the difficulty is one of reception rather than of authorial inconsistency.
- **D:** Incorrect: the two are cognate and the analyses are related, though not identical - which is a point about doctrine, not about translation.

Examiner trap 28: Referring to "*The Concept of Dread*" and "*The Concept of Anxiety*" as two works doubles Kierkegaard's bibliography and reveals that the sources were not checked against one another.

MCQ 29. Remedial drill - the status of authenticity

Which statement about Heidegger's *Eigentlichkeit* is correct?

- A. It is a moral virtue whose opposite, inauthenticity, is a culpable failure to live according to one's own standards.
- B. It is a psychological achievement in which anxiety is mastered and the fear of death is finally overcome.
- C. It is an existential modification, not a moral category; Dasein is inauthentic proximally and for the most part, and this is structural.
- D. It is a political stance, since resoluteness is said to require commitment to a historical community and to the destiny it has inherited.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: inauthenticity carries no blame, because falling is an ontological structure rather than a failure of will.
- **B:** Incorrect: anticipatory resoluteness is not the mastery of a feeling; being-toward-death concerns a possibility, not an emotion.
- **C:** Correct: authenticity changes the ownership of an existence rather than its moral quality, and the call of conscience issues no content whatever.
- **D:** Incorrect: this reads the later political catastrophe back into the analysis, which is the objection critics press rather than the doctrine itself.

Examiner trap 29: Glossing authenticity as "being true to yourself" imports a popular ideal, and it makes the strongest objection - that the doctrine is formally empty - impossible to state.

MCQ 30. Remedial drill - "hell is other people"

How should the line from *Huis clos* (1944) be handled in an answer?

- A. Quote it, then give Sartre's own correction: it describes twisted relations, and the characters are dead and therefore fixed.
- B. Quote it as Sartre's considered view that human relations are inherently poisonous and cannot be improved by any effort.
- C. Avoid it entirely, since a line from a play carries no philosophical weight and cannot be cited in a philosophy answer.
- D. Quote it as evidence that Sartre abandoned the ontology of *Being and Nothingness* in favour of a literary treatment of the same themes.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Sartre explained in a 1965 recorded preface that the line does not mean relations with others are always poisonous, and that the three characters can no longer change their acts.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the popular misreading the author himself corrected.
- **C:** Incorrect: the line follows from the analysis of being-for-others and is legitimately citable when its context is supplied.
- **D:** Incorrect: the play and the treatise are contemporaneous and mutually supporting, not successive positions.

Examiner trap 30: Quoting the line without the correction converts an ontological thesis about objectification into a slogan about misanthropy, and it forfeits an easy demonstration of familiarity with the source.

MCQ 31. Remedial drill - ordinary time

Which statement about Heidegger's treatment of ordinary or "vulgar" time is correct?

- A. Clock-time is an illusion produced by falling, and authentic Dasein dispenses with measurement altogether.
- B. Clock-time is a derived interpretation reached through world-time and public dating; "vulgar" names a levelling, not a moral defect.
- C. Clock-time and primordial temporality are two wholly independent structures, and neither of them is derivable from the other in either direction.
- D. Clock-time is primordial, and Dasein's ecstatic temporality is a subjective distortion of the objective now-series.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: clock measurement is practically indispensable, and nothing in the analysis condemns it.
- **B:** Correct: the derivation runs from ecstatic temporality through world-time to public dating and measurement, and the levelling concerns a conceptual interpretation rather than conduct.
- **C:** Incorrect: independence would defeat the point of Division Two, which is to show the derivative status of the ordinary conception.
- **D:** Incorrect: it reverses the order of foundation the analysis is constructed to establish.

Examiner trap 31: Treating "vulgar time" as inauthentic in a moral sense converts a claim about the order of foundation into a complaint about punctuality, and overclaiming here is a standard way of losing the assessment marks.

MCQ 32. Remedial drill - the ownership fence

Which item is correctly assigned to this syllabus clause rather than to another owner?

- A. The theory of essences and free imaginative variation, since Heidegger and Sartre both employ phenomenological method.
- B. The dialectical method and the doctrine of Absolute Spirit, since Kierkegaard's whole position is defined against them.
- C. The doctrine of eternal recurrence and the will to power, since Nietzsche is standardly grouped with the existentialists in survey histories.
- D. Heidegger's rejection of the transcendental ego, since the burden of that argument is his own account of being-in-the-world.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the theory of essences and imaginative variation belong to Topic 09, Phenomenology (Husserl); this clause owns only Heidegger's redirection of the method.
- **B:** Incorrect: Hegel's dialectic and Absolute Spirit belong to Topic 05; here Hegel is the target, stated in two clauses.
- **C:** Incorrect: Nietzsche is not a printed thinker in this clause, so nihilism, will to power and recurrence are not owner content.
- **D:** Correct: the 2018 part is routed here because its argumentative burden is Heidegger's being-in-the-world, with the *epoche* attributed to Husserl in a single accurate sentence.

Examiner trap 32: Expounding Husserl's method, Hegel's dialectic or Nietzsche's nihilism inside this clause spends marks on another owner's territory while leaving the printed thinkers under-treated.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answers for Philosophy Paper I. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the typographic quotation marks the repository ledger records and the printed spelling of names. The 2018 to 2025 Paper I texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger. *Being and Time* is cited by **Section number**, which is stable across the Macquarrie and Robinson (1962) and Stambaugh (1996, revised Schmidt 2010) translations; Kierkegaard's pseudonymous works are cited **by pseudonym**, following the "First and Last Declaration" appended to the *Postscript* (1846); and Sartre's slogans are dated to the lecture of **October 1945**, published **1946**, rather than to *Being and Nothingness* (1943). Interpretive disputes - whether the leap is fideism, whether bad faith is coherent without an unconscious, whether authenticity is formally empty, and whether conflict is really the original meaning of being-for-others - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 330 words**, and **20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **14 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus - **joint-highest** with Rationalism and with Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein - and it owns **at least one part in every one of the eight years**. All fourteen are solved in full below, followed by **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the exam: **Sartre** carries eight parts (2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2023, 2024, 2025 and, jointly, the comparison part), **Kierkegaard** four (2020, 2022, 2023, 2024) and **Heidegger** three (2018, 2019, 2022); the twenty-mark parts cluster on Heidegger's

being-in-the-world and on Kierkegaard's subjectivity, while the ten-mark parts test single distinctions. Three of the fourteen are **statement questions** (2020 Q4(a), 2021 Q4(b), 2023 Q3(c)), and for those the first move is always to locate the sentence inside its own author's system.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: How does Sartre connect inauthenticity with bad faith? Why does Sartre show that inauthenticity and bad faith lead to alienation? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two linked "how/why" questions - a connection and then a consequence
Core issue	That bad faith, inauthenticity and alienation form an ordered chain, not a set of synonyms
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the structure, one example, the chain, one limit
Ideal thesis	Bad faith is the project, inauthenticity the resulting mode, alienation the cost
Non-negotiables	facticity and transcendence named; the waiter or the woman on the date; the pre-reflective solution flagged

Independent model answer

Thesis. Bad faith is the project, inauthenticity the mode it produces, and alienation the price the for-itself pays for it.

The structure. Human reality has two dimensions at once: **facticity** - body, past, social position, situation - and **transcendence**, the freedom to negate that given and project beyond it. **Bad faith** (*mauvaise foi*) is not ordinary lying but the collapse of this tension: I live as though only one dimension were real.

The connection. Inauthenticity follows immediately, because a consciousness that denies its own unstable freedom has adopted a settled self-description it cannot honestly hold. Sartre's woman on the date denies her **transcendence** by reducing herself to a body-object, and simultaneously denies the **facticity** of the gesture by treating it as neutral - one act, two denials.

Why alienation. The self that lives through a fixed social role, or through the objectifying **Look** of others, relates to itself as to a thing. What was mine to answer for becomes something I merely am, and the for-itself is estranged from the freedom that constitutes it.

Qualification. CAUTION: Since Sartre rejects the Freudian unconscious, the self-deception must be lodged in a **pre-reflective, non-thetic** awareness; whether that is coherent remains disputed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question contains two verbs - "connect" and "lead to" - so the answer must be a chain, not a definition.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; structure three; connection four; alienation three; qualification one.

- **Structure:** thesis -> the two dimensions -> bad faith -> inauthenticity -> alienation -> limit.
- **Doctrine:** facticity/transcendence; the collapse of the tension.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Nothingness* (1943); the woman on the date; the Look.
- **Distinction:** project against mode against cost.
- **Criticism:** the coherence of self-deception without an unconscious.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2018 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: What is 'Epoche'? How does Heidegger reject this method of phenomenological reduction? Explain Heidegger's concept of 'being in the world' as opposed to the concept of a transcendental ego.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three sequenced tasks - define, reject, replace - and all three must appear
Core issue	That the objection concerns the starting point , not the accuracy, of phenomenological description
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: one accurate sentence on Husserl, then the argument, then the positive structure
Ideal thesis	The reduction begins from reflection and so presupposes what it claims to bracket; being-in-the-world is more primordial
Non-negotiables	<i>epoche</i> attributed to Husserl ; unitary structure; ready-to-hand; care; no spatial reading

Independent model answer

Thesis. Heidegger does not accuse Husserl of describing badly; he argues that the reduction begins one step too late, and being-in-the-world names the condition it presupposes.

What the epoche is. FACT: **Husserl's** suspension puts out of play the natural attitude's positing that the world exists. Nothing is denied or doubted; the belief-character is withheld so that what is given may be described purely, and the residue is **transcendental subjectivity**. ANALYSIS: It is a change of attitude, not a sceptical doubt, and it belongs to another owner in this syllabus.

The rejection. Heidegger's objection is one of **order**. A reflective suspension is available only to a spectator already set over against a world; but reflection is not the first relation Dasein has to anything. Dasein is **proximally and for the most part** absorbed in tasks, using equipment competently and understanding its situation practically. **Subject and object** are therefore **derivative abstractions** from involvement, and a method that starts by bracketing the world's existence has silently retained the framework it meant to suspend. The residue it isolates - a transcendental ego - is on this reading not the ground of world-disclosure but a late abstraction from a Dasein that was already disclosing a world. ANALYSIS: He does not abandon description; he **redirects** it toward the disclosedness of Being through care, equipment and temporality.

Being-in-the-world. FACT: The hyphens carry the doctrine: it is one **unitary** phenomenon, not subject plus relation plus world, and "in" is not spatial containment. The **world** is a **referential context of meaning**, not the totality of objects. Entities are met first as **ready-to-hand** equipment within an in-order-to chain - hammer, nail, board, house, dwelling - and the **present-at-hand** object appears later, typically through **breakdown**: unusability, absence, obstruction. ANALYSIS: Breakdown makes the network conspicuous without abolishing significance. The unity of this structure is **care** (*Sorge*, Section 41): **ahead-of-itself, already-in, alongside**. Because the compound is unitary, the Cartesian demand for a proof of the external world does not arise: the gap such a proof would bridge is an artefact of decomposing the phenomenon.

Assessment. CAUTION: The argument stands or falls on whether the subject-object pair really is derivative; and Heidegger's own project remained incomplete, since Division III was never published.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the first sentence of the question belongs to another owner. Attribute it accurately in one line and move.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; *epoche* three; rejection six; being-in-the-world eight; assessment two.

- **Structure:** define -> object -> replace -> assess.
- **Doctrine:** suspension and residue; unitary structure; equipment; care.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Time* (1927) Section 41; the in-order-to chain; breakdown modes.
- **Distinction:** rejection of a **starting point**, not of description.
- **Criticism:** the derivative status of subject and object; the unwritten Division III.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2019 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: Is Dasein authentic existence for Heidegger? How does he relate temporality with Dasein? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	A yes/no ruling followed by a second, technical question; both must be answered
Core issue	That Dasein is <i>not</i> defined as authentic, and that temporality is the meaning of care
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the ruling, the modification, the three ecstases, the criticism
Ideal thesis	No - authenticity is one modification of Dasein's being, and temporality is what makes that being intelligible
Non-negotiables	<i>zunächst und zumeist</i> ; the four characters of death; the care/ecstases mapping; future-primacy

Independent model answer

Thesis. No. Dasein is not authentic existence; authenticity is one **modification** of Dasein's being, and the being so modified is **care**, whose meaning is **temporality**.

Why the ruling. FACT: Dasein is **proximally and for the most part** (*zunächst und zumeist*) inauthentic - dispersed in the "they" (*das Man*), whose marks are **idle talk**, **curiosity** and **ambiguity**, and absorbed by **falling** (*Verfallen*). ANALYSIS: This is not a moral failing but a **structural feature** of being-in-the-world, and *das Man* is not "other people" but the impersonal anyone in whose name things are done. Authenticity and inauthenticity are therefore **existential modifications** of one structure, not two kinds of person.

How authenticity arises. The **call of conscience** (Section Section 54-60) is **silent** and issues no rule; it summons Dasein back to its null responsibility for taking over its thrown projection. **Death** (Section Section 46-53) is Dasein's **ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite** possibility; the inauthentic "**one dies**" conceals its individualising force, while **anticipatory resoluteness** owns it and lets Dasein take over its existence **as a whole**. ANALYSIS: Individualisation **modifies** rather than abolishes **being-with** (Section 26).

Temporality. FACT: Division Two argues that the meaning of **care** - "ahead-of-itself, already-in, alongside" (Section 41) - is **temporality** (*Zeitlichkeit*). The three limbs map exactly: **ahead-of-itself -> future** (*Zukunft*), **already-in -> having-been** (*Gewesenheit*), **alongside -> present** (*Gegenwart*). ANALYSIS: *Gewesenheit* is not the elapsed past but the past Dasein **still is** and carries as possibility. These are **ecstases**, not segments of a line: Dasein stands out into all three simultaneously, so temporality is a finite **unity**. The **future has priority**, since past and present are temporalised out of Dasein's projection upon death - which is why authenticity is **futural** and why only a being that can relate to its own end can be grasped as a whole. Ordinary clock-time, the infinite now-series, is **derived** through world-time and public dating; ANALYSIS: "vulgar" names a **levelled interpretation**, not a moral defect. **Historicity** (*Geschichtlichkeit*) follows: possibilities are inherited and projected.

Assessment. CAUTION: The formality that keeps authenticity non-prescriptive is also the strongest objection to it, and **Division III**, where temporality was to yield the meaning of Being as such, was never published.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the ruling must arrive first; a script that describes authenticity without denying the identification has answered a question that was not asked.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: ruling one line; inauthenticity four; conscience and death five; temporality eight; assessment two.

- **Structure:** ruling -> why -> how authenticity arises -> temporality -> limit.
- **Doctrine:** *das Man*, falling, conscience, being-toward-death, the ecstases.
- **Evidence:** Section Section 27, 35-38, 41, 46-53, 54-60, 65.
- **Distinction:** modification against identity; ecstasis against segment.
- **Criticism:** formal emptiness; the unwritten Division III.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2019 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: How does Sartre look at the problem of freedom of choice and determinism? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain" - a reconstruction with a stated position , not a debate survey
Core issue	That determinism misdescribes the for-itself, so the problem is dissolved rather than won
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the argument, the qualification, one criticism
Ideal thesis	A motive determines nothing until it is constituted as a motive
Non-negotiables	nihilation; meaning-conferral; situation; the 1960 concession

Independent model answer

Thesis. For Sartre the dispute is a **false problem**: determinism describes the for-itself in categories that belong to the in-itself.

The argument. FACT: A **motive** - a desire, an emotion, a situation - becomes a reason for action only through the **meaning** conferred on it; and meaning-conferral is itself an act of the **for-itself** (*pour-soi*), which nihilates the given and projects beyond it. Therefore no motive determines me **unless I freely constitute it as a motive**. Remove the project and the same desire motivates nothing.

Why this is not a rival causal theory. The **for-itself** is not a thing among causes. It "is what it is not and is not what it is": it cannot coincide with its past, and it is defined by a future that does not yet exist. To treat it as an *en-soi* standing in causal relations is to have changed the subject.

Situation, stated honestly. ANALYSIS: Sartre does not deny that **facticity** limits practical possibilities. Freedom is called "absolute" only in the **structural** sense that the for-itself cannot become a completed thing; "there are no excuses" concerns responsibility for **taking up** motives, not the dismissal of trauma or coercion.

Criticism. CAUTION: The account is charged with psychological and social implausibility: oppression limits not only action but the range of alternatives one can even entertain (Merleau-Ponty; Marxist, feminist and postcolonial critics). Sartre's distinction between freedom of consciousness and freedom of action answers the charge but weakens the radical thesis, and in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) he himself integrates **scarcity**, **seriality** and the **practico-inert** - the clearest evidence that the objection landed.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the examiner is testing whether the candidate can state *why* Sartre thinks the question is malformed, not merely that he defends freedom.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis one line; argument four; ontology three; situation three; criticism three.

- **Structure:** dissolution -> argument -> ontology -> qualification -> criticism.
- **Doctrine:** nihilation; meaning-conferral; facticity.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Nothingness* (1943); *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960).
- **Distinction:** structural absoluteness against practical omnipotence.
- **Criticism:** oppression and the cognitive range of alternatives.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2020 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: What does Kierkegaard mean by saying "Subjectivity is the truth" in the context of the problem of 'the single individual'?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"What does ... mean ... in the context of" - an exposition tied to a second concept
Core issue	That the thesis is about the mode of appropriation and is answerable only through the single individual
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: attribution, thesis, three denials, the complement, the method, a verdict
Ideal thesis	The thesis states how existential truth can be held, and the single individual is the only one who can hold it
Non-negotiables	Climacus; the <i>Postscript</i> (1846); "subjectivity is untruth"; "the crowd is untruth"; indirect communication

Independent model answer

Thesis. The claim is not that belief makes things true but that a truth about how to exist can be possessed only in the manner of existing it - and only the **single individual** (*den Enkelte*) can do that.

Attribution. FACT: The thesis is argued by the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus** in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846), a humorist who says explicitly that he is **not** a Christian, which is why he can pose the problem of becoming one.

What it asserts. For **ethical and religious** truth, the **mode of appropriation** - infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk - is decisive. To hold that God exists as an item in a system is not to exist before God in fear and trembling. The *how* of the relation, not the *what* of the proposition, is where truth is located for an existing subject.

Three denials. ANALYSIS: It is **not** relativism; it does **not** deny objective truth in logic or history, only its **sufficiency** for existence; and it is **not** the claim that factual truth varies with passion.

The complement that proves it. FACT: Climacus also writes "**subjectivity is untruth**": the existing subject stands in sin and finitude and therefore **needs the leap**. A relativist could make no use of that sentence.

The single individual. The thesis requires a bearer no system can absorb. To exist is to be particular, temporal, passionate and deciding - none of them a category a completed system can hold without cancelling it. Against Hegel, Kierkegaard insists that "a logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible", because the systematiser must still exist, choose and die; against the public, "**the crowd is untruth**", since responsibility distributed among everyone is borne by no one. The spheres of existence supply the content: appropriation intensifies from the aesthetic through the ethical to the religious, joined not by mediation but by the **leap** (*Springet*).

The method that follows. ANALYSIS: If such truth is a mode of existing, direct communication would convert it into a result and falsify it - hence **indirect communication** and the pseudonyms.

Verdict. CAUTION: Kierkegaard exposes a first-person appropriation that a system-view risks losing; he does not refute Hegel's ontology, and the fideism charge remains live.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "in the context of the single individual" is not decoration; an answer that expounds the thesis without the bearer has answered half the question.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; attribution two; assertion three; denials three; complement three; single individual five; method two; verdict two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> attribution -> assertion -> denials -> complement -> bearer -> method -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** appropriation; subjectivity as untruth; the crowd; indirect communication.
- **Evidence:** *Postscript* (1846); the "First and Last Declaration".
- **Distinction:** the *how* against the *what*.

- **Criticism:** fideism; the bounded scope of the anti-Hegelian result.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2020 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: "You can always make something out of what you have been made into." Critically discuss this statement by Sartre with reference to his views on existentialism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically discuss" a statement - locate it, unpack it, then assess
Core issue	The exact force of "always", and the concession contained in the first half
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the two halves, the ontology behind them, the objection, the verdict
Ideal thesis	The sentence concedes facticity and asserts that facticity must still be taken up
Non-negotiables	facticity/transcendence; "always" as structural; the 1960 self-revision

Independent model answer

Thesis. The sentence is not a slogan of self-help but a compressed statement of the facticity/transcendence structure, and its whole weight rests on the word "always".

"What you have been made into." FACT: Sartre **concedes the making**: class, body, upbringing, history and the objectifying gaze of others are **facticity**, the given from which any project must start. The sentence begins by granting the determinist his data.

"You can always make something out of." The for-itself is constituted by **transcendence** - the nihilating movement that surpasses what it is towards what it is not yet. Facticity is therefore never received as a completed nature; it must be **taken up** in a project, and taking it up is something the for-itself does.

What "always" means. ANALYSIS: It is a **structural** claim: there is no situation in which the for-itself becomes a thing, because it must still confer meaning on whatever it has been made into. It is **not** the promise that every outcome is available. The distinction matters, because the popular reading - that circumstances impose no limits - is the reading critics rightly attack.

Why this connects to the wider position. FACT: It follows from the atheistic argument of the 1945 lecture, published 1946: with no divine artisan there is no antecedent blueprint, so **existence precedes essence** and a person is what he makes of what he has been made into. Evading that is **bad faith** - the collapse of the facticity/transcendence tension - and non-choice is itself a choice, since "I can always choose, but if I do not choose, I am still choosing".

Criticism. CAUTION: Slavery, torture, severe illness and structural oppression limit not only action but the alternatives one can entertain; **de Beauvoir** and **Fanon** press gendered and racialised constraint. Sartre's reply distinguishes freedom of consciousness from freedom of action, which answers the objection while weakening the radical thesis; in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) he integrates **scarcity**, **seriality** and the **practico-inert**.

Verdict. The sentence is defensible read structurally and indefensible read practically, and Sartre's own later work is the best evidence for that division rather than an external critic's.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the concession in the first half is what most scripts miss; showing it first makes the critical section credible rather than adversarial.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; first half three; second half three; "always" three; wider position four; criticism four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** locate -> unpack both halves -> fix the modal -> connect -> criticise -> rule.
- **Doctrine:** facticity/transcendence; existence precedes essence; bad faith.
- **Evidence:** lecture 1945, published 1946; *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960).
- **Distinction:** structural against practical reading of "always".
- **Criticism:** oppression; the author's own revision.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2021 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

Question: "I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing". Critically discuss Sartre's conception of choice and responsibility in the light of above statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically discuss ... in the light of" - the statement frames a doctrine , and assessment is required
Core issue	Why non-choice is a stance, and what responsibility follows
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the structural claim, bad faith, universalisability, the objection
Ideal thesis	Because freedom is what the for-itself is, no stance-free relation to a situation is possible
Non-negotiables	freedom as constitutive; bad faith; "in choosing myself I choose man"; coercion objection

Independent model answer

Thesis. The sentence states that there is no stance-free relation to a situation, because freedom is not something the for-itself has but what it is.

The structural claim. FACT: The **for-itself** (*pour-soi*) is the nihilating, self-transcending movement that continually surpasses what it is towards what it is not yet. It cannot therefore *not* take up a relation to its circumstances. Deferral, conformity and "having no option" are ways of relating, and hence choices.

Why non-choice is typically bad faith. ANALYSIS: To present a deferral as an absence of choice is to describe oneself as a thing determined by circumstance - the collapse of **transcendence** into **facticity** that Sartre calls **bad faith** (*mauvaise foi*).

Responsibility. Since the outcome of a non-choice is produced by that non-choice, responsibility is not diminished by passivity. FACT: The 1945 lecture adds the universal dimension: "**in choosing myself, I choose man**" - each choice projects an image of what human beings ought to be, which is the source of **anguish** (*angoisse*).

Criticism. CAUTION: Is the distinction between choosing-not-to-choose and being genuinely unable to choose real? Structural oppression, coercion and severe illness appear to limit not merely action but the awareness of alternatives, and the universalisability clause sits uneasily with the denial of *a priori* values - a tension Sartre concedes, and which the unfinished *Notebooks for an Ethics* was to address. His later *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) integrates scarcity and seriality.

Verdict. Read structurally the claim is strong: no situation converts the for-itself into a thing. Read as practical advice it under-describes constraint, and that is where the criticism bites.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critically discuss" means the assessment must be a third of the answer, not a closing sentence.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis one line; structural claim three; bad faith two; responsibility three; criticism four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** locate the sentence -> structural claim -> bad faith -> responsibility -> criticism -> rule.
- **Doctrine:** freedom as constitutive; non-choice as choice; universalisability.
- **Evidence:** lecture 1945, published 1946; *Notebooks for an Ethics*; the 1960 *Critique*.
- **Distinction:** structural against practical readings.
- **Criticism:** coercion and awareness of alternatives.

Solved PYQ 8 · 2022 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: Provide a critical account of Heidegger's Being-in-the-world and discuss the problem of 'authenticity' in the context of Dasein.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critical account" plus "discuss the problem" - exposition with assessment , then a second topic
Core issue	That authenticity is a modification <i>within</i> being-in-the-world, not an escape from it
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the structure, worldhood, care, the "they", death, the emptiness charge
Ideal thesis	Being-in-the-world is the <i>what</i> ; authenticity is the <i>how</i>
Non-negotiables	unitary compound; ready-to-hand; care's three limbs; non-moral authenticity; formal emptiness

Independent model answer

Thesis. Being-in-the-world is the **what** of Dasein and authenticity is the **how**: a modification of that structure, never a departure from it.

The unitary structure. FACT: The hyphens are the doctrine. Being-in-the-world is one phenomenon, not subject plus relation plus world, and "in" is not spatial containment. Dasein does not first exist and then meet a world; it is constitutively engaged, absorbed, concerned. The Cartesian demand for a proof of the external world therefore does not arise: the gap it would bridge is an artefact of decomposing the phenomenon.

Worldhood. The **world** is a **referential context of meaning**. Entities are met first as **ready-to-hand** (*Zuhandenheit*) equipment within an **in-order-to** chain - hammer, nail, board, house, **dwelling** - which terminates not in a further tool but in a possibility of Dasein's own being; the **present-at-hand** (*Vorhandenheit*) object with properties emerges through **breakdown**: unusability, absence, obstruction. ANALYSIS: Breakdown makes the network conspicuous; it does not abolish significance, and the theoretical object is a **modification** of practical engagement rather than the neutral baseline.

Care and disclosedness. FACT: Dasein is always **attuned** (*Befindlichkeit*), always **understanding** by projecting upon possibilities (*Verstehen*), and always articulable (*Rede*); these constitute its **disclosedness**. Their unity is **care** (*Sorge*, Section 41): **ahead-of-itself - already-in - alongside**, collecting projection, thrownness and absorbed concern.

Authenticity. ANALYSIS: *Eigentlichkeit* is an **existential modification**, not a virtue, and Dasein is inauthentic **proximally and for the most part** - dispersed in the "they" (*das Man*) through **idle talk**, **curiosity** and **ambiguity**, and absorbed by **falling**. The **silent call of conscience** returns Dasein to its null responsibility, and **being-toward-death - ownmost, non-relational, certain, indefinite** - is owned in **anticipatory resoluteness**, which gathers existence into a whole. Individualisation **modifies** rather than abolishes **being-with** (Section 26).

Critical account. CAUTION: Three objections stand: authenticity is **formally empty**, prescribing no content, a charge sharpened by Heidegger's 1933 complicity and by Adorno's "jargon of authenticity"; **Levinas** and **Arendt** contest the primacy of death against the Other and against natality; and the project itself is unfinished, Division III never having appeared. The defence - that fundamental ontology is not ethics - is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critical account" makes assessment part of the exposition, not an appendix; the emptiness charge should be signalled before it is developed.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; structure three; worldhood five; care two; authenticity seven; criticism four.

- **Structure:** what -> how -> assess.
- **Doctrine:** unitary compound; equipment; care; *das Man*; death.
- **Evidence:** Section 26, 27, 35-38, 41, 46-53, 54-60.
- **Distinction:** modification within the structure, not escape from it.

- **Criticism:** formal emptiness; Levinas and Arendt; the unwritten division.

Solved PYQ 9 · 2022 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: How does Soren Kierkegaard define the notion of 'subjectivity'? Explain it with reference to three stages of existence as propounded by him.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Define" then "explain with reference to" - a concept plus its content , in that order
Core issue	That the spheres are the content of which subjectivity is the form
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the definition, the three spheres with their collapses, the leap, a verdict
Ideal thesis	Subjectivity is intensifying inwardness, and the spheres trace its intensification
Non-negotiables	Climacus; the <i>how</i> against the <i>what</i> ; spheres not stages; the leap; the two knights

Independent model answer

Thesis. Subjectivity names the **mode of appropriation** in which existential truth is held, and the three spheres are the successive shapes that appropriation takes.

The definition. FACT: Argued by the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus** in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846): for ethical and religious truth the **how** - infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk - matters more than the objective content. ANALYSIS: This is not relativism; Climacus also writes "**subjectivity is untruth**", since the existing subject stands in sin and finitude.

The aesthetic sphere. Life organised around **the interesting** - enjoyment, immediacy, irony, and the avoidance of anything binding - portrayed in *Either/Or* (1843), edited by **Victor Eremita**, who prints the aesthetic and ethical papers side by side without deciding. Its limit is **boredom** and fragmentation: nothing binds, so nothing holds the self together.

The ethical sphere. Life organised around **universal duty** - commitment, marriage, vocation, transparency - voiced by **Judge William**. Its limit is **guilt**: the demand cannot be perfectly met, and the universal cannot accommodate the individual's anguished singularity.

The religious sphere. Standing **before God** as a singular individual, with faith as "the absurd" and infinite passion. **Johannes de Silentio** stages this in *Fear and Trembling* (1843) through Abraham and the **teleological suspension of the ethical**, distinguishing the visibly renouncing **knight of infinite resignation** from the **knight of faith**, outwardly indistinguishable from an ordinary citizen because he lives fully in the finite while relating absolutely to the Absolute. Its structure is **paradox**: faith is not rational, not universal and not mediated by the crowd or the church.

The movement. ANALYSIS: Transition is a **qualitative leap** (*Springet*), not Hegelian mediation and not maturation; the spheres are **qualitative**, and relapse is always possible. The English phrase "leap of faith" is the tradition's, not Kierkegaard's, who writes of *the leap*. FACT: The connection back to the definition is exact: each sphere is a mode of appropriating existence, so the sequence from dispersion through duty to the absolute relation **is** the intensification of inwardness that subjectivity names.

Verdict. CAUTION: The spheres trace an intensification of inwardness from dispersion through duty to the absolute relation. The account is powerful against systematic closure but exposed to the **fideism** charge and to the objection that its treatment of community remains thin.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the two halves must be joined; a script that defines subjectivity and then narrates three stages without connecting them has written two answers.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; definition three; three spheres nine; movement three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** definition -> three spheres with collapses -> the leap -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** appropriation; the spheres; the teleological suspension; the two knights.

- **Evidence:** *Either/Or* and *Fear and Trembling* (1843); *Postscript* (1846).
- **Distinction:** qualitative spheres against developmental stages.
- **Criticism:** fideism; thin account of community.

Solved PYQ 10 · 2023 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: How does Kierkegaard argue against Hegel's idea of universal spirit in favour of the individual as the essence of spirit? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does ... argue" plus "critically" - a structural argument and a ruling , in ten marks
Core issue	That the objection concerns what any completed system must omit
Scope boundary	Ten marks: target, argument, one contrast pair, verdict
Ideal thesis	No system can contain the one who builds it
Non-negotiables	mediation against the leap; either/or against both/and; the bounded verdict

Independent model answer

Thesis. Kierkegaard's argument is structural: spirit is realised in the existing individual because no completed system can contain the one who builds it.

The target. FACT: Hegel's claim that reality is the self-development of **Absolute Spirit**, that oppositions are **mediated** into higher unities, and that the individual is a moment within a total rational process.

The argument. To exist is to be particular, temporal, passionate and deciding. None of these is a category the system can absorb without cancelling it, and the systematiser himself must still exist, choose and die. Hence Climacus's formula: "**a logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible.**"

The contrasts that carry it. ANALYSIS: **Either/or** against **both/and**: to exist is to choose one thing rather than another, whereas mediation dissolves the exclusive choice. **The leap** (*Springet*) against **mediation**: no argument delivers me from one sphere of existence to the next. And "**the crowd is untruth**", since responsibility distributed among all is borne by none.

Verdict. CAUTION: Bounded. Kierkegaard exposes a first-person appropriation that a system-view risks losing; he does not refute Hegel's ontology, offers no rival comprehensive system, and a Hegelian may reply that the existing individual is a stage philosophy sublates.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: ten marks and two demands - the argument and the assessment. One contrast pair, not four, and a ruling in the last two lines.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; target two; argument three; contrasts three; verdict two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> target -> argument -> contrasts -> bounded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** existential against logical system; leap against mediation.
- **Evidence:** *Postscript* (1846), by Climacus.
- **Distinction:** exposing a loss against refuting a system.
- **Criticism:** the Hegelian sublation reply.

Solved PYQ 11 · 2023 · Q3(c) · 15 marks

Question: "Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is." In the light of this statement bring out the chief features of Sartre's conception of consciousness.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"In the light of ... bring out the chief features" - the statement is the organising principle
Core issue	Both halves of the formula, and what they generate
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the contrast, both halves, nihilation, two consequences, one objection
Ideal thesis	Non-self-identity is the definition of the for-itself, and everything else is its application
Non-negotiables	en-soi/pour-soi; both halves; nihilation; bad faith; the useless passion

Independent model answer

Thesis. The formula is a definition, not a paradox: it says that consciousness is constituted by a distance from itself that it can never close.

The contrast. FACT: **Being-in-itself** (*en-soi*) is full, solid, **self-identical** and opaque - "it is what it is" - and contingent, "de trop". **Being-for-itself** (*pour-soi*) is nihilating and self-surpassing, and never coincides with itself.

"Is what it is not." Consciousness is always **ahead of itself**, projecting toward possibilities it does not yet possess; it is defined by a **future** that does not yet exist.

"Is not what it is." Consciousness cannot coincide with its **past** or its **facticity**. Sartre's waiter *is* a waiter in his facticity and *is not* one in his transcendence: he can question the role, resent it, leave it.

How this is possible. FACT: **Nihilation** (*neantisation*): consciousness stands back from what is and negates it - questioning, imagining alternatives, projecting beyond it. The for-itself is "the being by which **nothingness** (*neant*) comes into the world."

What it generates. ANALYSIS: **Freedom**, since nothing in me is fixed enough to determine me; **bad faith**, the attempt to be self-identical anyway by collapsing into facticity or transcendence alone; **ecstatic temporality**, since the for-itself exists as past-facticity and future-project; **being-for-others**, since the Look confers an outside I cannot occupy; and the impossible desire to be a *pour-soi-en-soi*, which is God - hence "man is a **useless passion**".

Objection. CAUTION: Is non-self-identity coherent, or a contradiction in phenomenological dress? The reply is that the for-itself has no completed nature with which to be identical, since it exists as a relation to its own possibilities rather than as a thing with properties; whether that succeeds is contested.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "chief features" invites a list; the statement forbids one. Derive the features from the formula and the answer becomes an argument.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis one line; contrast three; two halves four; nihilation three; consequences four; objection two.

- **Structure:** definition -> contrast -> both halves -> mechanism -> consequences -> objection.
- **Doctrine:** en-soi/pour-soi; nihilation; the impossible synthesis.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Nothingness* (1943); the waiter.
- **Distinction:** future-projection against past-facticity.
- **Criticism:** the coherence of non-self-identity.

Solved PYQ 12 · 2024 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: How does Kierkegaard define truth in terms of subjectivity? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How does ... define" plus "critically" - definition and ruling in a ten-mark space
Core issue	The <i>how</i> against the <i>what</i> , and the anti-relativist safeguard
Scope boundary	Ten marks: attribution, definition, the denials, complement, verdict
Ideal thesis	Truth here names a mode of appropriation, protected from relativism by its own complement
Non-negotiables	Climacus; appropriation; "subjectivity is untruth"; fideism named

Independent model answer

Thesis. Truth, in this sense, names the **manner** in which an existing individual holds what he holds, not a property that belief confers on propositions.

Attribution. FACT: The thesis belongs to the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus**, *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846).

The definition. For **ethical and religious** truth the **mode of appropriation** - infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk - is decisive. Knowing that God exists as an item in a system is not existing before God in faith.

Three denials. ANALYSIS: Not relativism; not a denial of objective truth in logic or history, only of its **sufficiency** for existence; not the claim that facts vary with passion.

The safeguard. FACT: Climacus also writes "**subjectivity is untruth**": the existing subject stands in sin and finitude and therefore needs the **leap**. A relativist could make no use of that sentence, which is the internal evidence against the relativist reading.

Critical ruling. CAUTION: The account rightly identifies truths that cannot be held without being lived. It remains exposed to the **fideism** charge, since reason is declared limited rather than corrected, and to the objection that its account of community is thin - and, being pseudonymous, it is deliberately not offered as a doctrine one can simply take over.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the whole answer turns on one distinction; state it in line one and use the remaining space to protect it.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; attribution one; definition three; denials two; safeguard two; ruling three.

- **Structure:** thesis -> attribution -> definition -> denials -> safeguard -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** the *how* against the *what*.
- **Evidence:** *Postscript* (1846); the pseudonym rule.
- **Distinction:** insufficiency of objective truth against its denial.
- **Criticism:** fideism; the deliberate non-doctrinal form.

Solved PYQ 13 · 2024 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: What do the existentialist thinkers mean by the slogan "existence precedes essence"? How is human existence related to human freedom according to them? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two questions, and the first contains a false presupposition to be corrected while answering
Core issue	That the slogan has one owner, and that "freedom" means three different things
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the argument, the two other positions, three conceptions of freedom, a verdict
Ideal thesis	One slogan, one owner, three refusals of antecedent essence, three conceptions of freedom
Non-negotiables	paper-knife; atheism as premise; 1945/46; the 1946/47 repudiation; Kierkegaard's date

Independent model answer

Thesis. The slogan is **Sartre's**, and the honest answer explains it, then shows that the other two printed thinkers refuse antecedent essence in different ways and mean different things by freedom.

Sartre's argument. FACT: For a manufactured object - the **paper-knife** (*coupe-papier*) - the artisan conceives the design and then produces it, so essence precedes existence; theism treated man analogously. **Atheism is Sartre's premise:** with no divine artisan there is no antecedent blueprint, so man "first of all exists ... and defines himself afterwards". Provenance: the lecture of **October 1945**, published **1946**, not *Being and Nothingness* (1943).

Heidegger. ANALYSIS: In the "**Letter on Humanism**" (written 1946, published **1947**) he **repudiates** the formula. His own sentence - "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence", **Section 9** - is **ontological**: Dasein's "what" is its **manner of being**, not a *quidditas*. Sartre, he charges, merely **reverses** the priority while keeping man at the centre - the **metaphysics of subjectivity**. Man is the "shepherd of Being".

Kierkegaard. FACT: He died in **1855** and never wrote the slogan, and could not accept its premise, since the God-relation is what makes the single individual possible at all. His refusal takes the form of the **existing individual** (*den Enkelte*) who cannot be completed inside a system: "a logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible."

Three conceptions of freedom. **Sartre:** freedom is what the for-itself *is* - inescapable, but exercised only in **situation**, since facticity limits practical possibility without converting the for-itself into a thing; hence responsibility, **anguish**, and "in choosing myself I choose man". **Heidegger:** freedom is **thrown projection** upon possibilities disclosed in a world one did not choose, not voluntarism, and authenticity is a formal owning of finitude rather than self-creation. **Kierkegaard:** freedom is **qualitative choice** within a finite God-relation, disclosed in anxiety as "the dizziness of freedom" and consummated in the **leap** that no argument can supply.

Verdict. CAUTION: What the three share is a refusal, not a creed: no general essence settles in advance what it is for this individual to exist. The Sartrean doctrine foregrounds project and responsibility but leaves value-criteria and situated constraint underdeveloped, which is why the charge of decisionism has proved durable.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question presupposes shared ownership. Correct it in the first line *while answering*, rather than complaining about the premise.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis one line; Sartre's argument five; Heidegger four; Kierkegaard three; three freedoms six; verdict two.

- **Structure:** correct the attribution -> the argument -> the two refusals -> three freedoms -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** paper-knife; Section 9; the existing individual.
- **Evidence:** lecture 1945/1946; "Letter on Humanism" 1946/1947; Kierkegaard d. 1855.
- **Distinction:** shared refusal against shared doctrine.
- **Criticism:** decisionism and the thinness of value-criteria.

Solved PYQ 14 · 2025 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: Explain the difference between being-for-itself and being-in-itself as presented by Sartre.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain the difference" - a clean contrast , with the ontological character stated
Core issue	That the distinction is ontological, not a mind-matter dualism
Scope boundary	Ten marks: two definitions, the formulas, nihilation, the impossible synthesis
Ideal thesis	Self-identity against constitutive non-identity
Non-negotiables	both formulas; "de trop"; nihilation; the <i>pour-soi-en-soi</i>

Independent model answer

Thesis. The distinction is **ontological**, not a division between matter and mind: it separates being that coincides with itself from being that cannot.

Being-in-itself (en-soi). FACT: Full, solid, **self-identical**, opaque: "**it is what it is**". A stone simply *is*. It is complete, non-relational, and **contingent** - "**de trop**", in excess, groundless - which is the ontological root of nausea.

Being-for-itself (pour-soi). Consciousness, which is **nihilating** and self-surpassing and never coincides with itself: "**it is what it is not and is not what it is**". It **is what it is not** because it is defined by a future it does not yet possess; it **is not what it is** because it cannot coincide with its past or facticity.

How the gap is possible. FACT: **Nihilation** (*neantisation*): consciousness stands back from what is and negates it - questioning, imagining alternatives, projecting beyond. The for-itself is "the being by which **nothingness** comes into the world".

The consequence. ANALYSIS: The for-itself perpetually desires to become en-soi while remaining conscious - a **pour-soi-en-soi**, which is God, and a contradiction. Human reality is defined by this impossible desire: "man is a **useless passion**".

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: ten marks reward precision, not coverage; the two formulas and the impossible synthesis are the whole examinable content.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; en-soi three; pour-soi four; nihilation two; consequence two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> in-itself -> for-itself -> mechanism -> consequence.
- **Doctrine:** self-identity; nihilation; the contradictory ideal.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Nothingness* (1943).
- **Distinction:** ontological, not mind-matter.
- **Criticism:** implicit - the coherence of non-self-identity, if space allows.

Six original questions in the style of the paper - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks - covering the parts of the clause the 2018-2025 corpus has not yet examined directly: Kierkegaardian anxiety, the "they" and falling, the Look, indirect communication, the fear/anxiety comparison, and the movement-level objections. Every model answer is independent learner practice.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: "Anxiety is the dizziness of freedom." Explain what Kierkegaard means by anxiety and why he distinguishes it from fear.

Independent model answer

Thesis. Anxiety is not an intense fear but an **objectless** disclosure of possibility, and it is the objectlessness that gives it its philosophical role.

The distinction. FACT: **Fear** is directed at a **determinate entity within the world** - a dog, an examination, a fall - and it drives one back toward the world, seeking shelter in the familiar. **Anxiety** (*Angest*), as the pseudonym **Vigilius Haufniensis** analyses it in *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), has no such object: "the object of anxiety is a **nothing**".

What it discloses. Since there is no entity for anxiety to be about, what it discloses cannot be an entity but must be a **structure: possibility**, "the possibility of being able". Hence the formula - anxiety is "the **dizziness of freedom**" - and its description as "a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy".

The example. The man at the edge of an abyss grows dizzy, but **the dizziness is as much in the eye as in the abyss**: what appals is not the drop but the discovery that nothing prevents him.

Its role. ANALYSIS: Anxiety is already present **in innocence**, before any knowledge of good and evil, and is the **presupposition** of the leap by which sin and selfhood enter - not its cause, since a caused leap would not be a leap. ANALYSIS: Lowrie renders *Angest* as "dread" and Hong as "anxiety".

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the whole answer is one distinction, stated in kind rather than degree, and defended by an example.

- **Structure:** thesis -> distinction -> what is disclosed -> example -> role -> translation caution.
- **Doctrine:** objectlessness; possibility; the presupposition of the leap.
- **Evidence:** *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), Vigilius Haufniensis.
- **Distinction:** difference in kind, not intensity.
- **Criticism:** implicit in the caution about translations and attribution.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Explain Heidegger's notion of *das Man* and show why 'falling' is not a moral failing.

Independent model answer

Thesis. *Das Man* names the impersonal "anyone" in whose name things are done, and falling is the ontological structure of absorption in that anonymity - which is why neither carries blame.

The "they". FACT: Dasein exists with others - **being-with** (*Mitsein*, Section 26) is constitutive, not added on - and tends to lose itself in what "**one**" (*man*) does, says and thinks. ANALYSIS: *Das Man* is not "other people" but the anonymous norm-setter: one reads what one reads, one retires when one retires, and nobody in particular is answerable.

Its three marks. FACT: **Idle talk** (*Gerede*) - passing along received opinions without genuine understanding; **curiosity** (*Neugier*) - flitting restlessly from novelty to novelty; **ambiguity** (*Zweideutigkeit*) - everything seems accessible and nothing is genuinely appropriated. Each is a **deficient mode** of an existentials rather than a vice.

Why falling is not a failing. **Falling** (*Verfallen*) is Dasein's tendency to be absorbed in the world of its concern and in *das Man*. ANALYSIS: It is expressly **not** a theological "fall from grace" but an **ontological structure**: Dasein is inauthentic **proximally and for the most part** (*zunächst und zumeist*), and this is a structural feature of being-in-the-world, not a deficiency to be repented.

Consequence. FACT: Authenticity is therefore a **modification** of this condition, reached through the silent **call of conscience** and **anticipatory resoluteness** - a change in ownership, not in moral quality.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the second clause of the question is the marked point; the exposition must be arranged so that the non-moral verdict is earned rather than announced.

- **Structure:** thesis -> the "they" -> three marks -> why not a failing -> consequence.
- **Doctrine:** *Mitsein*; deficient modes; falling as structure.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Time* (1927) Section 26, 27, 35-38.

- **Distinction:** ontological structure against moral fault.
- **Criticism:** implicit - the formality that makes falling blameless also makes authenticity contentless.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Sartre's claim that conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The claim follows validly from Sartre's premises, and the premises - above all the exclusivity of subject and object - are where the argument is vulnerable.

How the Other is given. FACT: In the keyhole scene I am absorbed pre-reflectively: there is **no ego** in my consciousness and no self to be ashamed. Footsteps transform this instantly: **I am seen**, and I become an object with a nature, judged from outside. **Shame** is by its structure shame **before someone**, so "shame is by nature **recognition**"; the Other is **lived**, not inferred. Hence "the Other is the **indispensable mediator** between myself and me": I acquire an **outside** I did not choose and cannot know from within.

Why conflict follows. ANALYSIS: Objectified by the Other's freedom, I have two options and both fail. **Assimilating** that freedom - love, language, masochism - fails because to be loved is to be made an object, so the very freedom sought is destroyed in the possessing. **Transcending** it - indifference, desire, sadism, hate - fails because an object cannot confer the recognition wanted, and hate seeks a disappearance that would leave my being-for-others intact. Hence *Huis clos* (1944): "**hell is other people**".

The correction. FACT: Sartre explained in a **1965** recorded preface that the line does not mean relations with others are always poisonous, but that if one's relations are twisted the Other's judgement becomes the medium of self-torment - and that the three characters are **dead**, and so fixed.

Criticism. CAUTION: Three objections. The examples are drawn from a narrow, largely pathological range. Love, trust and being-cared-for seem equally basic and are not objectifications. And **Levinas** argues that to meet the Other only as a rival freedom is still to think him from the self - an objection **unanswered** within *Being and Nothingness*. Sartre's later **group-in-fusion** (1960) suggests the first objection landed.

Verdict. The Look gives a compelling non-inferential account of exposure to another perspective; the leap from that to universal conflict depends on the presupposition that one cannot be looking and looked-at at once.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critically examine" requires that the objection attack a **premise**, not merely register discomfort with the conclusion.

- **Structure:** thesis -> the Look -> why conflict -> the correction -> three objections -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** shame as recognition; the two failing strategies.
- **Evidence:** *Being and Nothingness* (1943) Part III; *Huis clos* (1944); the 1965 preface; the 1960 *Critique*.
- **Distinction:** ontological claim against statistical generalisation.
- **Criticism:** subject/object exclusivity; Levinas unanswered.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "Pseudonymity is the formal counterpart of the doctrine that truth is subjectivity." Discuss.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The statement is correct: the form is **deduced** from the doctrine, and reading pseudonymity as a literary habit removes an argument.

The argument, in steps. FACT: (i) Objective truth - historical, scientific, metaphysical - can be transmitted **directly**: I state a result, you receive it, and nothing about your existence need change. (ii) Ethical and religious truth is not a result but a **mode of existing**, an appropriation in inwardness. (iii) Communicated directly, it would be taken over **as a result** - as information one can hold without becoming - and the communication would therefore **falsify** what it communicates. (iv) Hence **indirect communication** (*indirekte Meddelelse*): a form that withholds the result and refuses authority. (v) The model is **Socratic maieutics**, the midwife who "**deceives into the truth**", and the author becomes a **vanishing occasion**. (vi) Hence **pseudonymity**: each pseudonym is a **personified existence-possibility** writing from within a sphere it cannot see beyond.

The evidence. FACT: **Johannes de Silentio** admires faith without possessing it; **Johannes Climacus** is explicitly not a Christian, which is why he can pose the problem of becoming one; **Anti-Climacus** stands above Kierkegaard himself. Simultaneously, under his own name, Kierkegaard published the **Upbuilding Discourses** - the **direct pole** of a single strategy. In the "**First and Last Declaration**" (*Postscript*, 1846) he calls himself the "author's author", a **prompter**, and asks that the pseudonym be quoted.

Objections. CAUTION: The method makes his own position **unattributable**; the reply is the signed pole and *The Point of View*, **written 1848, published posthumously 1859** - itself a disputed retrospective. More sharply, if subjective truth cannot be said directly, the thesis cannot be said directly either; **Climacus concedes this** by **revoking** the *Postscript* at its close.

Verdict. The method's **cost** is that it is self-consuming; its **power** is that the cost is intended. Kierkegaard is not evading a position but denying that a position, in Hegel's systematic sense, is the kind of thing an existing individual can hand over.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the six numbered steps are the answer's spine; the pseudonym evidence proves the steps rather than replacing them.

- **Structure:** thesis -> six-step argument -> evidence -> objections -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** appropriation; maieutics; existence-possibilities.
- **Evidence:** *Postscript* (1846); the "First and Last Declaration"; *The Point of View* (1848/1859).
- **Distinction:** method against biography.
- **Criticism:** unattributability; the revocation.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Anxiety is not a stronger kind of fear." Examine the role of anxiety in Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre, and assess whether a mood can disclose a philosophical truth.

Independent model answer

Thesis. Fear and anxiety differ **in kind**, not degree, and the shared argument in all three thinkers turns on that difference - though the conclusion each draws is different.

The general argument. ANALYSIS: (i) Moods are not private colourings added to a neutral world; they are ways in which one's situation is **disclosed**. (ii) **Fear** discloses an entity as threatening and keeps us within the world of concern. (iii) **Anxiety** has no entity as its object and therefore cannot disclose an entity. (iv) Yet it plainly discloses something, since it has definite content and is not mere confusion. (v) Therefore what it discloses is a **structure**. (vi) Therefore anxiety is philosophically **privileged**: the one mood in which existence as a whole becomes an issue.

Kierkegaard. FACT: *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844), by **Vigilius Haufniensis**: "the object of anxiety is a **nothing**"; what appears is **possibility**, "the possibility of being able". Anxiety is "the **dizziness of freedom**", present already in **innocence**, and the **presupposition** of the leap.

Heidegger. FACT: *Being and Time* **Section 40**: in anxiety "the world has the character of **complete insignificance**" - the totality of involvements collapses and Dasein is thrown back on its bare *that-it-is*. That in the face of which and that for which one is anxious **are the same: being-in-the-world**. Anxiety discloses Dasein as *solus ipse* and **frees it for authentic choosing**. In "What is Metaphysics?" (1929) he adds that it reveals the **Nothing** (*das Nichts*) - "nothing noths", never "noughts".

Sartre. FACT: *Being and Nothingness* (1943), Part I. On the **cliff path** I feel fear of the drop, then realise that **nothing prevents me** from throwing myself over - vertigo before my own freedom. The **gambler** finds yesterday's firm resolution **present but powerless**: it must be remade now, and nothing guarantees he will remake it. ANALYSIS: Anguish is distinct from **nausea**, which discloses the contingency of the in-itself.

Assessment. CAUTION: The naturalist replies that anxiety is a clinical or neurochemical state with no cognitive credentials. The counter is that the existentialist claim is not that anxious people know more, but that the **structure** of the mood - having no object - is itself the datum requiring explanation, and no reduction of it to an unnoticed object has succeeded. **Verdict:** a mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition; naturalistic and clinical explanations remain compatible competitors rather than refuted rivals, and the three analyses must not be merged

into one mood theory.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the six-step argument makes the three expositions cumulative rather than parallel; without it the answer becomes three summaries.

- **Structure:** thesis -> shared argument -> three analyses -> naturalist objection -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** objectlessness; possibility, being-in-the-world, freedom.
- **Evidence:** *Concept of Anxiety* (1844); *Being and Time* Section 40; "What is Metaphysics?" (1929); the cliff path and the gambler.
- **Distinction:** difference in kind; anguish against nausea.
- **Criticism:** the naturalist competitor, met but not defeated.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Existentialism has been charged with subjectivism, pessimism and social abstraction. Examine these charges with reference to Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger.

Independent model answer

Thesis. Each charge has a different answer for each thinker, so a single reply on behalf of "existentialism" would answer for none of them; two of the three charges fail as stated, and the third partly succeeds.

Why the charges must be split. ANALYSIS: "Existentialism" is a retrospective family label: Kierkegaard died in **1855** and never met the word, Heidegger denied it in the "Letter on Humanism" (**1946/47**), and only Sartre accepted and defined it (**1945/46**). A movement-level objection is therefore a shape awaiting three different fillings.

Subjectivism. CAUTION: Against **Kierkegaard** the charge misfires: Climacus's thesis concerns the **mode of appropriation**, not the content of belief, and the same author writes "**subjectivity is untruth**", which no relativist could use. Against **Sartre** it misfires differently: choice is bound to **responsibility** and to "in choosing myself, I choose man". Against **Heidegger** it misfires most clearly: he is conducting **fundamental ontology**, and *das Man* is criticised precisely for validating received opinion. FACT: The charge fails as stated.

Pessimism. CAUTION: Anxiety, despair, death and nothingness are **diagnostic and disclosive structures**, not the claim that every life is emotionally miserable. Kierkegaard's despair is a **misrelation** that may be entirely unfelt; Heidegger's being-toward-death is a **possibility** that individualises rather than a morbid preoccupation; Sartre's anguish is the recognition of freedom. FACT: The charge rests on reading technical terms as mood-reports.

Social abstraction. ANALYSIS: Here the critics land a blow. Sartre's early vocabulary under-describes gendered, racialised and material constraint - pressed by **de Beauvoir**, **Fanon** and Marxist critics - and his own *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), with **scarcity**, **seriality** and the **practico-inert**, concedes it. Heidegger's **being-with** (Section 26) is constitutive, but authenticity remains **formally empty**, a charge sharpened by his 1933 complicity and by Adorno's "jargon of authenticity". Kierkegaard's treatment of institutions and community is genuinely thin, and "the crowd is untruth" answers only part of the objection.

Verdict. CAUTION: Subjectivism and pessimism are misdescriptions that dissolve once the technical vocabulary is respected. Social abstraction is a **real residue**: the replies available - situated freedom, being-with, and the individual's irreducible responsibility - are **partial rather than complete**, and the honest closing move is to concede that rather than to argue it away.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the structure - one charge, three replies, then a ruling - is what converts a survey into an examination, and the concession at the end is what makes the earlier defences credible.

- **Structure:** thesis -> why split the charges -> three charges, three replies each -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** appropriation; responsibility; fundamental ontology; disclosive moods.
- **Evidence:** *Postscript* (1846); "Letter on Humanism" (1946/47); *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960); Section 26.
- **Distinction:** misdescription against genuine residue.
- **Criticism:** formal emptiness; thin community; partial replies conceded.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Prerequisite check before using this block

ANALYSIS: Nothing below is needed to write a complete answer to any of the fourteen routed 2018-2025 question-parts. Complete Sessions 1-18, the thirty-two diagnostics and the fourteen solved parts first. In a fifteen-mark answer use **at most one** module from this block, and in a twenty-marker **at most two**; each is a second-order interpretive dispute, not a doctrine the core answer rests on.

A1. How far does a pseudonym speak for Kierkegaard? CAUTION:

- **Core status, stated first.** FACT: Indirect communication and the pseudonymous authorship were **promoted out of optional status on 15 August 2026** and now live in the Core owner. Session 5 is therefore **not** optional background, and this module addresses only the residue.
- **The second-order issue.** Granting Session 5's account, *how far* may a reader treat a pseudonym's thesis as Kierkegaard's own - and does the method leave him with any assertible doctrine at all?
- **Competing interpretations.** CAUTION: (i) The **authorial-doctrine** reading: the pseudonyms are transparent, and the theses are Kierkegaard's. (ii) The **strict indirect-communication** reading: nothing pseudonymous may be attributed to him at all. (iii) The **mixed** reading: the pseudonyms are dramatised standpoints through which the reader must work, while the signed writings carry first-person religious assertion.
- **Extra objection and counter-reply.** **Objection:** if the author speaks through masks, doctrine becomes unstable and unfalsifiable. **Counter-reply:** the instability is deliberate and self-limiting - the pseudonyms stage standpoints the reader must *occupy and exhaust*, while the signed *Upbuilding Discourses* retain direct religious assertion.
- **Safe 15/20 use.** ANALYSIS: One attribution-caution clause when quoting *Fear and Trembling* or the *Postscript*. Never a replacement for the Core exposition.
- **What not to over-study.** ANALYSIS: Do not turn the answer into literary biography or editorial history.
- **Promotion status.** FACT: Fired and executed. Re-promote only if a future part asks for the *attribution problem itself*.

A2. Is Sartrean freedom solitary, or constituted through the Other? ANALYSIS:

- **The issue.** Is freedom in *Being and Nothingness* fundamentally an interior structure, or is it always already exposed to conflict, shame and objectification through others?
- **Competing interpretations.** CAUTION: (i) The **conflictual social ontology** reading, which takes Part III at its word. (ii) A **softer** reading that finds room for reciprocity in Sartre's own analysis of love and language. (iii) The **later-revision** reading, which treats history and social mediation in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) as the position Sartre was moving toward.
- **Extra objection and counter-reply.** **Objection:** if "hell is other people", Sartrean freedom becomes theatrically hostile and politically thin. **Counter-reply:** the doctrine is best used to show that freedom is never purely interior - it is lived under the gaze of others and later requires social mediation.
- **Safe 15/20 use.** ANALYSIS: One enriching sentence in a freedom or bad-faith answer. The core answer must still rest on the for-itself, facticity and choice.
- **What not to over-study.** ANALYSIS: Do not drag *No Exit* or the later Marxist Sartre into every Paper I answer.
- **Promote to Core if:** a future part directly asks about being-for-others, the Look, or intersubjective conflict.

A3. Is Heideggerian authenticity decisionism or a formal existential structure? CAUTION:

- **The issue.** Is authenticity a heroic decisionist ideal, or a formally thin owning of one's finite possibilities?
- **Competing interpretations.** CAUTION: (i) The **heroic/decisionist** reading, in which resoluteness supplies its own justification. (ii) The **formal-existential** reading, in which authenticity modifies ownership and prescribes nothing. (iii) The **political-shadow** reading, influenced by Heidegger's 1933 complicity, which treats the formality itself as the doctrine's political liability.
- **Extra objection and counter-reply.** **Objection:** authenticity can look morally empty or politically dangerous once detached from norms. **Counter-reply:** in *Being and Time* authenticity is not a programme or a virtue-code; it is a mode of owning finitude, guilt and death instead of dissolving into *das Man*.
- **Safe 15/20 use.** ANALYSIS: A closing nuance in a Heidegger question on authenticity or temporality - one sentence, after the Core verdict.
- **What not to over-study.** ANALYSIS: Do not let biography displace the ontological text unless the question invites the move.
- **Promote to Core if:** a future part directly asks whether authenticity is ethical, political or merely ontological.

A4. What the promotion record shows ANALYSIS:

One module in this clause has already **fired**: pseudonymity and indirect communication migrated into the Core owner on 15 August 2026 and are now marks-essential. The two remaining modules are **bounded enrichment** and should be promoted only if a future paper asks for them directly. The practical lesson is that the boundary between "core" and "advanced" in this clause is set by the **PYQ corpus**, not by intrinsic interest: a doctrine becomes compulsory the moment a question makes it answer-necessary.

Conceptual links - not current-affairs items

ANALYSIS: No dated official or academic development is claimed for this clause. Its live relevance is the standing philosophical agenda: the analysis of autonomy and manipulation, the ethics of authenticity in professional and public life, the philosophy of moods and their cognitive standing, phenomenological approaches to embodiment and finitude in medicine and psychiatry, and the continuing use of facticity and situated freedom in feminist and postcolonial theory. Each of these is **analytical**, carries no sourced factual claim, and should never be presented as a current-affairs anchor.

Source trail for this block

Kierkegaard, *Either/Or*, *Fear and Trembling*, *Concluding Unscientific Postscript*, *The Point of View for My Work as an Author*; Sartre, *Being and Nothingness*, *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, *Critique of Dialectical Reason*; Heidegger, *Being and Time*, "Letter on Humanism"; and the secondary trail of Hubert Dreyfus, William Blattner, Steven Crowell, Joseph Catalano and Thomas Flynn.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

The compressed revision layer. Eighteen parts, A to R, running against the eighteen teaching sessions, followed by the complete ASCII master flow diagram. Read the parts for recall and redraw the diagram from memory as the final check.

A. The clause, its thinkers and what is not owned

- **Syllabus, verbatim:** *Existentialism* (Kierkegaard, Sartre, Heidegger): *Existence and Essence*; *Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence*; *Being-in-the-world and Temporality*. □ "Sarte" is a printed misspelling of **Sartre**.
- **Family label, not a school.** Kierkegaard d. **1855**, never met the word; Heidegger **denied** it ("Letter on Humanism", written 1946, published **1947**); Sartre **accepted and defined** it (lecture Oct **1945**, published **1946**).
- **Three names, three concepts:** the **single individual** (*den Enkelte*) · the **for-itself** (*pour-soi*) · **Dasein**.
- **God:** central (K) · denied **as a premise** (S) · not settled by the ontology (H).

- **Limb 3** - being-in-the-world and temporality - is almost entirely **Heidegger's**.
- **Corpus: 14 of 112** owned parts, **joint-highest**, at least one in **every year 2018-2025**. Sartre 8, Kierkegaard 4, Heidegger 3.
- **Not owned:** Husserl's method, essences and anti-psychologism as doctrine (**Topic 09**) · Hegel's dialectic and Absolute Spirit (**Topic 05**) · Descartes' cogito and dualism (**Topic 02**) · Kant on freedom and the antinomies (**Topic 04**) · **Nietzsche entirely** · Camus, Jaspers, Marcel and de Beauvoir as systems · existentialist theology and immortality (**Paper II**).

B. Provenance and chronology - examiner-checked

- **1843** *Either/Or* (Victor Eremita) · *Fear and Trembling* (Johannes de Silentio) · *Repetition* (Constantin Constantius).
- **1844** *The Concept of Anxiety* (Vigilius Haufniensis) - Lowrie: *The Concept of Dread* · *Philosophical Fragments* (Climacus).
- **1846** *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (Climacus) + the **"First and Last Declaration"**.
- **1848/1859** *The Point of View* - **written 1848, published posthumously 1859**; retrospective and disputed.
- **1849** *The Sickness unto Death* (Anti-Climacus) · **1850** *Practice in Christianity*.
- **1927** *Being and Time* - **unfinished**; Division III and Part Two never published. Cite by **Section** .
- **1929** "What is Metaphysics?" - the **Nothing**; **"Nothing noths"**, WRONG: never "noughts".
- **1943** *Being and Nothingness* - tr. Barnes 1956, Richmond 2018.
- **1944** *Huis clos* - "l'enfer, c'est les autres"; corrected by Sartre in a **1965** recorded preface.
- **1945/1946** *Existentialism Is a Humanism* - **all the slogans**; Sartre regretted publishing it.
- **1946/1947** "Letter on Humanism" - the repudiation. **1960** *Critique of Dialectical Reason*.
- **Translations:** Macquarrie & Robinson 1962 / Stambaugh 1996 (rev. Schmidt 2010); Hong & Hong 1978-2000 / Lowrie / Hannay.
- **Attribution rule:** cite the **pseudonym**, per the printed request; Kierkegaard is only the "author's author", a **prompter**.

C. Kierkegaard: the existing individual and truth as subjectivity

- Target: **Hegel's System** - Absolute Spirit, **mediation**, the individual as a moment.
- Counter: **"A logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible."** No system contains the one who builds it.
- **"Truth is subjectivity"** - **Johannes Climacus, *Postscript* 1846**: the **how** of appropriation (infinite passionate inwardness, commitment, risk) for **ethical/religious** truth.
- **Three denials:** not relativism · not a denial of objective truth · not "facts vary with passion" - only **insufficiency**.
- **Complement:** **"subjectivity is untruth"** - sin, finitude, the need of the leap. A relativist could not use it.
- **"The crowd is untruth"** - distributed responsibility is borne by no one.
- **Contrasts:** either/or vs both/and · the leap vs mediation · indirect communication vs the lecture.
- **Verdict:** exposes what a system-view loses; does not refute Hegel, offers no rival system.

D. Kierkegaard: the three spheres and the leap

- **Aesthetic** - the **interesting**, immediacy, irony, no binding commitment -> **boredom**, fragmentation. *Either/Or* (1843), "A".
- **Ethical** - **universal duty**, marriage, vocation, transparency -> **guilt**. Judge William.
- **Religious** - before God as a singular individual, faith as "the absurd" -> **paradox**. *Fear and Trembling* (1843), **de Silentio**.
- **Teleological suspension of the ethical** - Abraham; the text **stages the paradox**, it does not license private revelation.
- **Two knights:** **infinite resignation** (visible renunciation) vs **faith** (invisible; double movement; lives fully in the finite).

- **Transition = qualitative leap (Springet)** - not mediation, not maturation; **relapse always possible**.
- ANALYSIS: "**Leap of faith**" is the **English tradition's** fused phrase.
- The spheres are the **content** of which "truth is subjectivity" is the **form**.

E. Kierkegaard: anxiety and despair

- **Anxiety (Angest)**, Vigilius Haufniensis, 1844: object is "**a nothing**"; discloses **possibility**, "the possibility of being able".
- "**The dizziness of freedom**"; "**a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy**"; the abyss - dizziness in the eye.
- Present already **in innocence**; the **presupposition** of the leap, not its cause.
- **Despair, Anti-Climacus**, 1849: the self is **a relation relating itself to itself** and thereby to **the power that established it**; despair is a **misrelation** - and may be **unfelt**.
- Two forms: **not willing to be oneself** · **defiantly willing to be oneself** without the God-relation.
- ANALYSIS: Kierkegaardian despair ≠ **Sartrean desespoir*** (not relying on outcomes beyond one's action).

F. Kierkegaard: indirect communication and pseudonymity

- **Promoted to Core, 15 Aug 2026** - marks-essential for subjectivity and anti-Hegel questions.
- Six steps: objective truth transmissible -> existential truth is a **mode of existing** -> direct transmission **falsifies** -> **indirect communication** -> **Socratic maieutics**, "**deceives into the truth**", **vanishing occasion** -> **pseudonymity**.
- Pseudonyms as **existence-possibilities**: **Eremita** · **de Silentio** (admires faith, lacks it) · **Constantius** · **Haufniensis** · **Climacus** (not a Christian) · **Anti-Climacus** (above the author).
- **Double authorship**: the signed *Upbuilding Discourses* are the **direct pole**.
- "**First and Last Declaration**" (1846): "author's author", **prompter (souffleur)**, quote the pseudonym.
- Objections: **unattributability** (reply: signed pole + *Point of View*, itself disputed) · **self-undermining** (reply: Climacus **revokes** the *Postscript*) · Hegelian sublation.

G. Sartre: existence precedes essence

- **Paper-knife (coupe-papier)**: artisan -> design -> object, so **essence precedes existence** for artefacts; theism applied this to man.
- **Atheism is a PREMISE**: no divine artisan -> no antecedent blueprint.
- "Man first of all exists, encounters himself, surges up in the world - and defines himself afterwards."
- ANALYSIS: **Facticity constrains**; "man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" is the **lecture's** formula and must be balanced by **situation**.
- Provenance: lecture **Oct 1945**, published **1946**; *Being and Nothingness* is **1943**; Sartre **regretted** the lecture.
- **Heidegger repudiates** it (1946/47): **Section 9** is **ontological**; Sartre merely **reverses** the priority and stays in the **metaphysics of subjectivity**; man is the **shepherd of Being**.
- **Kierkegaard** never wrote it and could not accept the premise.
- Objection: **decisionism** / no value-criteria (Murdoch; Marxists).

H. Sartre: in-itself and for-itself

- **En-soi**: full, solid, **self-identical**, opaque - "**it is what it is**"; contingent, "**de trop**" (root of **nausea**).
- **Pour-soi**: nihilating, self-surpassing, never self-identical - "**it is what it is not and is not what it is**".
- "**Is what it is not**" = ahead of itself, defined by a **future** that does not exist. "**Is not what it is**" = cannot coincide with **past/facticity** (the waiter).
- **Nihilation (neantisation)**: consciousness stands back and negates - questions, imagines, projects. The for-itself is "the being by which **nothingness** comes into the world".
- **Impossible synthesis**: *pour-soi-en-soi* = **God** = contradiction -> "**man is a useless passion**".

- ANALYSIS: **Ontological**, not mind-matter. Objection: is non-self-identity coherent? **Contested**.

I. Sartre: freedom, choice and the three moods

- Freedom is **what the for-itself is**, not what it has. "**Man is condemned to be free**" (1945/46). "Thrown" is Heidegger's word.
- **Non-choice is choice**: "I can always choose, but if I do not choose, I am still choosing" - usually **bad faith**.
- **Anguish** (*angoisse*) - vertigo before my own freedom. **Abandonment** (*délaissement*) - no *a priori* values in an "intelligible heaven". **Despair** (*désespoir*) - no reliance on outcomes beyond my action.
- "**In choosing myself, I choose man**" - quasi-Kantian universalisability; source of the **weight** and the anguish.
- Tension: universalisability against the denial of objective values; reply = the **form** is inherent in free choice; *Notebooks for an Ethics* unfinished.
- Two boundaries: freedom is **situated**; "**no excuses**" = responsibility for taking up motives.

J. Sartre: facticity, transcendence and bad faith

- **Facticity** = body, past, social position, situation. **Transcendence** = freedom to negate and project.
- **Bad faith** (*mauvaise foi*) = the **collapse of the tension** into one dimension - not ordinary lying.
- **The waiter** - denial that a role **exhausts** the for-itself; role-performance alone is **not automatically** bad faith.
- **The woman on the date** - the **double lie**: denies her **transcendence** (a body-object) *and* the **facticity** of the gesture (treated as neutral).
- **Paradox**: must know and not know. **Freudian unconscious rejected** -> **pre-reflective, non-thetic** awareness in a non-self-identical consciousness. CAUTION: Contested (Fingarette).
- 2018 chain: **bad faith (project)** -> **inauthenticity (mode)** -> **alienation (cost)**.
- Everyday form: the **serious spirit**. Residue: **no completed positive doctrine of authenticity**.

K. Sartre: freedom and determinism

- A **motive** guides action only through the **meaning** conferred on it; conferral is an act of the for-itself -> **no motive determines unless constituted as one**.
- Determinism misdescribes the *pour-soi* as an *en-soi*: the problem is **false**.
- "**You can always make something out of what you have been made into**": facticity **conceded** + transcendence **asserted** + "always" is **structural**.
- Objection: oppression limits **action and the cognitive range** (Merleau-Ponty; Marxists; **de Beauvoir, Fanon**).
- Reply: freedom of **consciousness** vs freedom of **action** - real, but **weakening**.
- **Critique of Dialectical Reason 1960**: **scarcity, seriality, practico-inert, group-in-fusion** - a **concession**, never the doctrine of 1943.

L. Sartre: the Look and being-for-others

- **Keyhole**: absorbed (**no ego**, pre-reflective, nothing to be ashamed of) -> **caught** -> an **outside** is conferred -> **shame**.
- "**Shame is by nature recognition**"; "**the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me**".
- Printed subterms: *le regard · l'être-pour-autrui · la honte · le corps-pour-autrui · conflit*.
- Two failing strategies: **assimilate** (love, language, masochism) - being loved is being made an object; **transcend** (indifference, desire, sadism, hate) - an object cannot confer recognition; hate seeks a disappearance that leaves being-for-others intact.
- "**Conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others**"; *Huis clos* **1944**; Sartre's **1965** correction - the characters are **dead**, i.e. fixed.
- **P1-P4**, esp. **P3 subject/object exclusivity**; the "we-subject" is discussed and rejected.
- Four accounts: **Husserl** (pairing, appresentation) · **Heidegger** (*Mitsein*) · **Sartre** (the Look) · **Levinas** (the face, ethical asymmetry) - **unanswered** in 1943.
- ANALYSIS: **Bounded content**: one development, never the spine of a freedom answer.

M. Heidegger: the Being-question and the break with the transcendental ego

- Project = **fundamental ontology**: the **meaning of Being**, not an existentialist psychology.
- **Ontological difference**: **Being** (intelligibility) $\neq$ **beings**; Being is **not a supreme entity**.
- Dasein chosen because it has a **pre-ontological understanding of Being** and **its own Being is at issue**.
- **Section 9**: "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence" -> **existentialia**, not categories.
- **Epoche*** = **Husserl's** suspension of the existence-posit, residue = transcendental subjectivity - **one accurate sentence**, Topic 09.
- Objection: the reduction **begins from reflection** and presupposes a spectator; the **primordial** condition is **already-involved being-in-the-world**; **subject and object are derivative**.
- ANALYSIS: He **redirects** description, does not abandon it. **WRONG**: Not spatial containment; **WRONG**: not Sartrean consciousness.
- *Being and Time* **1927** is **unfinished**; the **turn** (*Kehre*) followed.

N. Heidegger: being-in-the-world and worldhood

- **Unitary** structure; the hyphens block decomposition; the Cartesian bridge problem is **dissolved**, not solved.
- **Worldhood** = **referential context of meaning**, not the totality of objects.
- **Ready-to-hand** (*Zuhandenheit*) is **primary**; **present-at-hand** (*Vorhandenheit*) is **derivative** - a **modification** of practical engagement.
- **In-order-to** (*Um-zu*) chain: hammer -> nail -> board -> house -> **dwelling**, a possibility of Dasein's own being. There is no such thing as one piece of equipment.
- **Breakdown**: **unusability** · **absence** · **obstruction** -> the network becomes **conspicuous**; ANALYSIS: significance is **not** erased.

O. Heidegger: the existentialia and care

- **Attunement** (*Befindlichkeit*) - always already in a **mood** (*Stimmung*); mood **discloses**, never colours; even indifference is a mood.
- **Understanding** (*Verstehen*) - **projection upon possibilities**; practical know-how, not cognition.
- **Discourse** (*Rede*) - the **articulation** of understanding; condition of speech and listening.
- Together = **disclosedness** (*Erschlossenheit*) = the **"there"** (*Da*).
- **Care** (*Sorge*, **Section 41**): **"ahead-of-itself - already-in - alongside"** = projection · thrownness/attunement · concern/falling.
- ANALYSIS: **Ontological**, not psychological: it makes worry **and** indifference possible.
- **Concern** (*Besorgen*, equipment) vs **solicitude** (*Fürsorge*, other Dasein); **being-with** (*Mitsein*, **Section 26**) is **constitutive**.

P. Heidegger: das Man, death and authenticity

- Authenticity/inauthenticity = **existential modifications**, not moral categories; inauthenticity is the **default** - *zunächst und zumeist* - and is **structural**.
- **Das Man** is the **impersonal anyone**, not "other people": **idle talk** (*Gerede*) · **curiosity** (*Neugier*) · **ambiguity** (*Zweideutigkeit**), each a **deficient mode**.
- **Falling** (*Verfallen*) - ontological structure, **not** a fall from grace.
- **Call of conscience** (**Section 54-60**) - **silent**, **no rule**, returns Dasein to its **null** responsibility.
- **Death** (**Section 46-53**) - **ownmost** · **non-relational** · **certain** · **indefinite as to when**; a **possibility**, not an event. Inauthentic: **"one dies"** (*man stirbt*).
- **Anticipatory resoluteness** (*vorlaufende Entschlossenheit*) -> existence **as a whole**; individualisation **modifies**, does not abolish, **being-with**.
- Four things it is not: moral goodness · "true to yourself" · individualism/withdrawal · fear of dying.
- Objections: **formal emptiness** (1933; **Adorno's** "jargon of authenticity") · **Levinas** (the Other) · **Arendt** (**natality**).

Q. Heidegger: temporality and historicity

- **Temporality is the meaning of care** - Division Two's central thesis.
- **Ahead-of-itself** -> **future** (*Zukunft*) · **already-in** -> **having-been** (*Gewesenheit*) · **alongside** -> **present** (*Gegenwart*).
- ANALYSIS: *Gewesenheit* = the past Dasein **still is**, not elapsed time.
- **Ecstases**, not segments: Dasein stands out into all three **simultaneously**; temporality is a **finite unity**.
- **Priority of the future**; authenticity is **futural**; anticipatory resoluteness gathers existence **as a whole**.
- **Ordinary time** (*innerzeitige Zeit*) = infinite **now-series**, clock-measured, **derived** via **world-time and public dating**.
- ANALYSIS: "**Vulgar**" = a **levelled interpretation**, **not** a moral defect; clock-time is indispensable.
- **Historicity** (*Geschichtlichkeit*): possibilities are **inherited** and **projected**.
- **Division III never published**.

R. Fear and anxiety, the criticism ledger and exam craft

- **Fear**: determinate object; flees **toward** the world. **Anxiety**: **no object**; **individualises**; discloses a **structure**.
- **K**: possibility, "dizziness of freedom". **H (Section 40)**: "**complete insignificance**"; in-the-face-of-which = for-which = **being-in-the-world**; *solus ipse*; **1929** the **Nothing**. **S**: **cliff path** and **gambler**; anguish ≠ **nausea**.
- Six-step argument: moods disclose -> fear discloses an entity -> anxiety has none -> yet has content -> so a **structure** -> hence **privileged**. CAUTION: Naturalist objection met, not defeated.
- **Sartre ledger**: implausibility (conceded 1960) · bad-faith coherence · **decisionism** · universalisability tension · constraint.
- **Heidegger ledger**: **formal emptiness** · unfinished Division III · Levinas/Arendt · obscurity (Carnap 1932) · political ambiguity.
- **Kierkegaard ledger**: **fideism** · thin institutions/community (**genuine weakness**) · elitism · relativism (a **misreading**).
- **Movement-level**: subjectivism (three replies) · pessimism (**disclosive structures**) · social abstraction (**partial** replies - concede the residue).
- **Debate grid**: God · core term · path · freedom · temporality · enemy · Hegel · mood.
- **Directive fidelity**: statement questions -> **locate in the thinker's system first**; "critically" -> assessment **dominates**; verdicts are **graded 10/15/20**.
- **Four cheap marks**: cite by **Section**, name the **translation**, date the **slogans** to 1945/46, quote the **pseudonym**.
- **WRONG**: Never: "the existentialists held..." · "authenticity = being true to yourself" · "*Being and Time* is complete" · "leap of faith" as Kierkegaard's · "nothing noughts" · the slogan as Heidegger's.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The data-complete, terminal-friendly master flow. The text below is byte-identical to the standalone artifact at notes\Final-Learning-Packages\Philosophy Optional\Philosophy Paper I - Western Philosophy\10-Existentialism\04-ASCII-Master-Flowchart\ASCII-Master-Flowchart.txt.

=====

READ TOP TO BOTTOM. 53 PANELS. PURE ASCII. EVERY DATE, SECTION NUMBER,
PSEUDONYM AND TECHNICAL TERM IS EXAMINABLE AS PRINTED.

=====

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/53: THE CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE THREE PRINTED LIMBS

SYLLABUS, VERBATIM

'Existentialism (Kierkegaard, Sarte, Heidegger): Existence and Essence;
Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence; Being-in-the-world and
Temporality.'

NOTE: the paper prints 'Sarte'. The philosopher is Jean-Paul SARTRE.
Preserve the misprint ONLY inside a verbatim quotation of the syllabus.

|

THE ONE MOVE THIS CLAUSE MAKES

STOP asking what a human being IS IN GENERAL.

START asking how THIS finite, situated, dying individual has to TAKE UP
an existence that was never handed over ready-made.

|

THE THREE PRINTED LIMBS, AND WHAT EACH ONE DOES

LIMB 1 EXISTENCE AND ESSENCE removes the BLUEPRINT

LIMB 2 CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND
AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE asks what a person must DO
once the blueprint is gone

LIMB 3 BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND
TEMPORALITY HEIDEGGER'S refusal to let
limbs 1-2 be answered by a
SUBJECT facing a WORLD

ASYMMETRY: limb 3 is ALMOST ENTIRELY HEIDEGGER'S. That is why 2019 Q3(a)
and 2022 Q2(a) are Heidegger questions and 2024 Q4(a) is a comparison.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/53: THE FAMILY-LABEL WARNING - SAY THIS BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

'EXISTENTIALISM' IS A RETROSPECTIVE FAMILY LABEL, NOT A SCHOOL.

KIERKEGAARD died 1855. Never met the word.

HEIDEGGER DENIED he was an existentialist - 'Letter on Humanism',
written 1946, published 1947.

SARTRE ACCEPTED the label and DEFINED it - lecture October 1945,
published 1946.

|

WHAT ACTUALLY UNITES THEM IS A REFUSAL, NOT A THESIS

Each DENIES that the being of a human individual is settled in advance by
a general nature.

KIERKEGAARD against Hegel's MEDIATING SYSTEM

HEIDEGGER against the CARTESIAN SUBJECT who is first a thinking
thing and only then in a world

SARTRE against the DIVINE ARTISAN and the DETERMINIST

UNITY = FAMILY RESEMBLANCE. Overlapping problems, NOT a common creed.

|

WHAT THE CLAUSE IS NOT

NOT PESSIMISM ... anxiety, despair, death are DISCLOSIVE STRUCTURES

NOT NIHILISM K grounds value in faith; S in the responsibility free
commitment generates; H in formal ownership of finitude

NOT WHIM appropriation, choice and resoluteness are SITUATED and
RESPONSIBILITY-LADEN

NOT SELF-HELP ... the clause is ontology, ethics and religious thought

FATAL OPENING: 'The existentialists held that ...'

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/53: THREE PROJECTS SIDE BY SIDE - THE ORIENTATION TABLE

	KIERKEGAARD 1813-1855 THEISTIC	SARTRE 1905-1980 ATHEISTIC	HEIDEGGER 1889-1976 ONTOLOGICAL
CORE TERM FOR THE HUMAN BEING	the single individual (den Enkelte)	being-for-itself (pour-soi) - nihilating consciousness	Dasein - the entity for whom its OWN BEING IS AT ISSUE
AIM	how does a SELF exist BEFORE GOD?	an ontology of consciousness, nothingness and	to REOPEN THE QUESTION OF THE MEANING OF BEING

situated freedom

ENEMY	Hegel's SYSTEM and the CROWD	determinism, bad faith, the 'serious spirit'	Cartesian subject-object dualism, das Man
METHOD	indirect communication, pseudonyms	phenomenological ontology of the for-itself	existential analytic of Dasein
GOD	CENTRAL	DENIED - AS A PREMISE	NOT SETTLED by the ontology
THE SLOGAN	never wrote it	COINED it	REPUDIATED it
AUTHENTICITY	faith, by a LEAP	NO positive doctrine - only the CRITIQUE of BAD FAITH	owning THROWN PROJECTION. A FORMAL modification. NOT a virtue
MOOD THAT DISCLOSES	anxiety (Angest), despair	anguish (angoisse), nausea (la nausee)	anxiety (Angst)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/53: CHRONOLOGY RAIL - THE DATES THAT ARE WORTH MARKS

1813 Soren Kierkegaard born, Copenhagen
1843 EITHER/OR (ed. Victor Eremita) - aesthetic 'A' and ethical Judge
William printed side by side WITHOUT a decision
FEAR AND TREMBLING (Johannes de Silentio) - Abraham, the teleological suspension of the ethical, the knight of faith
REPETITION (Constantin Constantius)
1844 THE CONCEPT OF ANXIETY (Vigilius Haufniensis) - 'the dizziness of freedom'. LOWRIE titles it 'The Concept of DREAD'; HONG 'ANXIETY'
PHILOSOPHICAL FRAGMENTS (Johannes Climacus)
1846 CONCLUDING UNSCIENTIFIC POSTSCRIPT (Johannes Climacus) - 'truth is subjectivity'; the FIRST AND LAST DECLARATION is appended
1848 THE POINT OF VIEW FOR MY WORK AS AN AUTHOR - WRITTEN 1848, PUBLISHED POSTHUMOUSLY 1859. Retrospective; disputed as evidence
1849 THE SICKNESS UNTO DEATH (Anti-Climacus) - despair as MISRELATION
1850 PRACTICE IN CHRISTIANITY (Anti-Climacus)
1855 Kierkegaard dies
1927 BEING AND TIME (Sein und Zeit) - PUBLISHED UNFINISHED. Only Divisions One and Two of PART ONE appeared. Division III ('Time and Being') and the whole of Part Two were NEVER PUBLISHED
1929 WHAT IS METAPHYSICS? - anxiety reveals the NOTHING (das Nichts). 'Nothing noths' / 'the nothing nothings'. NEVER 'nothing nothings'
1932 Carnap's attack on that sentence - see Topic 07, one clause only
1943 BEING AND NOTHINGNESS (L'Etre et le Neant) - the ONTOLOGY. Eng. tr. Hazel Barnes 1956; Sarah Richmond 2018
1944 HUIS CLOS / NO EXIT - 'L'enfer, c'est les autres'
1945 EXISTENTIALISM IS A HUMANISM - DELIVERED October 1945; PUBLISHED 1946. ALL THE SLOGANS COME FROM HERE. Sartre later regretted it
1946 LETTER ON HUMANISM written; PUBLISHED 1947
1960 CRITIQUE OF DIALECTICAL REASON - scarcity, seriality, practico-inert, group-in-fusion. A CONCESSION, never the doctrine of 1943
1962 Macquarrie and Robinson translate Being and Time
1965 Sartre's recorded preface CORRECTING 'hell is other people'
1976 Heidegger dies 1980 Sartre dies
1996 Stambaugh translation of Being and Time (rev. Schmidt 2010)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/53: PROVENANCE AND ATTRIBUTION - FOUR CHEAP MARKS

RULE 1 CITE THE PSEUDONYM.
'Johannes Climacus argues in the Postscript ...', NOT 'Kierkegaard says'. Kierkegaard PRINTED the request himself, calling himself only the 'AUTHOR'S AUTHOR' and a PROMPTER (souffleur).
RULE 2 CITE BEING AND TIME BY SECTION - section numbers survive BOTH translations; page numbers do not.
SECTION 9 the essence of Dasein lies in its existence
SECTION 26 being-with (Mitsein)
SECTIONS 27,
35-38 das Man, idle talk, curiosity, ambiguity, falling
SECTION 40 anxiety

SECTION 41 care (Sorge)
 SECTIONS 46-53 . being-toward-death
 SECTIONS 54-60 . the call of conscience
 SECTION 65 temporality

RULE 3 NAME THE TRANSLATION, OR USE THE SOURCE WORD ONCE.
 Angest = 'dread' (Lowrie) / 'anxiety' (Hong)
 Zuhandenheit = 'readiness-to-hand' (Macquarrie and Robinson) /
 'handiness' (Stambaugh)
 Being and Nothingness: Barnes 1956 vs Richmond 2018 differ
 throughout

RULE 4 SAY WHERE A SLOGAN COMES FROM.
 'Condemned to be free', 'existence precedes essence' and 'man is
 nothing else but what he makes of himself' ALL come from the
 LECTURE of October 1945, PUBLISHED 1946 - NOT from Being and
 Nothingness (1943).

FORBIDDEN: 'leap of faith' as Kierkegaard's own phrase; 'nothing noughts';
 'Being and Time completes the analysis of Being'.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/53: KIERKEGAARD - THE TARGET AND THE STRUCTURAL COUNTER

THE TARGET: HEGEL'S SYSTEM, AS KIERKEGAARD RECEIVES IT
 Reality is the self-development of ABSOLUTE SPIRIT (Geist).
 Every opposition is MEDIATED (aufgehoben) into a higher unity.
 The individual is a MOMENT in a total rational process.
 'The truth is the whole.'
 FENCE: the dialectic and Absolute Spirit belong to TOPIC 05. Two clauses
 of target-setting here, then the counter.

|

THE COUNTER - STRUCTURAL, NOT A COMPLAINT ABOUT DIFFICULTY
 The system explains everything EXCEPT THE EXISTING INDIVIDUAL WHO IS
 SUPPOSED TO UNDERSTAND IT.
 To exist is to be PARTICULAR, TEMPORAL, PASSIONATE and DECIDING - none of
 which is a category the system can accommodate without CANCELLING it.
 THE SENTENCE TO DEPLOY:
 'A LOGICAL SYSTEM IS POSSIBLE; AN EXISTENTIAL SYSTEM IS IMPOSSIBLE.'
 NO SYSTEM CAN CONTAIN THE ONE WHO BUILDS IT: the systematiser must still
 EXIST, CHOOSE and DIE.

|

THE THREE CONTRAST PAIRS THAT CARRY IT

EITHER/OR	vs BOTH/AND	to exist IS to choose one thing rather than another
THE LEAP (Springet)	vs MEDIATION	no argument delivers me from one sphere to the next
INDIRECT COMMUNICATION	vs THE LECTURE	the form must not hand over a result

|

BOUNDED VERDICT
 Kierkegaard EXPOSES a first-person appropriation that a completed system-
 view risks LOSING. He does NOT refute Hegel's ontology and offers NO
 rival comprehensive system. A Hegelian may reply that the existing
 individual is an unreflective stage philosophy SUBLATES.
 PYQ ANCHORS: 2023 Q1(d) 10m; 2020 Q3(a) 20m; 2022 Q4(a) 20m.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/53: KIERKEGAARD - 'TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY' AND ITS THREE DENIALS

ATTRIBUTION
 Argued by the pseudonym JOHANNES CLIMACUS in the CONCLUDING UNSCIENTIFIC
 POSTSCRIPT, 1846. Climacus is a HUMORIST who says explicitly that he is
 NOT A CHRISTIAN - which is exactly why he can pose the problem of
 BECOMING one.

|

WHAT IT ASSERTS
 For ETHICAL and RELIGIOUS truth the MODE OF APPROPRIATION is decisive:
 HOW one holds a belief - with INFINITE PASSIONATE INWARDNESS, personal
 COMMITMENT, RISK - is the locus of truth FOR THE EXISTING SUBJECT.
 WORKED CONTRAST: to 'know' that God exists as an item in a philosophical
 system is NOT the same as EXISTING BEFORE GOD in faith and trembling.

|

THREE DENIALS - WRITE ALL THREE

- (i) NOT relativism. It is not the claim that anything I believe is
true.
- (ii) NOT a denial of objective truth in logic, mathematics or history -
only of its SUFFICIENCY for existential and religious truth.
- (iii) NOT a general theory that FACTUAL truth varies with the passion of

the believer.

WHY THE FORM FOLLOWS

If existential truth is a MODE OF EXISTING rather than a RESULT, it cannot be handed over directly without being FALSIFIED - which is why Kierkegaard writes PSEUDONYMOUSLY and INDIRECTLY (Panels 13-14).

PYQ ANCHORS: 2020 Q3(a) 20m; 2022 Q4(a) 20m; 2024 Q1(e) 10m.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/53: KIERKEGAARD - THE ANTI-RELATIVIST COMPLEMENT

'SUBJECTIVITY IS UNTRUTH'

The dialectical complement, also Climacus. The existing subject is ALSO IN UNTRUTH - in SIN, in FINITUDE, in NON-IDENTITY WITH THE ETERNAL - and therefore NEEDS THE LEAP.

A RELATIVIST HAS NO USE FOR THIS SENTENCE. CLIMACUS CANNOT DO WITHOUT IT. That is the INTERNAL EVIDENCE against the relativist reading, and it should be quoted in every subjectivity answer.

'THE CROWD IS UNTRUTH'

The SOCIAL form of the same point. The anonymous public permits ETHICAL EVASION, because a responsibility DISTRIBUTED among everyone is BORNE BY NO ONE. Authentic existence requires the individual to stand ALONE - before God, or before the ethical demand.

DO NOT MERGE WITH HEIDEGGER'S DAS MAN

STRUCTURALLY PARALLEL, DOCTRINALLY DIFFERENT.

KIERKEGAARD target = evasion of RESPONSIBILITY BEFORE GOD

HEIDEGGER target = a LEVELLING OF POSSIBILITIES, with NO theological content and NO blame attached

TRAP: writing that Kierkegaard's crowd and Heidegger's das Man are 'the same idea in different words' collapses a theological category into an ontological one.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/53: KIERKEGAARD - THE THREE SPHERES AND THEIR COLLAPSES

SPHERE	CORE / MODE	LIMIT - HOW IT COLLAPSES
AESTHETIC Either/Or 1843, ed. Victor Eremita	living for the moment: the INTERESTING, enjoyment, the avoidance of binding commitment; immediacy, detachment, IRONY	BOREDOM, FRAGMENTATION, DESPAIR. Nothing binds, so nothing holds the self together
ETHICAL Judge William	living by UNIVERSAL DUTY: commitment, marriage, vocation, transparency; the self as responsible agent under universal categories	GUILT. The ethical demand cannot be perfectly fulfilled, and the UNIVERSAL cannot accommodate the individual's anguished singularity
RELIGIOUS Johannes de Silentio, Fear and Trembling 1843	standing BEFORE GOD as a singular individual; faith as 'THE ABSURD'; infinite passion	PARADOX. Faith is not rational, not universal, not mediated by the crowd or the church

THEY ARE QUALITATIVE SPHERES, NOT CHRONOLOGICAL STAGES.

One does NOT 'grow out of' the aesthetic by maturation.

RELAPSE IS ALWAYS POSSIBLE.

The English word 'stages' is standard in translation, which is exactly why the qualification must be written explicitly.

THE SPHERES ARE THE CONTENT OF WHICH 'TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY' IS THE FORM: appropriation INTENSIFIES from dispersion through duty to the absolute relation. 2022 Q4(a) asks for both, in that order.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/53: KIERKEGAARD - THE LEAP, THE SUSPENSION, AND THE TWO KNIGHTS

THE LEAP (Springet)

Transition between spheres is a QUALITATIVE CHOICE - not a Hegelian deduction, not a psychological development.

PROVENANCE CAUTION: Kierkegaard writes of THE LEAP and of FAITH. The fused English phrase 'LEAP OF FAITH' belongs to the ENGLISH TRADITION.

Write: 'the leap - what the English tradition calls the leap of faith.'

|

THE TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION OF THE ETHICAL

Analysed by JOHANNES DE SILENTIO in FEAR AND TREMBLING (1843) through ABRAHAM, commanded to sacrifice Isaac. The ETHICAL (the universal) is SUSPENDED in relation to a higher TELOS - the absolute relation to the Absolute.

THE TEXT STAGES THE PARADOX OF FAITH. It must NOT be cited as Kierkegaard's straightforward LICENCE for private revelation to override morality.

'DE SILENTIO' = the SILENCE of one who ADMIRES faith but DOES NOT HAVE it - he can DESCRIBE Abraham but not UNDERSTAND him.

|

THE TWO KNIGHTS - THE DIFFERENCE IS THE DOCTRINE

KNIGHT OF INFINITE RESIGNATION gives the finite UP, and the renunciation SHOWS. Visibly heroic, visibly apart from ordinary life.
KNIGHT OF FAITH gives it up AND RECEIVES IT BACK. OUTWARDLY INDISTINGUISHABLE from a bourgeois citizen: lives FULLY in the finite world WHILE relating absolutely to the Absolute.

THE DOUBLE MOVEMENT: infinite resignation FIRST, THEN faith - which is why faith is HIGHER than resignation, not easier.

USE: the fastest available refutation of 'existentialism is world-denying'.

OBJECTION: FIDEISM / IRRATIONALISM. REPLY: reason is not WRONG but LIMITED - it cannot deliver what the religious individual needs. Whether that is a reductio or a valid critique of rationalism DEPENDS ON ONE'S EPISTEMOLOGY. Leave the verdict open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/53: KIERKEGAARD - ANXIETY AS THE DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM

SOURCE THE CONCEPT OF ANXIETY, 1844, by VIGILIUS HAUFNIENSIS ('watchman of Copenhagen'), writing as a PSYCHOLOGICAL OBSERVER and deliberately NOT as a dogmatician. Lowrie's title: THE CONCEPT OF DREAD.

|

OBJECT NONE. 'THE OBJECT OF ANXIETY IS A NOTHING.'

WHAT APPEARS POSSIBILITY - 'the possibility of being able'

FORMULA 'ANXIETY IS THE DIZZINESS OF FREEDOM'

AMBIVALENCE 'a SYMPATHETIC ANTIPATHY and an ANTIPATHETIC SYMPATHY'
- we are DRAWN to what we SHRINK from

CANONICAL EXAMPLE . the man at the edge of an abyss grows dizzy - but
'THE DIZZINESS IS AS MUCH IN THE EYE AS IN THE ABYSS'.
The vertigo is not produced by the drop but by the disclosure that NOTHING PREVENTS HIM

IN INNOCENCE there is NO knowledge of good and evil, yet anxiety is
ALREADY there, because freedom's possibility is already sensed

ROLE anxiety is the PRESUPPOSITION of the LEAP by which sin
- and selfhood - enters. NOT its CAUSE: a caused leap would not be a leap

|

TRAP: defining anxiety as INTENSE FEAR. The difference is IN KIND, not degree - fear has a DETERMINATE OBJECT, anxiety has NONE (Panel 33).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/53: KIERKEGAARD - DESPAIR AS A MISRELATION IN THE SELF

SOURCE THE SICKNESS UNTO DEATH, 1849, by ANTI-CLIMACUS - a Christian at an EXTRAORDINARILY HIGH level, ABOVE Kierkegaard himself, and the deliberate MIRROR IMAGE of Climacus, who says he is NOT a Christian

|

THE DEFINITION

THE SELF IS NOT A THING. It is A RELATION THAT RELATES ITSELF TO ITSELF - and, in relating to itself, RELATES TO THE POWER THAT ESTABLISHED IT. DESPAIR = A MISRELATION IN THAT RELATION.

NOT an emotion. NOT sadness. A STRUCTURAL FAULT THAT MAY BE ENTIRELY UNFELT - which is the most examinable feature of the doctrine, because it is what allows the claim that despair is universal to be STRUCTURAL rather than an empirical exaggeration.

|

TWO FORMS

FORM 1 NOT WILLING TO BE ONESELF - fleeing the self one is; wanting to be someone else, or no one

FORM 2 DEFIANTLY WILLING TO BE ONESELF - insisting on being oneself
WITHOUT the grounding God-relation. THE DEEPER FORM, precisely
because it looks like STRENGTH

THE FENCE THAT MUST BE STATED
KIERKEGAARDIAN DESPAIR (theological: a misrelation before God)
IS NOT
SARTREAN DESPAIR (desespoir, 1946 lecture: acting without relying on
outcomes beyond one's control and reasonable probabilities)
SAME ENGLISH WORD. TWO UNRELATED DOCTRINES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/53: KIERKEGAARD - INDIRECT COMMUNICATION IN SIX STEPS

CORE STATUS: promoted OUT of optional-enrichment status on 15 AUGUST 2026.
Marks-essential for any question on subjectivity or the critique of Hegel.

- 1 OBJECTIVE TRUTH - historical, scientific, metaphysical - can be
transmitted DIRECTLY. I state a result, you receive it, and NOTHING
ABOUT YOUR EXISTENCE NEED CHANGE.
- 2 ETHICAL AND RELIGIOUS TRUTH is not a result but A MODE OF EXISTING, an
APPROPRIATION IN INWARDNESS (Climacus, Postscript 1846).
- 3 IF such truth were communicated DIRECTLY, the recipient would take it
over AS A RESULT - as information, as doctrine, as something one can
KNOW WITHOUT BECOMING. THE COMMUNICATION WOULD THEREBY FALSIFY EXACTLY
WHAT IT COMMUNICATES. <-- THE LOAD-BEARING STEP
- 4 THEREFORE ethical-religious truth requires INDIRECT COMMUNICATION
(indirekte Meddelelse): a form that WITHHOLDS THE RESULT, REFUSES TO BE
AN AUTHORITY, and forces the reader to relate to the possibility FOR
HIMSELF.
- 5 THE MODEL IS SOCRATIC MAIEUTICS - the midwife who brings to birth what
the other must produce, and who, in Kierkegaard's phrase, 'DECEIVES INTO
THE TRUTH'. The author must become a VANISHING OCCASION, not a teacher
with a doctrine. The 'deception' is FORMAL, not moral: the reader is
denied a result FOR HIS OWN SAKE.
- 6 THEREFORE PSEUDONYMITY. The pseudonyms are NOT disguises for a shy
author but PERSONIFIED EXISTENCE-POSSIBILITIES, each writing from INSIDE
a sphere of existence it CANNOT SEE BEYOND.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/53: KIERKEGAARD - PSEUDONYMS AND THE DOUBLE AUTHORSHIP

PSEUDONYM	WORK (YEAR)	STANDPOINT WRITTEN FROM
VICTOR EREMITA (ed.)	Either/Or 1843	prints aesthetic 'A' and ethical Judge William SIDE BY SIDE WITHOUT DECIDING - the reader must choose
JOHANNES DE SILENTIO	Fear and Trembling 1843	one who ADMIRES faith but DOES NOT HAVE IT; hence the 'silence'
CONSTANTIN CONSTANTIUS	Repetition 1843	the aesthetic-experimental observer
VIGILIUS HAUFNIENSIS	The Concept of Anxiety 1844	psychological observer of anxiety, deliberately NOT a dogmatician
JOHANNES CLIMACUS	Philosophical Fragments 1844; Postscript 1846	a HUMORIST who is explicitly NOT A CHRISTIAN - which is why he can pose the problem of BECOMING one
ANTI-CLIMACUS	The Sickness unto Death 1849; Practice in Christianity 1850	a Christian at an EXTRAORDINARILY HIGH level - ABOVE Kierkegaard himself; Climacus's mirror image

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/53: KIERKEGAARD - THE DOUBLE AUTHORSHIP AND THE DECLARATION

THE DOUBLE AUTHORSHIP
SIMULTANEOUSLY, AND UNDER HIS OWN NAME, Kierkegaard published the
UPBUILDING / EDIFYING DISCOURSES. The signed religious writings stand
BESIDE the pseudonymous works as the DIRECT POLE of a SINGLE STRATEGY.

Saying this shows pseudonymity is a METHOD, not an evasion.

|

THE PRINTED INSTRUCTION

'FIRST AND LAST DECLARATION', appended to the POSTSCRIPT (1846). He ACKNOWLEDGES authorship while insisting he is only the 'AUTHOR'S AUTHOR', a PROMPTER (souffleur) who produced CHARACTERS, and ASKS THAT ANYONE CITING THEM QUOTE THE PSEUDONYM'S NAME, NOT HIS.

|

OBJECTIONS AND REPLIES

(a) UNATTRIBUTABILITY - the method insulates him from criticism.

REPLY: the signed discourses are the direct pole, and THE POINT OF VIEW (WRITTEN 1848, PUBLISHED POSTHUMOUSLY 1859) gives an explicit account. RESIDUE: that text is a RETROSPECTIVE self-interpretation and is DISPUTED as evidence.

(b) SELF-UNDERMINING - if subjective truth cannot be said directly, the THESIS cannot be said directly either.

REPLY: CLIMACUS CONCEDES THIS - the POSTSCRIPT ENDS BY REVOKING ITSELF. Cross-link in ONE CLAUSE to Tractatus 6.54 (Topic 06) and Hegel's Unhappy Consciousness (Topic 05). Do NOT expound either.

(c) HEGELIAN SUBLATION - the existing individual is an unreflective stage.

COUNTER: no system can contain the one who BUILDS it.

EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the method's COST is that it is SELF-CONSUMING; its POWER is that the cost is INTENDED.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/53: SARTRE - 'EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE': THE ARGUMENT

SOURCE EXISTENTIALISM IS A HUMANISM - lecture OCTOBER 1945, PUBLISHED 1946. NOT Being and Nothingness (1943). Sartre later REGRETTED publishing it.

|

P1 For a MANUFACTURED object, the artisan conceives the DESIGN (essence/function) and THEN produces it. ESSENCE PRECEDES EXISTENCE. SARTRE'S EXAMPLE: the PAPER-KNIFE (coupe-papier).

P2 Theism treats MAN analogously: God conceives 'human nature' and creates individuals to that blueprint.

P3 THERE IS NO GOD.

ATHEISM IS A PREMISE OF SARTRE'S ARGUMENT, NOT A CONCLUSION FROM IT.

C There is NO prior design. 'MAN FIRST OF ALL EXISTS, ENCOUNTERS HIMSELF, SURGES UP IN THE WORLD - AND DEFINES HIMSELF AFTERWARDS.' EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE.

|

WHAT FOLLOWS

No predetermined blueprint EXHAUSTS human reality; the for-itself must TAKE UP a project; RESPONSIBILITY is radical.

WHAT MUST BE QUALIFIED

Biology, history and society form FACTICITY and CONSTRAINT. 'Man is nothing else but what he makes of himself' is the 1946 LECTURE's formula and must be BALANCED BY SITUATION. The slogan denies a PRIOR ESSENCE; it does NOT deny that circumstances limit what can be done.

OBJECTION: if there are NO a priori values, on what basis do I choose?

DECISIONISM (Iris Murdoch, The Sovereignty of Good; Marxist critics).

REPLY: the ENGAGEMENT of choice generates its own criteria. CRITICS FIND THIS CIRCULAR. VERDICT: the doctrine foregrounds PROJECT and RESPONSIBILITY but leaves VALUE-CRITERIA and SITUATED CONSTRAINT UNDERDEVELOPED.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2024 Q4(a) 20m; opening of 2020 Q4(a) 20m.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/53: THE SLOGAN'S OTHER TWO OWNERS - REPUDIATION AND ABSENCE

HEIDEGGER REPUDIATES IT

'LETTER ON HUMANISM', written 1946, PUBLISHED 1947.

* 'THE ESSENCE OF DASEIN LIES IN ITS EXISTENCE' (BEING AND TIME, SECTION 9) does NOT mean 'existence precedes essence' in Sartre's voluntarist sense. It is an ONTOLOGICAL claim: Dasein's 'what' (essence) is not a fixed QUIDDITAS but its very MANNER OF BEING - its being-open-to-Being, its EXISTENZ, its standing-out into the clearing of Being.

* SARTRE MERELY REVERSES the essence/existence priority WHILE KEEPING the humanistic framework, with man at the centre. He therefore remains inside the METAPHYSICS OF SUBJECTIVITY.

* The question is not man's SELF-CREATION but BEING. Man is the 'SHEPHERD OF BEING', not the LORD OF BEINGS.

|

KIERKEGAARD NEVER WROTE IT

He died in 1855 and could not accept its PREMISE: the God-relation is what makes the single individual possible at all. His refusal of an antecedent essence takes an entirely different form - the EXISTING INDIVIDUAL who cannot be completed inside a system.

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WHAT THE THREE ACTUALLY SHARE - THE CORE OF ANY 2024 Q4(a) ANSWER

ALL THREE DENY that a general essence settles in advance what it is for THIS individual to exist. HOW they deny it differs:

SARTRE by REMOVING THE DESIGNER

HEIDEGGER by RECONCEIVING WHAT 'ESSENCE' MEANS for the entity whose being is at issue

KIERKEGAARD by insisting that EXISTING IS A TASK, not a classification

TRAP: 2024 Q4(a) asks what 'the existentialist THINKERS' mean by the slogan. CORRECT THE ATTRIBUTION WHILE ANSWERING - do not merely complain about the premise.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/53: SARTRE - BEING-IN-ITSELF AND BEING-FOR-ITSELF

	EN-SOI (being-in-itself)	POUR-SOI (being-for-itself)
NATURE	full, solid, SELF-IDENTICAL, opaque	NIHILATING, self-surpassing, NEVER self-identical
FORMULA	'IT IS WHAT IT IS'	'IT IS WHAT IT IS NOT AND IS NOT WHAT IT IS'
EXAMPLES	a stone, a table - they simply ARE	consciousness - always BEYOND itself, intending what it is not, negating what it is
FREEDOM	NONE - determined, complete	structurally INESCAPABLE yet SITUATED and FACTICAL
TEMPORALITY	not defined by projective temporal transcendence	ECSTATIC - related to past facticity and future project
CONTINGENCY / RELATION	groundless, brute - 'DE TROP', in excess. This is the ontological root of NAUSEA	DESIRES to BECOME en-soi while remaining conscious - which is IMPOSSIBLE

THE DISTINCTION IS ONTOLOGICAL, NOT A MIND-MATTER DUALISM.

EN-SOI IS NOT 'MATTER'. POUR-SOI IS NOT 'MIND'. A mental state considered as a COMPLETED FACT would be en-soi. This correction belongs in the FIRST THREE LINES of any answer on the pair.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2025 Q1(c) 10m.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/53: SARTRE - NIHILATION AND THE IMPOSSIBLE SYNTHESIS

'CONSCIOUSNESS IS WHAT IT IS NOT AND IS NOT WHAT IT IS' - UNPACK BOTH HALVES

'IS WHAT IT IS NOT' consciousness is always AHEAD OF ITSELF, projecting toward possibilities it does not yet possess. It IS (is defined by) its FUTURE - WHICH DOES NOT YET EXIST.

'IS NOT WHAT IT IS' consciousness can NEVER COINCIDE with its PAST or its FACTICITY. THE WAITER is a waiter (facticity) and simultaneously IS NOT a waiter (he transcends the role, is free to quit).

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HOW IS THIS POSSIBLE? NIHILATION (neantisation)

Consciousness introduces NOTHINGNESS (neant) into being: it STANDS BACK from what is and NEGATES it - QUESTIONS it, IMAGINES alternatives, PROJECTS beyond it. Those three are the concrete faces of nihilation. THE POUR-SOI IS 'THE BEING BY WHICH NOTHINGNESS COMES INTO THE WORLD'.

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THE IMPOSSIBLE SYNTHESIS

The pour-soi PERPETUALLY DESIRES to become en-soi - full self-identity WHILE REMAINING CONSCIOUS. That would be a POUR-SOI-EN-SOI = GOD, and it is a CONTRADICTION. Human reality is defined by this impossible desire: hence 'MAN IS A USELESS PASSION'.

|

WHAT THE SINGLE STRUCTURE GENERATES

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/53: SARTRE - FACTICITY, TRANSCENDENCE AND BAD FAITH

THE STRUCTURE

Human reality has TWO DIMENSIONS AT ONCE:

FACTICITY (facticite) - the GIVEN: body, past, social position,
situation

TRANSCENDENCE - the SELF-SURPASSING: freedom to NEGATE my facticity, to
project myself beyond what I presently am

BAD FAITH (mauvaise foi) occurs when I identify EXCLUSIVELY WITH ONE
DIMENSION AT THE EXPENSE OF THE OTHER.

IT IS THE COLLAPSE OF THE TENSION - NOT 'LYING TO ONESELF' IN GENERAL.

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THE TWO CANONICAL EXAMPLES

THE WAITER

He performs the role with exaggerated, THING-LIKE precision.

READ IT CAREFULLY: Sartre reads this as DENIAL THAT A SOCIAL ROLE
EXHAUSTS THE FOR-ITSELF. ROLE-PERFORMANCE ALONE IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY
BAD FAITH. The bad faith lies in the CLAIM TO BE the role IN THE MODE
OF THE IN-ITSELF, not in doing the job well.

THE WOMAN ON THE DATE - A DOUBLE LIE

A man takes her hand; she leaves it there, 'not noticing', treating the
hand as a mere physical thing.

(i) She denies her TRANSCENDENCE - her freedom to accept or reject the
advance - by reducing herself to pure FACTICITY, a body-object.

(ii) She simultaneously denies the FACTICITY of the gesture - its
sexual meaning - by treating it as purely neutral.

TWO DENIALS, IN OPPOSITE DIRECTIONS, IN ONE ACT.

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EVERYDAY SOCIAL FORM: THE 'SERIOUS SPIRIT' - treating values as though they
were PROPERTIES OF THE WORLD rather than products of commitment.

BAD FAITH IS A PERMANENT TEMPTATION, NOT A RARE PATHOLOGY, because the
tension it flees is CONSTITUTIVE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 23/53: SARTRE - THE PARADOX OF SELF-DECEPTION AND ITS SOLUTION

THE PARADOX

To deceive MYSELF I must SIMULTANEOUSLY

KNOW the truth in order to CONCEAL it

NOT KNOW it in order to BE DECEIVED

SARTRE REJECTS THE FREUDIAN UNCONSCIOUS, so he CANNOT split the person
into a DECEIVING CENSOR and a DECEIVED SUBJECT.

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SARTRE'S SOLUTION

CONSCIOUSNESS IS NON-SELF-IDENTICAL - the pour-soi 'is what it is not and
is not what it is' (Panel 18) - so it can hold TRUTH and DENIAL in a
SINGLE PRE-REFLECTIVE STANCE: I am aware NON-THETICALLY without
reflectively AVOWING. NO SECOND PERSON INSIDE THE PERSON IS REQUIRED.

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STATUS

CONTESTED. Fingarette (SELF-DECEPTION) and analytic philosophy of mind
press whether a non-thetic awareness can do the work. STATE THE
OBJECTION AND RULE ON IT; do not present the solution as settled.

TRAP: 'solving' the paradox by invoking the unconscious CONTRADICTS the
position being expounded, and removes the reason Sartre needs the
non-self-identity thesis in the first place.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/53: SARTRE - THE 2018 CHAIN: BAD FAITH TO ALIENATION

BAD FAITH THE PROJECT. Treating oneself as ONLY facticity or ONLY
transcendence in order to FLEE RESPONSIBILITY.

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v

INAUTHENTICITY .. THE RESULTING MODE. Consciousness DENIES ITS OWN
UNSTABLE FREEDOM and adopts a settled self-description it
cannot honestly hold.

|

v

ALIENATION THE COST. The self lives THROUGH fixed social roles, or
through the OBJECTIFYING LOOK of others, and so relates
to itself AS TO A THING. What was MINE TO ANSWER FOR
becomes something I MERELY AM.

THE THREE ARE NOT SYNONYMS: PROJECT -> MODE -> COST.
2018 Q1(d) IS PRECISELY ABOUT THE CHAIN.

WHAT SARTRE DOES NOT SUPPLY: Being and Nothingness gives a powerful CRITIQUE of bad faith but NO DEVELOPED POSITIVE DOCTRINE OF AUTHENTICITY; the promised ethics was never completed. This is the correct CLOSING QUALIFICATION for any bad-faith answer, and the honest reason Sartrean 'authenticity' cannot be compared straightforwardly with Heidegger's EIGENTLICHKEIT.

EXTERNAL OBJECTION: radical freedom UNDER-DESCRIBES gendered, racialised and material constraint - DE BEAUVOIR, FANON, feminist and postcolonial criticism. REPLY: situated freedom appropriates facticity without being reducible to it; later Sartre broadens social mediation - BUT THE EARLY VOCABULARY REMAINS ABSTRACT. CONCEDE THE RESIDUE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 25/53: SARTRE - FREEDOM AND DETERMINISM, AND THE 2020 SENTENCE

THE KEY ARGUMENT (Being and Nothingness, 1943)

- 1 A MOTIVE - a desire, an emotion, a situation - can become a REASON FOR ACTION only through the MEANING I confer on it.
- 2 Meaning-conferral is itself an ACT of the pour-soi - nihilation, transcendence, projection.
- 3 THEREFORE no motive determines me UNLESS I FREELY CONSTITUTE IT AS A MOTIVE. Remove the project and the same desire motivates nothing.
- 4 THEREFORE determinism MISDESCRIBES the for-itself: it treats a nihilating being as an EN-SOI, a thing among causes. THE 'PROBLEM' OF FREEDOM AND DETERMINISM IS A FALSE PROBLEM.

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THE 2020 SENTENCE, WORD BY WORD

'YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE INTO.'
'WHAT YOU HAVE BEEN MADE INTO' = FACTICITY. SARTRE CONCEDES THE MAKING: class, body, upbringing, history, the gaze of others. THE SENTENCE BEGINS BY GRANTING THE DETERMINIST HIS DATA.
'YOU CAN ALWAYS MAKE SOMETHING OUT OF' = TRANSCENDENCE. The for-itself must still TAKE UP that facticity in a project.
'ALWAYS' = THE STRUCTURAL CLAIM. There is NO SITUATION IN WHICH THE FOR-ITSELF BECOMES A THING. NOT a promise that every outcome is available.

|

THE CRITICISM THAT LANDED, AND THE EVIDENCE THAT IT LANDED

OBJECTION slavery, torture, mental illness and structural oppression limit not only ACTION but the COGNITIVE RANGE of alternatives (Merleau-Ponty, ADVENTURES OF THE DIALECTIC; Marxist critics; de Beauvoir; Fanon).

FIRST REPLY distinguish FREEDOM-OF-CONSCIOUSNESS (I can always interpret) from FREEDOM-OF-ACTION (limited by situation). BUT THIS WEAKENS THE RADICAL THESIS.

DECISIVE EVIDENCE in the CRITIQUE OF DIALECTICAL REASON (1960) SARTRE HIMSELF integrates SCARCITY, SERIALITY and the PRACTICO-INERT, and introduces the GROUP-IN-FUSION. USE IT AS A CONCESSION, NEVER AS THE DOCTRINE OF 1943.

PYQ ANCHORS: 2019 Q4(c) 15m; 2020 Q4(a) 20m.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/53: SARTRE - THE LOOK AND BEING-FOR-OTHERS: SEVEN STEPS

BOUNDED RELEVANCE: necessary for ALIENATION, BAD FAITH and INTERSUBJECTIVITY questions, but it must NOT DISPLACE the printed freedom/choice spine. ONE DEVELOPMENT, NEVER A SECTION.

EXACT PRINTED SUBTERMS: le regard (the Look) - l'etre-pour-autrui (being-for-others) - la honte (shame) - le corps-pour-autrui (the body-for-others) - 'objet-autrui' / 'sujet-autrui' - 'la chute originelle' (the original fall) - CONFLIT as 'the original meaning of being-for-others'.

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THE KEYHOLE - TWO STAGES, LEARN BOTH

- 1 ABSORBED Out of jealousy or curiosity I am bent at a keyhole, looking through. I am WHOLLY ABSORBED: there is NO EGO in my consciousness, only the scene and my project. Consciousness is PRE-REFLECTIVE, non-positional about itself. THERE IS NO SELF TO BE ASHAMED.
- 2 CAUGHT Footsteps in the hall. I AM SEEN. Instantly my whole being is transformed: I am no longer pure surveying transcendence but A PEEPING TOM, an object with a nature, seen from outside, judged.

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THE ARGUMENT

- 1 In being looked at I experience SHAME - and shame is not a private feeling I might have alone; by its structure it is SHAME OF MYSELF BEFORE SOMEONE.
- 2 'SHAME IS BY NATURE RECOGNITION': in being ashamed I RECOGNISE that I

am as the Other sees me. I do not INFER the Other; I LIVE his presence as the condition of my own new mode of being.

3 The Other is NOT reached by explicit inference. Sartre contrasts the Look with Husserlian APPRESENTATION and Heideggerian BEING-WITH - though neither rival is fairly reduced to an argument from analogy or to neutral co-existence. THE OTHER IS GIVEN AS THE SUBJECT FOR WHOM I AM AN OBJECT.

4 THEREFORE 'THE OTHER IS THE INDISPENSABLE MEDIATOR BETWEEN MYSELF AND ME': I acquire an OUTSIDE, a 'nature', a being I AM without having chosen it and without being able to know it from within - my BEING-FOR-OTHERS.

5 The Look reveals a dimension of FACTICITY: the meanings of my acts and my body are constituted from a perspective I CANNOT CONTROL. This is ONE limit on mastery, not the only constraint Sartre recognises.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 27/53: SARTRE - THE LOOK: THE FOUR PRESUPPOSITIONS

PRESUPPOSITIONS

- P1 shame is IRREDUCIBLY RELATIONAL and cannot be analysed away as self-assessment
- P2 pre-reflective consciousness is EGOLESS, so the ego that appears under the Look is genuinely CONFERRED
- P3 SUBJECT AND OBJECT ARE EXCLUSIVE - I cannot be looked-at and looking in the same act, which is what makes RECIPROCITY IMPOSSIBLE
- P4 there is NO THIRD TERM - no 'we-subject' of the kind Marxists posit - that could stabilise the relation. Sartre DISCUSSES AND REJECTS it in Part III

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 28/53: SARTRE - CONFLICT AND THE FOUR ACCOUNTS

6 THE DIALECTIC OF CONCRETE RELATIONS (Being and Nothingness, Part III, ch. 3). Objectified by the Other's freedom, I can respond in only TWO directions - AND BOTH FAIL.

(a) ASSIMILATE the Other's freedom - possess the freedom that judges me WHILE IT REMAINS FREE
FORMS: LOVE, LANGUAGE, MASOCHISM
WHY IT FAILS: love wants to be loved FREELY - but TO BE LOVED IS TO BE MADE AN OBJECT, so the very freedom sought is DESTROYED IN THE POSSESSING. Masochism collapses because I cannot succeed in being PURE OBJECT while REMAINING CONSCIOUS.

(b) TRANSCEND the Other's freedom - reduce him to an object so his look cannot fix me
FORMS: INDIFFERENCE, DESIRE, SADISM, HATE
WHY IT FAILS: AN OBJECT CANNOT CONFER THE RECOGNITION I WANTED; the moment he looks back, the whole structure REVERSES. Hate wants the Other's DISAPPEARANCE - which would leave my BEING-FOR-OTHERS INTACT.

7 THEREFORE 'CONFLICT IS THE ORIGINAL MEANING OF BEING-FOR-OTHERS.'
The line of HUIS CLOS (NO EXIT, 1944) - 'L'ENFER, C'EST LES AUTRES' - follows from this.
QUOTE IT, THEN CORRECT THE POPULAR MISREADING. Sartre explained, in a 1965 RECORDED PREFACE to the play, that the line does NOT mean relations with others are always poisonous; it means that IF one's relations are twisted, the Other's judgement becomes the medium of one's own self-torment - AND THAT THE THREE CHARACTERS ARE DEAD, i.e. FIXED, unable to change their acts. MAKING THIS CORRECTION IS A HIGH-VALUE MOVE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 29/53: SARTRE - THE FOUR ACCOUNTS OF THE OTHER, AND OBJECTIONS

THE FOUR ACCOUNTS OF THE OTHER - A TABLE WORTH MEMORISING

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| HUSSERL | passive PAIRING and APPRESENTATION, not a discursive analogy-inference. The Other is NON-ORIGINALLY GIVEN; ownness-first circularity remains |
| HEIDEGGER | Dasein is ALWAYS ALREADY BEING-WITH (Mitsein). Social existence is CONSTITUTIVE, though Sartre presses for the conflictual concrete encounter |
| SARTRE | the LOOK - the Other is revealed in the SHAME of being objectified. CONFLICT; recognition STRUCTURALLY UNATTAINABLE |
| LEVINAS | the FACE (visage) of the Other, which COMMANDS before it is known. ETHICAL ASYMMETRY - RESPONSIBILITY PRECEDES FREEDOM; explicitly a reply to BOTH Husserl and Sartre |

STRONGEST OBJECTIONS

- (i) Sartre GENERALISES FROM PATHOLOGICAL encounters (peeping Tom,

sadism, seduction). REPLY: the claim is ONTOLOGICAL, not statistical. RESIDUE: strong objection; Sartre's own move to the GROUP-IN-FUSION in the Critique (1960) is the best evidence it landed.

- (ii) LOVE, TRUST and BEING-CARED-FOR are equally basic and are not objectifications. REPLY: Sartre analyses love and finds an internal contradiction - compelling ONLY IF P3 IS ACCEPTED.
- (iii) LEVINAS: to encounter the Other only as a RIVAL FREEDOM is still to think him FROM THE SELF. SARTRE HAS NO REPLY WITHIN BEING AND NOTHINGNESS. THE STRONGEST SINGLE LINE OF CRITICISM.

EXECUTABLE VERDICT: the Look gives a powerful NON-INFERENTIAL account of being exposed to another perspective, but Sartre may GENERALISE CONFLICT from selective examples. Later solidarity, feminist and postcolonial accounts TEST rather than simply repeat the subject/object model.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 30/53: HEIDEGGER - THE BEING-QUESTION AND DASEIN

THE PROJECT: FUNDAMENTAL ONTOLOGY. BEING AND TIME (Sein und Zeit), 1927.

The question is THE MEANING OF BEING. NOT an existentialist psychology. NOT a general ethics of authenticity.

PUBLISHED UNFINISHED: only Divisions One and Two of PART ONE appeared; DIVISION III ('Time and Being') and the whole of PART TWO were NEVER PUBLISHED. NEVER write that Heidegger 'completes' his analysis of Being. Later: THE TURN (Kehre) toward the history of Being, language and art. Whether that is FAILURE or DEEPENING is DEBATED.

THE ONTOLOGICAL DIFFERENCE

BEING (Sein) the INTELLIGIBILITY in virtue of which entities show up AS entities

BEINGS (Seiende) .. the entities themselves

BEING IS NOT ONE SUPREME ENTITY. Treating it as such is the 'onto-theological' mistake Heidegger charges the tradition with. This single distinction blocks the misreading in which 'Being' becomes a metaphysical super-object or a synonym for God.

WHY DASEIN IS THE ROUTE - TWO TEXTUAL REASONS

(i) It ALREADY HAS A PRE-ONTOLOGICAL UNDERSTANDING OF BEING - it copes competently with a world long before it theorises about it.

(ii) ITS OWN BEING IS AT ISSUE FOR IT.

DASEIN IS CHOSEN FOR A METHODOLOGICAL REASON, not because human beings are metaphysically special.

DASEIN IS NOT a biological synonym for 'human being', NOT consciousness, NOT a subject, NOT a soul.

SECTION 9 AND THE REPLACEMENT OF CATEGORIES

'THE ESSENCE OF DASEIN LIES IN ITS EXISTENCE': Dasein's 'what' is not a fixed QUIDDITAS but its MANNER OF BEING. Therefore EXISTENTIALIA (the structures of Dasein) REPLACE CATEGORIES (which apply to things). THIS IS THE SENTENCE SARTRE APPROPRIATES AND HEIDEGGER REPUDIATES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 31/53: HEIDEGGER - THE EPOCHE AND ITS REJECTION

STEP 1 WHAT THE EPOCHE IS - ATTRIBUTE IT TO HUSSERL (TOPIC 09)

The SUSPENSION of the natural attitude's EXISTENCE-POSIT. NOTHING IS DENIED OR DOUBTED; the belief-character is put OUT OF PLAY so that what is given can be described purely. The residue is TRANSCENDENTAL SUBJECTIVITY. It is A CHANGE OF ATTITUDE, NOT A SCEPTICAL DOUBT. ONE ACCURATE SENTENCE. DO NOT EXPOUND TOPIC 09 HERE.

STEP 2 HEIDEGGER'S OBJECTION - IT IS ABOUT ORDER, NOT ACCURACY

A REFLECTIVE SUSPENSION is available only to a SPECTATOR ALREADY SET OVER AGAINST A WORLD. But reflection is NOT the first relation Dasein has to anything: Dasein is PROXIMALLY AND FOR THE MOST PART ABSORBED IN TASKS, using equipment competently and understanding its situation practically. THEREFORE SUBJECT AND OBJECT ARE DERIVATIVE ABSTRACTIONS FROM PRACTICAL INVOLVEMENT, and a method that starts by bracketing the world's existence has SILENTLY RETAINED THE FRAMEWORK IT MEANT TO SUSPEND.

The residue it isolates - a TRANSCENDENTAL EGO - is on this reading NOT the ground of world-disclosure but a LATE ABSTRACTION from a Dasein that was ALREADY disclosing a world.

STEP 3 WHAT HEIDEGGER DOES NOT DO

He does NOT reject careful phenomenological description. He REDIRECTS it - from TRANSCENDENTAL CONSCIOUSNESS to the DISCLOSEDNESS OF BEING through

CARE, EQUIPMENT and TEMPORALITY.

TWO FORBIDDEN EQUATIONS

DO NOT equate BEING-IN-THE-WORLD with SPATIAL CONTAINMENT. Dasein is not 'in' the world as water is in a glass.

DO NOT equate it with SARTREAN CONSCIOUSNESS. The for-itself is still a CONSCIOUSNESS FACING BEING - precisely the framework this structure dissolves.

PYQ ANCHOR: 2018 Q4(a) 20m - three sequenced tasks: DEFINE, REJECT, REPLACE.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 32/53: HEIDEGGER - BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND WORLDHOOD

THE HYPHENS ARE THE DOCTRINE

BEING-IN-THE-WORLD (In-der-Welt-sein) is a UNITARY phenomenon - a SINGLE hyphenated structure, NOT three separate elements (subject + relation + world). It is intended to DISSOLVE the Cartesian split between an inner subject and an external world.

Dasein does NOT first EXIST and then subsequently ENCOUNTER a world; it IS constitutively IN a world - practically engaged, absorbed, concerned. CONSEQUENCE: the Cartesian BRIDGE PROBLEM ('how do I know the external world exists?') DOES NOT ARISE - the gap it bridges was an ARTEFACT of the decomposition. Heidegger treats the PERSISTENCE OF THE DEMAND as the scandal, not the lack of an answer.

WORLDHOOD (Weltlichkeit)

The 'WORLD' is NOT the totality of physical objects (the universe of natural science). It is the REFERENTIAL CONTEXT OF MEANING within which things show up AS SIGNIFICANT.

THE TWO MODES

READY-TO-HAND (Zuhandenheit) - THE PRIMARY MODE. Entities are met as EQUIPMENT (Zeug) that we USE in a practical context. The hammer is NOT first 'an object with properties' and THEN 'used for hammering'; it is ORIGINALLY encountered as EQUIPMENT-FOR-HAMMERING, within a totality of references.

PRESENT-AT-HAND (Vorhandenheit) - entities THEMATISED as OBJECTS WITH PROPERTIES; prominent in THEORETICAL INQUIRY. DERIVATIVE.

THE CLAIM IS ABOUT ORDER OF FOUNDATION: the theoretical stance is a MODIFICATION of practical engagement, NOT the neutral baseline from which practice is a special case. THIS REVERSES THE MODERN ORDER OF EXPLANATION and is the real content of the doctrine.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 33/53: HEIDEGGER - THE REFERENTIAL TOTALITY AND BREAKDOWN

THE REFERENTIAL TOTALITY - THE 'IN-ORDER-TO' (Um-zu)

HAMMER --in-order-to--> drive the NAIL --in-order-to--> fix the BOARD
--in-order-to--> build the HOUSE --in-order-to--> SHELTER
--for-the-sake-of--> DWELLING, i.e. A WAY OF BEING FOR DASEIN
EVERY piece of equipment REFERS BEYOND ITSELF. THERE IS NO SUCH THING AS ONE PIECE OF EQUIPMENT. THE CHAIN TERMINATES NOT IN ANOTHER TOOL BUT IN A POSSIBILITY OF DASEIN'S OWN BEING.

BREAKDOWN - HOW THE OBJECT APPEARS

UNUSABILITY the hammer is too heavy, the head is loose
ABSENCE the hammer is missing from where it should be
OBSTRUCTION something is in the way of the work
-> the equipment-network becomes CONSPICUOUS, and a shift toward explicit OBJECT-THEMATISATION can open.

QUALIFY: BREAKDOWN DOES NOT INSTANTLY ERASE ALL PRACTICAL SIGNIFICANCE.

The workshop does not become a heap of physical objects the moment a tool fails. THIS IS WHERE CARELESS SCRIPTS OVERCLAIM.

FENCE: Descartes' own system - methodic doubt, the cogito, dualism - belongs to TOPIC 02. Here he is the position dissolved, in a clause.

PYQ ANCHORS: 2022 Q2(a) 20m; final third of 2018 Q4(a).

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 34/53: HEIDEGGER - THE EXISTENTIALIA, DISCLOSEDNESS AND CARE

EXISTENTIALIA	GERMAN	WHAT IT MEANS
ATTUNEMENT / STATE-OF-MIND	Befindlichkeit (mood = Stimmung)	Dasein ALWAYS ALREADY finds itself in a MOOD - anxiety, boredom, joy. Mood is NOT a subjective colouring added to an objectively given world; it is a fundamental mode of DISCLOSING the

world and one's situation. 'WE ARE ALWAYS ALREADY ATTUNED' - there is no mood-free access, and even INDIFFERENCE is a mood

UNDERSTANDING	Verstehen	Dasein PROJECTS ITSELF UPON POSSIBILITIES - it understands its world in terms of WHAT IT CAN DO. NOT theoretical cognition but practical KNOW-HOW and projection upon POTENTIALITY-FOR-BEING
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DISCOURSE	Rede	The ARTICULATION of understanding. Dasein's being-open to meaning is always linguistically structured. Discourse is the CONDITION OF POSSIBILITY of both speech and listening. NOT the act of talking - IDLE TALK is a DEFICIENT MODE of it
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TOGETHER THEY CONSTITUTE DISCLOSEDNESS (Erschlossenheit) = the 'THERE' (Da) of DA-SEIN: the fact that BEING IS DISCLOSED for this entity.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 35/53: HEIDEGGER - CARE AS THE BEING OF DASEIN

CARE (Sorge) - THE UNITARY STRUCTURAL WHOLE, BEING AND TIME SECTION 41
 FORMAL DEFINITION - REPRODUCE IT, DO NOT PARAPHRASE:
 'AHEAD-OF-ITSELF -- ALREADY-IN (a world) -- ALONGSIDE (entities encountered within-the-world)'
 (Sich-vorweg -- schon-sein-in -- Sein-bei)
 AHEAD-OF-ITSELF Dasein is always PROJECTING toward its future possibilities UNDERSTANDING, freedom
 ALREADY-IN Dasein is always THROWN into a world and a situation it did not choose FACTICITY, ATTUNEMENT
 ALONGSIDE Dasein is always ABSORBED in its practical dealings with entities CONCERN, FALLING
 CARE IS NOT A PSYCHOLOGICAL ATTITUDE (worry, anxiety). It is the ONTOLOGICAL STRUCTURE that makes ALL particular attitudes and activities possible - INCLUDING INDIFFERENCE, which is a MODE of care, not its absence.

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TWO NEIGHBOURING TERMS, KEPT DISTINCT
 CONCERN (Besorgen) dealings with EQUIPMENT and TASKS - the 'alongside' limb
 SOLICITUDE (Fursorge) .. dealings with OTHER DASEIN, because BEING-WITH (Mitsein, SECTION 26) is CONSTITUTIVE, not added on. DASEIN IS NEVER FIRST SOLITARY AND THEN SOCIAL

WHY MEMORISE THE FORMULA: the three limbs MAP EXACTLY onto the three ecstases of temporality (Panel 32). Learn the two lists together and the hardest 20-marker in the clause becomes ONE DIAGRAM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 36/53: HEIDEGGER - DAS MAN, CONSCIENCE, DEATH AND AUTHENTICITY

THE PRELIMINARY THAT DECIDES THE ANSWER
 AUTHENTICITY (Eigentlichkeit) IS NOT A MORAL VIRTUE, AND INAUTHENTICITY IS NOT A MORAL FAILING. They are EXISTENTIAL MODIFICATIONS - modes of Dasein's SELF-RELATION. Dasein is PROXIMALLY AND FOR THE MOST PART (zunächst und zumeist) INAUTHENTIC - and this is NOT a deficiency but a STRUCTURAL FEATURE of being-in-the-world.
 BOTH 2019 Q3(a) AND 2022 Q2(a) DIRECTLY DEMAND THIS CLARIFICATION.

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INAUTHENTICITY: THE 'THEY' (das Man), SECTIONS 27, 35-38
 Dasein exists WITH OTHERS (Mitsein) and tends to lose itself in what 'ONE' (man) does, says, thinks - the ANONYMOUS PUBLIC.
 DAS MAN IS NOT 'OTHER PEOPLE'; it is the IMPERSONAL NORM-SETTING ANYONE in whose name things are done - and in whose name NOBODY IN PARTICULAR IS ANSWERABLE.

THREE MARKS, EACH A DEFICIENT MODE OF AN EXISTENTIALE:
 IDLE TALK (Gerede) passing along received opinions WITHOUT genuine understanding [of DISCOURSE]
 CURIOSITY (Neugier) flitting restlessly from novelty to novelty; never dwelling [of SIGHT]
 AMBIGUITY (Zweideutigkeit) everything SEEMS accessible, nothing is genuinely appropriated [of UNDERSTANDING]

FALLING (Verfallen): Dasein's tendency to be ABSORBED in the world of its concern and in das Man - losing its 'OWNMOST' self. NOT a theological 'fall from grace'. AN ONTOLOGICAL STRUCTURE, which is why it carries NO BLAME.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 37/53: HEIDEGGER - CONSCIENCE AND BEING-TOWARD-DEATH

THE CALL OF CONSCIENCE (Ruf des Gewissens), SECTIONS 54-60
Dasein is called BACK from dispersal in das Man to its NULL / GROUNDLESS responsibility for TAKING OVER its thrown projection.
THE CALL IS SILENT. IT GIVES NO MORAL RULE AND NO SUBSTANTIVE PROGRAMME.
ITS WHOLE CONTENT IS: THIS EXISTENCE IS YOURS.

BEING-TOWARD-DEATH (Sein-zum-Tode), SECTIONS 46-53

FOUR CHARACTERS - GIVE ALL FOUR:

OWNMOST no one can die for me
NON-RELATIONAL it isolates me from others
CERTAIN it is inevitable
INDEFINITE AS TO WHEN . it may come at any time

AND IT IS A POSSIBILITY, NOT AN EVENT ON A CALENDAR - which is why the analysis is not morbid.

INAUTHENTIC RELATION we FLEE it: 'ONE DIES' (man stirbt), 'everyone dies someday' - COVERING OVER death's INDIVIDUALISING FORCE by making it an event that happens to people in general.

AUTHENTIC RELATION ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS (vorlaufende Entschlossenheit) - I face death as MY OWN possibility, which discloses the FINITUDE and URGENCY of my existence, FREES ME FROM DAS MAN, and lets me take over my existence AS A WHOLE. 'AS A WHOLE' does technical work: only a being that can relate to its OWN END can be grasped as a TOTALITY - the problem Division Two is built to solve.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 38/53: HEIDEGGER - WHAT AUTHENTICITY IS NOT, AND ITS CRITICS

FOUR THINGS AUTHENTICITY IS NOT

NOT 'living a morally good life'

NOT 'being true to yourself' in the popular sense

NOT rugged individualism or social withdrawal - INDIVIDUALISATION BY DEATH DOES NOT ABOLISH BEING-WITH; it MODIFIES HOW DASEIN OWNS ITS ALREADY SOCIAL POSSIBILITIES

NOT contemplating suicide or fearing the empirical event of dying

IT IS: a FORMAL modification of everydayness - OWNING one's THROWNNESS and projecting upon one's OWNMOST possibilities.

THE STRONGEST OBJECTION: FORMAL EMPTINESS

Authenticity prescribes NO CONTENT - so, critics say, A NAZI COULD BE 'AUTHENTIC', a charge sharpened by HEIDEGGER'S OWN 1933 COMPLICITY and by ADORNO'S 'JARGON OF AUTHENTICITY'.

HEIDEGGER'S REPLY: authenticity is DELIBERATELY NON-PRESCRIPTIVE; it tells you HOW to hold your existence, not WHAT to choose.

HONEST VERDICT: THE FORMALITY IS DELIBERATE AND IT IS THE DOCTRINE'S DEEPEST PROBLEM. A criterion that tells you to OWN your choices without telling you WHICH to make can DIGNIFY ANY RESOLUTE COMMITMENT. The defence - that FUNDAMENTAL ONTOLOGY IS NOT ETHICS - is TEXTUALLY CORRECT AND PHILOSOPHICALLY UNSATISFYING.

SECOND OBJECTION: MORBIDITY AND THE OTHER. LEVINAS - the ethical relation to the Other, not death, is primary. ARENDT - NATALITY against MORTALITY. REPLY: death is not morbidity but the DISCLOSURE OF FINITUDE that makes ANY authentic engagement possible, INCLUDING CARE FOR OTHERS. Levinas's alternative remains a POWERFUL COUNTER and should be NAMED, not dismissed. PYQ ANCHORS: 2019 Q3(a) 20m (first half); 2022 Q2(a) 20m (second half).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 39/53: HEIDEGGER - TEMPORALITY, THE ECSTASES AND ORDINARY TIME

THE CENTRAL THESIS OF DIVISION TWO

The MEANING of CARE - and therefore of Dasein's being - is TEMPORALITY (Zeitlichkeit). 'MEANING' here is technical: that in terms of which the structure becomes intelligible AS A UNITY.

ECSTASIS

EXISTENTIAL MOMENT

LIMB OF CARE

FUTURE (Zukunft)
'coming toward'
oneself

Projection, anticipation,
BEING-TOWARD-DEATH

AHEAD-OF-ITSELF

HAVING-BEEN

THROWNNESS, facticity, guilt

ALREADY-IN

(Gewesenheit)
the past I STILL AM

PRESENT (Gegenwart) Absorption in entities, ALONGSIDE
'making present' practical engagement

GEWESENHEIT IS NOT 'THE PAST'. It means HAVING-BEEN - the past Dasein
STILL IS and carries forward AS POSSIBILITY, not a stretch of elapsed time
left behind.

PRIORITY OF THE FUTURE

The FUTURE - Dasein projecting upon its OWNMOST possibility, DEATH - is
the PRIMARY ecstasis. The past and the present are TEMPORALISED OUT OF
the future. AUTHENTICITY IS FUTURAL: in ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS Dasein
RUNS AHEAD to its death and thereby GATHERS ITS EXISTENCE INTO A WHOLE.

'ECSTATIC' - WHAT THE WORD IS DOING

The three dimensions are NOT containers or segments of a line. They are
ECSTASES: Dasein STANDS OUT (ek-stasis) into each SIMULTANEOUSLY.
Temporality is a UNITY of future-past-present in which Dasein holds
itself open. A DIAGRAM OF THREE BOXES IN A ROW MISREPRESENTS IT.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 40/53: HEIDEGGER - PRIMORDIAL AGAINST ORDINARY TIME

PRIMORDIAL TEMPORALITY (Zeitlichkeit)	VULGAR / ORDINARY TIME (innerzeitige Zeit)
ECSTATIC, FINITE, UNIFIED, FUTURAL	a SEQUENCE OF 'NOWS' - past nows gone, a present now here, future nows not yet
the temporality OF DASEIN - how Dasein EXISTS its own being	'time' as measured by CLOCKS - the time IN WHICH events occur
FINITE - bounded by DEATH	INFINITE - the now-series is endless in both directions
the MORE PRIMORDIAL existential condition	DERIVED public/world-time interpretation and clock measurement

THE QUALIFICATION THAT MUST BE WRITTEN

Heidegger DERIVES ordinary now-time THROUGH WORLD-TIME AND PUBLIC DATING
from more primordial temporality. A LEVELLED interpretation CAN
accompany falling - BUT CLOCK-TIME IS NOT THEREBY MORALLY DEFECTIVE OR
PRACTICALLY DISPENSABLE. 'VULGAR' NAMES A LEVELLED CONCEPTUAL
INTERPRETATION, NOT A SIN. SCRIPTS ROUTINELY OVERCLAIM HERE.

HISTORICALITY (Geschichtlichkeit)

Dasein INHERITS possibilities and PROJECTS them. History is an
EXISTENTIAL STRUCTURE rather than merely an external sequence - which is
how the finite, futural self is ALSO A HANDED-DOWN SELF, and which
prevents resoluteness from reading as pure SELF-CREATION.

INCOMPLETENESS: DIVISION III, where the move from Dasein's temporality to
the meaning of BEING AS SUCH was to be made, WAS NEVER PUBLISHED.

COMPARATIVE COUNTERS: SARTRE - temporality grounds FREEDOM and the project,
not a formal ontology. LEVINAS - death individualises excessively; what of
the TEMPORALITY OF THE OTHER?

PYQ ANCHOR: 2019 Q3(a) 20m (second half).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 41/53: FEAR AGAINST ANXIETY - A DIFFERENCE IN KIND

	FEAR (Frygt/Furcht/peur)	ANXIETY / DREAD / ANGUISH (Angest/Angst/angoisse)
OBJECT	A DETERMINATE ENTITY WITHIN THE WORLD - a dog, an examination, a fall	NO DETERMINATE OBJECT. KIERKEGAARD: 'the object of anxiety is a NOTHING'. HEIDEGGER: that in the face of which one is anxious 'is COMPLETELY INDEFINITE'
WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT	the threatening thing	KIERKEGAARD: POSSIBILITY - 'the possibility of being able' HEIDEGGER: BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AS SUCH SARTRE: MY OWN FREEDOM
DIRECTION	I FLEE TOWARD the world, seeking shelter in the	It INDIVIDUALISES: the world's significance COLLAPSES, das Man

familiar	FALLS AWAY, Dasein stands alone
DISCLOSIVE VALUE	discloses a THREAT
	discloses FREEDOM, FINITUDE and the GROUNDLESSNESS of existence - a PRIVILEGED mood (Grundbefindlichkeit)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 42/53: FEAR AND ANXIETY - THE THREE CANONICAL EXAMPLES

THE THREE CANONICAL EXAMPLES - LEARN ONE FROM EACH THINKER

- 1 KIERKEGAARD (INNOCENCE). The man at the edge of an abyss looks down and grows dizzy - BUT THE DIZZINESS IS AS MUCH IN THE EYE AS IN THE ABYSS. In innocence there is no knowledge of good and evil, yet there IS anxiety, because freedom's possibility is already sensed.
- 2 HEIDEGGER (BEING AND TIME, SECTION 40). In anxiety 'THE WORLD HAS THE CHARACTER OF COMPLETE INSIGNIFICANCE': the totality of involvements - the workshop of ready-to-hand things - COLLAPSES, and Dasein is thrown back on its bare THAT-IT-IS. COMPRESSED FORMULA: THAT IN THE FACE OF WHICH ONE IS ANXIOUS AND THAT FOR WHICH ONE IS ANXIOUS ARE THE SAME - BEING-IN-THE-WORLD. Anxiety discloses Dasein as SOLUS IPSE and FREES IT FOR AUTHENTIC CHOOSING. In 'WHAT IS METAPHYSICS?' (1929) he adds that anxiety reveals DAS NICHTS - the Nothing. 'NOTHING NOTHS' / 'the nothing nothings'; NEVER 'NOTHING NOUGHTS'. Source of the sentence CARNAP attacks in 1932 - Topic 07, one clause only.
- 3 SARTRE (BEING AND NOTHINGNESS, PART I). TWO examples, BOTH named.
THE CLIFF PATH. Walking a narrow path above a precipice I feel FEAR of the drop - the loose stone, the gust of wind. Then I realise that NOTHING PREVENTS ME FROM THROWING MYSELF OVER: no barrier within me, no fixed nature. That vertigo is ANGUISH - not fear of the abyss but anguish BEFORE MY OWN FREEDOM.
THE GAMBLER. A man resolved firmly, YESTERDAY, never to gamble again. At the table today he finds yesterday's resolution THERE BUT POWERLESS - it must be REMADE NOW, and nothing guarantees he will remake it. ANGUISH IS THE DISCOVERY THAT MY PAST SELF CANNOT BIND MY PRESENT SELF. THE EXAMPLE MOST SCRIPTS OMIT.
ANGUISH IS NOT NAUSEA: la nausée discloses the CONTINGENCY of the in-itself (de trop); anguish discloses FREEDOM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 43/53: FEAR AND ANXIETY - THE ARGUMENT AND THE NATURALIST REPLY

THE ARGUMENT IMPLICIT IN ALL THREE

- 1 MOODS are not private colourings added to a neutral world; they are ways in which one's situation is DISCLOSED.
- 2 FEAR discloses an entity as threatening, and so KEEPS US WITHIN the world of concern.
- 3 ANXIETY has NO entity as its object; therefore it CANNOT disclose an entity.
- 4 YET it plainly discloses SOMETHING, since it has definite content and is not mere confusion.
- 5 THEREFORE what it discloses is not an ENTITY but a STRUCTURE.
- 6 THEREFORE anxiety is philosophically PRIVILEGED: the one mood in which existence AS A WHOLE becomes an issue.

PRESUPPOSITIONS: P1 moods are COGNITIVELY DISCLOSIVE, not merely affective; P2 the difference between an INDEFINITE and a DEFINITE intentional object is one of KIND; P3 what a rare mood discloses is not thereby LESS REAL.
NATURALIST OBJECTION: anxiety is a pathological or neurochemical state with no cognitive credentials. REPLY: the claim is not that anxious people KNOW MORE, but that the STRUCTURE of the mood - HAVING NO OBJECT - is itself the datum requiring explanation, and no account in terms of an unnoticed object has succeeded. VERDICT: a mood can DISCLOSE A STRUCTURE without becoming INFALLIBLE COGNITION; naturalistic and clinical explanations remain COMPATIBLE COMPETITORS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 44/53: THE CRITICISM LEDGER AND THE INTER-THINKER DEBATE GRID

CRITICISMS OF SARTRE - IN ORDER OF FORCE

- 1 RADICAL FREEDOM IS PSYCHOLOGICALLY AND SOCIALLY IMPLAUSIBLE. Source: common sense; Merleau-Ponty, ADVENTURES OF THE DIALECTIC; Marxists. Reply: freedom-of-consciousness vs freedom-of-action - WEAKENS the thesis. DECISIVE: SARTRE HIMSELF concedes scarcity, seriality and the practico-inert in the CRITIQUE (1960).
- 2 BAD FAITH PRESUPPOSES WHAT IT DENIES. Source: Fingarette, SELF-DECEPTION. Reply: PRE-REFLECTIVE, NON-THETIC awareness. DEBATED.
- 3 CHOICE WITHOUT CRITERIA IS BLIND - DECISIONISM. Source: Iris Murdoch, THE SOVEREIGNTY OF GOOD; Marxist critics. Reply: engagement generates

its own criteria - CRITICS FIND THIS CIRCULAR.

- 4 UNIVERSALISABILITY sits uneasily with the denial of objective values.
Source: Kantians, communitarians. Reply: Sartre CONCEDES TENSION;
NOTEBOOKS FOR AN ETHICS never completed.
- 5 UNDER-DESCRIBES GENDERED, RACIALISED AND MATERIAL CONSTRAINT. Source:
de Beauvoir, Fanon, feminist and postcolonial criticism. Reply:
situated freedom - BUT THE EARLY VOCABULARY REMAINS ABSTRACT.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 45/53: THE CRITICISM LEDGER - HEIDEGGER

CRITICISMS OF HEIDEGGER - IN ORDER OF FORCE

- 1 AUTHENTICITY IS FORMALLY EMPTY; a Nazi could be 'authentic'. Source:
political critics; Heidegger's 1933; Adorno's 'jargon of authenticity'.
Reply: deliberately non-prescriptive. MANY FIND THIS ETHICALLY
IRRESPONSIBLE.
- 2 THE PROJECT WAS NEVER COMPLETED - Division III never published.
Source: INTERNAL. Reply: the TURN (Kehre). Failure or deepening is
debated.
- 3 BEING-TOWARD-DEATH IS MORBID / EXCLUDES POSITIVE SOCIAL BONDS. Source:
Levinas (ethics of the Other), Arendt (NATALITY over mortality).
Reply: death discloses the finitude that makes ANY authentic engagement
possible. LEVINAS REMAINS A POWERFUL COUNTER.
- 4 OBSCURITY - neologisms obstruct rather than clarify. Source: Carnap
(1932), Ayer, Russell. Reply: ordinary language is saturated with the
metaphysical tradition. WHETHER THIS JUSTIFIES THE OPACITY IS
CONTESTED.
- 5 ONTOLOGICAL FORMALITY PERMITS POLITICAL AMBIGUITY. Reply: fundamental
ontology is not a political programme - TEXTUALLY RELEVANT, but it does
not settle whether formal authenticity LACKS CRITICAL NORMS.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 46/53: THE CRITICISM LEDGER - KIERKEGAARD

CRITICISMS OF KIERKEGAARD - IN ORDER OF FORCE

- 1 FIDEISM / IRRATIONALISM. Source: Hegel implicitly; analytic philosophy
of religion. Reply: reason is not WRONG but LIMITED. WHETHER THIS IS
A REDUCTIO OR A VALID CRITIQUE OF RATIONALISM DEPENDS ON ONE'S
EPISTEMOLOGY.
- 2 THIN ACCOUNT OF INSTITUTIONS AND COMMUNITY. Source: secular and social
critics. Reply: despair is a UNIVERSAL STRUCTURAL POSSIBILITY and
responsibility is INDIVIDUAL - BUT THE LIMITED ACCOUNT REMAINS A
GENUINE WEAKNESS. CONCEDE IT.
- 3 ELITISM OF THE INDIVIDUAL. Source: communitarians, Hegelians. Reply:
'the crowd is untruth' because it enables ETHICAL EVASION.
- 4 'TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY' COLLAPSES INTO RELATIVISM. Source: COMMON
MISREADING - an error, not an objection. Reply: WHAT is believed vs
HOW it is believed; 'subjectivity is untruth'.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW - PANEL 47/53: MOVEMENT-LEVEL OBJECTIONS AND THE DEBATE GRID

MOVEMENT-LEVEL OBJECTIONS NEED THINKER-SPECIFIC REPLIES

SUBJECTIVISM / IRRATIONALISM	K: APPROPRIATION, not opinion. S: choice tied to RESPONSIBILITY. H: ONTOLOGY, not the validation of opinion
PESSIMISM	anxiety, despair, death and nothingness are DIAGNOSTIC / DISCLOSIVE structures - NOT the claim that every life is emotionally miserable
SOCIAL ABSTRACTION	feminist, Marxist and postcolonial critics RIGHTLY pressure the early focus on solitary or formally free agents; facticity, being-with and later situated ethics give PARTIAL replies. CONCEDE THE RESIDUE

INTER-THINKER DEBATE GRID - EIGHT AXES

AXIS	KIERKEGAARD	SARTRE	HEIDEGGER
GOD	CENTRAL	DENIED as PREMISE	BRACKETED
CORE TERM	den Enkelte	pour-soi	Dasein
PATH	religious faith	bad-faith	ANTICIPATORY
		CRITIQUE only	RESOLUTENESS
FREEDOM	qualitative choice in a God-relation	radical BUT SITUATED	THROWN PROJECTION
TEMPORALITY	REPETITION and THE MOMENT (Ojeblikket)	ecstatic; freedom NIHILATES the past	Zeitlichkeit - three ecstases, FUTURE- primacy, FINITE

CHIEF ENEMY	Hegel's System, the crowd	determinism, bad faith, the serious spirit	Cartesian dualism, das Man, metaphysics of presence
HEGEL	existing individual vs completed system	uses negation and otherness, rejects teleological totality	REOPENS the Being-question AGAINST metaphysics
MOOD	Angest, despair	angoisse, nausea	Angst - the Nothing

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 48/53: PYQ ROUTING - ALL FOURTEEN OWNED PARTS, 2018-2025

CORPUS SIGNAL: 14 OF 112 PARTS. JOINT-HIGHEST with Rationalism and with Moore-Russell-Early Wittgenstein. AT LEAST ONE PART IN EVERY YEAR.
SPLIT: SARTRE 8, KIERKEGAARD 4, HEIDEGGER 3 (2024 Q4(a) needs all three).

YEAR Q	MK	DEMAND	ANSWER ROUTE
2018 Q1(d)	10	Sartre: inauthenticity, bad faith, alienation	facticity/transcendence evasion -> waiter/date cautiously -> self-alienation -> authenticity difficulty
2018 Q4(a)	20	What is 'Epoche'? Heidegger's rejection; being in the world vs the transcendental ego	Husserlian suspension (ONE sentence) -> Being-question -> Dasein/world unity -> care/equipment -> anti-subjectivist verdict
2019 Q3(a)	20	Is Dasein authentic existence? Temporality and Dasein	Dasein NOT authenticity -> they/falling -> conscience/death -> care's temporal ecstases -> formal-emptiness objection
2019 Q4(c)	15	Freedom of choice and determinism	for-itself/nihilation -> motive meaning -> facticity/situation -> structural constraint criticism
2020 Q3(a)	20	'Subjectivity is the truth' and 'the single individual'	Climacus attribution -> appropriation NOT relativism -> existing individual/Hegel -> indirect communication -> fideism verdict
2020 Q4(a)	20	'You can always make something out of what you have been made into.'	facticity vs transcendence -> situated project -> no excuses QUALIFIED -> oppression/late Sartre
2021 Q4(b)	15	'If I do not choose, I am still choosing'	non-choice as stance -> responsibility/anguish -> bad-faith evasion -> coercion and inability objection

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 49/53: PYQ ROUTING - 2022 TO 2025, WITH ANSWER ROUTES

2022 Q2(a)	20	Being-in-the-world; the problem of authenticity	unitary being-in-world -> worldhood/equipment -> care -> they/death/resoluteness -> non-moral and political critique
2022 Q4(a)	20	Kierkegaard on 'subjectivity'; three stages of existence	pseudonymous attribution -> how/appropriation -> aesthetic/ethical/religious -> qualitative leap
2023 Q1(d)	10	Kierkegaard against Hegel's universal spirit	existing individual -> system closure -> choice/death -> Hegel reply -> bounded verdict
2023 Q3(c)	15	'Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is.'	in-itself/for-itself -> nihilation -> temporality/project -> bad faith -> coherence objection
2024 Q1(e)	10	Kierkegaard: truth in terms of subjectivity	Climacus -> objective truth RETAINED -> existential appropriation -> faith/fideism caution

2024 Q4(a)	20	'Existence precedes essence'; existence and freedom	Sartre-OWNED slogan -> Kierkegaard/Heidegger differences -> three freedom concepts -> family- label verdict
2025 Q1(c)	10	Being-for-itself vs being-in-itself	English-first definitions -> self-identity/non- identity -> nothingness/ freedom -> impossible synthesis

THREE STATEMENT QUESTIONS - 2020 Q4(a), 2021 Q4(b), 2023 Q3(c). FOR THESE THE FIRST MOVE IS ALWAYS TO LOCATE THE SENTENCE INSIDE ITS OWN AUTHOR'S SYSTEM, AND TO NAME THE PAIR OF TERMS IT TURNS ON.
NO OBJECTIVE OR PRELIMS-STYLE PART IS OWNED IN THIS CORPUS, SO NO ANSWER LETTER IS ASSERTED FOR ANY PAST PAPER. UPSC PUBLISHES NO DESCRIPTIVE MODEL ANSWER FOR PHILOSOPHY PAPER I.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 50/53: THE ANSWER SPINE AND THE QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

DIRECTIVE DECODER - WHAT EACH COMMAND WORD OBLIGES YOU TO DO
'COMMENT / ELUCIDATE THE STATEMENT' locate the sentence IN ITS OWN THINKER'S SYSTEM, then unpack the technical terms. Identify the work, the PAIR OF TERMS it turns on, two consequences, a judgment.
FATAL: treating it as a general maxim about life.
'DISCUSS EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE' no divine artisan -> no predetermined blueprint -> persons take up projects IN SITUATIONS. Then Heidegger's rejection. FATAL: attributing the slogan to all.
'CRITICALLY EXAMINE AUTHENTICITY' ASSESSMENT DOMINATES, and the NON-MORAL reading is the marked point. FATAL: 'being true to yourself'.
'DISCUSS BEING-IN-THE-WORLD' THE HYPHENS ARE THE DOCTRINE. Refuse the subject/object split FIRST, then Zuhandenheit/Vorhandenheit, the broken hammer, care, and ONLY THEN temporality. FATAL: 'a human being in the world'.
'HOW DOES KIERKEGAARD OPPOSE HEGEL?' a STRUCTURAL opposition. Existing individual vs the system; either/or vs both/and; the leap vs mediation; indirect communication vs the lecture. FATAL: 'he disliked abstraction'.
'EXPLAIN FREEDOM AND DETERMINISM IN SARTRE' MEANING-CONFERRAL together with FACTICITY. FATAL: pretending coercion or material limits are unreal.
'FEAR AND DREAD/ANXIETY' compare object-directed fear with existential anxiety WHILE PRESERVING THINKER DIFFERENCES. FATAL: one mood theory.
'ASSESS / DO YOU AGREE?' A DEFENDED RULING IN THE FIRST LINE. FATAL: a neutral survey.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 51/53: THE GRADED VERDICT BANK - CLOSE AT THE RIGHT GRADE

GRADED VERDICT BANK - CLOSE AT THE RIGHT GRADE
EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE
10 Sartre's atheistic argument denies a predetermined blueprint; it does not erase biological or social facticity.
15 ...It is SARTRE'S slogan, not existentialism's common creed.
20 The doctrine foregrounds project and responsibility but leaves value-criteria and situated constraint underdeveloped.
RADICAL FREEDOM
10 Freedom is the for-itself's non-coincidence with facticity, exercised ONLY IN SITUATION.
15 ...Motives acquire action-guiding significance WITHIN a project.
20 Coercion, trauma and material structures pressure early radicalism; later scarcity and seriality broaden Sartre without retracting.
BAD FAITH
10 It evades the TENSION of facticity and transcendence.
15 ...Pre-reflective, non-thetic awareness is the proposed answer to the self-deception paradox.
20 Influential but NORMATIVELY INCOMPLETE: positive authenticity remains thin.
THE LOOK
10 Shame discloses myself as object for another subject; not a proof of other minds.
15 ...Improves on inferential models but may generalise conflict.
20 Love, solidarity, de Beauvoir, Fanon and later Sartre pressure subject/object exclusivity - BOUNDED criticisms, not replacements.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 52/53: THE GRADED VERDICT BANK - MOODS, AUTHENTICITY AND METHOD

ANGUISH / FEAR

- 10 Fear has a determinate threat; anxiety discloses possibility, freedom or world-collapse depending on the thinker.
- 15 ...Related but NON-IDENTICAL moods.
- 20 A mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition.

AUTHENTICITY (HEIDEGGER)

- 10 Eigentlichkeit is an existential modification, not a moral achievement.
- 15 ...Anticipatory resoluteness gives Dasein a whole - but prescribes NO CONTENT WHATEVER.
- 20 The formality is deliberate AND it is the doctrine's deepest problem.

KIERKEGAARD VS HEGEL

- 10 No completed system substitutes for the temporal choice of the existing individual.
- 15 ...Leap, either/or and indirect communication resist mediated closure, but Hegel need not simply deny individuality.
- 20 He exposes first-person appropriation that a system-view risks losing; he offers no rival comprehensive ontology.

INDIRECT COMMUNICATION

- 10 Ethical-religious appropriation cannot be handed over as neutral information.
- 15 ...Pseudonyms stage existence-possibilities; attribution must follow their voices.
- 20 Revocation makes the method deliberately SELF-LIMITING.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 53/53: NEVER WRITE, AND THE QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

NEVER WRITE

'The existentialists held that ...' as though the three shared a doctrine
'Authenticity means being true to yourself'
'Being and Time is a completed system'
'Leap of faith' is Kierkegaard's phrase'
'Nothing noughts'
'Existence precedes essence' as Heidegger's or Kierkegaard's

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QUALIFIED CONCLUSION - THE POSITION THIS PACKAGE DEFENDS

'Existentialism' names a SHARED REFUSAL, not a shared doctrine: no general essence settles in advance what it is for THIS individual to exist. Beyond that refusal the three printed thinkers diverge at every point that matters - on God, on method, on what freedom is, and on what authentic existence would be. Kierkegaard's account is powerful against systematic closure and exposed to the FIDEISM charge and to a thin treatment of community. Sartre's is powerful on project and responsibility and underdeveloped on value-criteria and situated constraint, as his own 1960 revision concedes. Heidegger's is the most rigorously ontological and the most normatively empty, and the defence that fundamental ontology is not ethics is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying. An answer that says all this - and says it with the right dates, the right pseudonyms and the right section numbers - has done what this clause asks.

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END OF ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM - 53 PANELS

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